唐人街影话
Showdown in Chinatown

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新警局故事
Fresh Police Story SC-01

It is said that during the Shāng and Zhōu Dynasties, our land was plagued by malevolent creatures. They roamed the land, bringing havoc and leaving the nation and its people in endless suffering.
相传商周时期，天地间魑魅魍魉横行，有恶兽为祸人间，令神州萧条、生灵涂炭。

On the emperor's order, Fāngxiàngshì the Wise sought the assistance of the twelve gods of Shètí. Bestowed with their divine might, Fāngxiàngshì bound the creatures and turned their monstrous power to the service of the people. These creatures became known as the Xiǎndào Beasts, guardians of the perilous path.
幸有大贤方相氏受天子之托，向十二摄提神请愿得巫舞之力，降伏恶兽，收为己用，更名为险道兽。

Now reformed, the beasts were used to drive away evil and protect the land, and thus earned the reverence of the people.
险道兽得摄提神感召，化为驱逐世间鬼疫、护一方安宁的神兽，得万民敬奉。

However, by the end of the Táng Dynasty, there arose many wars and troubles.
然至唐末时，战乱频起。

To preserve the legacy of the Xiǎndào Beasts, the last Fāngxiàngshì entrusted them to the Twelve Zhènzǐ, servants of the ritual, before passing away.
为守险道兽之传承延续，最后的方相氏在仙去之前将其分别托付给十二侲子。

Among the Xiǎndào Beasts, Qiángliáng, whose body was like a tiger with a serpent's tail, was considered unmatched in ferocity.
其中，险道兽强梁状虎衔蛇，凶悍无匹。

The Zhènzǐ who was entrusted with Qiángliáng took Liáng as their surname, passing this knowledge down through their descendants.
得强梁之人后以兽为名，改姓为梁——世代相承。

Liang's Father: *Until today, while the world no longer suffers from the evil spirits of the past and the reputation of our family has lessened, we have never forgotten our ancestors' teaching.*
梁父： 时至今日，虽说世间已不再有妖魔肆虐，梁家也已不像过去那样风光，但家族上下都始终牢记祖训。

Liang's Father: *That is, self-restraint, propriety, righteousness, and the art of banishing evil. Study our family's history, and you will find each generation has lived up to our family name and our motto. To practice restraint, seek justice and expel evil.*
梁父： 守礼克己、秉公持正、将为世间惩奸除恶视为己任。翻开家谱，每一个名字后面必定都是一个行得端坐得正、响当当的梁家子弟。

Liang's Father: *Yet, Qiángliáng had not appeared to us for almost a hundred years.*
梁父： ……然而，险道兽强梁却已有近百年未曾现身了。

Liang's Father: *That was, until you, my daughter—my pride, successfully summoned it after these long years.*
梁父： ——直到你，我最引以为傲的女儿。直到你再一次唤醒了强梁。

Liang's Father: *Do you understand the weight of the expectations you now carry?*
梁父： 你可知自己肩负着何种重望?

His hand rests on the girl's shoulder, its weight like that of the world.
父亲的手落在女孩的肩膀上，重如千钧。

Girl: *I understand. You can trust in me, Father.*
女孩： ……我知道的，爸爸。你就相信我吧。

She has heard this story a thousand times, and for years, this answer has been engraved in her mind, for it is the only answer she has ever been allowed to give.
不需要父亲再次提点，无数次的耳提面命早已让女孩有了答案。
那是她唯一被允许拥有的答案。

Liang Yue: I will not fail our family. I will fulfill my destiny as a worthy master of Qiángliáng.
梁月： ——请您相信我。我一定会完成强梁之主的使命，绝不会辜负家族的期望。

Division of Arcane Affairs, LA
洛杉矶·神秘学犯罪科

Poitier: Morning, guys. Alright, who wants to hit me with some good news and make my day a little easier?
波蒂埃： 早上好，伙计们。
有谁能给我些配得上这个阳光明媚上午的好消息吗?

Arcane Affairs Officer I: The report on that summoning ritual is done. Seems like the destination was some farm out in the sticks.
神秘学警察 I： 召唤阵事件的分析报告出来了，它们连通的是郊外的一座牧场——

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Hey! Did someone take the pendulum without signing it out? We've only got one to go around.
神秘学警察 II： 嘿！谁拿走了署里的公共灵摆?
我还要用呢，怎么也不打一声招呼?

Everyone in the Division of Arcane Affairs is caught up in the chaos of their own work, too busy to notice the officer who has just stepped in.
神秘学犯罪科办公室内，每一名警员都忙得热火朝天，没人理会这位刚刚进门的同僚。

Poitier: Let's try this another way. First three of you to give me some good news will earn yourselves a coffee, my treat.
波蒂埃： ……我带了咖啡，一共三杯，先到先得！

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Get ready, Poitier, cause what I'm about to tell you next is gonna blow your mind.
神秘学警察 I： 哦亲爱的，你真是个天使！今天这是刮的什么风?

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Save me a cup. I gotta find our pendulum thief first.
神秘学警察 II： 给我留一杯！我找出那个拿走了灵摆却没有登记的混蛋后就来！

Apparently, it doesn't take much to become the most popular person in the office. But before anyone can earn a steaming cup of joe, an angry shout interrupts them.
高个子的年轻女警立刻成为了整个办公室中最受欢迎的人，但愤慨的咒骂声打破了这忙里偷闲的咖啡时间。

???: Hello. Excuse me. I'm still here.
???: ——嘿，我还在这呢！

???: *tut* I'm a tax-paying citizen. I pay your salary, so why don't you stop gossiping and do your job?! A crooked stick will have a crooked shadow!
???: 你们这些警察总是这样浪费纳税人宝贵的时间和金钱。
真係“上梁不正下梁歪”……

He shoots Poitier a glare before stomping his way out of the Division of Arcane Affairs, muttering curses under his breath.
男子瞪了波蒂埃一眼，骂骂咧咧地走出神秘学犯罪科的大门。

Poitier: Him again? What's he complaining about this time?
波蒂埃： ……他怎么又来了，这次是投诉什么?

Having brought the missing pendulum back to its place, the officer strides over and grabs a coffee. He shrugs.
找回公共灵摆后匆匆返回的警员接过咖啡，向波蒂埃耸了耸肩。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Ah, some nonsense about making a mistake while we were out searching for a dog in Chinatown.
神秘学警察 II： 说我们不分青红皂白，就跑去唐人街里面寻找市民丢失的狗。

Poitier: A missing pooch? Since when are we the dog patrol?
波蒂埃： 什么？狗?

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Ah. I know. It's not our job. And then he got all huffy about us being brash and naive, and then it was right back to complaining about the incident last year.
神秘学警察 I： 是啊，然后又是那老一套，说我们的人都是些搞不清楚状况的愣头青。
接着当然少不了那个我们耳朵都听出茧子来的例子——

Arcane Affairs Officer II: You remember? When that rookie saw bruises on a kid and kicked up a whole fuss about child abuse? Turned out it was just some traditional Chinese massage. After they got cleared of the charges, the kid's parents were fuming about it for weeks.
神秘学警察 II： 一年前，一名年轻的警员把一个孩子身上留下的中式按摩痕迹，误以为是虐待的伤痕通报了儿童保护组织，险些害那对可怜的父母失去抚养权……

Arcane Affairs Officer II: But like, come on, it's literally a rookie mistake. He apologized, and they forgave him. You'd think that'd be problem solved, right? But this guy just wouldn't let it go. He's not even related.
神秘学警察 II： 那件事上我们的人的确不够谨慎，但误会很快得到了澄清，那个年轻人也亲自登门道歉得到了原谅，不知道他一个无关人员还在耿耿于怀什么。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Still, must have left a bad taste in his mouth, I guess. I just don't get why he's complaining about it to us. We don't find missing dogs. We find critters.
神秘学警察 I： 但我猜那件事就是他看我们科不顺眼的契机，因为这次他根本投诉错地方了。找狗这种事就不归我们管，找魔精才归。

They exchange a glance, and Poitier lets out a sigh.
他们对视了一眼，叹了口气。

Poitier: Well, at least most folks are friendly.
波蒂埃： ……我只能说，我很庆幸并不是所有的市民都是这样的。

Poitier: Yeah, yeah. Well, I was asking for good news. So how about something upbeat?
波蒂埃： 来吧，今天有什么好消息吗?

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Sorry. I've got nothing of that particular flavor. Just the opposite.
神秘学警察 I： 遗憾。只有坏消息。

Poitier: Let me guess. Our "vigilante" struck again?
波蒂埃： ……那家伙又动手了?

The officer drops the morning paper in front of her. As her eyes land on the headline, her coffee suddenly smells bitter.
今晨的报纸被递到了她的眼前。
在看清最上面格外醒目的标题后，手中咖啡的香气似乎也不再诱人了。

Poitier: "The Vigilante 'Nightpiercer' Bestows Justice to L.A. Streets." Urgh, so melodramatic. Who got hit this time?
波蒂埃： “正义的英雄‘针人’现身洛杉矶？恶人再次得到审判”……那些媒体还是这么喜欢夸大其词。这次又是什么人?

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Some rich varsity boys. They got in the news over some hazing incident that put a teammate into the ICU. But, you know how it is. Strings were pulled, and all the charges went away.
神秘学警察 I： 一伙富家公子哥为了取乐，把自己的队友弄进了重症监控室，结果连拘留室都没进，派去的警察直接被老爹们安排的律师请回去了。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: But, get this: all of them were found pinned up on the school's fencing this morning, and with those injuries, looks like they can kiss college football goodbye.
神秘学警察 II： 今天早上，他们被发现叫人钉在了学校体育场的围栏上……
别说打球了，大概下半辈子都要和轮椅拐杖打交道。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Hate to say it, but I gotta side with the vigilante on this one. Those kids were monsters. Still ...
神秘学警察 I： 如果要是问我个人的感想，我肯定没办法同情那群家伙，我太清楚学校里的那种货色是什么德性了。但……

Arcane Affairs Officer II: We're the police, and crime is crime. Doesn't matter how scummy the victims might be.
神秘学警察 II： 我们是警察，而我们那位“正义的英雄”是在犯罪，他的所作所为绝不是值得推崇的。

Irritated, Poitier tosses the newspaper onto one of the many cluttered desks around her.
波蒂埃烦闷地将手中的报纸丢到了一旁不知道哪个同事乱糟糟的桌子上。

Poitier: The arcane skill this guy cast, using those needles? It's like he's trying to imitate Detective C07. What's up with that?
波蒂埃： 如果真的是个为民除害的英雄也就罢了，但使用“飞针神秘术”?
他是在模仿 C07 吗？透着一种哗众取宠的味道……

Arcane Affairs Officer I: C07, like from the movie series? Don't act so surprised I've seen them. You know I love movies about arcanum.
神秘学警察 I： 哦，你说那个电影《神秘警探 C07》？我看过，我爱神秘学电影。

Poitier: So, do we got anything?
波蒂埃： 这次有什么线索了吗?

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Ha. Have you seen the look on Chief Elden's face yet?
神秘学警察 II： 埃尔登警长的脸色会告诉你答案。

Poitier looks over at the Deputy Chief's Office, squinting as she tries to see through the slatted blinds.
波蒂埃疑惑地望向角落的警长办公室，透过半开的百叶窗观察屋内的情形。

Poitier: Hot damn, I know that look. Wasn't the last time when he found out his daughter was dating some jackass crook?
波蒂埃： ……我的天呐！上一次埃尔登的脸变成这个颜色，还是他发现女儿交了个瘪三男友那时候吧?

Poitier: I know this Nightpiercer guy's been tricky, but is it really that bad?
波蒂埃： “针人”一向神出鬼没，就算这次还是没有线索，也不必这样吧?

Arcane Affairs Officer I: You don't know the half of it. The pressure's been building on him. Now, apparently, the up-tops are sending us some support.
神秘学警察 I： 你有所不知……就是那个“上面”，说看我们迟迟抓不住“针人”的尾巴，所以派了个外援过来。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Some cadet, from the Vigiles Bureau. I guess they've decided we're not working hard enough, or something.
神秘学警察 I： 一名来自那个夜巡特遣管理局的见习执夜人即将大驾光临，帮助我们这些没用的神秘学警察解决这座城市的麻烦。

Poitier: Vigiles? From the Foundation? Aren't they only responsible for the arcanum crimes that'll "cause serious consequences"?
波蒂埃：你是说基金会的那个?
他们不是专门负责那些“可能造成极其严重后果”的神秘学犯罪事件的吗?

Poitier: I don't see how this Nightpiercer guy is their kind of trouble.
波蒂埃：虽然“针人”的确很棘手，但我并不认为他的危险性有那么高。

Poitier: Besides, how's a vigil even going to help us? They don't know this city like we do. And not even a full agent, just a cadet.
波蒂埃：再说这是我们的城市，用不着夜巡特遣的家伙来“热心帮忙”，他们对这里了解多少——

Poitier: Wait, did you say cadet?
波蒂埃：等等，你刚才说“见习”?

Poitier's head snaps back to the officer, her eyes wide. She can't just let that word slide by without notice.
她终于意识到同僚方才的话语中有一个不该被忽视的关键词，不禁瞪大了眼睛。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: You heard me. Apparently, they decided this is gonna be a thing. Send the cadets along to assist and test their chops. So now we're not just dogcatchers. We're babysitters, too.
神秘学警察 I：他们选拔新人的考核中有那么一些实习项目。
看起来我们这里成了给未来的超级精英练手的幼儿园了。

Poitier: Is this some kind of joke?
波蒂埃：……这是什么新式笑话吗?

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Your words, my lips.
神秘学警察 II：我刚听说的时候也和你一个反应。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: The Chief said it's a chance to develop a better working relationship between us and the Vigiles. I think brass just wants to cozy up with the St. Pavlov Foundation.
神秘学警察 I：但我们的局长大人认为这是个好主意——和未来的超级精英、夜巡特遣管理局还有背后的圣洛夫基金会打好关系总不是坏事。

She downs the rest of her coffee and tosses the empty cup into the trash.
她喝干手中的咖啡，将空杯精准地掷进一旁的垃圾桶。

Poitier: Yeah, that would explain the look on Elden's face. So, what? Anyone know when this cadet is due? Or hell, anything useful at all?
波蒂埃：怪不得埃尔登那个表情……那家伙什么时候来？有人知道那人的底细吗?

Arcane Affairs Officer I: I heard tell it's some Chinese girl from a famous family of arcanists. She's got a mega-powerful familiar, and that's why the Vigiles recruited her.
神秘学警察 I：听说是个来自东方的小丫头，家里很有来头，有一头祖传的强大“密友”，也正因为这个原因被选进了夜巡特遣管理局。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Really, just for her familiar? That can't be the only reason. Did she at least like score well on her tests?
神秘学警察 II：我很想说既然我们的新朋友通过了那场选拔，那么无论她是否靠的是祖传的好帮手，多少都能够派上些用场。但……

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Apparently, she didn't even take the test. She was still in training when she was picked. No field experience at all.
神秘学警察 I：据可靠消息称，我们的小精英是从警校被直接挑选过去的。
这意味着这位援兵实际上并没有任何工作经验。

Poitier tries to maintain her steely demeanor, but the frustration proves too much to contain.
波蒂埃沉默了一会儿，怒火从她的胸口熊熊燃起。

Poitier: So you mean this girl's a total liability? Some spoiled rich kid debutante looking for a chance to polish her resume?
波蒂埃：……所以你们是说，我们即将迎来的是一个刚毕业的菜鸟、一个背靠家族的世家大小姐，要来我们这里给简历镀一层金。

The officer lets out a dry chuckle, but as her reply is about to leave her lips, her eyes flick behind Poitier, and her tone changes.
坐在波蒂埃对面的警员嗤笑一声，刚想接话——他的目光落在波蒂埃的身后，忽然口风一转。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: That's not exactly what I said.
神秘学警察 I：这可不是我说的。

They wouldn't put just anyone in this position. The office falls silent as all eyes turn to the unfamiliar figure standing in the doorway.
缺根筋的家伙很难被选上这个岗位，方才还嘈杂无比的办公室很快安静了下来。每个人都望向门口那个陌生的小个子身影。

Liang Yue: Excuse me.
梁月：不好意思，打扰一下。

Liang Yue: I'm vigil cadet Liáng Yuè from the St. Pavlov Foundation, Vigiles Bureau, reporting for duty, ma'am. Could you please point me to Deputy Chief Elden?
梁月：我是来报到的见习执夜人梁月，来自圣洛夫基金会夜巡特遣管理局。
请问我在哪里可以找到埃尔登警长?

Poitier: Hmm. He's in his office.
波蒂埃：……那边。

Poitier is the one to break the silence. She jerks her head toward the office in the corner as she speaks.
最终是波蒂埃回答了少女。
她扬了扬下巴，向来人示意角落办公室的方向。

Liang Yue: I see. Thank you.
梁月：我知道了，谢谢您。

She offers a slight nod and, under the scrutiny of every officer present, makes her way to the Deputy Chief's Office.
这位单枪匹马闯入神秘学犯罪科的不速之客微微点头示意，在众人的注视下穿过鸦雀无声的办公室。

As soon as the door is shut, murmurs break out like wildfire.
窃窃私语在警长办公室的门关上后一发不可收拾。

Poitier: That's our princess? I've seen street rats bigger. I bet I could lift her up with one hand.
波蒂埃：就这家伙？她像一只刚出生的小老鼠，我单手就能把她拎起来。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Don't forget her familiar. Though, I don't see it now, so she must be a summoner.
神秘学警察 II：你忘了她的好帮手。没有跟在身边……那应该就是召唤系的了。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Lucky her. I wish my great-great-great grandpa left me something like that.
神秘学警察 I：我还能说什么呢?
真希望我的曾曾曾爷爷也能留下个什么东西给我继承。

Poitier: So, what's Elden gonna do? No way he's letting this baby rat scurry into our investigation. I'll show her the door myself if he'll let me.
波蒂埃：不知道埃尔登打算怎么处理她，难道真的让这大小姐参与调查？我想帮忙都被埃尔登拒绝了。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Guaranteed our vigil-to-be is a spoiled, air-headed legacy pick. I can't imagine she's the type to follow orders.
神秘学警察 I： 万一还有个什么大小姐脾气，那就更完蛋了。一毕业就是精英警探的天之骄子，我想象不出她老老实实听从命令的样子。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Guys, we won't get any answers just sitting here.
神秘学警察 II： 我说伙计们，我们光是在这里瞎琢磨也不会有什么结果的。

Poitier: Yeah, you're right. I need to get back to work. Josh is out on leave, so I've gotta cover all his cases.
波蒂埃： 唉，你说得对，我去忙今天的工作了。自从乔什休了假，本来该两个人干的活就都落在我身上了……

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Hey, hold on. I've got a way to get the scoop on this girl.
神秘学警察 I： 等等，别着急走啊。
我有个方法能解答咱们的疑问。

Before Poitier can walk away, she grabs her sleeve and, with a knowing look on her face, indicates toward the Deputy Chief's office.
刚欲离开的波蒂埃被拉住了。同僚望向警长办公室的方向，向她挤了挤眼睛。

Deputy Chief's Office
警长办公室

Deputy Chief Elden: Liáng Yuè, specially recommended by the Foundation's East Asia branch for selection into the Vigiles Bureau, top-of-class during your training, selected to serve as the pilot for the vigil cadet field training program with the LAPD Division for Arcane Affairs.
埃尔登警长： 夜巡特遣管理局见习执夜人，由圣洛夫基金会东亚分部特别推荐参与选拔，培训期间综合成绩第一名……

Deputy Chief Elden: Hmph. It's an impressive resume.
埃尔登警长： 听着可真了不得啊。

Liang Yue: Thank you, sir. Actually, it's not that—
梁月： 您过奖了，这不算什么——

Deputy Chief Elden: Did I ask for an explanation?
埃尔登警长： 我让你说话了吗?

Her voice falters for a moment.
警长办公室中少女的声音明显停顿了片刻。

Liang Yue: No, sir.
梁月： ……没有，长官。

Deputy Chief Elden: Then don't give me one. You talk when I tell you to talk, you sit when I tell you to sit, and you do exactly as I say, when I say.
埃尔登警长： 那就闭嘴。在这里我让你说话你才可以说话，让你坐下你才可以坐下，让你做什么你就做什么。

Deputy Chief Elden: Do I make myself clear?
埃尔登警长： 明白了吗?

Liang Yue: Yes, sir.
梁月： 我……明白了，长官。

On the other side of the thin walls of the office, the officers exchange smirks as they listen in to their conversation.
一墙之隔外的好事者们互相交换了一个心照不宣的坏笑。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Classic Elden. Reminds me of the good old days.
神秘学警察 I： 来了，埃尔登的下马威。
这还真让人有些怀念啊。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Good? The hell was so good about them? Think you've taken one too many smacks on the noggin. Still, she isn't as stuck-up as I expected.
神秘学警察 II： 我可一点都不怀念。
但……那个大小姐似乎比我想象中的要老实听话。

Poitier: Then she's probably a wuss. I figured she was gonna back talk him—more like a meek little mouse than a rat.
波蒂埃： 她要是能给埃尔登呛回来那倒还有趣些。
没胆的家伙。

They press their ears against the wall and fall silent once again.
短暂的交头接耳后，他们再次安静下来，将耳朵贴到墙壁上捕捉办公室内的对话。

Deputy Chief Elden: I've been told you're here to assist us in catching the vigilante known as Nightpiercer. But one look at you tells me you don't have the chops.
埃尔登警长： 上面告诉我，你是为协助我们抓住那个连续袭击犯“针人”而来的。
但我对于你是否能做到这一点持怀疑态度。

Deputy Chief Elden: I'll bet you're greener than any rookie on my force. Now, Liáng, answer me. Are you ready?
埃尔登警长： 坦白说，我对你是否已经做好准备成为一名神秘学警察也持怀疑态度。
回答我，梁。你准备好了吗?

Liang Yue: Yes, sir.
梁月： 是的，长官。

Deputy Chief Elden: On this beat, you're going to encounter arcane crime that is worse than anything you've seen in your training—beyond your imagination. Are you prepared?
埃尔登警长： 作为神秘学警察，我们往往会遇到超乎你想象的神秘学案件。
你对此有心理准备了吗?

Liang Yue: Yes, sir.
梁月： 是的，长官。

Deputy Chief Elden: When it comes to dealing with arcanist criminals, you need wits and you need strength. One mistake, and you could end up in a casket on that long flight back home.
埃尔登警长： 你需要灵活运用你的智慧和力量逮捕那些危险的神秘学家罪犯，而不是把名字列在受害者那一栏里给司里丢脸。

Deputy Chief Elden: So I ask again, are you up to this challenge?
埃尔登警长： 你确定你做好准备了吗?

Liang Yue: Yes, sir. I'm ready.
梁月： 是的，长官！我做好准备了。

Deputy Chief Elden: No, you aren't.
埃尔登警长： 不，你没有。

He pulls a newspaper from a drawer and slams it onto the desk.
一份报纸被埃尔登从柜子里抽出，拍在了办公桌上。

Deputy Chief Elden: Read it.
埃尔登警长： 读读上面写了什么。

Liang Yue: The arcanist scammer, Johnny Three-Times, has been apprehended. Using his arcane skill "Omnis Obeisance," he manipulated his victims to do anything he asked, specifically, transferring all their money to him.
梁月：通过电话作案的神秘学家诈骗犯“棍骗约翰”落网，他用专属神秘术“唯命是从”控制受害者向自己的账户汇入大笔金钱。

Liang Yue: In order to successfully cast his arcane skill, he requires his target to answer "yes" three times in one minute.
梁月：而他的神秘术发动条件是，让目标在一分钟内回答……三个“是的”。

Deputy Chief Elden: If you had been dealing with him, he'd already have you dumping your trust fund into his bank account, or worse.
埃尔登警长：如果我是这家伙，你现在已经在掏钱包了——或是更糟。

Liang Yue: With all due respect, sir, that isn't a fair evaluation. I wouldn't have answered you that way if you were not my commanding officer.
梁月：……恕我直言，长官。
您是我的长官，我不可能拒绝回答您的问话，这个测试并不公平。

Deputy Chief Elden: Fair? There is no fair when it comes to arcanists. You've read the headlines about this guy and think you know what to expect, but what if he had abilities the news didn't know about? What if he could disguise himself?
埃尔登警长：涉及神秘术的案子打从一开始就没有所谓的公平。
绝大多数时候，你都要在对犯人神秘术一无所知的情况下面对他们。

Deputy Chief Elden: Or do you think that crooks just leave their resumes behind at the crime scene?
埃尔登警长：还是说怎么，你需要每个犯人都在案发现场留下一份圣洛夫基金会神秘学家登记信息的复印件吗?

For a brief moment, she is at a loss for words.
少女语塞了片刻。

Liang Yue: No, sir.
梁月：……不，长官。

Deputy Chief Elden: This article was published a week ago. If you were as ready as you claimed, you should've known about this conman and his arcane skill. If you had any smarts, you'd have at least figured out I was probing you.
埃尔登警长：看看日期，这份报纸是上周的东西。如果你做好了准备，你就会知道这件事，如果你足够敏锐，就能在我问话时察觉到不对劲。

Deputy Chief Elden: But you didn't. I don't know what the Foundation and your Vigiles teachers taught you. Frankly, I don't care. Because you don't have the practical skills necessary to keep yourself alive on these streets.
埃尔登警长：但你没有。也许你在某些方面十分出色，但刚才的测试结果已经证明，你在实战方面仍然缺乏经验。

Deputy Chief Elden: I will absolutely not put a kid like you on the Nightpiercer case.
埃尔登警长：我不会让你参加“针人”事件的调查。

His cold voice carries through the wall. The officers outside exchange glances.
办公室内传来的声音冷若冰霜，门外偷听的警员们互相交换了一个眼神。

Poitier: Cold and ruthless as a Minnesota winter. Elden's never been a people person. Guess that's why they keep him stuck down here with us.
波蒂埃：埃尔登说话还是这么不客气，也怪不得他这么多年一直没办法升职。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: I don't know. I agree with him. But he's being pretty rough on her.
神秘学警察 I： 他说的这些的确就是我想说的话，不过……是不是稍微有点过火了？

Arcane Affairs Officer II: She's definitely too young for this. Whatcha think? She gonna cry?
神秘学警察 II： 那个少女有多大，成年了吗？嘿……有人能看到她的表情吗？她不会哭了吧？

Poitier: Look, if she can't handle the Chief, then she can't handle the city.
波蒂埃： 如果她连这点心理承受能力都没有，那我建议她趁早回家找妈妈去。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Is that right? I seem to remember someone's eyes going red a few times on her first day.
神秘学警察 I： 奇怪，是我记错了吗？我记得波蒂埃警官报到那天，从警长办公室里走出来的时候是红着眼睛的……

Poitier: What? Shut up. I didn't.
波蒂埃： 什么——胡扯！你苦目糖吃太多，把脑子吃坏了吧！

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Shh. Listen.
神秘学警察 II： 伙计们！嘘——！

They fall silent again, waiting to hear what fate will befall the young vigil cadet.
警员们重新安静下来，他们都好奇地等待着，警长究竟会对那名见习执夜人少女做出怎样的发落。

Deputy Chief Elden: End of discussion. If you want to call home to your daddy or the Foundation and get reassigned somewhere else, be my guest.
埃尔登警长： ——这就是我要说的了。
如果你想要哭着找你爸爸或是老师之类的大人物更换你的实习场所，请便。

Deputy Chief Elden: But as long as you're in my department, you'll follow my rules. For now, I'll assign you some of the lighter cases. This is grunt work, kid. Try not to mess it up.
埃尔登警长： 但既然目前你被分到了我的地盘，一切就要按照规矩走。
我给你的安排是处理“基础神秘学警情”，这是每个新人的必经之路。

Poitier: Hold on. I've got a bad feeling.
波蒂埃： ……嗯？等等。

Poitier's eyes widen, but it's too late to act.
波蒂埃瞪大了眼睛，但已经太迟了。

Deputy Chief Elden: Arya Poitier will be your partner and field training instructor. She'll be happy to help you adjust. Isn't that right, Officer Poitier?
埃尔登警长： ——你的搭档是艾丽娅·波蒂埃，她同时也将担任你的临时教官。
事实上，她现在就在门外。

Poitier can't help but mutter a curse under her breath.
听到这里，门外波蒂埃没忍住低声咒骂了起来。

Poitier: Crap. Guess my day isn't getting any easier.
波蒂埃： 该死……真是个配得上这个阳光明媚早上的“好”消息。

非商务广告
This Is NOT a Business Ad 小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.
???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
2. 我要前进到未来

分支 1 / Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.
???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...
???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……

分支 2 / Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.
???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—
???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.
???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。

选项 / Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.
1. 好了，开始胡扯吧

2. No. I'm tired of you.
2. 不，我已经厌倦你了

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.
???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.
???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

We are! The Vigiles Bureau!
我们是！夜巡特遣管理局！

英文 / ENGLISH

"Is there an arcanum situation you're dealing with?"

"Got a dispute with your arcanist neighbor?"

"Don't worry! We're here to help!"

"We are—the Vigiles Bureau!"

"Committed to upholding the Vigiles Mediation Code! Protectors of peace in every situation!"

"Whether it's for you or your local police, we've got your back!"

"Next time, leave this to the foundation's PR department. These guys are hopeless at this," the senior remarked, sealing away the footage while struggling to keep a straight face. "I'm getting a headache ... Their evaluations will just have to be postponed for another three months."

中文 / CHINESE

“有神秘学案件发生?”
“和你的神秘学家邻居闹了矛盾?”
“不用担心！有我们在！”
“我们是——”
“夜巡特遣管理局！”
“呵！严守夜巡调解条例！不问何时何地！安宁夜晚的守卫！”
“哈！不管是你！还是当地警察！我们都是你们忠实的后盾！”

“下次这种事还是委托给基金会宣传部吧，这些小子不是干这个的料，”年迈的上司在努力控制面部表情的同时封存了样片，“我有点头疼……这些小子的考核得延后一下，让他们三个月后再来找我。”

百分百商务广告
This Is 100% a Business Ad 小径

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???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
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分支 1 / Branch 1

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分支 2 / Branch 2

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分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.
???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.
???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Your Close Companion is Here
你的密友在这里

英文 / ENGLISH

"Close Companions," everyone's best friends. The earliest of these companions can be traced back to the East, where the "Zhenzi" befriended the powerful "Xiandao Beast." Together, they battled against evil and maintained peace and harmony. To this day, the "Liang" family still takes pride in the bond their ancestors shared with "Qiangliang the Xiandao Beast." The Xiandao Beasts protect the world, a story familiar to every child, often whispered by their mothers to soothe them to sleep ...

But it's not just a legend; close companions also exist around us. Your grey-headed chickadee poet, your imaginary wolf friend, your changeling childhood playmate—they've long been a part of our lives, and have become our most loyal friends ...

Now, it's your turn to find your own close companion—or perhaps get one for the kids! Thanks to the NewBabel Critter Rehab Center, critter companions are coming to every home!

Special thanks to the St. Pavlov Foundation for providing the companion footage featured in this program.

中文 / CHINESE

“密友”，人们的好伙伴。最早的“密友”或许可以追溯到遥远的东方，那里的“侲子”与强大的“险道兽”作伴，他们互帮互助，消灭邪恶，守护和平。直到如今，东方的“梁”家族仍传唱着他们的祖先与“险道兽强梁”结为密友的故事。险道兽守护世间，每个东方小孩都知道这故事，他们的母亲用这些故事哄他们入睡……

不止是传说，密友也存在于我们身边。你的西伯利亚山雀诗友，你的幻想狼朋友，你的换生灵童年玩伴，他们早已融入我们的生活，成了我们最忠实的朋友……

现在轮到你们得到自己的密友，或为孩子们物色一个了！新巴别塔魔精公司，让魔精密友，走进千家万户！

本次节目中的密友片段由圣洛夫基金会独家提供，感谢圣洛夫基金会的大力支持。

最高危机 · 1/2
Total Crisis · 1/2 SC-02

Poitier: Here we are. Get out.
波蒂埃：我们到了，下车。

Street, Los Angeles
洛杉矶·街道

Poitier: First case of the day.
波蒂埃：这就是今天我们要处理的第一起警情了。

Poitier: Any time regular beat cops find a case related to arcanum, they'll call it in to Dispatch, then we get to come mop it up.
波蒂埃：每当巡警发现神秘术相关的非紧急案情时，就会上报给调度中心，这些案子随后会被交给我们处理。

Poitier: This is what we call a Basic Arcanum Incident, the bread-and-butter of our work, kid. It's not often that we get anything urgent, but you've gotta stay on your toes.
波蒂埃：“基础神秘学警情”，这就是我们的主要工作。有时也会有紧急情况需要我们处理，不过那种时候比较少。

Poitier: But to be honest, I hope we don't get anything big today. Last thing I want is to take a rookie like you into a real emergency.
波蒂埃：我个人希望今天不会遇到那种情况，我可不想在穿越枪林弹雨时还要照顾一只第一天出勤的菜鸟。

Liang Yue: I hope so, too.
梁月：好的。

Poitier: That's "Yes, ma'am." You got me?
波蒂埃：你该说“是的，波蒂埃教官”。

Poitier: You're probably thinking I'm trying to put you in your place, huh? That I'm just bossing you around.
波蒂埃：我知道你心里大概不服气，觉得像我这样草根出身的家伙居然敢对你这样的精英颐指气使。

Poitier: But get off your high horse, princess. Cause as long as I'm your field instructor, you need to show some respect.
波蒂埃：但你记住，尽管只是临时的——可无论如何，现在我就是你的教官。

This is the "pro tip" her colleagues gave her before she left. If your trainee has powerful connections, you've got two choices: either make sure they know who's in charge from day one, or spend the rest of your day sucking up to them.
这是临行前同僚们教给她的“小技巧”。当你的学员大有来头时，要么选择巴结到底，要么必须在一开始就告诉对方：你不是好惹的。

But it seems she and her colleagues were worrying over nothing.
然而，她和她的同僚们似乎有些杞人忧天了。

Liang Yue: But I don't have a horse, and I didn't think you were bossy. I'm honored to have you as my partner and field instructor. I look forward to learning under you.
梁月：我没有觉得不服气，波蒂埃教官。
我很荣幸能够得到您的指点，希望您能够多指点。

Poitier: Hmm?
波蒂埃：……哦?

Pretty humble coming from a big-shot cadet. Poitier narrows her eyes, only to be met with an earnest, slightly puzzled gaze.
这位“大有来头”的学员态度格外谦逊。波蒂埃狐疑的审视只得到了对方带着几分恰到好处的疑惑不解的坦然回望。

Liang Yue: Is there something wrong with what I said, ma'am?
梁月：波蒂埃教官？怎么了吗？

Poitier: Are you just that much of a pushover, or is this all an act?
波蒂埃：倒是装得挺乖巧……或者真是个没脾气的怂包？不会吧？

Liang Yue: P-Pardon? I don't quite understand.
梁月：抱歉，我没有听清，您说什么？

Poitier: Nothing. Just keep close. You never know what can happen with these cases.
波蒂埃：我是说我们要处理的案子可能和精英小姐想象的不同，你最好做好准备。

They take their last few steps up to the door and ring the bell. Heavy footsteps approach from within, and the door is flung open with a bang.
波蒂埃按响街边一户人家的门铃，伴随着隔着门板传来越来越近的沉重脚步声，门在少女错愕的目光下被猛地掀开。

Citizen I: Oh, finally. Do you know how long I've been waiting? Those monsters are at it again. Do something.
市民 I：你们终于来了！
你知道我等了多久吗？那些怪物又来了，就在那里！快做点什么！

Such an "enthusiastic" welcome isn't exactly what the vigil cadet was expecting.
如此“热情”的欢迎显然不在见习执夜人的意料之中。

She turns her head, only to see her instructor comfortably positioned a few feet behind her. Looks like she'll have to handle this one on her own.
但当她下意识地转过头，却发现自己的教官早已退到了几个台阶下远离战场的有利地势。看来她需要独自应付这一切了。

Liang Yue: Um, please remain calm, ma'am. We're here now, and we won't let them hurt you.
梁月：……请您冷静一些，女士。我们在这里，没有什么能够伤害您。

Liang Yue: Am I correct that you reported there are critters that have broken into your house? Could you describe them for us? Do you have an idea how many?
梁月：我看到您报告说有魔精屡次闯入您的住宅中，您能描述一下袭击您的魔精的具体外形吗？它们一共有几只？

Citizen I: I don't know. Like a ton, a bunch, two and a half butt-loads. I didn't stick around to count them.
市民 I：很多！它们有很多，那些该死的恶魔！

Even among the woman's chaotic shouting, useful information can be extracted. Liáng quickly formulates a plan.
即便是夹杂着愤怒与恐慌的歇斯底里，其中仍然存在着有效信息。
见习执夜人略作思考，给出了自己的方案。

Liang Yue: So, there are many of them. Hmm, in that case, I suggest we split up, ma'am.
梁月：存在复数的危险对象……既然如此，波蒂埃教官，我提议我们分头行动。

Liang Yue: You could stay here and keep the lady safe, and send me to take the critters down? Given we're in the city, I suspect them to be tamed, and it's possible that someone may be controlling them.
梁月：能否请您负责保护这位女士，将制服魔精的任务交给我？
这里并不是野生的危险魔精会喜爱的环境，背后可能有人操控那些魔精。

Liang Yue: Once we've established their type, we may be able to deduce the incantation that's controlling them. Some incantations can be easily traced, such as the Manipulation incantation or the Shadow incantation—
梁月：根据魔精的种类，我可以推断出操控它们的术法。如果是提线魔咒、拟影魔咒这类的神秘术，我们可以快速找出施术者——

Citizen I: Ahhh. Over there. There they are.
市民 I：它们来了！就在那里！

Liang Yue: Please stay behind me, ma'am. Where are ...
梁月：请躲到我身后去，女士！它们在哪——

Liang Yue: ... are ... they ...?
梁月：里……

She freezes mid-step, her eyes locking onto a corner of the yard. From the shadows, a row of plump creatures waddles into view.
摆出警戒姿态的少女僵在了原地，目光凝结在院子的角落。
那里有几个胖乎乎的身影排着队，慢悠悠地转了出来。

Munchalo: Mooo.
慢慢吞：呒——

Liang Yue: Is this ...?
梁月：这是……慢慢吞……？

Liang Yue: This appears to be a Munchalo, a new breed of critter from the Ms. NewBabel Critter Rehabilitation Center, endorsed by the LSCC. They're medium to large in size, and classed as non-aggressive.
梁月：由拉普拉斯科算中心背书的“新巴别塔”魔精公司培育出来的新品种魔精，体型中等偏大，但基本无攻击性。

Liang Yue: The Munchalo consumes base arcane materials and extracts the energy from them. They're intended to assist in the arcane production industry. They've been slated for worldwide distribution.
梁月：它们会缓慢地吃下各种神秘学材料，并在萃取其中的能量后将其排出体外，现在世界各地的魔精牧场中都开始大范围养殖……

Liang Yue: But, why are they here?
梁月：但它们为什么会出现在这里？

Citizen I: Well? What are you waiting for? Do something. Kill them, ah!
市民 I：不要光傻站着了，做点什么！快把它们给我杀掉！

Liang Yue: Kill them? Oh, ma'am. Please don't worry. They will not attack people, and it's against our procedures to kill non-aggressive critters without authorization.
梁月：杀掉？可是女士，它们并不会攻击人。
我想“杀掉”是有些反应过度的，这也不符合我们的操作流程。

Citizen I: But they're destroying my azaleas. And the stairs and my lawn. And they almost bit my sweetie's tail off, ah.
市民 Ⅰ： 但它们在攻击我好不容易修整好的草坪！还嚼碎了我的花盆和台阶！
我的小甜心都让这群傻大个给咬秃了尾巴！

Even the ever-composed vigil cadet is momentarily at a loss for words.
饶是始终一本正经的见习执夜人少女似乎也因为这个答案而语塞了片刻。

Liang Yue: Your sweetie? Um, I see, ma'am. I will do my best to get them out—
梁月： 您的小甜心是指……不，我是说我明白了，女士。
我会将它们赶出去的——

She decides to put off investigating "sweetie's" identity for now. But before she can act, a shrill voice interrupts from outside the yard.
见习执夜人少女决定暂时不再深究“小甜心”的真面目。
但她的话并没能说完，便被一道从院子外飞进来的尖叫声打断了。

Citizen II: Hey! Don't you dare lay a finger on my precious munchies.
市民 Ⅱ： 不！你敢碰一下我的心肝宝贝试试！

Liang Yue: Wha—Can I help you, sir?
梁月： 什——先生，您又是谁?

Citizen I: I-I knew it. This jerk is my next-door neighbor. He keeps all kinds of these ridiculous, smelly critters around. I order you to throw him and all his disgusting little pets in jail.
市民 Ⅰ： 隔壁的厚颜无耻的混蛋！就是这个怪咖养了这群臭烘烘的傻大个！
警察小姐，请把他和他的恶心宠物一起丢到监狱里去！

Citizen II: Are you out of your mind? They're just some adorable Munchalos. What kind of sicko would wanna hurt them?
市民 Ⅱ： 你这个疯子，它们只是一群可爱的慢慢吞，你为什么要和它们计较?
你那恶毒的心灵里难道没有哪怕一小块柔软的部分吗?

The shouting match quickly escalates as a barrage of increasingly colorful insults fills the air.
他们开始隔着围墙争吵起来，越加不堪入耳的词汇开始被填充上膛，街区沐浴在让人眉头直皱的枪林弹雨之中。

Liang Yue: ...
梁月： ……

Liáng glances at her instructor. Poitier simply smirks and shrugs.
梁月看向自己的教官。波蒂埃好整以暇地向她耸了耸肩。

Poitier: What did I tell you, huh?
波蒂埃： 我说了，你最好“做好准备”。

Munchalo: Mooo.
慢慢吞： 呃——

抽查
Spot Check 小径

Here is a well known question you must have heard: "What goes on four legs in the morning, two in the afternoon, and three in the evening?" it's so well "known" that no one finds it novel anymore.
???: 我想您一定听过那个著名的问题，早上四条腿走路，中午用两条腿，到了晚上则是三条……答案流传得太广，以至于这个谜失去了趣味。

But please do me a favor and answer me yourself.
???: 但我还是得麻烦您接个话儿，亲自告诉我答案。

选项 / Choices

1. "A human being"
1. “人”

2. Let's talk about the questioner instead.
2. 还是说说出题者吧

分支 1 / Branch 1

Correct! This is the same answer Oedipus gave to defeat Sphinx. Thus becoming a hero, but also starting him on his ill-fated destiny.
???: 是的！人——俄狄浦斯用这个漂亮回答击败了斯芬克斯，得以成为英雄，也无知觉地坠入了命运的漩涡。

Raise a question, give an answer. This is the most fundamental ritual. Through this, we get nearer to God.
???: 给出问题，解决问题，这之中包含着最为基础的仪式，指出一条上升的通路。

分支 2 / Branch 2

The Sphinx, an embodiment of mercy and nobility in Egypt, was seen as a mystery to the Greeks: a dangerous being that kept secrets, and delivered the punishments of the gods.
???: 斯芬克斯，在埃及象征着仁慈与高贵，来到希腊后，则完全归入隐秘之中，变得不可捉摸。它看护着秘密，也代表了神的惩罚。

When the question is answered, the ritual is finished, and the answerer is granted the right to reach the treasure it guards.
???: 谁能完成这位出题者的试炼，谁就能通过仪式，接触其后的珍贵之物。

选项 / Choices

1. Ritual?
1. 仪式?

Yes, a ritual. Whether it is by pouring out wine; slaughtering a calf; or circling round a fire with a baby in your arms... It is an agreement; a question that demands an answer.
???: 这再常见不过啦。将酒液泼洒，作为祭奠；宰杀牛犊；怀抱婴儿围着火堆绕圈……更简单些，在一问一答之中，某种约定便就此达成。

Every desire has a price. Whether it is paid in wine, blood, or fire, but sometimes that sacrifice is taken from you without it ever being noticed.
???: 凡请求必有代价。酒、血、火堆，都是献上的牺牲——但有时候“牺牲”并不需实体，甚至难以发觉。

And the treasure you seek might be the undoing of your own desires.
???: 而那恩赐也未必能如我们所愿。

Let us take a look at another question: "Stranger, what's your name?" Cried Polyphemus.
???: 这儿有另一场问答——“你名叫什么?”波吕斐摩斯如此问。

"Nobody!" Odysseus answered, and it allowed him to flee the cyclops' cave, safe and sound.
???: “‘没有人！’”奥德修斯答。借着这个机灵的点子，无名的奥德修斯得以逃离巨人的洞穴。

A human being and nobody, two answers that could not be more alike, yet both were bound to fate by their answer.
???: 人与无人，这几乎是截然相反的答案，回答者却无一例外地被命运裹挟。

Alright, dear, time to call it a day. As for you? You'll get the answers you seek, you've already paid the price.
???: 好啦，亲爱的。传说故事就讲到这儿吧。你会达成你想做的，因为你的代价早已给过了。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Excerpt from the New York Times
《纽约新闻报》节选

英文 / ENGLISH

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

中文 / CHINESE

前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。

于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

最高危机 · 2/2
Total Crisis · 2/2 SC-02

Restaurant
餐馆

Poitier: Finally, lunchtime. I'll grab the cheeseburger and an Americano—large.
波蒂埃：终于，午餐时间！
我绝对会点一份芝士汉堡，再加一杯黑咖啡。

The front door to the diner has barely closed by the time Poitier has shouted out her order. It seems this is just another part of a beat cop's routine.
波蒂埃推开餐馆的大门，熟门熟路地带着自己的学员来到吧台处点餐。

Poitier: So, some fluffy trespassers, an alchemy incident, a noise complaint for a werewolf-infected, and a speeding ticket on an unregistered arcane vehicle ...
波蒂埃：一起魔精非法入侵、一起炼金术事故、一起狼人诅咒感染者扰民的投诉，还有一个驾驶未报备的神秘学物品在道路上超速行驶的……

Poitier: Honestly, busier than I expected, but it all went smoother than I expected too. We've earned ourselves a decent lunch, I'd say. So, what do you want, princess?
波蒂埃：这个上午比我预想中的忙碌，但也比我预想中的顺利。
我想不论是你还是我，都应当获得一份美味的午餐。你要什么？

Liáng studies the menu on the wall, hesitating to answer.
黑发少女盯着墙上的菜单看了一会儿，迟迟没有给出回答。

Poitier: What? Don't tell me our little vigil princess can't stomach a bit of fast food?
波蒂埃：……怎么，不合你的口味？

Poitier: Better get used to it, kid. We're on a tight schedule. There's no time for fancy dining.
波蒂埃：那还真是抱歉了，但我们的午休时间有限，通常只能在这种小餐馆解决。

Liang Yue: Oh, it's not that. It's just ... Are all the restaurants here so expensive? This is the first time I've been to L.A., and it seems things cost more than I expected.
梁月：不是的，我没有什么忌口。只是……这边的餐厅都是这个价格吗？
我刚刚来到洛杉矶，它比我想象的要贵一些。

Poitier is taken aback.
这个答案显然不在波蒂埃的意料之内。

Poitier: What, you broke? You telling me the Foundation—THE FOUNDATION—can't afford to pay you a decent wage?
波蒂埃：……你还需要担心钱的问题？
我听说你的工资是基金会那边发，大名鼎鼎的基金会难道其实那么吝啬吗？

Liang Yue: Oh, no. No. It's ... My subsidy should be enough for daily necessities. It's only that I was hoping to save some money, but it seems the prices here won't allow me to.
梁月：不是的，夜巡特遣给我们发的补助是够用的，不过……
我最初还以为能够存下一些，但现在看来是我太贪心了。

Liang Yue: Sorry, please forget it. I'll have a chicken sandwich. Thank you.
梁月：抱歉，请您忘了我刚才说的吧。
我想我要一份三明治就可以了。

Poitier: Okay.
波蒂埃：……行。

Their orders placed, the two take a seat at Poitier's usual spot.
二人点过餐后，在波蒂埃的老位置坐下。

Poitier: Alright, question time, rookie. Cause I think I've got the wrong impression.
波蒂埃：好吧……看来我对你有一些误解。

Poitier: What I heard was that you were some pampered rich kid from a crazy old legendary family.
波蒂埃：我之前还以为你是个有钱人家的大小姐之类的，毕竟我们听说了一些事——关于你的家族。

After a brief flicker of surprise, Liáng's expression shifts. It's as if she expected to hear this question, or at least has grown accustomed to it.
梁月在片刻的惊讶后，很快露出了了然的神情，就好像她早已预料到，或是早已习惯了这类疑问。

Liang Yue: It's true. The Liáng family have a long history and many legendary ancestors.
梁月：梁家的确有着很长时间的历史，我的祖先中也确实出过不少令人景仰的人物。

Liang Yue: But that was a long time ago. Nowadays, we're not so different from any other ordinary family.
梁月：但那些都是很久以前的事了，到了我们这一代，梁家基本上和普通的人家没有什么区别。

Poitier: Mhm, sure. "Ordinary," that's definitely what I think of when I see you.
波蒂埃：一个没落的古老家族这可不叫作“和普通人没两样”，至少我身边没有这种普通家庭。

Poitier: I also heard that you've got a familiar.
波蒂埃：我们都听说了，你有个厉害的“好帮手”。

Liang Yue: You mean Qiángliáng?
梁月：您是说“强梁”?

Poitier: Yeah, sure, that. Come on. It's some mysterious arcane creature from the Far East. Everyone in the DAA's curious about it, myself included.
波蒂埃：一只来自遥远东方的强大神秘学生物——科里的所有人都对它很是好奇，我当然也不例外。

Poitier: So, you gonna show me?
波蒂埃：放出来看看?

Liáng looks a little troubled.
黑发女孩露出为难的神色。

Liang Yue: Um, now? I'm sorry, but I must refuse your request, Ms. Poitier.
梁月：现在吗?
抱歉，波蒂埃教官。我想我不能这么做。

Liang Yue: With all due respect, the Qiángliáng is a sacred being. It is deserving of great respect.
梁月：您可能不太了解，在我的故乡，强梁是备受尊敬的神圣存在。

Liang Yue: It has a divine mission to expel diseases and evil beings and has guarded the world through the ages.
梁月：它肩负着驱除鬼怪、疫病以及其他邪恶存在的使命，从古至今无数次为了守护人世间的安宁挺身而出。

Liang Yue: Maybe that just sounds like old legends, but it's the truth. We've recorded every battle it fought in our family chronicles.
梁月：这不是传说故事，而是事实。
强梁的每一次战斗都会被记录在梁家的典籍之中。

Liang Yue: And we're only allowed to borrow its power when we are in the greatest of danger.
梁月：但另一方面，只有遇到人力无法对抗的危机时，我们才被允许召唤强梁、借助这只古老神兽的力量。

Liang Yue: Please understand that I can't just summon it simply to show it to others.
梁月： 我不能仅仅为了向人展示它的英姿就将它唤出，还请您谅解。

Poitier: Okay, okay. I'm not unreasonable, princess. If it's a sacred thing or whatever, I won't bother you over it.
波蒂埃： ……不行就算了，我也不是那种蛮不讲理的人，你不必说那么一大串的。

From Liáng's sincerity, it's clear that this isn't just an excuse. Poitier isn't annoyed by it, but she does seem a little bored by the overly serious response.
少女言辞诚恳，因此尽管要求被拒绝，波蒂埃也并未因此恼火，只觉得对方一板一眼的回答颇为无趣。

An awkward silence falls at the table. Luckily, the waitress breaks it with the arrival of their meals.
相对无言，餐桌被尴尬的沉默笼罩，直到服务生端上二人的午餐。

Poitier: Anyway, I guess I should say, you're doing a lot better than I thought today. And I don't just give out compliments, you got that? So, take some pride in it.
波蒂埃： 不过说真的，你的表现比我想象中的好。
我很少夸人的，你可以稍微骄傲一些。

Poitier: But don't get cocky either. This was all chump work. You haven't seen the ugly side of this job yet.
波蒂埃： 但可不要以为这就是全部了，这份工作的困难程度远超你的想象。

Poitier: This morning might have been a cakewalk. But this job can blindside you just like that. Never underestimate anything.
波蒂埃： 看着大多是些鸡毛蒜皮的小事，但稍有疏忽就会倒大霉，你不会想要体验那种滋味的。

She takes a hefty bite of her burger and launches into a monologue, the food still rolling around in her mouth. Liáng simply looks blank. Poitier finally swallows.
波蒂埃一边大口咬着汉堡，一边对自己带的第一个新人滔滔不绝了起来。
但对方却始终没有回应。

Poitier: Hey? You in there, princess?
波蒂埃： ……你怎么不说话?

Liang Yue: I apologize, but in our family, we have a rule, Shí Bù Yán, Qǐn Bù Yǔ. It means we believe you shouldn't talk when eating or sleeping.
梁月： 请原谅，我的家中一直要求“食不言寝不语”，意思是吃饭和睡觉的时候不该说话。

Poitier: What? You're kidding! You trying to say I'm being rude? Or wait, you're serious, aren't you?
波蒂埃： 你是在借口讥讽我没有教养，还是——天哪，你是认真的。

Liáng sits totally still, her expression unchanged.
对面一本正经的表情否认了波蒂埃最初的推测。
她不敢置信地看向坐在桌子对面的少女，就像是在看一个外星人。

Poitier: What kind of stupid rule is that?
波蒂埃： 那是哪门子的鬼扯规矩？我家在吃饭的时候就从来没有安静过。

Poitier: Besides, why would anyone be talking while they're asleep? What, like you can't sleep talk? How do you even control that?
波蒂埃： 再说……睡觉的时候怎么说话？说梦话?
这是能想不说就不说的吗?

Poitier appears to be giving the question some genuine thought.
面对这个问题，坐在她对面的少女似乎认真思索了一番。

Liang Yue: Sorry, maybe I didn't translate it right. It means "keep quiet before sleep."
梁月： 您说得对，是我的翻译有纰漏。
那句话更准确的意思是“在到了该睡觉的时间后，我们就应该保持安静”。

Poitier: ...
波蒂埃：……

For a long moment, Poitier stares at her, dumbfounded. Then, she slumps back in her seat.
波蒂埃瞠目结舌了半晌，最终瘫软在了座位上。

Poitier: The heck? So many rules. Damn, princess, you must've had a miserable childhood.
波蒂埃：天哪……可怜的家伙，你也太无趣了。
我都已经能够想象到你的童年是什么样的了。

Poitier: Let me guess. Every day was courses and training, stuck inside, no books, no movies. Did they even let you watch Saturday morning cartoons? I've heard of kids like you. Sounds worse than jail to me.
波蒂埃：每天安排各种课程和训练，家里的管教比监狱还严，不论是什么小说电影动画片统统碰都没碰过，对不对?

Poitier: A childhood like that is rough, kid. It's bad for your head. Bad for the job, too.
波蒂埃：这不行，这可不行啊。不论是对你的生活来说，还是对工作来说。

Liáng furrows her brow a little. She can't follow her thought process at all.
少女似乎完全不能理解波蒂埃的崩溃，她皱起了眉头。

Liang Yue: I don't understand why you're upset, Ms. Poitier. How is it bad for the job?
梁月：我不明白您在诧异什么……您说的“对工作来说”是什么意思?

Poitier: Did you check the list of incidents before we set off? There's a case we're going to after lunch. A director that received some kind of threat. She's shooting a film in Chinatown.
波蒂埃：比如你看到那个等待我们处理的“基础神秘学警情”清单了吧?
其中有一项，是一个在唐人街拍戏的电影导演疑似受到人身威胁的事件。

Poitier: Anyways, this director's an arcanist, and her movie is all about arcanum. So, it's in our department.
波蒂埃：虽然目前还没有出事，但她拍的电影涉及神秘学元素，她本人也是神秘学家，所以这个案子就被划给了我们。

Poitier: The point is, knowing's half the battle in this job. It'd be easier if you were a cinephile or at least familiar with films. Maybe then you'd know a thing or two about her.
波蒂埃：你要是懂电影，事情就会好办一些，毕竟对工作中涉及到的人员总是了解越多越好，那还是个很有名的导演呢。

Poitier: She's famous for those Detective C07 films, the first movies to really put a focus on arcanum and arcanists. Something about it, though: the detective in those films used a skill a lot like this Nightpiercer crook.
波蒂埃：就是“针人”那个混蛋模仿的、十年前火遍世界各地的那部“第一部将真正的神秘术搬上银幕”的电影，《神秘警探 C07》的导演。

Poitier: What's her name again? Something with an N? Nu ...
波蒂埃：我记得是叫菲林……菲林……

Poitier strains to recall the name. She only saw it flash on screen for a moment when she watched the film way back when. In her focus, she fails to notice the flash of surprise on Liáng's face.
波蒂埃努力挖掘记忆中的那个往往只在电影开头或是结尾一闪而过的名字，因此忽略了对面少女脸上一闪而过的惊讶表情。

Liang Yue: Noire.
梁月：菲林士多。

Poitier: Yeah. That's it.
波蒂埃：没错，就是这个名字!

Poitier: Wait, so you—
波蒂埃：等等，所以你……

Liang Yue: Yes, I've watched her movies, too.
梁月：我也是会看电影的。

Poitier: I'll be damned. So, was it a special reward for getting straight A's? Or—
波蒂埃：哇哦，这可真是出乎我的意料。
是那种你拿了满分试卷回家的奖励吗？又或是——

Dispatch Center: Calling all nearby units. Code 3. We have a hostage situation at City Hall.
调度中心：呼叫附近警员，市政大厅发生人质劫持事件。

The radio announcement cuts their get-to-know-you session short.
忽然响起的通信打断了波蒂埃饶有兴趣的追问。

Dispatch Center: Suspect is a registered arcanist, posing a threat to life. On-scene officers are requesting immediate arcanist support.
调度中心：嫌疑犯为登记神秘学家，已使用神秘术造成人身威胁，现场警员请求神秘学人员增援，3 级警情。

Liang Yue: City Hall? We're close by, aren't we?
梁月：市政大厅……我记得地图，那就是这附近。

Poitier: Pack up. Lunchtime's over.
波蒂埃：看来我们的午餐时间要结束了。

秩序与失衡
Order and Chaos SC-03

City Hall
市政大厅

Old Police Officer: Let go of the hostage, sir. This won't do you any good.
老警察：嘿，冷静点！即使你那么做也无济于事的！

Enraged Man: Go away!!
男子：滚开！！

Old Police Officer: Damn!
老警察：该死！

Old Police Officer: That was close! Where's our backup?
老警察：好险……那群神秘学犯罪科的还没来吗?！

Poitier: DAA, at your service.
波蒂埃：随时为您服务，我们来了。

Liang Yue: What's the situation?
梁月：情况怎么样了？

Old Police Officer: See for yourself.
老警察：你们看就知道了。

The City Hall, usually bustling with foot traffic, now stands eerily empty. The reason is immediately clear.
本应人来人往的市政大厅如今格外空阔，原因一目了然。

Enraged Man: Don't come any closer! Stay back! Stay back!!
男子：别过来！退后，都退后！

Hostage: Please! Don't kill me! I'm sorry, I really am! Please let me go!
人质：不要杀我，求你了！
我可以向你道歉，好吗？我真的很抱歉！

Enraged Man: Shut up! It's too late now. Say another word, and you're dead! Stay back!!
男子：闭嘴！事到如今已经太迟了，你再说一句话我就杀了你！
——都退后！！

He swings the blade in his hand wildly, his voice a furious, panicked snarl.
挟持了人质的男子晃动着手中的利刃，发出愤怒的咆哮。

The crowd on the other side of the police barricade instinctively recoils, but the woman standing just ten paces away doesn't move an inch.
远远站在警戒网之外的围观群众中，都有不少人都情不自禁地后退了数步——但身处仅距离男子十步前后的女子，却丝毫不为所动。

???: Hey, hey. Trust me, pal.
???：不，相信我，先生。

???: You really don't want to do this.
???：您不会想要那样做的。

Poitier: Who's that? Doesn't look like one of ours.
波蒂埃：那是谁?
看着不像是我们的人。

Old Police Officer: Just some civvy. She was talking with the suspect before we got here.
老警察：是个事发时在现场的普通民众。
在我们赶到之前，她帮忙稳住了犯人的情绪。

Liang Yue: That woman ...
梁月：那个人……

Poitier: What, you know her? Look familiar or something?
波蒂埃：你认识?

Liang Yue: No. Just a thought. It's nothing.
梁月：不……我想应该是我记错了。

???: ...
???：……

The woman glances toward the officers, seeming to notice their conversation.
她们关注的对象似乎注意到了此处的交谈，不着痕迹地向梁月与波蒂埃的方向望了一眼。

???: People make mistakes. But some mistakes can't be undone. Don't put that blood on your hands, or it'll never wash off.
???：……有些错误一旦犯下就再也无法挽回，弄脏双手后，你将永远失去站在阳光下的资格。

???: Is hurting this guy worth all that pain and guilt?
???：在那里的那个男人，真的值得你舍弃这一切吗?

???: Sooner or later, he'll get what's coming to him for what he's done. I promise you that.
???：他迟早会受到应有的惩罚，我向你保证。

Her words seem to have an effect. The hostage-taker hesitates, his face contorted in pain, his grip on the knife faltering.
神秘女子的话语似乎对男子生了效，他逐渐露出痛苦挣扎的神色，手上的刀子有所晃动。

Enraged Man: But, but, I must ...
男子：我……但是我必须……！

Poitier: He's distracted. Rookie, time for us to take him down!
波蒂埃：很好，他的注意力分散了。
菜鸟，到我们出场的时候了！

Liang Yue: Please stand down, sir.
梁月：您最好不要乱动，先生！

Although almost half his size, Liáng manages to pin the suspect to the ground. The other officers swarm in, snapping handcuffs around his wrists before he can put up another fight.
人高马大的劫犯最终被比他矮了一个头的少女警探按在了地上。
其他警员们一拥而上，很快将劫犯铐了起来。

Old Police Officer: Suspect under control. I repeat, suspect under control. No further backup needed.
老警察：嫌疑犯已被控制，重复，嫌疑犯已被控制，不需要后续支援。

Looks like this case is wrapped up.
看来他们的任务告一段落了。

Poitier: Nice moves. I was kinda hoping we'd get to see that familiar of yours, though.
波蒂埃：……身手不错。
但真可惜，我还以为终于能够一睹你那位“密友”的真容呢。

Liang Yue: A simple threat like this isn't worthy of Qiángliáng. I have to reserve its assistance unless absolutely necessary.
梁月：对付这种普通的嫌犯并不需要动用到强梁，在我力所能及的方寸之内，我会靠自己解决。

Poitier: So, is this just another one of those rules? Or, do you mean its help comes with a price tag?
波蒂埃：这也是你家里的教诲吗?
还是说驱使它需要额外的代价?

Liang Yue: Both.
梁月：……二者皆是。

Despite the curtness of her response, her eyes widen a little at Poitier's astuteness.
少女有些惊讶地睁大了眼睛。波蒂埃的敏锐出乎了她的意料。

Poitier scowls.
但简短的回答后，梁月却不再做进一步的解释，似乎不愿多说。
这让波蒂埃感到了不满。

Poitier: That it?
波蒂埃：就这样?

Liang Yue: What do you mean?
梁月：您指什么?

Poitier: I mean, so far, every time you talk about the job or your family rules, it's just the surface-level stuff. How do you actually feel about any of this?
波蒂埃：我是指当你开口时，讨论的似乎总是我们的职责和你的家族使命之类的。
不是说这是坏事，但你似乎从来不说你对每件事情的感受。

Liáng looks genuinely confused.
少女似乎颇为不解。

Liang Yue: How I feel? I-I don't understand why it would be necessary to mention that.
梁月：我的感受?
抱歉……但我不太明白讨论这个话题的必要性。

Poitier: Cause we're partners, kid. We've got to trust each other. How am I gonna let you watch my six if I don't even know how you tick?
波蒂埃：当然有必要了。我们可是搭档，我可不想和心里不知道在想什么的家伙并排坐在警车里。

But Liáng still doesn't seem to get it.
但对方似乎仍然没有理解她的意思。
这名年轻的见习执夜人眼神中依然写着疑惑。

Liang Yue: I see. You're my partner and instructor during my assignment with the LAPD Division of Arcane Affairs.
梁月：是的。在我于洛杉矶神秘学犯罪科实习期间，您是我的搭档兼教官。

Liang Yue: So, I will do my best to learn from you and complete my work as assigned. I won't slow you down.
梁月：我会学习您的经验，牢记您的教诲，完成我的工作并通过最终的考核。
我不会给您添麻烦或拖后腿的。

Poitier: That's not what I'm—Urgh. Forget it.
波蒂埃：不，我不是说那个——该死，算了！
当我没说吧。

Liang Yue: ...?
梁月：……？

Liáng's tone all but says, "My personal feelings don't matter." Poitier gives up trying to argue with someone with such a stubborn, unreadable demeanor.
梁月的潜台词仿佛在说“自己的想法并不重要”，这让波蒂埃心中恼火，但对方油盐不进的模样又让她无处发泄。

She simply stares at her, quietly seething to herself. Luckily, before things can spiral further, the hostage cuts through the tension.
围绕着二人的空气变得扎人。
幸亏在事情变得更糟之前，从一旁凑上来的青年闯入了这令人窒息的空间。

Hostage: Oh, thank God you took down that lunatic. I'm really grateful, Miss.
人质：谢天谢地，以及谢谢你，可爱的小姐！
那个家伙真是疯了！

Hostage: But, ain't you a bit young to be an Arcane Affairs Officer? I think I've seen that uniform somewhere else before. You're a vigil, right?
人质：看你小小年纪，可真是了不起。你是神秘学犯罪科的警官吗？
但你的制服看起来似乎有些不同，我想我见过它……是夜巡特遣，对吗？

Liang Yue: Yes, sir. Wait.
梁月：是的，先生——等等。

Liáng swallows the rest of her words as she stares at the hostage she just rescued, her expression suddenly wary.
梁月忽然咽下了未尽的话语，狐疑地盯着刚刚亲手解救出来的人质的面孔。

Liang Yue: I know you.
梁月：我见过你。

Liang Yue: The arcanist scammer, Johnny Three-Times, has been apprehended. Using his arcane skill "Omnis Obeisance," he manipulated his victims to do anything he asked, specifically, transferring all their money to him.
梁月：通过电话作案的神秘学家诈骗犯“棍骗约翰”落网，他用专属神秘术“唯命是从”控制受害者向自己的账户汇入大笔金钱。

Liang Yue: You're that scammer, Johnny Three-Times.
梁月：你是那个神秘学家诈骗犯“棍骗约翰”！

Johnny Three-Times: Oopsie. Guess that's the downside of getting your name in the papers.
棍骗约翰：哎呦……看来这就是上过报纸的坏处了。

Poitier: What? Didn't we already book that guy? What's he doing here?
波蒂埃：什么？
等等，可“棍骗约翰”不是被抓了吗，为什么会出现在这里？

Old Police Officer: He got a sweetheart deal. A reduced sentence in exchange for revealing where he stashed all the dough he stole.
老警察：因为这个家伙骗来的钱一直没有追回来，让他给藏起来了。

Old Police Officer: And it was a s**tload of money too, apparently from some big donors to the mayor's re-election campaign.
老警察：他要求以把钱还回来作为条件，申请减刑。
那也包含政府的一大笔钱，不是个小数目……所以上面的人答应了。

Old Police Officer: Of course, he demanded he be present for the unveiling of his stash. So, they brought him here. That's when this loony attacked the police escort and took him hostage.
老警察：这次放这个人渣出来，就是让他指认藏钱的地方。
没想到半路有人袭击了押送的警员，把他给绑到了这里。

Johnny Three-Times: Hey, easy, officer. You've already got me. No need to be so rough with the cuffs.
棍骗约翰：哎哟！轻点啊，警官。
只是戴个手铐，抓得那么用力做什么？

Old Police Officer: Clam it, Johnny.
老警察：闭嘴，你这个渣滓！

Poitier: We should've just let that guy ice him.
波蒂埃：……早知道刚才就让这家伙死了算了。

Liang Yue: May I ask, officer, do we know if the man trying to kill him was—
梁月：等等，那么刚才那个要杀他的人……难道是？

Old Police Officer: Yeah, he's the son of a victim. This bastard took his mom for all she was worth, and when she found out—boom—heart attack.
老警察：一个受害者家属。被骗钱的是他妈妈，七十多岁的老太太，发现被骗后承受不住……没救回来。

He shakes his head, heaving a weary sigh. Johnny Three-Times snickers.
老警员叹息着摇了摇头，但一旁的“棍骗约翰”却嗤笑了一声。

Johnny Three-Times: Ha. Like mother, like son. He was just as dumb as his doddering old mom. Worse even, cause he didn't even catch wise to it.
棍骗约翰：那人和他家老太婆一样，不仅脑袋不好使，还没有自己是个傻瓜的自知之明。

Johnny Three-Times: It's a concrete jungle, baby, and it follows jungle rules. Survival of the fittest. Crap for brains here never had a chance.
棍骗约翰：丛林里弱肉强食靠的是力量，而在钢筋水泥的城市里优胜劣汰靠的是脑子。

Johnny Three-Times: If it wasn't me, it woulda been someone else. What a joke! Imagine keeling over just cause you lost a bit of cash.
棍骗约翰：没有我，他那老太婆也会叫别人骗了。
再说只是被骗走几个钱就把自己的命整没了，要我说也真是搞笑得很。

Johnny Three-Times: Then we've got this dumbass, coming at me with even less of a brain. Think about it. If he killed me, how's he gonna get his money back?
棍骗约翰：这种人永远不会学习教训，永远不会用脑子。
他也不想想，把我弄死了，他老太婆给骗走的钱从哪里找回来——

Poitier: Shut the f**k up, asshole!
波蒂埃：闭嘴吧，你这个混球！

She levels a punch to his gut, sending him crumpling to the ground, gasping for air.
一记重拳凿进了棍骗约翰的腹部，他抽搐着蜷缩在地。

Johnny Three-Times: UGH!
棍骗约翰：——呃?!

Liang Yue: Officer Poitier, what are you doing?
梁月：波蒂埃教官?!
您在做什么?

Poitier: What? I'm teaching this douchebag a lesson.
波蒂埃：你看了还不明白？当然是给这个自命不凡的畜生一点教训。

Liang Yue: But we can't do that. It's against the rules.
梁月：我们不能这么做，这是违反规定的。

Liáng steps between the two, blocking Poitier from doing any more.
见习执夜人坚定地挡在了棍骗约翰的身前，波蒂埃因此不得不停下了动作。

Johnny Three-Times: *cough* Well, I guess the Vigiles are a cut above the trash when it comes to the DAA. Am I right?
棍骗约翰：咳咳……看来执夜人就是比普通的神秘学警察更明白事理。
你说对吗，警官?

Poitier takes a deep breath as she tries to rein in her frustration.
少女那副义正辞严的模样，和身后棍骗约翰小人得志的嘴脸，让波蒂埃深吸了一口气才压住了心中的怒火。

Poitier: Let's get this straight, rookie. You don't tell me what to do.
波蒂埃：啧……轮不到你来教我什么是对什么是错，菜鸟。

Poitier: I should've known. You're just the worst kind of cop—Everything by the book, sticking to your high-and-mighty principles like you know what's best.
波蒂埃：我最讨厌的就是像你这样的家伙了。
只会高高在上地说些冠冕堂皇的大道理，总以为自己是最正确的那个。

She lets out a frosty huff and turns away.
她的教官冷哼一声，别过头走开了。

Liang Yue: ...
梁月：……

Girl: Liáng Yuè! How dare you rat us out?
女孩：梁月！你为什么要告诉老师?

Liang Yue: Be-Because you did something wrong.
梁月：因为……因为你们那么做是不对的。

Girl: Then you're a rat. I didn't really care if you wanted to come along, but now you go and snitch on us?
女孩：告密精！你不来就算了，为什么要让老师知道?

Boy: I told you we shouldn't have invited her.
男孩：我早说了，就不应该叫她。

Liang Yue: Wait, don't go.
梁月：等等，别走——

Liang Yue: I—
梁月：我——

The clamor of fearful voices cuts her off.
梁月开口，刚想要说些什么——在她的目光落在波蒂埃身后大厅的另一角时，忽然止住了话头。

Young Police Officer: No. Somebody stop him.
青年警察：——我的天哪！快来人阻止他！

降邪 · 1/2
Exorcism · 1/2 SC-04

Johnny Three-Times: Stay back!! Help me! Help!!!
棍骗约翰：不要过来，救命、救命！

The City Hall has been plunged back into chaos. Johnny lets out a shriek, scrambling to get as far away as possible.
市政大厅再一次陷入了混乱，棍骗约翰尖叫着仓皇逃命，试图远离身后的煞星。

Enraged Man: Get away!
男子：让开！

Young Police Officer: Urgh!
青年警察：呃……！

He hurls the officer aside. Blood drips down his fingers from the thumb he broke to slip his hand out of his cuffs.
男子用鲜血淋漓的双手，将试图阻拦他的警员抛到一旁——那是他挣脱手铐时，掰断自己的拇指流下的血。

He moves with inhuman strength, fighting off the approaching officers with ease.
他有如鬼神附体，不知从哪里得来了一股怪力，数个警员一拥而上，竟然也被他轻松撞开。

Enraged Man: Out of my way! I will kill you! I will kill you all!
男子：不要挡我的路！那个王八蛋……我要杀了你，我要杀了你！

Poitier: Damn it! Is this dude high or something?
波蒂埃：该死，那老兄是怎么回事?!

Liang Yue: No, no. I don't think this is drugs.
梁月：他的样子看起来明显不对劲！
那是……

Liang Yue: It's an arcane skill. I sense some kind of evil spirit.
梁月：某种神秘术，和……某种邪祟之物的气息。

Liang Yue: I think I can stop him, ma'am.
梁月：——波蒂埃教官，我想我能让那位先生停下来！

The tension between them has been totally forgotten. The situation is urgent. Poitier gives a sharp nod.
方才的不愉快已经被二人抛在了脑后。
事态紧急，波蒂埃立刻点了头。

Poitier: Fine. Whatever it is, and whatever you think you can do, do it.
波蒂埃：好吧，虽然我不知道你说的“邪祟之物”究竟是个什么——但如果你觉得能做些什么的话，就快做！

Liang Yue: I will. This is my duty.
梁月：明白。
这正是我的使命所在。

Liáng gives a firm nod before rushing toward the suspect.
梁月郑重点了点头，向大厅中央的男子跑去。

Enraged Man: Kill ... I must kill this bastard.
男子：我要杀了这个人渣。杀了他，杀了他……

Enraged Man: Who are you?!
男子：谁?!

Liang Yue: Please stay calm, sir. I have no weapon.
梁月：请您不要紧张，先生。我身上没有武器。

Liang Yue: I'm just here to make a phone call.
梁月：我只是想要请您听一通电话。

Enraged Man: What? A phone call?
男子：什么？……电话?

Liang Yue: Yes.
梁月：是的。

Liang Yue: And you're going to make it.
梁月：一通电话。

Enraged Man: Who are you dialing?
男子：……电话那边是谁?

Liang Yue: You'll soon find out.
梁月：请不要着急，我现在拨通它。

Liang Yue: Arise Qiángliáng, swift and fierce! Banish all evil and cleanse this place!
梁月：强梁既出，罔有不韙。斩杀凶咎——枭截不祥！

NG 画面

Deleted Scene 小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.
???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
2. 我要前进到未来

分支 1 / Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.
???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...
???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……

分支 2 / Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.
???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—
???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.
???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。

选项 / Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.
1. 好了，开始胡扯吧

2. No. I'm tired of you.
2. 不，我已经厌倦你了

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.
???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.
???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Live Tonight with Special Guests

嘉宾夜现场

英文 / ENGLISH

"Tonight's first guest is a brilliant young actress you've seen in C07 Part 1 and C07 Part 2. Now, she's returning for the upcoming C07 Part 3—though, honestly, why not just call them C08 and C09? Anyway, please welcome Qi Xing!"

...

"And then? You know what Noire said? She said, 'We're wrapping up, so we might as well use all the explosives!'"

"So your reaction to the explosion wasn't just your stellar acting?"

"I'd like to think some of it was! But that wide-eyed reaction when the explosion's shockwave hit me? That was definitely real."

"No more big fireworks for Part 3, I take it? You must have used them all up in the last one."

"Fifty-fifty."

"What's that?"

"Fifty-fifty. Either this film ends the series with a bang or flops on its face because of its garbage excuse for an ending. It—"

"Whoa, whoa, whoa! I think we're about to head into spoiler territory! Before Noire sues us, let's cut to commercial!"

中文 / CHINESE

“今晚我的首位嘉宾将是一位优秀的青年演员。你可能已经在很多地方见过她了，比如 C07 第一部、C07 第二部，还有即将上映的 C07 第三部……为什么我们不按序号叫它们 C08 和 C09？总之让我们有请奇星！”

……

“然后呢，你知道菲林士多怎么说么？她说‘反正要杀青了，我们就把炸药都用上吧！’”

“所以你那被爆炸震懵的表现不是演技?”

“一半是演技，只有前半面是演技！那爆炸的推背感可真不是盖的。”

“那我猜 C07 第三部不会有大烟花了？因为你们在前一部用了太多。”

“五十五十吧。”

“嗯?”

“五十五十吧，这电影要么放一个大烟花，要么变成扑街，那个莫名其妙的结……”

“哇喔哇喔哇喔！我想我们遇到了未经许可的结局剧透！在菲林士多女士把我们告上法庭之前，让我们进入广告！”

例行检查
Routine Check 小径

Look at this mirror, dear. There's a sizable stain on it.
???: 看看这面镜子，亲爱的，这上面有好大一个污点。

选项 / Choices

1. It's broken.
1. 它已经碎了

2. I don't see any stains.
2. 我没有看到污点

分支 1 / Branch 1

Yes, it is. Maybe its owner meant to break it so that the stain would be thoroughly removed.
???: 是的，碎了，也许这正是它的主人想要的，要清除一个莫大的污点，你就只有用暴力去摘掉它。

Now the stain is gone, and the owner has a collection of little mirrors. She must have accidentally left this one behind.
???: 现在污点不见了，它的主人还得到了无数面小镜子，我想这面应该是她不小心留下的。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Look closer, dear. You can no longer see the part that has broken off, but you can see where it once was. Right there, a sizable stain.
???: 再仔细瞧瞧，亲爱的，看看这两条裂痕，想象它们延伸出去的交界处，那里有一块难以去除的污渍。

The owner thought the stain would be removed if she smashed the mirror. Now she has a collection of little mirrors, and the stain has gone into hiding.
???: 它的主人以为这样就可以把污渍去掉，现在却只得到了一堆碎镜子，污渍也躲到了她看不到的角落。

选项 / Choices

1. Whose mirror is this?
1. 它的主人是?

A lady with great ambitions and an unconscious charm. A lady who wishes to make the rest of the world accept who she is, and has suggested that many others join her way of thinking.
???: 一位胸怀理想的女性，一心想要让这个世界与自己和解，还会建议其他人加入自己，也因此拥有了无自觉的人格魅力。

Her brother, on the contrary, hopes to be taken in. In his attempt to act like everyone else, he lost an arm in a duel.
???: 而她的哥哥恰好相反，一生的愿望就是得到世界的谅解，会积极地适应世界，想尽办法去融入他人，结果却在决斗中失去了一只胳膊。

If you ask me, dear, I'd say they're very alike. Equally lonely.
???: 但要我说，亲爱的，他们都是一样的，孤独的人。

The brother and sister are a mirror image of each other. She's often repulsed by the sight of him, unable to reconcile herself with all that he reminds her of.
???: 兄妹俩就像是镜子的两面，她却在看着另一个自己时忍不住地反感，总想着生活不该如此。

Now, the brother has found his missing arm, along with his long-lost dignity. The surgery that the sister had been hoping would be done on this world has finally started. But all of a sudden, she's terrified of the incisions.
???: 而现在，另一个她捡起了尊严，找回了丢掉的胳膊。她为世界预约了无数次的大手术也终于有人来执行。她却开始害怕术后创伤了。

As I said, despite their differences in approach, the brother and sister are mirror images of one another.
???: 正如我所说，兄妹俩就是镜子的两面，亲爱的。

But now the mirror is broken. I hope she can make it through the seven years of bad luck. Poor thing. There's no way around it.
???: 现在这面镜子碎了，希望她可以承受得住七年的坏心情，真可怜，她不得不承受。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Excerpt from the New York Times
《纽约新闻报》节选

英文 / ENGLISH
Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson
中文 / CHINESE
前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。
于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。
火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

降邪 · 2/2
Exorcism · 2/2 SC-04

Enraged Man: No! No! My head! Ugh!
男子：不！不……！
我的头……呃啊啊——

Enraged Man: I'm so sorry, Mama.
男子：对不起，妈……对不起……

With one last garbled whisper, the man collapses. The officers around him remain frozen, still too wary to approach.
男子在留下几句模糊不清的呢喃低语后栽倒在地。
周围的警员心有余悸，一时仍然不敢靠近。

Young Police Officer: Should we cuff him?
青年警察：……我们还要给他上手铐吗?

Liang Yue: Allow me. But I believe we should bring him to the hospital to be checked over immediately.
梁月：我来吧。
但我想比起警察局，我们应该先送他去医院进行一番彻底的检查。

Old Police Officer: Think you can handle him? We got this conman to take care of.
老警察：那么他能交给你们吗？我们还得照看那个家伙。

She follows the older officer's gaze.
梁月顺着年长警官所指的方向看去。

Not long ago, Johnny Three-Times was brimming with arrogance. Now, he is a crumpled heap on the floor. A dark stain has formed on the crotch of his pants.
不久前还不可一世的棍骗约翰此刻瘫软在地，细看还会发现他身着的下装有一片不自然的深色印记。

Poitier: God, what a loser.
波蒂埃：天呐，真是个没胆的窝囊废。

Poitier sneers, shaking her head as she turns away. She hesitates, then shifts her gaze to Liáng.
波蒂埃冷笑一声摇了摇头后，便收回了目光。
随后她犹豫片刻，最终将视线投向了梁月。

Poitier: So, uh, y-you know what I'm about to say, right?
波蒂埃：你知道我想说什么，就是……那个，你知道的吧?

Liang Yue: ...?
梁月：……?

Liáng looks visibly confused, although more understandably this time.
回应波蒂埃的是一张满是疑问的面孔。
好吧，这也不能怪对方。

Poitier: Okay. I'm sorry. Is that what you want? For me to say it? Sorry.
波蒂埃：好了……我很抱歉!
这就是我想说的。

Poitier: I felt bad for that guy, but there was nothing we could do for him while he was possessed. If it weren't for you, we might've shot him.
波蒂埃：我同情那个伙计，但也没有帮上什么忙。如果不是你，我们就真的只有击毙他了，而这可不是我想看到的。

Poitier: Well done, Vigil Liáng. And please just forget what I said. I was out of line.
波蒂埃：我刚才说了点难听的话，你就忘了吧。
你帮了大忙——做得好。

The moment her apology ends, she turns her head, unwilling to see Liáng's reaction. But after a long pause, there is no response.
她一气呵成地说完了这番话，别过头去不想看对方的表情。
然而等了许久，波蒂埃却没有等到任何一句回复。

Poitier: Say something.
波蒂埃：……说点什么呀！

She looks back to see Liáng frozen in surprise.
撞进她视野中的是一张写着意外的面孔。

Liang Yue: Oh, right, I ...
梁月：哦……当然，我……

Liang Yue: It's okay. I didn't take it to heart.
梁月：我并没有在意，波蒂埃教官。

Poitier: Ahem. Good.
波蒂埃：……很好。

???: Heh heh.
???：噗……

Poitier: Who's there?
波蒂埃：什……什么人?!

A stifled laugh hits their ears. Poitier springs back like a startled cat.
一声轻笑从侧旁传来，波蒂埃像是一只被踩了尾巴的猫一样蹦了起来。

???: Sorry, I shouldn't eavesdrop. It's a bad habit.
???：抱歉，我并不是有意偷听你们的对话，也并没有取笑你们的意思。

???: It's just you remind me of my friends back in the old days.
???：只是……你们的感情真好，让我想起我从前的朋友们。

Liang Yue: You're the lady that tried to help us soothe him. Thank you for the help.
梁月：您是方才的那位小姐。
是我们疏忽了，我们还没有向您表示过感谢。

Liang Yue: It could have turned out much worse if you hadn't been there. Thank you again.
梁月：多亏了您帮忙安抚住犯人的情绪，事态才没有恶化，我们也才能及时制服那位先生。谢谢您。

???: That's too kind of you, young vigil. I just did what anyone should. Really, it was you and your partner that were the real heroes.
???：你太客气了，小小的见习执夜人小姐，我只是做了我力所能及的事。
更何况，最后真正控制住场面的是你和你的伙伴。

Liang Yue: You're too modest, ma'am. Actually, forgive me for asking.
梁月：您真是谦虚。您……

Liang Yue: Haven't I seen your face before?
梁月：我是不是在哪里见过您?

She studied the woman's face for quite some time before speaking this thought aloud.
梁月盯着女子看了许久，终于忍不住将这个疑问说出了口。

They haven't met in person, no, it was in some other way, but how? Where? She has barely begun forming the words when the woman gives her the answer.
也许她们的相会发生在某个“非现实”的地方——但那是哪里?
徘徊在嘴边的答案，被对方先一步揭晓。

???: Good to know that someone still remembers those old flicks, even after all these years.
???: 没想到时隔多年，还能遇到仍然记得那部电影的人。

The features of the face beneath the beret overlap with a face from Liáng's memory.
贝雷帽下那人的眉眼，逐渐和记忆中另一张面孔重叠在一起。

But the face she remembers lacks the maturity and composure of the woman before her. That face was brimming with youthful confidence, full of fire and energy.
那张记忆中的面孔没有面前女子身上的成熟与稳重，更多的则是意气风发与神采飞扬。

But one thing has remained the same—those bright, shining eyes, like stars twinkling on silver screens and television sets.
但不变的是那双明亮的眼睛。它们就像是夜空中的星星，总是在银幕或录像厅电视机的小小屏幕上闪闪发光。

Liang Yue: Yes, from the movies. That's right.
梁月: 我……想起来了，我见过您。
在电影里见过您。

Liang Yue: You—You're ...
梁月: 您是……您是那位——

Qi Xing: Oops, you got me. I'm Qí Xīng, or were you hoping I'd say Detective C07?
奇星: 是的。
我是奇星，在《神秘警探 C07》里面演 C07 的那个。

She winks at the two dumbfounded officers.
女子向目瞪口呆的二人眨了眨眼睛。

Hospital
医院

ER Doctor: Our full report will take some time. You'll need to wait for now.
值班医生: 辛苦了，距离检测结果出来还需要一段时间，请你们稍等。

Liang Yue: Thank you, doctor.
梁月: 好的……麻烦您了。

Poitier: Our perp had his ID with him. That saves us a lot of digging. Eric Wong, 43, runs a grocery store in Chinatown.
波蒂埃: 那个劫犯随身带着证件，倒是为我们省了不少事。
艾瑞克·黄，43 岁，在唐人街附近经营一家蔬菜店。

Poitier: Let's see. The only family member we've got is his wife, a Lilian Lau, who immigrated to the States 10 years ago. Both have no criminal record, totally clean.
波蒂埃: 父母均已过世，但有个妻子丽莲·刘，十年前来美，各种证件都没有问题。
全家上下没有犯罪记录，可以说都是清清白白的优秀市民。

Poitier: He's an arcanist, apparently, and a powerful one at that. But no reports of any prior misuse of arcanum.
波蒂埃: 虽然因血统原因天生能够使用强大的神秘术，但在这件事之前，他一次都没有将这份能力用在过歪处。

Poitier: His car was found near the crime scene, all filled up with potatoes and carrots from the wholesalers. Either this was just a spur-of-the-moment whacko move or some bizarre attempt at a tuber-based alibi.
波蒂埃：我们在案发地点附近找到了他的车，里面装满了采购回来的土豆啦，胡萝卜什么的……作为障眼法，这高明得有些多此一举了。

Poitier: Anyway. We've contacted his wife, and she should be here soon. Maybe we'll get some more clues from her.
波蒂埃：无论如何，我们已经联系了他的家属，应该过一会儿就能到，我们也许可以从他们的口中获得一些线索。

Poitier: Yo, Liáng? You listening?
波蒂埃：……菜鸟？你在听吗？

Liang Yue: Oh. Y-You're right.
梁月：是啊……在……

Poitier: ...
波蒂埃：……

The answer is obvious—No. Poitier takes a deep breath.
答案显然是否定的。波蒂埃深吸了一口气——

Poitier: Earth calling Liáng.
波蒂埃：回神！

Liang Yue: Whoa!
梁月：哇?!

The sudden shout snaps Liáng out of her daze.
耳边骤然炸开的吼声让神游天外的梁惊得跳了起来。

Liang Yue: Officer Poitier, we're in a hospital. We should keep quiet.
梁月：您……您做什么，波蒂埃教官？
这里可是医院！

Poitier: Hmph. I would have, but that didn't seem likely to bring you back to earth, space cadet.
波蒂埃：我也想要小声，但我看要是声音小了，就根本进不去你的大脑了。

Poitier: So, what's got you lost in space now?
波蒂埃：你到底要发呆到什么时候，不就是见到 C07 的演员了吗？
至于吗？

Liang Yue: Um, I-I'm just thinking.
梁月：我没有发呆，您刚才说的话我都听到了，我只是……只是在思考一些问题。

Poitier: About what?
波蒂埃：哦？那你在思考什么？

Liang Yue: About Ms. Qí Xīng.
梁月：……奇星小姐的事。

Poitier: Ha, right. I guess you're really into those movies, huh? It's all good, boo.
波蒂埃：你看吧？
你说起那个导演的名字时那么熟悉，我就觉得奇怪了。

Poitier: I get the picture now. Our little C07 fan sneaking into the cinema behind her parents' back. You know, you're beginning to almost seem human, princess.
波蒂埃：原来我们的乖乖仔经常会瞒着父母去偷看电影，而且还是《C07》系列的粉丝。你早说嘛！

Poitier: At first, I thought you might be an android, like those Laplace bots that they've got writing parking tickets for us.
波蒂埃：我还一度担心你是个假人，像上次拉普拉斯提供给警局贴罚单的机器人之类的，会偷偷在背地里喝机油。看来我终于可以松一口气了。

Liang Yue: I ...
梁月：我……

Liáng looks as if she wants to argue, but at the last moment, she stops herself.
梁月起初似乎想要反驳，但话到嘴边，她最终改变了主意。

Liang Yue: In fact, I do like Ms. Qí Xīng's C07 movies very much. Her character means a lot to me.
梁月：是的……我的确很喜欢奇星小姐饰演的 C07 系列电影。
那个角色对我来说也有很重要的意义。

Poitier: Oh. Is that the reason why you decided to be a vigil?
波蒂埃：难不成你是因为那部电影才选择做执夜人的?

Liang Yue: Specifically, yes. It's the reason I decided my destiny was to be in the police.
梁月：……准确地说，是它让我接受了自己只能成为警察。

Liang Yue: But back to the topic. I was thinking about Ms. Qí Xīng, but it wasn't because I like her or anything like that.
梁月：话扯得有些远了，波蒂埃教官。
我的确在思考关于奇星小姐的事，但那和我个人的喜恶无关。

She shakes her head, her gaze sharpening, her brows furrowed slightly.
少女摇了摇头，眼神变得凌厉，眉头却微微蹙起。

Liang Yue: It's just that ... her being here made me think about Nightpiercer. Ms. Qí Xīng has a similar arcane skill to the one he appears to use. She called it Silver Needle. She even performed it in her movies.
梁月：制造连续袭击案的“针人”擅长使用飞针型的攻击性神秘术，而奇星小姐当年也正是以亲身上阵实拍的“银针”神秘术闻名。

Liang Yue: Could that really just be a coincidence?
梁月：……这仅仅只是一个巧合吗?

Poitier: Huh?
波蒂埃：哈?

The officer knits her brow as if she's just been hit with a bad joke. But Liáng, deep in thought, continues.
警官拧紧了眉头，就像听到了一个差劲的脑筋急转弯。
但若有所思的梁月继续说了下去。

Liang Yue: And what she said felt meaningful, in some way.
梁月：以及……她刚才的话，我总感觉有些意味深长。

One hour earlier
维尔汀：约一个小时前

Liang Yue: It's a great pleasure to meet you, Ms. Qí Xīng. I—I grew up watching your films.
梁月：很荣幸见到您，奇星小姐!
我……我小的时候是看着您演的电影长大的。

Liang Yue: But what are you doing here in L.A.? Um, I mean, if it's okay to ask?
梁月：您来这里是做什么呢?
我的意思是说，如果方便问的话?

Qi Xing: Sure, not a problem at all. I'm here to see an old friend.
奇星：没有什么不方便的。我是来见一位老友的。

Though she was once a star known across the nation, Qí Xīng speaks warmly and without airs. It's like she's chatting with an old friend.
作为一名曾火遍大江南北的影星，奇星的态度却十分亲和。
她说话的口吻如同与友人闲谈，没有丝毫的拿腔作调。

Liang Yue: Is it Ms. Noire? I heard she's planning a new film.
梁月：您是说……菲林士多导演?
我听说她正在唐人街那边拍戏。

Qi Xing: Oh, so you heard the news? It's been a long time since I last saw her. You're right, though, kid. I've got something I need to talk to her about.
奇星：是的，你也知道?
我们已经很久没见面了，这次因为一些契机，我决定找她聚一聚。

Liang Yue: Um, of course. That's great.
梁月：原来是这样，那真是……太好了。

Liang Yue: Oh, and the Dùshuò Festival is coming soon. I hope you'll go to the Shèhuǒ Parade in Chinatown. It'd be so much fun to see you there.
梁月：马上就是度朔节了，我听说唐人街那边也会举办社火游行，一定会很热闹的。

Poitier: ...?
波蒂埃：……?

The quiet, reserved Liáng has suddenly turned chatty. Poitier stares at her. She's like an entirely different person.
波蒂埃疑惑地盯着话忽然多了起来的梁月，感觉自己的搭档仿佛变成了另一个人。

Qi Xing: Shèhuǒ ... Is it really that time of year again?
奇星：今年的社火游行……也是，不知不觉又到这个时候了。

Liang Yue: You don't like the parade?
梁月：您不喜欢社火游行吗?

Qi Xing: Of course I do.
奇星：不，怎么会呢。

Qi Xing: I like every bit of it—watching people eat, perform, and come together to celebrate the end of the year and to pray for peace and good luck in the next.
奇星：酬神、消灾、祈福、欢祝……人们在热闹的庆典中迎接新一年的到来，祈祷来年风调雨顺、合境平安。

Qi Xing: I like the pure and simple wish that the Shèhuǒ Parade carries.
奇星：社火游行寄托着人们最朴实的愿望，那样纯粹、又那样美好，没有人会不喜欢它。

Qi Xing: But it always reminds me of the ending.
奇星：……只是，每年的社火游行总会让我想到那个结局。

Poitier: What ending?
波蒂埃：结局?

Qí Xīng falls silent, shaking her head. But no more explanation is needed. Liáng's memories have come back to her.
奇星摇了摇头，似乎没有进一步继续这个话题的意思，梁月却忽然福至心灵。

Liang Yue: You mean the ending of the last film in the C07 series?
梁月：难道您是说……C07 系列电影最后一部的那个结局?

She must have guessed correctly. Qí Xīng's eyes widen a little. Then, she gives a small nod.
看起来她猜对了，因为奇星略感意外地睁大了双眼后，点了点头。

Qi Xing: Yes.
奇星：是的。

Qi Xing: I know lots of people like that ending. "A reflection of reality," they say, "Tragedy leaves people with a deeper impression than comedy."
奇星：虽然有许多人对那个结局十分追捧，说它“反映现实”“悲剧比喜剧更能让人记住”……

Qi Xing: But as for me, I hated it. The good guys failed, and the bad guys won? Ha. What kind of an ending is that?
奇星：但坦白说，我并不喜欢当时的那个结局。
坏人在最后并没有得到惩罚，正义的英雄失败了……这算什么?

Qi Xing: Maybe we don't get a say in how things work in reality, but in stories we can. We should.
奇星：我们无法控制现实，但至少能够决定电影里的故事。

Qi Xing: Reality itself is tragic enough already. Why should a movie remind us of how absurd things really are? "What goes around comes around." That's what people want to see in the movies.
奇星：现实的世界已经足够模棱两可，荒谬不经。
善有善报、恶有恶报，这才是大家走进电影院时期待看到的东西。

Her tone has turned unusually serious for a discussion about film, but these words strike a chord with Liáng.
作为一番由电影衍生出的讨论，这名昔日影星的口吻显然有些过于严肃了。
但她所言之中仍然有些梁月颇有同感的地方。

Liang Yue: I-I agree with you. When I was little, I also didn't like how it ended.
梁月：我……我有同感。
我记得小时候的我觉得很奇怪，疑惑为什么会是那种结局。

Liang Yue: Maybe it's true that reality can't guarantee us true justice, but I still want to see justice being served, at least in fiction.
梁月：也许现实的确就是这样无法尽如人意，但我想……至少在电影里，我还是想要看到纯粹的“邪不胜正”。

This response seems to earn Qí Xīng's approval.
梁月的回答似乎博得了奇星的好感，她的眼睛亮了起来。

Qi Xing: I feel the same way. Pardon me for asking.
奇星：见习执夜人小姐，我想请问您一个也许有些冒昧的问题。

Qi Xing: That beast you summoned was something else. It reminded me of a certain creature, a legendary beast from the north of China.
奇星：您刚才呼唤出的那位伙伴让人印象深刻，我想我在传说中读到过符合它特征的记载。

Qi Xing: *"Arise Qiángliáng, swift and fierce! Banish all evil and cleanse this place!"*
奇星：“强梁既出，罔有不韙。斩杀凶咎，枭截不祥”……

Qi Xing: That must make you a descendant of the Liáng family, right?
奇星：您想必就是梁家的后人，并且是那少数受到了眷顾的孩子之一，对吗?

Something in Qí Xīng's gaze makes Liáng feel as though she's standing too close to an open flame. But even so, she answers truthfully.
奇星眼中的某种东西，让梁月产生了被灼烧般的错觉。
但梁月仍然诚实地回答了对方的问题。

Liang Yue: Yes. I'm Liáng Yuè, from the Liáng family of the Twelve Zhènzǐ.
梁月：我的确是十二振子之一的梁家之后，我叫梁月。

Qi Xing: Liáng Yuè ... Liáng Yuè.
奇星：梁月……梁月。

Qi Xing: It's a good name, little vigil. I'll keep it in mind.
奇星：好的，我记住你了。

局外人 · 1/2
Outsider · 1/2 SC-05

Liang Yue: I read an article about the conflicts between Ms. Qí Xīng and the other two producers of the Co7 series.
梁月：我记得我在报纸上看到过，关于奇星小姐以及另外两位《神秘警探 C07》系列电影主创人员之间的矛盾与纠纷。

Liang Yue: Before, I thought it was only rumors. But now, thinking over what she said, what if it's true?
梁月：我本以为那不过是八卦杂志捕风捉影编造的谣言，但如果包括奇星小姐与菲林士多的分歧和矛盾在内的那些传闻都是真的的话……

Liang Yue: What am I saying? It's ridiculous.
梁月：不，这太荒谬了。

Poitier: Then stop pouting over it, princess. We've got work to do.
波蒂埃：别想啦，瞧你那副愁眉苦脸的样子！

Liang Yue: Urgh!
梁月：呃！

The hallway of the Laplace Rehabilitation Center Cooperative Hospital is bustling with people. Lost in thought, Liáng is jolted back to reality by a firm clap on the back.
人来人往的拉普拉斯康复中心合作医院走廊中，冥思苦想的见习执夜人少女后背上挨了搭档的一记掌击。

Poitier: You wanna bet on how many people in L.A. have similar arcane skills? Come on. It's a total coincidence.
波蒂埃：一个用“银针神秘术”的罪犯出没在洛杉矶，而奇星本人也刚好在这个城市，用着同一个神秘术……

Poitier: You don't really think they're the same person, do you? That'd be nuts!
波蒂埃：你不会打算单凭这些就说奇星是犯人吧？那也太离谱了。

Poitier: I mean it's the Detective Co7 we're talking about. Sure, she's been retired from acting for a while, but she's like super famous.
波蒂埃：拜托，那可是奇星，曾经的超级巨星！
虽然她现在不再出演电影了，但是当年谁没有看过她演的电影？

Poitier: If she was gonna go all kooky and start taking out crooks like she was the real Co7, why wait all this time? It's been years since her last movie, and we're only just dealing with this Nightpiercer guy now.
波蒂埃：如果是演戏走火入魔、觉得自己真是电影里那个行侠仗义的正义英雄，那又为什么现在才开始作案？这讲不通。

Poitier: Besides, it's not like it's a crazy, unusual type of arcane skill. Who knows? Maybe this Nightpiercer guy is a fan of Detective Co7's films too? Can't rule out anything yet.
波蒂埃：针型的攻击性神秘术不是什么少见的东西。“针人”也许只是看过那部电影之后模仿了里面的神秘术，又或者这只是巧合……

Poitier: Hey, you okay in there? Did I knock the wind out of you?
波蒂埃：……喂，你没事吧？我刚才有那么用力吗？

Liang Yue: *cough* It's okay. I'm fine.
梁月：咳、咳……请别在意，我没事。

Liáng shakes her head.
梁月摇了摇头，并无追究的意思。

Poitier, still bewildered and perhaps feeling a little guilty, insists that she didn't mean to hit her so hard. Not that it matters. At least the sudden smack did the trick in pulling Liáng out of her spiraling thoughts.
波蒂埃茫然中带着心虚的表情诉说着她并非有意而为之，更何况……
这突如其来的一击，也的确将梁月带离了方才纷杂的思绪。

Neither the test results nor the suspect's family has arrived yet. Liáng makes her way to the vending machine at the far end of the hallway with the coins Poitier dropped in her hand as a half-hearted apology and buys herself an orange juice.
检查结果和嫌犯的家属都还没有到来，带着波蒂埃聊表歉意的几枚硬币，梁月来到医院走廊的一角，和自动贩卖机交换了一瓶橙汁。

But that absurd thought, that ridiculous guess from earlier, still refuses to leave her mind.
但方才那个“荒谬的猜测”仍然盘踞在她的脑海中，不肯离去。

Liang Yue: Forget it. Just like you said, it doesn't make any sense.
梁月：……快忘了它们吧，那根本不可能，而且也不符合逻辑。

All attempts to push the thought from her mind are failing. That is, until a frantic voice cuts through the air.
忘却的尝试并不成功，直到一个焦急的声音打断梁月纷乱的思绪。

Doctor: But you're injured, ma'am. You can't just leave.
医生：但您受伤了！您不能就这样离开。

???: I'm totally fine. It's just a tiny smidge of damage. I can fix it myself.
???：我没受伤，我没事！这个只是……只是坏了一点而已，我会自己修的！

Doctor: You call a broken arm a smidge? You need to let us treat it immediately.
医生：您在说什么呀，您怎么能如此轻视自己的身体？我看得出来，您的手臂绝对是断了，必须要处理一下才行！

Liang Yue: What's going on here?
梁月：发生什么事了？

The doctor recognizes her uniform immediately.
医生通过梁月身上的制服认出了她的身份。

Doctor: Are you a vigil? Could you help me stop this girl? She's trying to leave with a broken arm.
医生：您是……一名执夜人？
您来得正好，也许您能够帮忙劝住这个孩子。

Doctor: She was in an accident. But since she's woken up, she's refused to let us examine anything.
医生：她刚才在乘坐出租车的时候遭遇了一场交通事故，失去意识被送到了这里。
但她醒来之后，居然要求我们不要管她……

Doctor: She might not be our normal kind of patient, but we're doctors. We can't let someone leave when they need immediate medical attention.
医生：我看得出这孩子的体质特殊，但无论如何我们是医生，不能就这样坐视伤者带着病痛离开。

???: A vigil?
???: 执夜人……?!

???: I-I-I-I-I-I'm in a hurry now. I'm gonna miss my bus.
???: 但但但但但我真的赶时间，再不走我就要赶不上车了！

Beneath the girl's clothing, the exposed skin has a cold, metallic sheen. That must be what the doctor meant by "not our normal kind of patient."
细看不难发现少女衣装下裸露的“皮肤”呈冷硬的金属色泽，想必这就是医师口中“体质特殊”的缘由。

Liáng notices the emblem on her chest, marking her as an employee of the St. Pavlov Foundation. How odd that she'd have such a panicked reaction at the sight of a vigil.
梁月当然没有错过少女胸前代表圣洛夫基金会职员身份的徽章。
但在看清梁月所身着的制服后，对方表现出的惊慌失措却令人生疑。

Liang Yue: There'll be another bus, but you only have one body. You should listen to the doctor, sit down, and wait, until you're cleared to leave.
梁月：……我想不论是什么样的急事，都比不上身体重要。
这位医生说得没错，您最好接受检查后再离开。

Liang Yue: Please show us your ID so that the doctor can give you treatment.
梁月：因此请您出示一下您的身份证件吧，这样医生才好为您进行诊疗。

For a few stiff seconds, the girl's mechanical head freezes in place. Then, in a movement almost too fast to follow, it snaps up.
那颗机械脑袋僵硬了几秒。
随后，以堪称迅猛的气势仰了起来。

???: Look. A hamster riding a stethoscope.
???: 我的老天爷！有一只仓鼠骑着听诊器在天花板上飞！

Liang Yue: A hamster what?
梁月：仓鼠骑……什么？

The bizarreness of these words leaves Liáng no choice but to glance in the pointed direction, only to confirm, of course, that there is no hamster nor stethoscope in sight.
实在过于令人匪夷所思的台词让梁月不由得真的转头看了看……
而理所当然的，并没有仓鼠骑着听诊器在天花板上飞。

???: Now!
???: 就是现在！

Liang Yue: Hey, wait!
梁月：你……等等，站住！

屏幕上的普通市民
Voices on the Street 小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.
???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
2. 我要前进到未来

分支 1 / Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.
???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...
???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……

分支 2 / Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.
???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—
???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.
???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。

选项 / Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.
1. 好了，开始胡扯吧

2. No. I'm tired of you.
2. 不，我已经厌倦你了

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.
???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.
???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Street Interviews

街边采访

英文 / ENGLISH

Last night, the Nightpiercer struck again, attacking the convoy transporting the infamous Johnny Three-Times. Two officers were knocked unconscious during the attack; however, Johnny Three-Times was seriously injured and is remains in critical condition.

Insiders say citizens clashed with the convoy earlier that day due to dissatisfaction over Johnny Three-Times's light sentencing. Later that night, the Nightpiercer struck, seemingly enacting vigilante justice on behalf of Johnny Three-Times's victims. Public support for the Nightpiercer has grown since.

And although it's already been a day since the attack, crowds still gather at the scene. We're here to hear what the people on the street have to say.

...

"Serves him right! That scumbag deserves a prickly end!"

...

"I think following the law is important, but honestly, the way Johnny Three-Times got such a light sentencing feels off ..."

...

"Who me? Are you asking me? Oh, sorry, miss, but you haven't happened to see Co7, have you?"

"Oh, no reason, I thought this was one of those prank interviews they've been doing lately. Um, how should I put this ... Sorry, but someone in my position isn't really allowed to comment on politics."

中文 / CHINESE

昨日夜间，针人再次出动，袭击了押送臭名昭著的棍骗约翰的队伍，两名警员昏迷但无大碍，棍骗约翰重伤，目前仍未脱离生命危险。

据知情人士透露，曾有市民因不满对棍骗约翰的处置而在昨日早晨与押送队伍发生正面冲突，加

上棍骗约翰的受害者不在少数，这使得支持针人的声音愈发响亮。
现在我们就在案发现场，尽管一天过去，这里仍然聚集了大量群众，让我们来直接听听他们的看法。
……
“做得好！就该把那混账扎成马蜂窝！”
……
“我是觉得总该依法行事的，但这次对棍骗约翰的处置于情于理都有些……”
……
“嗯？问我么？不好意思，这位小姐，你看过 C07 么？”
“哦，没什么，我还以为这是不是什么整人节目。嗯……怎么说呢，不好意思，我的身份不允许我乱谈时政啦。”

救死扶伤
Saving Lives 小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.
???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
2. 我要前进到未来

分支 1 / Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.
???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...
???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……

分支 2 / Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.
???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—
???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.
???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。

选项 / Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.
1. 好了，开始胡扯吧

2. No. I'm tired of you.
2. 不，我已经厌倦你了

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.
???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.
???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

The Laplace Rehab Center Welcomes You!
拉普拉斯康复中心合作医院欢迎你!

英文 / ENGLISH

Welcome to the Laplace Rehabilitation Center!

We are the world's leading hospital specializing in arcanum, whether you are:

· Suffering from arcanum-related injuries.

· Cursed with bad luck after an argument with your neighbor.

· Transforming more and more into a beetle with each passing morning.

· Suddenly recalling your past life as a Pharaoh, causing you great distress at your office job.

The Laplace Rehabilitation Center is committed to giving you the best treatment available!

Don't worry about whether your rare condition is covered by health insurance. To thank you for contributing to medical advancements, we offer discounts and subsidies based on the rarity of your condition. Each rare condition gets you a flat 60% discount! If you're simultaneously bitten by a vampire and a dragon while dissolving into an oil painting, but you're somehow still

alive, then that's right—your treatment will be free, AND we'll even pay you 80% of the treatment cost as a bonus!

Thank you for supporting the Laplace Rehabilitation Center, helping you helps us help everyone.
中文 / CHINESE
欢迎来到拉普拉斯康复中心合作医院！
我们是世界首屈一指的神秘学专科医院，不论您是：
·遭受了神秘术创伤。
·被邻居下了霉运诅咒。
·一觉醒来变成了甲壳虫。
·突然苏醒了前世作为法老王的记忆而导致日常生活天翻地覆。
拉普拉斯康复中心合作医院都将为您提供最妥善的治疗方案！
请不要担心疑难杂症是否纳入医疗保险，为了感谢您对医学进步做出的贡献，我们会根据症状的稀有度提供减免以及补贴，每种罕见病症将带来百分之六十的费用减免！如果您同时被血食怪和龙咬了还正在溶解成油画却仍活着，我们甚至会在免费治疗时为您提供相当于治疗费百分之八十的奖金！
感谢您对拉普拉斯康复中心的支持！

局外人 · 2/2
Outsider · 2/2 SC-05

Medical Staff: Watch out!
医护人员：哦，小心！

Liang Yue: Sorry, I'm after a—
梁月：抱歉，医生，我急着——

The hospital's narrow hallways are hardly suitable for a chase, and Liáng quickly finds her path blocked by a supply cart. By the time she's made it past, the mechanical-headed girl has disappeared.
并不宽敞的医院走廊显然并不适合上演追逐战，梁月被一辆从拐角处出现的手推车挡住了去路，再抬头时已经不见那颗机械脑袋的影子了。

Her metal chameleon communication device, issued by the Division of Arcane Affairs, gives off its distinctive chime.
自神秘学犯罪科领取的金属变色龙通信器发出了独有的声响，打消了梁月正欲继续追踪的意图。

Poitier: Hey, rookie. Where did you go? Get back here. The medical report is ready, and Mr. Wong's family just arrived.
波蒂埃：喂，菜鸟！你买个饮料跑去哪里了？
尽快回来，检查结果出来了，那位先生的家属也到了。

Liang Yue: I ... Understood. How's Mr. Wong doing?
梁月：我……好的。
检查的结果如何？

There's a long pause on the other end of the line.
通信的另一端沉默了片刻。

Poitier: It's not pretty.
波蒂埃：不太乐观。

Ward
病房

Enraged Man: ...
男子：……

Mr. Wong is lying unconscious on the hospital bed, looking haggard. His breathing is labored and raspy, like wind rattling through a hollowed-out log.
病床上沉睡的男人形容枯槁，呼吸间发出犹如拉风箱般的声音，宛如一棵被蛀虫掏空的朽木。

Woman: How ... What happened to him? He seems completely normal this morning.
女子：怎么……怎么弄成这样啊！
他这是怎么了？早上还好好的呀！

Her legs go weak. Were it not for the man supporting her, she might have collapsed entirely.
她的四肢软了下去，幸而有随行的男人托撑着，才不至于垮倒。

???: Please relax, Ms. Wong. We have to wait and see what the doctor says.
???：别着急，听听医生怎么说。

Poitier: You again?
波蒂埃：是你?

Poitier instantly recognizes him—one of the Division of Arcane Affairs's least welcome and regular visitors.
波蒂埃立刻认出，男子正是隔三岔五就会造访神秘学犯罪科的那位并不受欢迎的常客。

Poitier: Right, right. You're the local arcane private eye, aren't you, Zhōu? Are you commissioned by the victim?
波蒂埃：哦……我记起来了。
您是一位持证的神秘学民间侦探。您是接受了这位女士的委托吗?

Private Investigator: What?
民间侦探：什么?

The man's eyes widen in surprise before shooting Poitier a venomous glare.
他先是诧异地瞪大了眼睛，随后狠狠剐了波蒂埃一眼。

Private Investigator: Ha. Unlike some tax leeches out there, I actually help people in need.
民间侦探：哈！
我和某些拿着不菲的薪酬，却无所作为的蛀虫可不同。

Private Investigator: And I don't charge a fee when it comes to my neighbors.
民间侦探：街坊邻里有难时帮一把手，在我这里是不收钱的。

Poitier: Sorry.
波蒂埃：……抱歉，是我失言了。

He clearly has no interest in arguing at a time like this. He lets out a cold snort and turns to the doctor with a questioning look.
男子显然也无意在此时争吵，冷哼一声后不再理睬身着制服的两名警官，而是用询问的眼神望向一旁的医生。

ER Doctor: Ms. Liáng has cleared the unknown arcane skill that was afflicting him. His physical condition is stable, but I fear there may be some long-term effects on his mind.
值班医生：执夜人梁小姐为他清除了身上所中的未知神秘术，但尽管生理上并无大碍，那种未知的术式仍然留下了后遗症。

ER Doctor: He seems to be suffering from a severe thought and memory disorder. It would be best to keep him asleep.
值班医生：他的精神状态十分糟糕，呈现出了严重的思维混乱和记忆错乱症状。
我们不得已，只好让他保持睡眠状态了。

Woman: Doctor, when will he wake up? Can I speak to him?
女子：那……那大夫，他什么时候能醒过来？我能和他说话吗？

ER Doctor: For now, we suggest against it. It may cause him additional distress to see someone familiar to him. We fear there might be memory loss.
值班医生：我们不建议您在您丈夫清醒的情况下和他会面。
他大概率……是无法认出您的。

Woman: What? How?
女子：什么？怎么……

Woman: What should I do now? With his mother gone, I can't take any more of this.
女子：诶呀，这都是什么事呀！
先是妈走了，现在你也……这叫我怎么办才好啊？

Liang Yue: Madam ...
梁月：女士……

The woman looks as though all the strength has been drained from her body as she slumps into a nearby chair. Liáng opens her mouth to offer comfort but can't seem to find the right words.
女子像是被抽走了力气，瘫坐在一旁的座椅上。
梁月张口欲安慰对方，却不知该说些什么。

Zhōu's gaze sweeps past Poitier before settling on Liáng.
男人的目光扫过波蒂埃，最终瞪向梁月。

Private Investigator: So, who's the little Chinese kid? Did the DAA give you a sidekick to do your job for you?
民间侦探：看来，你们警局专门请来了一个华人小跟班来“对症下药”。

Private Investigator: Forget it lah. Listen, if you're not going to do your best to help these people, then it's better you just stay out of my way.
民间侦探：但如果你们帮不上忙，就不必假惺惺地站在这里碍事了。
算我拜托你们，给我片刻安宁吧！

Liang Yue: ...
梁月：……

Liáng looks to Poitier with a questioning gaze. Poitier shakes her head and sighs, gesturing for her to come closer before handing over the hospital's diagnosis.
梁月用询问的目光看向波蒂埃，后者无奈地摇摇头，招手让梁月来到身旁后，向她出示了院方的诊断结果。

Poitier: When they first brought him in, there were remnants of the arcanum riddled through his body. It might have gone a long way to proving he wasn't in control of himself.
波蒂埃：这个可怜的家伙身上残留的神秘术痕迹，能够证明当时他无法控制自己的行为。这让他能够免于牢狱之灾。

Poitier: But I guess anything definitive has already faded away. The doctors couldn't isolate a cause.
波蒂埃：但坏消息是那股神秘术气息很快消散了，医院没能查出他到底是出了什么毛病。

Poitier: Worse-case scenario, they might not believe us and have this poor guy shoved off to the funny farm.
波蒂埃：这样下去，这个可怜的家伙也许后半辈子都要在精神病院里度过了。

Liáng clenches her fists and looks toward the woman curled up in the hospital chair, quietly sobbing. She looks so small against the oversized seat.
梁月握紧了拳头，看向蜷缩在病房的座椅上低声啜泣的女子。
和宽大的座椅相比，她的身影是那样单薄。

Finally, Liáng steps forward and crouches beside the chair.
最终，梁月走上前去，在坐椅旁蹲下了身。

After a brief hesitation, she reaches out and places a hand over the woman's. Zhōu looks surprised.
迟疑片刻后，在那名并不友好的男子惊讶的目光中，她伸手覆上女子的手背。

Liang Yue: Madam, please, you need to stay strong for your husband.
梁月：阿姨，您别太难过了……这样伤身体。

Liang Yue: They've brought in some of the best doctors from the Laplace Rehab Center. If there is anyone that can help him, it'll be them.
梁月：叔叔现在这样的情况也只是暂时的。
这里有拉普拉斯康复中心外派来的名医，一定能够找到方法治好他的。

In a way, it is a promise with no real guarantee—a statement that could almost be considered a lie. But even lies have value when a person needs to hear them.
某种意义上来讲，这番其实并无任何保证的承诺甚至可以被定义为谎言。
但谎言也有它的价值，有人需要谎言。

The woman hastily wipes her tear-streaked face and lifts her head.
它起效了。
女子抬手草草擦去面庞上的泪珠，仍然红着眼睛，但至少抬起了头。

Woman: He said that he was going to buy produce from the wholesalers, but I couldn't reach him. And then, the police called.
女子：我……我从上午起就联系不上他，说是去进货，人却迟迟不见踪影。
结果到了下午，我就接到警察的电话，说他……

Woman: My husband is a good man. Everyone knows that. He would never do something like this.
女子：我家这口子一向老实、脾气好，街坊邻里都知道。
他肯定做不出来这种违法的事情的！

Woman: Please, Miss, you have to help us.
女子：警官，求求你啊！
你可得帮帮我们，帮我们查清楚啊！

Liang Yue: ...!
梁月：……！

The woman grasps Liáng's hand tightly in hers, her fingers trembling.
女子捉住了梁月的手，紧紧握住，却又在不断颤抖。

Her hands are gentle, yet rough, etched with years of hard work—the kind of hands earned through long days and nights of striving for a better life.
那是一双柔软却也粗糙的手，书写着一对平凡的夫妇为更好的生活而勤恳拼搏的日日夜夜。

Liang Yue: I ...
梁月：……我……

In her palm, she can feel the woman's desperate, burning warmth. It is so hot. She feels it could scorch her.
贴合的皮肤处传来带着焦急和绝望的体温。
那温度滚烫，甚至让人产生了要被灼伤的错觉。

Liáng takes a deep breath.
——梁月吸了一口气。

Liang Yue: You can rely on us, ma'am.
梁月：当然了。
阿姨，您放心。

Liang Yue: We'll find out the truth behind this. I promise you.
梁月： ——我们一定会查清楚真相的。

She gives the woman's hand a firm, reassuring squeeze.
梁月用力回握住那双手。

Woman: Thank you. Thank you so much!
女子： 好呀……好呀！我先谢谢你们了！

Woman: You are our only hope, please!
女子： 就全靠你了，姑娘！

Sometimes, a lie can become the truth. All it takes is someone willing to make it so.
——谎言也能够成真，有人决心做到这一点。

Private Investigator: ...
民间侦探： ……

The door to the ward is shut behind them. After a moment of silence, Poitier tilts her head.
病房的门在二人的身后合上。
短暂的相顾无言后，波蒂埃挑起一侧的眉毛，先开了口。

Poitier: Rookie mistake, princess. Never make a promise about something you don't get to decide on.
波蒂埃： 听起来你擅自答应了一些不在我们职务范围内的事情，菜鸟。

Liang Yue: I'm sorry, Ms. Poitier. But I only meant—
梁月： 抱歉，波蒂埃教官。
但请您听我说，我——

Poitier: Hold it.
波蒂埃： 停，停。

Poitier: I didn't say we weren't gonna do our best.
波蒂埃： 我又没说不行。

Liang Yue: ...
梁月： ……

The words she was about to say no longer serve any purpose. Instead, Liáng does something Poitier has never seen her do before. She smiles.
那些还没能出口的话语失去了它们的用场。
片刻后，梁月露出了一个在波蒂埃印象中也许是第一次见的笑脸。

Liang Yue: Thank you, ma'am.
梁月： 谢谢您，波蒂埃教官。

Poitier: Not so fast. We still need some solid evidence if we're gonna crack this case.
波蒂埃： 别着急谢我。
就算要调查，我们也得有线索才行。

Liang Yue: But where to begin? It seems like there are no obvious clues beyond what we've seen. Mr. Wong had no enemies and was well-loved in his community.
梁月： 目前并没有明显的线索。
就像那位女士说的一样，她的丈夫一向与人为善，没有任何仇家。

Liang Yue: If that's the case, then it can't be a simple motivation. Still, something sticks out to me. When I asked about any recent events or happenings, it wasn't Mrs. Wong that answered. It was ...
梁月： 他的交友圈子也十分干净，属于低危人群。
但当我问到唐人街有没有什么怪事的时候，她身边的那个大叔主动开口了。

Poitier already knows where this is going.
这是个足以让波蒂埃惊讶的消息。

Poitier: Zhōu. Our private eye with a chip on his shoulder against the DAA.
波蒂埃：那个一向讨厌我们的赤脚侦探?

Liang Yue: Yes. He mentioned that there have been strange things going on around L.A.'s Chinatown recently.
梁月：是的。他提到最近唐人街一带，零零碎碎地发生了许多怪事。

Liang Yue: According to my notes, he mentioned there were children that suddenly became distant and unresponsive, young men that began showing signs of memory loss, and an otherwise healthy elder that rapidly developed signs of dementia.
梁月：像幼儿经常神不守舍，年轻人忽然变得精神恍惚，又或是原本精神抖擞的老者一夜间变得痴呆健忘……

Liang Yue: Absent-mindedness, empty despondence towards family and friends, memory loss. It all sounds very familiar to Mr. Wong's condition. But no one thought to bring the matter to the police.
梁月：也有人像是黄先生这样，变得癫狂易怒。
但他们认为这只是邻里之间的小摩擦，因此大多没有报案。

Liang Yue: I also spoke with the nurses here. They said they've also noticed an increase in patients from Chinatown, complaining of confusion and memory loss.
梁月：我询问了护士，她们也证实说唐人街片区最近收治了不少“因不明原因出现精神异常”的患者。

Liang Yue: I guess, once again, no one thought it was serious enough for our attention.
梁月：不过没有一例上报——毕竟事情“不大不小”。

Poitier's expression darkens.
梁月话语间透露的意思让波蒂埃的脸色凝重了起来。

Poitier: Well, whatcha thinking, cadet? Are all these cases related?
波蒂埃：你怀疑这些“怪事”都是同一种神秘学事件导致的?

Poitier: If it's as widespread as you're making it out to be, we might be in over our heads.
波蒂埃：这可不是一个能随随便便拿出来的结论。
如果真是这样，那……这件事的严重程度就远超我们的想象了。

Liang Yue: Even so, I think we can't overlook it as a possibility.
梁月：既然存在这个可能性，我想我们就不该忽视。

Liang Yue: Arcane skills that directly affect the mind are rare, but they do exist. I've read of similar cases in the Vigiles Archive.
梁月：直接影响高等智慧生命精神层面的神秘术虽然罕见，但并不是不存在。
在夜巡特遣的档案室中，我阅读过不少这样的案例。

Liang Yue: One of them, as I recall, had very similar symptoms to what we're seeing here.
梁月：在那些案例中，受害者的症状乍看起来都各不相同——
这恰好和眼下发生在唐人街的现象一致。

Liáng's brow furrows.
梁月说到这里，又皱眉露出了思索的神情。

Liang Yue: However, if there were some criminal intention behind all of these symptoms, what could it be?
梁月：令我百思不得其解的是，若这一切都是人为，施术者的动机又是什么?

Liang Yue: Or could it be an accident? Maybe a child with a powerful arcane skill who can't control it? Or some unregulated and dangerous arcane objects?
梁月： 又难道说，这起事件是个意外？是某个血统强大却还无法掌控神秘术的幼童，抑或是某些未被监管的危险神秘学物件引发的?

Liang Yue: We can't draw any conclusions without more evidence.
梁月： 现阶段证据太少……我们还无法下定论。

The two officers look troubled. Then, as if something has clicked in her mind, Poitier's face lights up.
眼下只能得出这个说不上是结论的结论，二人都是愁眉不展。
片刻后，波蒂埃却像是忽然想起了什么。

Poitier: Arcane objects ... Isn't there a department in the Foundation that stores and records dangerous arcane materials?
波蒂埃： 不过说起来，我记得你们基金会就有一个专门的部门，负责“关押”那些可能捅出篓子来的小玩意。

Liang Yue: Yes, at the headquarters of the Foundation. And its official name is ...
梁月： 是的，就在圣洛夫基金会总部。
它叫做——

Liang Yue: The Arcanum Containment Department.
梁月： 神秘学藏品管理部。

Matilda: Ah. Voilà. I believe I am here.
玛蒂尔达： 到达，我想就是这里没错了。

Matilda: Hmm, it is much brighter and more spacious than I expected.
玛蒂尔达： 嗯……倒是比我想象中的更整洁明亮一些。

秘密通缉令
Secret Warrant SC-06

Matilda: Cabinets, cabinets, and more cabinets.
玛蒂尔达： 柜子，柜子，柜子……还是柜子。

Matilda: Who is in charge here? I was under the impression this was an important department, no? Where is the security?
玛蒂尔达： 这里的人去哪里了?
奇怪，这样重要的部门，连个看管的人都没有吗?

The ever-curious Matilda weaves her way through the rows of filing cabinets. She has read about this department in books detailing the Foundation's history.
博闻强识的优等生玛蒂尔达小姐穿过一排又一排的档案柜。
她在介绍基金会历史的书籍中读到过关于这个部门的事。

Matilda: "The department contains all known objects which have produced dangerous or mysterious arcane phenomenon."
玛蒂尔达： 我记得那本书上写着：“从古至今几乎所有的神秘学现象，你都能够在神秘学藏品管理室中找到与之匹配的物件。”

Matilda: Some even say it contains "Every arcane mystery—solved and unsolved—that has ever been recorded."
玛蒂尔达： 甚至还有人说：“在神秘学藏品管理室的档案柜之外，已经不存在尚未解开的神秘学谜团了……”

Matilda: But of course, the biggest mystery of all time, the "Storm," still defies them.
玛蒂尔达：但接下来的事大家都知道了，“暴雨”来了。

Matilda: As it does for us all. It seems, with every department turned to the study of the "Storm," there is little time to spare for these more trivial puzzles.
玛蒂尔达：几乎所有部门的工作重心都转向破解这个最大的神秘学谜团，没有人再关心神秘学藏品管理室的档案柜里那一个个“小谜团”了。

Her footsteps echo through the empty department, and the odd sense that she's being watched settles over her.
脚步声在空荡荡的楼层中回响。
玛蒂尔达莫名有一种被注视的感觉，却始终没有看到半个人影。

Silence can be comforting, but it can also be unsettling—a breeding ground for loneliness, dredging up long-buried unease.
安静有时令人放松，有时则令人避讳。
它会传染孤独，将人们压在心底深处的不安翻出水面。

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Matilda: I wonder how Mama is doing. Madam Z said she would keep an eye on her, but still no updates.
玛蒂尔达：不知道妈妈怎么样了。
Z 女士说会帮忙关注她的消息，可现在却还是没有音信……

She finds herself pausing, her gaze lowering to the ground.
勇敢的小调查员不知不觉停下了脚步，垂下了头去。

But only for a moment.
——但也只有片刻。

Matilda: No, bring yourself together, Matilda Bouanich. This is your mama, the greatest mother of all time. What could possibly have gone wrong?
玛蒂尔达：不对，你在想什么呢？那可是伟大的玛蒂尔达小姐的伟大的妈妈！
她不会出什么事的。

With renewed confidence, she picks up her pace, her pale ponytail bouncing behind her.
伴随着她大步迈开的步伐，浅色的单边马尾再次精神抖擞地跃动了起来。

Matilda: Now her most outstanding daughter runs an important errand for the Foundation, unlike some others who have dedicated their valuable time to a vacation in the name of "reviving the Uluru Games."
玛蒂尔达：倒是那个狡猾的维尔汀，打着什么“复兴乌卢鲁运动会”的名号度假……
而踏实可靠的优等生玛蒂尔达小姐却在这里跑腿！

Matilda: Still, one must hope they will succeed in making the games as grand and sublime as they say they were in the distant past, or else ...
玛蒂尔达：她最好祈祷真的能够举办一场像是历史书里面写的那样的、盛大而恢宏的运动会，不然我就要——

Matilda: Hmm?
玛蒂尔达：嗯？

Just as she passes another set of shelves, something catches her eye.
在穿过某排档案柜时，划过视野边缘的一抹异色让她停下了脚步。

???: Everything's fine here. Now, on to the next row.
???：看来这边没有什么问题。那么下一列就是……

???: Oh. This is one of my favorites.
???: 哦！
是它，我最喜欢的神秘学管理品之一！

Matilda: What is it?
玛蒂尔达: 那是什么？

???: An excellent question, Miss. See that serial number on it?
???: 好问题！
这可是件了不起的东西，看看上面的编号你就明白了。

???: AN-003, a water sample from the Pèilín River. Number 003.
???: ——神秘学管理品编号 AN-003，沛霖川的河水。
003 号耶！

???: There are hundreds of thousands of samples, collections, and records here, but no matter who you ask, this particular one will always make their top list.
???: 尽管我们神秘学藏品管理部里收藏着无数珍奇有趣的东西，但不论让谁来选出自己最喜欢的前一百名，它都百分百会上榜。

???: Collected in a remote city in China. When the investigators arrived, they found that it had been isolated in time. All its inhabitants dressed and lived as if they were from the late Táng Dynasty.
???: 它来自中国内陆一个与世隔绝的古城，当调查员来到那座城池的时候，他们发现城里的人们居然依旧维持着中国晚唐时期的着装与风俗。

???: They were completely unaware of the state of the world beyond their lands, as if trapped in a time capsule from the forgotten past.
???: 他们对时代的变迁一无所知，就像是被世界遗忘了一样。

Matilda: Oh ...
玛蒂尔达: 哦……

The liquid inside the vial is clear and pristine—less like river water and more like a perfectly liquefied gemstone. Matilda can't help but stare in fascination.
试管中的液体清澈而晶莹，与其说是河水，不如说更接近液化的某种透亮的宝石，玛蒂尔达不禁看得有些入神。

Matilda: But how is that possible? Did no one ever leave the city? Not even to travel or do business?
玛蒂尔达: 但这怎么可能呢?
又不是原始部落，他们总要和外面往来的。

???: You're a clever one, Miss. Yes, it seems the investigators were confused, too. In the end, they realized that an arcane skill was affecting the Pèilín River.
???: 问得好！调查员们也为此感到疑惑，他们最终发现问题出在环绕那座城市的护城河“沛霖川”上。那条河里蕴藏着不可思议的神秘术。

???: Sadly, it seems the arcane energy was dissipating by the time they arrived, and they weren't able to figure out its cause.
???: 然而……那份力量却在不断消散。没等调查员们弄清其中的奥秘，河水中就已经再也无法检测出任何神秘术残留了。

???: This is the only sample they were able to recover. Laplace has been begging for access to it. They're eager to unravel the mystery.
???: 只有这一份样本幸运地被保存了下来。拉普拉斯的人对它很有兴趣，他们一直在寻找方法，试图搞明白其中的奥秘。

Matilda: Wow. That is indeed a most intriguing claim.
玛蒂尔达：哇哦……原来是这样。
我承认这个故事还是挺有趣的。

???: It's not just a claim, Miss. It's real. Wait.
???：这可不是故事，这是真……的……

???: Ms. Matilda Bouanich?
???：你是……玛蒂尔达·布翁尼小姐?!

The careless young staff member only now seems to have fully recognized Matilda's presence.
这个粗心大意的年轻职员似乎刚刚才真正意识到玛蒂尔达的出现。

Matilda: You've heard of me?
玛蒂尔达：你认识我?

???: Yeah, of course. Who hasn't heard of the Bouaniches and their star investigator daughter. Didn't you know that everyone's been talking about you since you joined the Foundation?
???：当然。您的父亲和母亲都颇负盛名，当年您一家人加入基金会的时候可是引起了不小的轰动。

???: Actually, my mother and I went to visit you. Oh. But I haven't introduced myself.
???：也许您已经忘了，那时我母亲还曾带着我上门拜访……哦！抱歉，我还没有自我介绍呢。

Scott: Constance Scott, I'm a fellow graduate from SPDM.
斯考特：我是康斯坦丝·斯考特，和您一样，也是第一防线学校毕业的。
但……

Scott: Of course, now, I'm just a record keeper here.
斯考特：惭愧的是如您所见，我毕业后只不过是个小小的神秘学藏品管理部的仓库管理员罢了。

It doesn't seem like false modesty. Every top student of the SPDM was granted the honor of having their name inscribed in the school's hall of fame, but Matilda has never once come across the name Scott.
这应当并非谦辞。历届第一防线学校的优等生都会获得将名字装点在校史馆里的荣耀，但玛蒂尔达对斯考特的名字毫无印象。

Matilda: Actually, I've been looking for you as well, Ms. Scott. Commissioner Pedra asked me to give this to you.
玛蒂尔达：好吧，斯考特小姐——实际上，正好，我正在找你。
佩德拉委员让我将这个交给你。

Scott: A letter? What's it about?
斯考特：一封信？是什么事?

Matilda: I couldn't say. But he had a most unpleasant look about him as he gave it to me. Then he asked me to review my report on the events in San Francisco.
玛蒂尔达：我也不知道。那个大块头刚才阴沉着脸将我喊过去，让我把几个月前在旧金山遇到的事又讲了一遍，然后就……

Matilda: Are you alright? Your face has grown quite pale.
玛蒂尔达：怎么了？你的脸色好难看。

Scott: I'm fine. I just have a bad feeling I know what I'm about to read.
斯考特：我没事，只是……我想我猜到是什么事了。

Having bid farewell to Matilda, Scott makes her way to a secluded room within the department, the letter clutched in her hand.
送别年轻的信使，斯考特捏着这封她并不愿意收到的信件来到了一间管理部内鲜有人踏足的偏僻房间。

She carefully closes the door behind her, and, with one last glance around the room, opens the envelope. A single sheet of paper floats out from within, one carrying a heavy message.
房门在她的身后关上。
她拆开信封，信纸轻盈地飘了出来，带给了她一个沉重的消息。

Pedra: The investigation has been concluded. Unfortunately, their findings were exactly as we feared.
佩德拉： 调查结果出来了，是个坏消息。
不论是对你，还是对基金会来说，都是。

Pedra: The suspect must be apprehended ASAP, and all efforts must be made to retrieve this arcane object before either cause further trouble.
佩德拉： 我们必须尽快逮住她，在那些东西引发难以收拾的麻烦之前，回收那些流出基金会的神秘学管理品。

Pedra: You must leave immediately. Her last reported sighting was in Chinatown, Los Angeles.
佩德拉： 我们已经锁定了她最后出现的地点，你需要立刻启程——地点是洛杉矶，唐人街。

Chinatown Street, Day
唐人街·昼

Vendor: Oranges! Fresh oranges!
商贩： 新鲜的橘子啊，看一看啊。

Tourist: Sorry, could you say that again? Zhǐ Mǎ Wǔ? And that means paper horse dance? Okay. I got it.
游客： 抱歉，能再告诉我一遍这个叫什么吗?
“纸马舞”“纸马舞”……好，记住了。

Chinatown Resident: Hey, shopkeeper! Got any Siu Yuk left? No? Then give me a piece of Char Siu and some Bak Chit Gai, please.
唐人街居民： 老板，今天还有烧肉吗?
……没了？那切一块叉烧吧，再拿半只白切鸡。

Child: Wow! Daddy, look! There's a dragon on the floor. That's totally cool!
孩童： 哇哦……爸，快看！
那个屋顶上有龙，这也太酷了！

People speaking many languages meet and weave around each other on the crowded avenue. Liáng wanders among them, stopping every now and then to take it all in.
操着不同语言的人们来来往往络绎不绝。
而梁月在宽敞的大道上走走停停，几乎目不暇接。

Poitier: Welcome to Chinatown. How do you like it?
波蒂埃： 欢迎来到唐人街，怎么样，有什么感想吗?

Liang Yue: Yes. It does give me a certain sense of nostalgia. Do you come here often, Ms. Poitier?
梁月： 这里的确让我感到十分亲切。
您经常来唐人街吗，波蒂埃教官?

Poitier: Yeah, I guess so. I mean, outside of work, it's been a while. Three years or so.
波蒂埃： 算是吧，我记得上次来是大概……唔，三年前?

Liang Yue: Only once in three years? I don't think you can consider that "often."
梁月： ……我想这应该不能叫“经常来”。

Poitier waves a hand, glancing down the lively streets on either side.
波蒂埃摆了摆手，看向两侧的熙熙攘攘的街道。

Poitier: Yeah, well, it's a fun place for a day trip, sure, but things are different when you put on the uniform.
波蒂埃：要是想来一场一日旅行的话，这里的确是个好去处。
但如果作为穿着这身制服的人来到这里……事情就不一样了。

Poitier: Remember that private eye back at the hospital, Zhōu? You can get an impression about how people see the police around here from him.
波蒂埃：正如你之前所见到的那个民间侦探，他就是警局与唐人街之间关系的缩影。

Liang Yue: You mean that the residents here don't cooperate with the Arcane Affairs division?
梁月：您的意思是说……唐人街里面的人不配合我们的工作吗?

Poitier: Well, it's complicated. There's a lot of language and cultural barriers. Folks here just don't turn to the police to solve their problems. Even when they do, we feel like we have no idea where to start.
波蒂埃：倒也不是。应该说因为语言和文化上的差异，他们有时并不倾向于寻求我们的帮助，而有时即使我们想要帮忙，也可能无从下手。

Poitier: The thing that surprised me the most was how arcanists of all kinds and humans live so closely together here. I guess it's the same in China, isn't it?
波蒂埃：我听说在你们那里，许多超自然者也会和人们生活在一起。
唐人街这里也是一样，第一次来的时候我吓了一跳。

Poitier: I remember this one time, we had a call about a break-in. When we got there, it turned out the shopkeeper was a big white bird as tall as I am.
波蒂埃：那次我们接到报警说这边的一家中药铺子遭了贼，过去一看，店主居然是只一人高的大白鸟。

Poitier: And this other time, we're chasing down a lost puppet for some lame-ass puppeteer. Anyways, so I ask an old lady if she'd seen a doll nearby. You know what she said?
波蒂埃：还有一次有个三流傀儡师让他的洋娃娃走丢了，我一路追到了这里，向路过的一个大婶问路……结果你知道她说什么吗?

Poitier: Well, I don't know what she said, but she started going off about me being a Lǎowài.
波蒂埃：她居然和旁边的人说“尼们敲，介个老外好香肘丢了……”

Poitier: Now, give me some credit. I might not speak Chinese, but I do know Lǎowài means foreigner. So, excuse me? Like I'm American, baby—born and raised.
波蒂埃：我不知道其他的话是什么意思，但我听得懂“老外”!
就是“外国人”的意思！可拜托，我是在这个国家出生的耶!

Liang Yue: Heh heh. Sorry.
梁月：噗……抱歉。

Liáng knows she should remain serious, but she can't help but be tickled by Poitier's indignation.
梁月知道自己应该保持严肃，无奈波蒂埃愤愤不平的控诉，让她最终还是没忍住笑出了声。

Poitier shoots her a glare, but then heaves a quiet sigh.
她的教官瞪了她一眼，却也没有说什么，反而是轻声叹了一口气。

Poitier: That's not even the half of it.
波蒂埃：当然，还有些更糟糕的例子，我就不说了。

Poitier: The thing is, I don't hate it here, although I can't say I love Chinatown very much either. To be honest, most of us on the force haven't found a way to make inroads with the people here.
波蒂埃：我并不讨厌这里，但也称不上喜欢。
最准确的说法是——我和其他警员们都不了解这里。

Liang Yue: If that's the problem, why don't we try to understand things step by step? Maybe then we can start fresh? We're here anyway.
梁月：那么就让我们从现在开始试着了解这里吧。
毕竟我们已经进来了。

Liáng turns back and examines the archway at the beginning of the road. They have already been in this "other world" for a while.
梁月回过头，用目光向波蒂埃示意道路尽头的那座牌坊。
距离她们穿过那扇“另一个世界”的入口，已经过去了片刻。

Poitier: Yeah, it's worth a shot.
波蒂埃：……你说得对。

Poitier: If we're gonna get anywhere, then we'll have to start here.
波蒂埃：这一系列被隐瞒的“怪事”背后的真相，至少离我们已不远了……

Poitier: But we need to check another task off our list first.
波蒂埃：不过在那之前，我们得先把另一件“正事”办了。

Chinatown Alley, Day
唐人街小巷·昼

They cross the street and turn into a narrow alleyway.
二人穿过大街，拐入一条唐人街内的小巷。

Poitier: Should be right there, down the alley. Feeling excited, rookie?
波蒂埃：穿过这条巷子应该就到了。
是不是很开心，菜鸟?

Poitier: We're about to pay a visit to your favorite director, Noire.
波蒂埃：我们马上就要去见你最喜欢的菲林士多导演了。

Liang Yue: Favorite? What? No. I just like the movies, that's all. I've got no specific feelings for the director.
梁月：我只是喜欢那部电影，对它的导演并没有什么特别的感情——

Liáng can't hold back her rebuttal, but under Poitier's teasing gaze, she stops herself.
梁月忍不住反驳，但在波蒂埃揶揄的目光下，最终止住了话语。

Liang Yue: Maybe just a little. I am curious about the mind of the director behind such great movies.
梁月：……好吧，还是有那么一点期待的。
我的确很想看看拍摄出我最喜欢的电影的导演究竟是什么人。

Liang Yue: But this is strictly a police matter, so I will act with professional self-restraint.
梁月：但这是工作，我会将它和我个人的感情与喜好分开。

Liang Yue: Actually, I've made a request with the Vigiles Intelligence branch for a file on Director Noire and any related events. We should get it soon.
梁月：我已经联系夜巡特遣的情报部门，请求他们帮忙整理关于菲林士多导演的个人信息，以及可能和事件有关的情报，相信一会儿就会有结果了。

Poitier: You've got a file on her already? Feels like you're going a bit overboard, rookie.
波蒂埃：这么上心?

Poitier: It wasn't actually the director that called us. Her assistant did. Later on, Noire herself contacted us and said the so-called threat was just a misunderstanding.
波蒂埃：虽然说那位大导演受到了人身威胁，但记录显示当时是她的助理报的警，后续菲林士多本人联系了警方，说一切都是误会……

Poitier: Normally, we'd leave it at that. There's too much real crime out there to bother with a case where the victim doesn't think anything happened.
波蒂埃：近些年大环境好了不少，那些针对神秘学家的激进行为已经很少见了。
按理来讲，那次报警应当被作为误报处理。

Poitier: Still, according to Dispatch, the assistant was real spooked over it. The operator got the feeling we should give it a second look, so they kept the file open.
波蒂埃：只是报警时那个助理说得煞有其事，接警员担心有什么隐情，才把这件事排进了我们的待处理事项里。

Poitier: But look, this is just a follow-up and an excuse to come down here. So, keep your mind on the real mission.
波蒂埃：咱们优先了这个紧急程度并不高的案子，只是因为咱们需要有个借口进来唐人街，你没有忘记吧?

Liang Yue: Got it, ma'am.
梁月：当然没有。

The scene from the Division of Arcane Affairs yesterday flashes across Liáng's mind.
昨日神秘学犯罪科中的情景浮现在梁月的眼前。

After leaving the hospital, they immediately returned to report their findings and highlight the dangers lurking behind Chinatown's strange events.
离开医院后，二人立刻返回神秘学犯罪科汇报了她们的发现，并指出了唐人街“怪事”背后所存在的隐患。

But the higher-ups had a different take on things.
——但上头显然有另一番判断。

Poitier: It's been reassigned to the local precinct.
波蒂埃：说是已经转交给负责那一带的人了，他们会继续调查这件事。
但……

Poitier stands in the doorway to the Deputy Chief's Office and shakes her head. Liáng immediately catches the subtle shift in her expression.
从警长办公室中走出的波蒂埃对梁月摇了摇头，敏锐的少女立刻从自己教官的神情中察觉到了端倪。

Liang Yue: What's wrong? What does that mean?
梁月：有哪里不妥吗?

Poitier: Nothing, kid. It's just most of the force aren't trained to deal with arcane crimes. Don't get me wrong. They're good, capable officers, but I'm worried.
波蒂埃：神秘学警察一直是紧俏货。我认识负责跟进的人，人品和能力都说得过去，但他们并没有接受过调查神秘学事件的培训。

Poitier: If this was any other case, I'd keep my mouth shut, but come on, this is clearly our department. This case has arcanum all over it.
波蒂埃：如果要查的是普通案子，也许没有什么可担心的。
可显然，我们面对的是神秘学案件。

Poitier: I don't think they know what they're getting into.
波蒂埃：说实话，我不认为他们能够查出什么有价值的东西。

Liang Yue: ...
梁月：……

For a brief moment, neither speaks. Then, Liáng's eyes light up.
二人相对无言了片刻。
但忽然，梁月眼前一亮。

Liang Yue: Ms. Poitier, I have an idea. What if we ...
梁月：等等，我有了一个想法。
或许我们可以这样做——

Poitier: We prioritize Noire's case, which just happens to put us in Chinatown. So, there's no harm in asking a few questions about our other investigation.
波蒂埃：借调查那位大导演受到人身威胁一事的机会进入唐人街，由我们亲自查清唐人街的“怪事”……

Poitier: I knew there was a little rebel in you, Liáng. You like to bend the rules, just not break 'em, am I right?
波蒂埃：真有你的！老实交代，你是不是经常披着一张老实孩子的绵羊皮，干这种钻规则空子的事情?

Liang Yue: Um, not too often.
梁月：咳……也不是经常。

Liang Yue: Actually, I think we're obliged to take Ms. Noire's case seriously, even if it wouldn't help us with the other case.
梁月：而且虽说菲林士多导演的案子只是我们为了应对报告拉来的幌子，我认为我们也应当认真对待……

Liang Yue: Please wait a minute. It's my communication device.
梁月：嗯？稍等，我的联络装置响了。

Liáng pulls out the communication device often criticized by Foundation employees for being too bulky. Poitier leans in to get a better look. Her chameleon comm perched on her chest stretches its neck in curiosity.
梁月将那个总被基金会内部人士诟病过于笨重的通信器拿了出来。
波蒂埃凑了过来，趴在她胸口的变色龙通信器也好奇地伸长了脑袋。

Notification: SPF-I Portable Contact Device activated. You've received a new message. Downloading attachment.
系统音：SPF-I 型便携联络装置已开启。
检测到您有一封新的邮件，正在为您下载附件……

Notification: Download complete. Please check your mailbox.
系统音：下载完成，请于收件箱中查收。

Poitier: Message? What's it about?
波蒂埃：邮件?
是关于什么的?

Liang Yue: It's from the Intelligence Department. They've found her records.
梁月：应该是我申请调阅的与菲林士多导演有关的情报，情报科那边给了我回复。

Liang Yue: Ms. Noire is registered with the Foundation. There might be something in her files that can provide us some clues.
梁月：菲林士多导演是在基金会登记过的神秘学家，因此基金会那边应该有不少关于她的资料，也许我们可以从中获得一些线索……

She opens the pinned email and scans through the attached files. Her expression turns serious.
梁月点开被置顶的那一封邮件，一目三行地扫过附件中的信息，声音逐渐低了下去，脸色也凝重了起来。

Liang Yue: Wait. Is this ...
梁月：等等，这是……八年前发生在香港的……“映像事件”?

拼凑
Pieced Together 小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.
???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
2. 我要前进到未来

分支 1 / Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.
???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...
???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……

分支 2 / Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.
???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—
???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.
???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。

选项 / Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.
1. 好了，开始胡扯吧

2. No. I'm tired of you.
2. 不，我已经厌倦你了

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.
???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.
???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Reconstructing Idealized Memories
妄想记忆补正

英文 / ENGLISH

Although I don't usually keep a journal, I had to record today's encounter—I met the great Miss Matilda Bouanich!

I still remember that summer. My mother lectured me for an hour before we left and then another hour during our journey. I thought I was following her instructions perfectly: I was dressed perfectly neat; my greetings were memorized word-for-word. But the moment I met the Bouanichs, I froze solid, too nervous to say anything. Even adults can get stage fright, so how was it fair to give her own daughter the cold shoulder for it? A smile or a pat on the back from mother was all I needed to finish my greeting without fumbling.

Thank goodness for Lady Beryl. She saw what happened, and her gracious words salvaged the situation. I didn't disappoint my mother after that. I'm sure of it because the rest of my memories of that visit were pleasant—Lady Beryl's warm smile and Matilda's energetic chatter. Matilda could be as noisy as she liked and still win her mother's approval, how I envied that so much.

But Lady Beryl ... for some reason, I can't remember what she looked like. Now I understand Latham's frustration. Being Matilda's mother, I could imagine a matured, refined version of Matilda—minus the childish energy and, oh right, without the hooked nose, that's my mother's trait.

中文 / CHINESE

虽然我平时不写日记，但今天的遭遇我得记下来。我遇到了玛蒂尔达·布翁尼小姐！

我还记得那个夏天，母亲在出发前叮嘱了我一个小时，路上又叮嘱了一个小时。我想我当时已经完全照她的要求去做了，衣服穿戴整齐，问候语也背得一字不差。见到布翁尼一家后我也没有忘词，只是紧张得说不出话。但我必须要说，就算是成年人都会在重要场合感到紧张，因此对自己女儿冷眼相待显然是不对的……如果她当时能露出一个微笑，或者拍拍我的背给我点儿鼓励，我想我是可以把问候语完整说出来的。

所以非常感谢贝丽尔女士用她的社交辞令为我解围，我的后续表现总算没有让母亲失望，我很清楚这点，因为后续的回忆似乎并没有什么特别值得记下的不愉快部分。只有贝丽尔女士的温柔笑容和玛蒂尔达小姐吵吵闹闹的记忆。玛蒂尔达小姐就可以吵吵闹闹着获得自己母亲的笑容，真是

令人羡慕。
贝丽尔女士……我居然记不得她长什么样了，现在我有些理解莱瑟姆了。既然是玛蒂尔达小姐的母亲，想象一下成熟后变得稳重的玛蒂尔达小姐，把那份幼稚和吵吵闹闹去掉……也不要鹰钩鼻，鹰钩鼻是母亲的特征。

参演须知
Rookie Actor's Guide SC-07

Noire's Set
片场

Crew Member: Whose is this? It's blocking the camera's sightlines. Get it out of the way!
工作人员：这是谁的东西？别放在这里，挡路了，一会儿摄像机要从这里过，快拿走！

Extra: When are we coming in? We've been waiting forever. I wish I brought a chair.
龙套演员：什么时候轮到我们上场？早知道这么久，我也应该带个板凳过来。

Crowd: What's going on? Are they filming another movie? Do you see anyone famous?
围观群众：这是干什么，拍戏？有大明星吗？……

At the end of the alley, in an old abandoned house filled with camera equipment, crew members and actors go about their business, drawing curious glances from passersby.
小巷尽头，一处原已空置许久的旧屋内摆满了各式摄影器材，剧组工作人员与演员们穿梭其间，引来过路人好奇的目光。

One particular figure catches Liáng's attention—someone strangely familiar.
其中一个有些眼熟的身影引起了梁月的注意。

???: Oh! Is that today's lunch? Mind if I take a look?
???：哇！这就是今天的盒饭？大叔，我可以打开看看吗？

???: Not now? Fine.
???：还没到放饭时间？好吧……

Liang Yue: That's that odd person I saw at the hospital. She works for the Foundation.
梁月：那是……医院里那个形迹可疑的基金会职员。

Poitier: Who? You mean camera-head over there? What do you mean by odd? You think she could be a fake?
波蒂埃：摄像头脑袋的那一个？
可疑是什么意思，假冒的？

Liang Yue: No, she's a real Foundation member. I checked her information as well when I inquired about Ms. Noire's file.
梁月：不……我在向情报科申请调阅资料的时候，也查了关于她的事情。

Liang Yue: Her name is Latham, an Awakened arcanist, currently working in the Arcanum Containment Department.
梁月：她名叫莱瑟姆，是一名意识唤醒者，供职于圣洛夫基金会神秘学藏品管理部。

Liang Yue: I wasn't given any access to her details. But based on our encounter, we should have no problem with her.
梁月：以我目前的权限还无法随意调阅她的详细个人信息，不过莱瑟姆小姐的身份看起来并没有什么问题。

Poitier: Good, fine. I'm happy enough leaving the Awakened to their quirkiness.
波蒂埃：那就暂时别管了。
意识唤醒者，或多或少有些怪癖。

She isn't their top priority—Liáng knows that. She pushes aside that odd feeling for now, following Poitier through the crowd and onto the set.
这的确不是她们眼下最应先关注的事，梁月暂时放下了心里那份怪异的感觉，和波蒂埃一起穿过围观的人群，踏入片场之中。

Assistant: What do you mean she hasn't eaten yet? Director Noire's doctor was explicit that she is not allowed to skip any meals.
助理：导演还没有吃饭?
她又这样，也不管自己的身体，之前医生都那样提醒她……

Assistant: Oh, hello, officers. How can I help you?
助理：嗯?
……两位警官，请问有什么事吗?

The well-dressed woman walks over to them.
一位打扮入时的女子注意到了二人，走上前来。

Poitier: We received a call from a Lin Wang. Did you make a report about some unknown person making physical threats and stalking Ms. Noire?
波蒂埃：我们之前接到了来自琳·王女士的电话，称菲林士多导演遭遇了不知名人士的跟踪和威胁。

Assistant: Yes. That's right. I'm Lin, but ...
助理：哦……您是说那件事。
我就是王琳，但……

Upon hearing their purpose, Lin hesitates, glancing uncertainly over at one end of the set.
听说梁月二人的来意后，女子的面上露出了迟疑的神情。
她犹豫地看向片场的一侧。

Actor I: We did it!
演员 I：干得好，伙计们!

Actor II: Abby?! You're here!
演员 II：哦，艾比！你在这里——

Noire: Cut.
菲林士多：停。

At this single command, the actors freeze in place.
角落坐在轮椅上的那人一声令下，场上所有的士兵都停下了手中的动作。

Noire: No. I'm afraid we'll have to roll that again.
菲林士多：不行。刚才你的情绪不对。

Actor II: I-I'm sorry, director.
演员 II：不、不好意思!
导演……

The young actor's body stiffens instantly. Based on where he's standing, it's clear that he is only a background character in this scene.
被点到的那个年轻人立刻手足无措了起来。
他淹没在一众演员之中，显然只是这一幕中的一个小角色。

But Noire, seated on her throne-like wheelchair—the overseer of everything—didn't miss his mistake, no matter how minor it was.
但显然，端坐于她的专属王座之上，纵览全局的菲林士多并没有遗漏这名普通士兵略有瑕疵的表现。

Noire: Not at all. I just want more emotion this time. She's your true love, but you have been apart for a long time. Things are different now. She is, you are.
菲林士多：她的确是你的恋人，但现在你处在一个长时间单方面和她断了联系的状态。

Noire: Your reunion must be more complex. It isn't simply happiness you feel. You must mix that emotion with worry and guilt.
菲林士多：现在你们重逢了，你当然应该欢喜，但不能是纯粹的欢喜，还需要带上一些担忧、一些心虚。

Noire: She doesn't know anything about what happened to you. You can't help but worry that she will never be able to understand you. You wonder if she has got herself into any troubles.
菲林士多：她并不知道你这边的特殊情况。你会想，她会不会误会你？会不会有怨言？又会不会在这期间遇到什么其他的麻烦事？

Noire: I know this is a short scene, but the audience must see your full range of emotions. You are capable of more, so be more.
菲林士多：这个镜头只是一闪而过，可还是会呈现给观众。
你们也是这场戏的一份子，我希望你能做得更好。

Noire: I know you attended drama school, so let's see that training shine. I know you can do it.
菲林士多：我记得你是戏剧学院出身的……我想这应该难不倒你？

Actor II: Yes, director. I'll try my best.
演员 II：当然……当然，导演！
我会做到的！

Simply being noticed by the famous director is enough to leave him visibly flustered. He immediately straightens up, shedding his nervous stance from moments before.
自己被大名鼎鼎的导演记住了，青年的受宠若惊一目了然。
他立刻直起了腰杆，一扫方才战战兢兢的畏缩模样。

Noire: Good. Let's roll it again.
菲林士多：很好，那我们再来一次。

Assistant: Ahem, excuse me, Director Noire?
助理：咳……导演，打扰一下。

Seizing this moment before the next take, the assistant swoops in and whispers something to Noire.
助理看准机会，在又一次的拍摄开始前三步并作两步走上前去，在菲林士多的身边耳语了一番。

Noire: ...
菲林士多：……

Noire glances toward the two officers, her face betraying no emotion. It's impossible to tell what she's thinking.
其间，菲林士多向梁月她们的方向看了一眼。她神色平静，并不见丝毫意外之色，看不出究竟在想什么。

Poitier: Huh, for someone that famous, you'd think I'd have known she uses a wheelchair.
波蒂埃：我只知道菲林士多拍了很多有名的电影，倒还是第一次知道她是坐轮椅的。

Poitier: How you feeling? Finally getting a chance to meet your favorite director. Thrilled?
波蒂埃：喂，怎么样？
终于见到你心心念的菲林士多大导演了，是不是很激动？

Poitier nudges Liáng with her elbow, tilting forward a little as she teases her. But when she sees Liáng's face, she pauses.
波蒂埃趁机用手肘捅了梁月一下，微微俯下身来拿她打趣。
但看到梁月的表情，她却是一愣。

Poitier: What's with the long face, kid? Where'd all your excitement go?
波蒂埃：怎么愁眉苦脸的?
刚才在路上的时候，你不是还挺兴奋的吗?

Poitier: Oh. Is it about the message you got?
波蒂埃：……是那封邮件?

Liang Yue: Yes. It's just something that's bothering me.
梁月：是的。
……里面有些事情，很让人在意。

Before Liáng can explain, the subject of their discussion rolls toward them in her wheelchair.
但没等梁月来得及向波蒂埃详细解释，她们讨论的对象就已经操控着轮椅来到了她们的面前。

Noire: Thanks for coming, officers. But I believe I've already explained that this was all just a misunderstanding.
菲林士多：感谢你们的到来，两位尊敬的警官小姐。
但我想我应该已经致电说明过了，这一切实际上是一场误会。

Noire: As you can see, I'm in perfect health, well, ignoring these two.
菲林士多：如两位所见，我现在安然无恙——当然，除了这老毛病之外。

She pats her legs with a cheerful laugh. It seems the director has no qualms about her physical condition, though it's hardly the kind of joke anyone else can comfortably laugh along to.
她拍了拍自己的双腿，笑得清朗。看来这位著名导演并不介意自己身体上的残缺，但显然这种玩笑外人很难捧场。

Poitier: But according to your assistant, there's been someone stalking you for months, and they've recently sent you a threatening letter.
波蒂埃：但您的助理王女士报警时曾声称，近几个月来有不明人士始终在对您进行跟踪行为，您还收到了一封“威胁信”。

Poitier: So what—that all just "misunderstandings" too?
波蒂埃：这些都是误会吗?

Noire: I'm terribly sorry for inconveniencing you, officers. Lin is a very dedicated assistant, always looking out for me. She may have just overreacted to my situation.
菲林士多：对此我真的很抱歉。
阿琳跟了我有段时间了，她很关心我，有的时候会有些反应过度。

Noire: I don't mean to brag, but I've been in the limelight for long enough that I've seen my share of crazy fans.
菲林士多：无意自吹自擂，警官，但我姑且小有名气，无论走到哪里，都可能会有一些狂热的影迷做出一些稍微越界的行为。

Noire: I'm used to it.
菲林士多：对此，我已经习惯了。

Poitier: Sure, I get that. But about that letter you received, do you still have it?
波蒂埃：但那封信的确存在，对吗?
可以给我看看吗?

Noire lets out a wry chuckle and shakes her head.
菲林士多苦笑着摇了摇头。

Noire: I'm afraid I don't have it anymore.
菲林士多：我恐怕现在我们已经很难找到它了。

Noire: I receive so many letters, most of them friendly, some of them not-so-much friendly.
菲林士多：每到一个新地方，我都会收到许多封来信。
有些较为友善，有些则并非如此。

Noire: I've made a name in this industry, and a few enemies too. If I paid any attention to the negativity, it'd only drag me down. I tend not to keep the bad ones around.
菲林士多：在这个圈子里多年，我帮助了不少人，但显然也有意无意得罪过一些人。
您所提到的那一封就来自后者，我没有特意保留它们的习惯。

Noire: While I'm sure you would do a fine job keeping me safe, officers, I can't let myself worry over it. Besides, what are they going to do? Break my kneecaps?
菲林士多：总有人期待着在我身上，发生些比再也站不起来更糟糕的事情。
如果能有两位英姿飒爽的警官小姐护卫左右，我自然也会安心不少。

Noire: Frankly, the only thing I am worried about is that your presence is another distraction for my crew.
菲林士多：令人为难的是……对于剧组来说，二位的存在可能会让大家产生一些不必要的忧虑。

She casts a grateful, and perhaps apologetic, look around the set.
她投来一个带着感激与歉意的眼神。

Noire: So, it's very much appreciated that you went out of your way to check in on me, but I have a movie to make. I can't disappoint my fans.
菲林士多：非常感谢二位警官的关心，但我必须为电影的质量负责。
我希望保证每一次搬上银幕的作品都是最好的。

Noire: Now, if you'll excuse me, we're burning daylight, and I still have four more scenes to film.
菲林士多：现在，警官们。
如果没有别的事，就请原谅我先失陪了。

Noire: These Hollywood producers may have opened doors for me, but they also give me so many problems lately.
菲林士多：今天还有四五场戏等着我们去拍。我在荷里活这边的制片人许可了不少我就拍摄提出的任性请求，相对地也给我出了不少难题。

She smiles at the officers, as if to signal the conversation's end.
她向梁月与波蒂埃二人笑了笑，似乎打算以此为这场对话的终止符。

Liang Yue: Is this really just because of your movie?
梁月：——只是因为电影吗?

Noire has already begun to turn her wheelchair away, but Liáng stops her in her tracks.
已经调转了轮椅方向的菲林士多，因梁月的话停下了动作。

Noire: Pardon me?
菲林士多：您是指?

Liang Yue: You seem to be refusing our assistance because you've decided this threat is only a harmless prank.
梁月：您拒绝了我们的帮助和调查，理由是您认为那些威胁不过是常见的恶作剧和并不会被付诸于行动的诳言，并不值得以引起过度的重视。

Liang Yue: You've decided that it's worth the risk to focus on your film.
梁月：您认为它们并不值得付出让警方进入剧组、带来例如媒体的过度关注等麻烦的代价去解决。

Liang Yue: I don't mean to judge your decision. It may be understandable in some cases.
梁月：这是您的选择，我无意妄加评论，它也的确在某种程度上说的通——

She moves closer, lowering her voice as she leans in to deliver the next sentence in a hushed voice.
梁月在菲林士多审视的目光中走到她的近前，俯身在菲林士多的耳边轻轻落下最后一句话。

Liang Yue: But if this threat is not just a prank, if it is serious ...
梁月： ——在“没有任何迹象表示您的周围存在实质危险”的情况下。

Noire: Am I sensing disapproval?
菲林士多： ……听起来警官小姐并不这么认为?

Noire narrows her eyes a little and raises a hand to halt her approaching assistant.
菲林士多微微眯起双眼，抬手制止了正欲靠近的助理。

This is a good sign. Liáng has earned the chance to talk for at least a little longer. She pushes aside her conflicting emotions and carries on in a voice only the two of them can hear.
这是成功的标志，对话得以延续，梁月获得了追问的机会。
她收起心底复杂的情绪，继续用只有二人能够听到的音量说了下去。

Liang Yue: There has been an increase in patients coming from Chinatown showing signs of mental instability.
梁月： 从数日前开始，唐人街附近的医院就不断收到因不明原因导致精神状态异常的患者。

Liang Yue: Their symptoms include confusion, amnesia, drowsiness, and volatile anger. None of the patients seem to have anything in common. No prior history, all without clear cause.
梁月： 暴躁易怒、颓废嗜睡、思维混乱、记忆缺失……尽管症状各不相同，但他们此前都并无相关病史，原因至今不明。

Liang Yue: Does that sound familiar?
梁月： 这番描述会让您感到熟悉吗?

Noire: Sorry, is this leading somewhere?
菲林士多： 抱歉，也许警官小姐能够给我一些提示?

After a moment of thought, Noire shakes her head, her calm face carrying a perfectly measured hint of confusion.
略作思索后，菲林士多摇了摇头，平静的表情中带着少许恰到好处的茫然。

Liang Yue: A case, eight years ago.
梁月： ……八年前，在您的身边应当也发生过极其类似的事件。

Liang Yue: Hé Rìjūn, the scriptwriter for your first big hit, Detective Co7. She burned to death in her own house.
梁月： 与您一起打造了您的成名作《神秘警探 C07》系列电影的编剧何日君，在八年前于自家燃起的熊熊大火中身亡。

Liang Yue: However, the cleaners found a film reel in the debris, surprisingly intact after the fire.
梁月： 但在化为一片废墟的火灾现场，负责现场清理的工作人员却发现了一盘完好无缺的胶片。

Noire: ...
菲林士多： ……

Liáng has been watching Noire's every expression. She doesn't miss the fleeting shift in her eyes at the mention of the film reel.
梁月一直紧紧盯着菲林士多的表情，因此她并没有错过菲林士多在听到“胶片”一词时，一瞬间眼神的变化。

Liang Yue: Strange, isn't it? Every other item was burned to ash, yet this one 8mm reel was as good as new.
梁月： 很奇怪，对吧？明明现场的其他物品都变成了看不出原型的焦炭，但只有那盘超 8 毫米胶片完好如初。

Liang Yue: The cleaners felt the same way, so, being curious, they played the reel.
梁月： 当时的那些工作人员也是百思不得其解，所以他们放映了那部影片。

Liang Yue: Three of the five who watched it ended up in an asylum, one jumped from a building, and the last, according to the reports, became like an empty shell of a person.
梁月： ——结果五个人中三人被送进了精神病院，一人坠楼身亡，最后一人虽无大碍，但也是性情大变，成了一副行尸走肉般的模样。

Noire: And what's happening here reminds you of that?
菲林士多： 你认为那件事和如今唐人街的“怪事”很相似。

Liang Yue: There are some commonalities between the cases. I can't ignore the possibility that they're related.
梁月： 鉴于二者之间的相似性，我认为不能排除这两起事件有关联的可能。

Liang Yue: Two in particular stand out to me, the similar symptoms of those affected, and you.
梁月： 毕竟受害者表现出的症状十分相似，而这两起事件中……也都有您的身影出现。

Liang Yue: Hard to shake the thought that these are not coincidences.
梁月： 若说是偶然，我想有些太过于巧合了。

Whispers spark among the crew as they eye this secret conversation.
片场中的其他人听不到二人谈话的具体内容，但拍摄暂缓的时间远比他们想象中的更久，这引发了一阵阵的窃窃私语。

Extra: What are the police still here for? Are we gonna get back to filming?
群众演员： 那两个警察找菲林士多导演做什么?
还要多久啊?

Crew Member: Who knows, but it doesn't seem good. We're losing light here. Can these guys wrap it up already?
工作人员： 总感觉不是什么好事。
我们只是想要拍电影，怎么总是有人来找麻烦?

These murmurs, of course, don't escape Noire's and Liáng's notice. When she speaks again, Noire's tone is far more direct.
那些声音自然也落入了菲林士多与梁月的耳中。
再开口时，菲林士多的态度干脆了许多。

Noire: Is that an accusation?
菲林士多： 这是一则指控吗?

Liang Yue: No, not at all. I'm just hoping you might be able to shed some light on our case.
梁月： 不，当然不。
我只是在考虑假如这两起案件相关，也许您能够提供一些线索。

Liang Yue: After our initial investigation, we officially recorded it as an ominous arcanum incident, and determined that the cause was that 8mm film reel, which contained a film titled Reunion of the Three Swallows.
梁月： 八年前的事件经夜巡特遣的调查，被正式认定为恶性神秘学事件，罪魁祸首就是编剧何日君留下的那盘胶片——《三燕归巢》。

Liang Yue: To this day, however, the exact nature of the arcanum hasn't been conclusively determined. We still aren't sure why it has this strange effect on people's minds, nor why the damage appears to be irreversible.
梁月： 可尽管已经结案，案件仍然残留了部分疑点。
最关键的……便是那盘胶片侵蚀无辜者精神的原因，至今未能查清。

Liang Yue: Perhaps more importantly, we still don't know the origin behind the arcanum on the reel. There are many possible causes that might create such an effect.
梁月：所有的神秘学存在都有其起源，像是“胶片”这类原本并不具有神秘学属性的物品更是如此。一定有什么契机让它发生了转变。

Liang Yue: One of the most common thoughts is from absorbing powerful emotions from an arcanist.
梁月：……而吸收了来自神秘学家的某种强烈感情，是普通物品非预期性地转化为神秘学物品最常见的原因。

Liang Yue: The darkest emotions possess the strongest power, anger, hatred ...
梁月：其中，憎恶、愤怒、仇恨……这些来自人心黑暗面的情感，拥有着超乎想象的强大力量。

Liang Yue: Emotions so strong that they can outlast their bearer's death, like a curse from beyond the grave carrying out their last will as an obsession.
梁月：即使孕育出它们的人已经死去，它们仍然能够以“诅咒”的形式留存在世间，完成主人未尽的执念。

Liang Yue: And in such cases, these objects are sure to lead to disaster.
梁月：——这通常意味着一场灾难。

Liang Yue: I believe that this film is, undoubtedly, one such cursed item.
梁月：《三燕归巢》表现出的性质就符合这一特征，毫无疑问，它是一张“被诅咒的胶片”。

Liang Yue: If it is the case that this film was involved in these new incidents, then we must find out what obsession it's carrying out, and find a countermeasure.
梁月：如果这次的事件也是那部胶片造成的，我们需要弄清楚它的目的，才能够拿出对策。

Noire: I assume you're already on the case.
菲林士多：而听起来警官小姐已经有调查的方向了。

Liang Yue: Indeed, I am, Ms. Noire. I've been studying the report on the original case, including some of the theories of the original investigator.
梁月：……当年负责调查那起案件的神秘学警察，在档案中留下了自己的调查报告和推测。

Liang Yue: One of those theories suggests that despite your collaboration on the C07 series, there were many points of conflict between you and Ms. Hé.
梁月：种种迹象指出，作为共同缔造了《神秘警探 C07》系列电影的伙伴，您与编剧何日君在背地里却存在着许多嫌隙。

Liang Yue: In fact, the reports mention you had a violent quarrel with her on the day of the fire. There was even a question about whether you might have been responsible for her death.
梁月：在何日君葬身火海的当天，您与她曾经爆发过激烈的冲突，而在何日君死后，更是有传闻称她的死与您脱不了干系……

Liang Yue: So, as you can see, I have more than a strong reason to believe you are connected. And if this cursed reel is behind these recent incidents ...
梁月：您愿意谈谈这件事吗？因为如果造成眼下唐人街怪事频发的罪魁祸首，真的是八年前的那张“被诅咒的胶片”……

Liang Yue: I'm afraid that you may be the intended target of this curse.
梁月：那么我恐怕，它最有可能瞄准的目标，就是您。

餐后审问室 · 1/2
Post-lunch Questioning · 1/2 SC-08

Guangfu Restaurant
广府饭店

Poitier: Hot damn, rookie. Who coulda guessed the famous director would be a part of her own real-life thriller.
波蒂埃：真是可恶！
我必须得说，那位导演的电影很有趣，可她本人就完全不同了。

Poitier: After talking to her, we still got nothing useful to go on. I can't read anything behind that smiling face of hers.
波蒂埃：费了九牛二虎之力，却根本没得到什么有用的信息……
我最讨厌那种整天面上挂着笑脸，却根本看不懂她在想什么的人了。

Poitier: But if your little theory has got any truth to it, then Noire is in real danger. So, why not talk? Isn't she worried about her own life?
波蒂埃：如果在唐人街作乱的真的是那张“被诅咒的胶片”，危险的可是她耶！
居然一点也不着急。

Poitier channels her frustration into her food, devouring most of the meal in the blink of an eye. As she swallows the last shrimp dumpling, she turns to look at Liáng, who is busy chatting with the restaurant owner.
波蒂埃化愤怒为食欲，眨眼间桌上的餐点就消失了大半。
咽下最后一只虾饺，她回头看向不远处正和老板娘攀谈的搭档。

Liang Yue: You mean the grocer's daughter has also ...
梁月：是吗？原来对面杂货店那家的女儿也……

Female Storekeeper: Yes. So many, many things happening around the neighborhood. Crazy!
老板娘：就是咯！最近都不知道搞什么，好多街坊家里都出了事。

Female Storekeeper: But the Lu's are lucky. They took their daughter to a good local doctor, and she got better.
老板娘：老林家还算好啦。他带个女儿去看了中医，抓了药，吃了一段时间就好了不少。

Female Storekeeper: But the other family down the road aren't so lucky. Their grandma was already so weak from arthritis, and now she's gone crazy. She's probably gonna drive them crazy too.
老板娘：但是对面街口马仔他阿嫲就麻烦了。那个阿婆原本就身体不好，忽然间又变到疯疯癫癫……他们两公婆都要担心死了！

Female Storekeeper: You know what? Another girl, she asked around about this too. *sigh* If I had to guess, it's because of those evil spirits. Things are never easy before the Dùshuò Festival.
老板娘：之前都有个靓妹来问这件事，说什么事情不太对路……唉，我说啊，就是临近年关，那些污糟的东西都出来了。

Liang Yue: Another girl? Do you know who she is?
梁月：您说还有人打听过这件事，那是什么人？

Female Storekeeper: She said she's an exorcist from the neo-science ... neo-science something ... exorcism office ... and is new here in Chinatown.
老板娘：她说自己是什么新科学……新科学什么鬼事务所的，好像是个神婆，刚来到唐人街这一带的。

Female Storekeeper: She gave me a fancy business card. But I don't know where it is now.
老板娘：她还给了一张卡片，印到鬼五马六的，不过不知道被我放到哪里了。

Liang Yue: I see. Thank you very much.
梁月：……原来如此，多谢您。

As Liáng returns to her seat, Poitier shoots her a questioning look.
向老板娘道过谢后，梁月返回座位，波蒂埃立刻投去疑问的眼神。

Poitier: So, any progress?
波蒂埃：怎么样?

Liang Yue: I have some bad news. First, there are more victims than we expected; second, we're not the only ones who've noticed.
梁月：有两个坏消息。受害者的数目比我们之前认为的还要多，并且……
我们并不是唯一察觉到这一事件的人。

Liang Yue: We need to hurry if we don't want this case to attract wider attention.
梁月：如果想要在引起恐慌和不必要的骚动前解决事件，我们就需要抓紧了。

Poitier: Why don't we start with the director, then? She seems like our best lead.
波蒂埃：那个菲林士多导演不能成为突破口吗?

Having cleared the dishes closest to her, Poitier pulls the char siu buns from the other side of the table.
解决掉了眼前一圈的餐点，波蒂埃将摆在桌边的叉烧包拉到了自己的面前。

Poitier: I've got a hunch her case is connected with this one.
波蒂埃：没想到原本只是我们用来作为进入唐人街的借口的事件，居然和我们在调查的事有关系。

Poitier: Just like you said, there are too many coincidences to not dig deeper.
波蒂埃：你也说了，发生在那个菲林士多导演过去的事件和现在发生在唐人街的事非常相似，这未免有些过于巧合了。

Poitier: That writer, what was it, Hé Rìjūn? She's an arcanist, right? No surprise that she'd imbue that film with all of her final bits of hatred. I've seen a dozen cases like it.
波蒂埃：那个编剧何日君也是神秘学家。在被烈火焚身的弥留之际，她的怨恨被自己的作品吸收……这样的案件在神秘学犯罪科中并不罕见。

Poitier: Cursed objects are weird as heck. It's definitely possible that it could've chased Noire all the way here.
波蒂埃：那种含有诅咒的物件往往邪乎的很，搞不好就是追着菲林士多来了唐人街，其他受害者都只是被殃及池鱼而已。

Liang Yue: But there isn't any evidence that corroborates the rivalry between Ms. Noire and Ms. Hé.
梁月：“菲林士多导演与何日君之死有关”只是一个传闻而已，并没有任何证据能够证明何日君临死时对菲林士多怀有怨恨。

Poitier: Hold on. Didn't you read that in a report by another vigil? Maybe it's only hearsay, but that's something.
波蒂埃：但就连你们夜巡特遣管理局都把这件事写进了情报里，不就说明了这件事并不全是空穴来风吗?

Poitier: Not only that. Get this—I did some digging of my own. The night that cleaner leaped off that roof was the exact same night that Noire was in the car accident that left her legs paralyzed.
波蒂埃：在那个看了胶片之后精神失常，最终跑到建设中的高楼一跃而下的家伙摔成一块肉饼的同一晚，菲林士多遭遇车祸，双腿残疾……

Poitier: It gets freakier. According to the reports, they happened within minutes of each other, and the building was less than a block away from the scene of the accident. How's that for evidence?
波蒂埃：这两件事发生的时间只相隔不到五分钟，发生的地点只相距一条街。
难道你要说这是巧合?

Poitier: We've got a saying in the DAA, cadet. "When it comes to arcanum, there's no such thing as coincidences."
波蒂埃：我告诉你，做神秘学警察最忌讳的一个词，就是“巧合”。

With this declaration, Poitier pops the last char siu bun into her mouth.
伴随着这句斩钉截铁的结论，最后一只叉烧包被波蒂埃吞进了腹中。

Liang Yue: Whether coincidence or not, it isn't much to go on. We need evidence.
梁月：……但这始终是推测，并未得到证实。

Poitier: Of course. We can't just leap to accusations without proof. But when it comes to arcane crime, you've gotta follow your hunches. So, keep your nose to the ground.
波蒂埃：是这样没错啦，但我的意思是说，当我们察觉到某些诡异的“偶然”时，彻查到底就是我们神秘学警察的工作……

Poitier notices the dejection on Liáng's face and sheepishly sets down her chopsticks.
话说到一半，波蒂埃终于察觉到对面少女的低落，讪讪放下手中攥着的筷子。

Poitier: I get you. This isn't just about evidence. You don't wanna point the finger at someone you admire.
波蒂埃：我明白你的心情，喜欢的电影背后居然有这么多乌烟瘴气的事，多少会有些幻灭。

Poitier: But you've gotta pursue this, even if that means you have to separate the artist from their work.
波蒂埃：有时候我们被告知要远离那些作品背后的人是有道理的。

Liáng remains silent for a moment, picks up the chilled lemon soda from the table, and takes a sip.
梁月沉默片刻，拿起桌上的冰镇柠檬汽水喝了一口，重新振作了起来。

Liang Yue: Actually, there is another reason that I'm not entirely convinced that Ms. Noire, the "film incident," and the events in Chinatown are connected.
梁月：我不敢确定菲林士多导演以及八年前的“映像事件”和现在的唐人街发生的怪事有关联，其实还有另外一个原因。

Liang Yue: In fact, it's quite a substantial reason. If our records are correct, the cursed reel was found and contained by the Foundation six months after the initial incident.
梁月：当年引发事件的那张“被诅咒的胶片”《三燕归巢》，其实早在事件过后约半年就被圣洛夫基金会回收了。

Liang Yue: Which means, unless something has gone horribly wrong, it should still be safely stored within the Arcanum Containment Depart—
梁月：现在它应该处在神秘学藏品管理部的监管之下，除非由于什么特殊原因，它从基金会内被流出到了外界，否则是不可能——

A sharp crash interrupts her words. The two turn toward the sound.
尖锐的破碎声打断了梁月的话，二人循声向一旁的座位上看去。

Scott: Oops! I'm sorry. I'm so sorry.
斯考特：呃，抱歉抱歉，真是对不起……

A bespectacled girl fumbles with a napkin as she hurriedly tries to clean up the shattered dish she just knocked over.
一个戴眼镜的少女正手忙脚乱地捏起桌上的纸巾，试图收拾不小心打翻在地的餐盘碎片。

But her sneaking glances toward the two officers don't escape their attention, and the shiny emblem on her chest tells them exactly where she's from.
——但她时不时瞥向梁月与波蒂埃这桌的眼神，和胸前令人眼熟的徽章，当然并没有逃过两名年轻警员的目光。

Liang Yue: ...
梁月：……

Poitier: Well ...
波蒂埃：呃……

They exchange a puzzled look.
她们交换了一个怪异的眼神。

Poitier: If I remember it right, you mentioned earlier that you saw someone from the Foundation acting suspicious yesterday.
波蒂埃：说起来，你是不是说你昨天也遇到了一个形迹可疑的基金会成员?

Liang Yue: Yes, like the lady over there, she also works for the ACD.
梁月：是的，而……根据资料，那个人正好是供职于神秘学藏品管理部的。

Poitier: Guess we'll have a talk with her.
波蒂埃：看起来我们有必要找这位小姐聊聊。

Liang Yue: I agree, Ms. Poitier.
梁月：我同意。

They rise from the table and approach the girl.
她们从桌边站起身，向那名少女走去。

个人隐私
Confidential Record 小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.
???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
2. 我要前进到未来

分支 1 / Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.
???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...
???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……

分支 2 / Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.
???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—
???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.
???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。

选项 / Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.
1. 好了，开始胡扯吧

2. No. I'm tired of you.
2. 不，我已经厌倦你了

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.
???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.
???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Investigation Record: Noire
调查记录：菲林士多

英文 / ENGLISH

Noire, female, arcanist. Her arcane skill allows her to manipulate inanimate objects within a defined range, designating them as "actors."

Born in Hong Kong, in 1950.

Graduated from USC School of Cinematic Arts in 1972. Later worked at what would eventually become known as TVB.

In 1978, she began collaborating with independent production companies to produce low-budget films.

Released her debut film, Muddle, in 1979.

Established New Art Company in 1980 and began working on the film Detective C07.

In 1983, a car accident left her paralyzed from the waist down, allegedly tied to the Film Incident1.

...

1 For more details on the "Film Incident," please refer to the attached documentation.
中文 / CHINESE
菲林士多，女，神秘学家，神秘术可操纵一定范围内被其定义为“演员”的非生命体。
1950 年出生于香港。
1972 年毕业于南加州电影艺术学院电影专业，此后在佳视电视台供职。
1978 年与民间独立制片公司合作，开始低成本电影制作。
1979 年首部电影《糊涂》上映。
1980 年成立新艺术公司，并着手于电影《神秘警探 C07》的拍摄。
1983 年遭遇交通事故致双腿残疾，疑似与同日发生的“映像事件”1 有关。
……
1 关于“映像事件”请查看附件资料

餐后审问室 · 2/2
Post-lunch Questioning · 2/2 SC-08

Under Liáng and Poitier's relentless questioning, the suspicious Foundation member ultimately surrenders.
在梁月和波蒂埃不依不饶的逼问下，形迹可疑的基金会成员最终选择了举手投降。

Scott: Alright, alright. I'll tell.
斯考特：好了好了，我说还不行吗！

Scott: But only to you, since you're a vigil, but she isn't, right? Sorry, I should really only disclose this info to other Foundation members.
斯考特：但只能和你说。你是执夜人，对吧?
这是基金会内部的事务，所以……

She shoots a cautious glance at Poitier.
她小心翼翼地瞥向一旁的波蒂埃。

Poitier: Hmph.
波蒂埃：啧。

Poitier says nothing, simply raising her chin at Liáng in approval.
她并未多说什么，扬了扬下巴表示了许可。

Liáng follows the girl out into the empty alley. After verifying Liáng's identity with her communication device, the girl gives a final glance up and down the alley before talking.
梁月跟着少女从后门离开。四下无人，少女在用便携联络装置确认了梁月的身份后，踌躇片刻，凑到梁月的耳边。

Scott: There's no one I would trust more than a vigil, Ms. Liáng.
斯考特：见习执夜人梁小姐，既然您被选入了夜巡特遣管理局，就说明您是值得信赖的人。

Scott: I'm here on a mission for the Foundation, and you might be able to help me with it.
斯考特：其实我是为了一项基金会的任务而来，也许……您能够提供一些帮助。

Pedra: September 1990, a female arcanist committed a serious assault and caused a number of casualties. She appeared at an illegal gathering held by the Order of Enlightenment, a subordinate organization of Manus Vindictae.
佩德拉：1990 年 9 月，出现在重塑之手下属组织启明会违法集会的未知女性神秘学家制造了严重的人身伤害事件。

Pedra: The Timekeeper encountered her and confirmed her identity: Anjo Nala, a Beyond arcanist.
佩德拉：司辰在该事件后与此女性神秘学家发生了接触，经调查，确认其身份为超自然者——天使娜娜。

Pedra: Born sometime in the 19th century, she was sealed inside a wind-up toy in the year 1968. Since then, she has become a lethal weapon that must obey whoever possesses her toy.
佩德拉：她诞生自 19 世纪，推测于 1968 年被封印进外形如同发条玩具的封印物中，成为了必须听从封印物持有者命令的致命武器。

Pedra: But back in 1985, I mean, the real 1985 ...
佩德拉：但早在 1985 年，我是说“真正的”1985 年——

Pedra: That toy had been safely stored in our Arcanum Containment Department as a "dangerous item."
佩德拉：这一封印物本应已被圣洛夫基金会作为“危险神秘学物品”回收，保管于神秘学藏品管理部。

Scott: Until it was stolen.
斯考特：……有人从基金会偷走了它，将它流出到了外界。

Pedra: You were involved in that particular inventory check. There are four additional items that are now lost aside from No. 066.
佩德拉：你也参加了那次清点工作。除了编号 NO.066“发条玩具”之外，另有四件神秘学管理品被发现失窃。

Pedra: The circumstances of the last "Storm" and that devastating "spell" threw our whole organization into chaos. However, there's no excuse for failing to uphold our department's most crucial mission.
佩德拉：“暴雨”的来袭和此前从未出现过的“规避‘暴雨’的咒语”……那场骚乱让我们无暇顾及其他。但毫无疑问，我们的工作出现了疏漏。

Pedra: Fortunately, it appears that our "break-in" was committed by a single culprit.
佩德拉：幸运的是，我们很快发现所有线索都指向了同一个嫌犯。

Scott: I heard what you and your partner just said. It's about all the weird things happening in Chinatown, right?
斯考特：我听到你和你的搭档在餐厅中的对话了，唐人街中发生了许多怪事，对吗?

Scott: It was my mission to catch Latham and retrieve all the arcane objects she'd stolen before they caused more damage.
斯考特：最理想的情况，是在莱瑟姆还没有借助那些神秘学物品的力量搞出太大的动静前，将她抓获并回收那些神秘学管理品……

Scott: But I guess it's already too late for that.
斯考特：但显然，事情已经有些迟了。

The meaning behind these words is crystal clear. There is no room for Liáng to feign ignorance.
这番话中的意思很明确了，不容得梁月假装听不懂。

Liang Yue: Then you're saying that ...
梁月： 难道说，在那些同样被发现失窃的神秘学管理品中……

Scott: Yes, the cursed reel from the incident you mentioned was among the stolen items. And you said that you have some clue about its current whereabouts?
斯考特： 你刚才提到的那张“被诅咒的胶片”正是其中之一。
似乎你们发现了它去向的线索?

The cursed film reel, Reunion of the Three Swallows, is in Chinatown—The weight of this revelation sinks heavily in Liáng's chest.
——“被诅咒的胶片”《三燕归巢》，就在唐人街。
这个消息和它背后代表的含义让梁月心里一沉。

Scott: I was told to operate under strict secrecy, but at this point, the faster they're retrieved, the better. So, shall we work together?
斯考特： 也许我们可以合作。我接到的任务，原本是让我隐秘行事……
但事到如今，我想比起保密，更重要的是尽快回收那些神秘学危险品。

Scott takes a notebook from her pocket and pulls out a photo tucked inside.
斯考特从怀中掏出了一本笔记本，抽出了夹在里面的一张照片。

Scott: Our main suspect is Latham, an Awakened arcanist.
斯考特： 嫌犯叫做莱瑟姆，是一名意识唤醒者。

Liáng can't help but look surprised when she recognizes the other girl in the photograph.
尽管早有心理准备，但在看清照片中除斯考特外的另一名少女时，梁月还是不禁露出了惊讶的表情。

But Scott seems to misinterpret her reaction.
但她的惊讶似乎被斯考特误解为了另一个意思。

Scott: It's hard for me to believe she'd do this. We were colleagues and close friends. I used to call her Loggerhead, because she's the most forgetful person I know.
斯考特： 是啊……她是我的同僚，和我的关系也很好。
我通常都是叫她“空脑袋”的，因为她平时笨笨的，又经常忘东西……

Scott: At first, I refused to believe she could do such a thing. I still don't understand why. She's not the kind to be greedy.
斯考特： 说实话，我不愿意相信她居然做了这样的事，她看起来并不像是会为了钱而做出这种事的人，但……

Scott: But the Vigiles investigated the theft thoroughly, and the Vigiles are not the kind to make mistakes.
斯考特： 当时负责调查这件事的也是一名执夜人女士，夜巡特遣总不会出错。

Scott: You've been here a few days already, right? Have you had any word about where she might be?
斯考特： 你刚才说近期你刚好在洛杉矶实习，也许你知道些关于莱瑟姆下落的线索?

Scott's brow furrows, her expression torn between hope and fear. It's as if she wants confirmation while equally dreading to hear the truth.
斯考特的眉头紧蹙，眼神满是挣扎，像是既期待听到一个肯定的回复，却又畏惧着那样一个答案。

Liang Yue: ...
梁月： ……

Liang Yue: Sorry, I haven't.
梁月： 不，我没有。

She shakes her head.
梁月摇了摇头。

Scott's expression visibly relaxes.
随即，斯考特的表情肉眼可见地放松了下来。

Scott: Oh. What a pity.
斯考特：哦……那真是太遗憾了。

没头脑嘉宾
A Name Deserved SC-09

Female Storekeeper: Have a good day!
老板娘：欢迎下次光临——

Before the owner can even say goodbye, Liáng has yanked Poitier out the front door.
老板娘最后的几个音节被拦在了餐馆内，梁月拉着波蒂埃三步并作两步跃出店门。

Poitier: What's the rush? I haven't even finished my noodles.
波蒂埃：等等，这么着急做什么？我还没有吃饱呢！

Liang Yue: We can eat later, but we need to find Ms. Latham, now!
梁月：您可以留些肚子晚上再吃，现在我们必须立刻找到那名神秘学藏品管理部的职员莱瑟姆！

Poitier: Wait, wait. Hold on. I'm all for chasing down a crook. But why do I get the feeling you didn't tell your Foundation friend about your run-in with Latham?
波蒂埃：等等，等等！我明白要趁着那个基金会追捕的嫌犯逃到其他地方之前逮住她，但我不明白的是为什么你不直接告诉那个基金会职员？

Poitier: What's up? Why you keeping her in the dark?
波蒂埃：为什么要瞒着她，在她离开之后偷偷去找那个摄像头脑袋？

Liang Yue: I think that something isn't right about her.
梁月：只是以防万一，这件事情让我觉得有些奇怪。

Liang Yue: I've been to the ACD before. To most, it might seem defenseless, but it's actually heavily protected by arcane rituals.
梁月：我们在培训时去过基金会的神秘学藏品管理部，那里看起来满是破绽，但实际上各处都安置了监控的术式。

Liang Yue: According to Ms. Scott, Latham acted alone.
梁月：根据斯考特小姐的说法，那名叫作莱瑟姆的职员是单独作案……

Liang Yue: But there's nothing in her file that would suggest she's capable of that. Her arcane skill level is frankly far from remarkable.
梁月：但我查询了她的档案，除了是一名意识唤醒者外，她并没有什么特殊之处，在神秘术上的造诣也不过平平。

Liang Yue: Even with insider knowledge, I don't believe it's possible she could have bypassed the security system and escaped on her own.
梁月：我并不认为那个叫做莱瑟姆的职员能够仅凭运气，突破神秘学藏品管理部的警戒系统。

Liang Yue: Either Ms. Latham has playing the Foundation for fools, or she has more powerful accomplices. That leads me to another thing. This mission is not something a typical Foundation staff member would be assigned to—as Ms. Scott claimed to be.
梁月：显然嫌犯莱瑟姆也许隐藏了实力，又或是有其他同伙……无论如何，这种量级的事，都不应该由一个普通职员负责追捕工作。

Liang Yue: There's something we don't know.
梁月：——这件事的背后一定有隐情。

Poitier: You're saying that girl with glasses lied to you?
波蒂埃：你的意思是说……那个眼镜妹骗了你?

Liang Yue: Maybe, or that she was being lied to herself.
梁月：又或许……她也被蒙在鼓里。

Liáng pulls her SPF-I contact device from beneath her cloak. After a few simple taps, she turns it around for Poitier to see.
梁月从披风下掏出自己的 SPF-Ⅰ型便携联络装置，简单操作两下后，将上面的界面展示给波蒂埃。

Liang Yue: There was another thing I found while searching through Ms. Latham's files, or rather, what I didn't find—there were no warnings or notices on her employee records.
梁月：我之前在基金会的系统中搜索过关于莱瑟姆的情报，上面并没有出现任何异常提示。

Poitier: You mean, she's not actually wanted?
波蒂埃：什么意思，她并没有被通缉?

Liang Yue: No, I don't think so.
梁月：不……如果那是个谎言，也未免太容易被戳破了。

Liang Yue: Ms. Scott said that their department wanted to solve this problem in secret, so I thought that might explain the reason Ms. Latham's warrant wasn't on her file.
梁月：依照斯考特小姐所说，神秘学藏品管理部希望隐秘处理这件事。
我最初认为也许是因此，抓捕莱瑟姆小姐的消息才没有被公开。

Liang Yue: However, when I tried to access more of their records to double-check my findings, I ran into a block on Ms. Scott's records.
梁月：但随后我又在夜巡特遣管理局的子系统中，搜索了有关神秘学藏品管理部失窃事件，以及莱瑟姆、斯考特小姐的信息……

Notification: Access denied. You do not have permission to view this information. If you need access, please contact your supervisor.
系统音：非常抱歉，您没有权限查看相关信息。如需要查阅，请联系您的上级管理者。

A warning symbol flashes on the screen.
显示屏上弹出刺眼的警示符号。

Liang Yue: It could just be because I'm only a cadet. There are some files that I don't have access to yet. I contacted my supervisor, but I haven't heard anything back.
梁月：意味着这里有一些还只是“见习”执夜人的我不被允许获知的信息。
我联系了我的导师，但并没有收到回复。

Liang Yue: I don't mean to distrust her, but I can't hold anyone above suspicion.
梁月：我也并不想要怀疑斯考特小姐，但怀疑就是我的工作。

Poitier shifts her gaze from the device's screen back to Liáng.
波蒂埃收回了望向那面拒绝给予她们任何信息的屏幕的目光，看向身旁的少女。

Poitier: And what about me? You're putting a lot of trust in me, Liáng. Is it really alright that you're telling me all this?
波蒂埃：……我说，那你就不怀疑我吗?
和我说这些真的没问题吗?

Poitier: A dangerous item stolen from the Foundation and possibly an inside job at that. That's a scandal in the making.
波蒂埃：惹出事端来的是从基金会流出的危险神秘学管理品，而罪魁祸首是监守自盗的自家职员……这可是个不小的丑闻。

Poitier: You could've just lied to me, make up some kind of story. It's not hard for a smart kid like you.
波蒂埃：我现在已经知道你这家伙心眼子绝不少，扯出一个让我挑不出漏洞的谎糊弄过去，对你来说应该也不是难事。

Liáng gives Poitier a puzzled look.
梁月用怪异的眼神看向了波蒂埃。

Liang Yue: Why would I? We're partners, Ms. Poitier. Hiding information from you wouldn't be right. You told me that yourself, didn't you?
梁月：因为我们是搭档。这不是您告诉我的吗?
我并不认为对自己的搭档隐瞒重要的线索是什么明智之举。

Poitier: Me?
波蒂埃：我?

Liang Yue: Yes, the first day we were on duty together, you said you "need to know what makes me tick."
梁月：是的，在我们共同执勤的第一天，在那间餐馆里享用午餐的时候。

Poitier: Hmm, I did, didn't I?
波蒂埃：哦……好像是有那么一回事。

Poitier seems a little dazed. Liáng looks at her, sincerity behind her eyes.
波蒂埃的反应慢了半拍，看起来有些发愣。
这让梁月不由得疑惑地看了自己的教官两眼。

Liang Yue: I've reconsidered it, and you're right.
梁月：我事后又思考了您说的话……您是对的。

Liang Yue: During my training as a vigil, our instructor emphasized many times that trusting in our partner was of vital importance.
梁月：在夜巡特遣的培训中，我的导师也无数次强调过搭档的重要性。
没有人能永远孤军作战。

Liang Yue: And you, Ms. Poitier, have proven to be capable, decisive, and compassionate. I have developed a deep respect for your work.
梁月：您有着出色的行动力、果决的判断力、敏锐的直觉和极高的同理心，是一位可靠且值得信赖的警官。

Liang Yue: We share the same goal: to discover the truth behind the incidents happening in Chinatown. I can't think of any reason why I shouldn't cooperate with you.
梁月：我们都赞同要亲自将唐人街发生的怪事彻查到底，目的是一致的，因此我们当然应该通力合作……

Poitier: Alright, alright, alright. Enough. I'm blushing already.
波蒂埃：行了行了行了，我明白了!

Poitier cuts Liáng off, almost flustered.
波蒂埃几乎是有些狼狈地打断了梁月。

Poitier: Damn, girl! I didn't expect my meek little mouse to turn into this.
波蒂埃：为什么你平常有什么事情总是闷在心里，说起这种话的时候却又……又一点也不觉得害臊?

Liang Yue: This what?
梁月：这种话是指……?

Poitier: Forget it. You've made your point. Now, stop it.
波蒂埃：……没什么!
总之，我明白你的意思了。

Poitier waves a hand, signaling the conversation's end.
波蒂埃挥手示意这个话题到此为止。

Poitier: But you kinda missed my point. I'm worrying that the Foundation is gonna punish you for leaking classified information. Won't you get in trouble?
波蒂埃：不过，基金会那边不会追究你的责任吗？例如说你“擅自把机密信息泄露给地方神秘学犯罪科”之类的。

Liang Yue: Though I may be a vigil of the Foundation, before that, I am a descendant of the Liáng family. I'm obliged to do all that is necessary to fulfill my destiny.
梁月：我的确隶属于基金会，但在这层身份之前……我更是十二侪子之一的梁家之后。

Liang Yue: And given the circumstances, I think providing all relevant information that might assist us in catching the thief and retrieving these threatening arcane objects is worth bending the rules ... just a little.
梁月：规矩并不是镣铐。我想追回危险神秘学管理品、逮捕监守自盗的犯人才是眼下最优先的事项。

Despite her conviction, Liáng can't help but hesitate a little.
梁月顿了顿。

Liang Yue: Besides, I'm not under any orders to keep this a secret. So ...
梁月：再说，我又没有真的接到来自上面的保密命令。

Poitier: Haha. Cheeky, and you say you don't like bending the rules. I see you, boo.
波蒂埃：……哈哈！
你这个坏家伙，真是不能对你放松一点警戒。

Poitier: And I like it. Come on. Let's work this out together, partner.
波蒂埃：好吧，就让我们一起去弄清楚这件事背后究竟藏着什么名堂吧。

Hotel Room
旅店房间

Loggerhead: Which one is my room again? Oh, right, I wrote it down. Let me see. There it is. I almost went too far again.
空脑袋：我的房间是哪个来着？对了，我写在这里了……
啊！是这个，差点走过了。

Loggerhead: Now, the key card. Where did I put it—oh, here.
空脑袋：房卡……房卡……在这里。

Loggerhead: Home, sweet home. Oh, I'm exhaust—
空脑袋：回来了！累死我……了……

The camera-headed girl freezes in place.
旅店房间的主人在推门入内后，僵在了原地。

Two officers are standing in her sweet home.
原因显而易见，本应当独属于她的小窝中一目了然地多了两个不速之客的身影。

Poitier: Latham, right? It's been a while.
波蒂埃：莱瑟姆，对吧？等你半天了。

Liang Yue: We have some questions for you. Please try to cooperate.
梁月：我们有些话需要问你。

Liáng steps forward and closes the door on her behalf.
梁月走上前去，代替房间的主人关上了房门。

When an unsuspecting prey steps into a carefully laid trap, the outcome is already decided.
当可怜的猎物毫无防备地踏入早已布置好的陷阱中时，结局就已经注定。

Loggerhead: Alright. Fine. I'll tell you everything.
空脑袋：好啦好啦！我说，我说还不行吗！

Loggerhead: It was me, okay? They said I stole those arcane objects and sold them for money, well, maybe I did—Ouch!
空脑袋：是我干的，他们说那些东西是我偷的，然后偷偷卖掉换了钱，都是我！
大概——诶哟！

As she speaks, she backs closer and closer to the wall behind her, until she smacks her oversized head into the window ledge.
她可怜兮兮地把自己的身体缩进了房间的角落，相较于她娇小的少女体型显得格外笨重的头部，还因此磕到了窗户的边沿。

A particular word in her statement makes Liáng tilt her head.
这番供词中的某个字眼让梁月疑惑地歪了歪头。

Liang Yue: What do you mean "maybe"?
梁月：你说的“大概”是什么意思?

Loggerhead: Because, actually, I can't remember it.
空脑袋：因为……其实我也不知道……

Loggerhead: I can't find my memory film for that time, so really, I just don't know.
空脑袋：我也不知道我究竟有没有做那些事，因为我找不到那段时间的记忆胶片了。

Liang Yue: Memory film?
梁月：……记忆胶片?

This so-called Loggerhead girl, an Awakened, isn't exactly a tough one. Within thirty minutes, she has spilled everything.
这名被称作“空脑袋”的意识唤醒者少女并不是什么硬骨头，约半小时后，她就已经将自己的所有底细倒了个干净。

Yet, despite this seemingly ideal result, neither of the officers looks pleased.
然而面对这个本该十分喜人的成果，两名年轻的执法者却丝毫不见欣喜之色。

Poitier: *sigh* So, to summarize what you just said, Latham:
波蒂埃：唉……好吧。
让我总结一下，莱瑟姆。

Poitier: You're an Awakened piece of a movie projector, which forms a Latham loop.
波蒂埃：你是一个意识唤醒者，你的本体是组成莱瑟姆环路的一枚零件。

Poitier: You were designed to play movies, not record them, and that's why you suffer from severe amnesia.
波蒂埃：你诞生的意义是“放映”而不是“记忆”，所以尽管你成为了一名意识唤醒者，你却有严重的健忘症。

Poitier: You can only recall things that happened within the last three days, and after that, you'll forget almost everything, do I got that right?
波蒂埃：你的记忆大概只能维持三天，三天过后，你的脑袋就会变得空无一物……是这个意思吗?

Loggerhead: I guess so.
空脑袋：是呀……哈哈。

Poitier: You guess so?
波蒂埃：哈哈什么哈哈！

Loggerhead: Eek!
空脑袋：咿！

Poitier's sudden questioning startles the girl. She shrinks further into the corner, wedging herself between the window and a nearby chair.
突然暴起的波蒂埃显然把莱瑟姆吓了一跳——她再次缩回了那个似乎能够提供给她少许安全感的角落，把自己塞进了窗边墙壁和椅子的中间。

Poitier: I can see why that friend of yours calls you Loggerhead. You deserve the name. What is going on here?
波蒂埃：你在开玩笑吗？怪不得那个眼镜妹叫你空脑袋，你的脑袋根本空空如也啊！
怎么会有这种事?!

Liang Yue: It's understandable. Awakened arcanists often suffer side effects related to their origins and materials, but still, this is quite unusual, to say the least.
梁月：虽说意识唤醒者由于其特殊的起源，原本就可能存在各种各样的体质问题，但……我实在是没有预料到会有这样的情况。

Liang Yue: So, she has no memory of what happened three days ago, or even any of the cases she was involved in. So then, she's basically useless to our investigation.
梁月：无法确保三天以前记忆的准确性……这就意味着她的证言完全不具备可信性，即使目击或是被卷入什么案件，她也可能完全不记得……

Liang Yue: I can only imagine what a disaster it would be if you showed up in a Detective Co7 movie.
梁月：如果这是一部悬疑推理电影，出现这种角色简直就是一场灾难。

Loggerhead: Hey! That's rude! How come I'm a disaster?
空脑袋：……也不用说得这么过分吧！我怎么就变成灾难了?

The girl, mustering what little courage she has left, waves her metal fists in defiance.
缩在角落的空脑袋挥舞着金属制造的拳头，鼓起勇气表达了她的不满。

But her feeble resistance has no effect on the officers. After sighing in unison, they exchange a glance.
但莱瑟姆的努力没有对梁月和波蒂埃起到任何威慑作用。
她们在不约而同地叹出一口气后，看向彼此。

Poitier: What do you think?
波蒂埃：……你怎么认为?

Liang Yue: I've made a request for Ms. Latham's detailed records. But, I don't think she's lying.
梁月：我已经发送了申请，等情报科传回莱瑟姆小姐的详细信息后，我们就可以确认了。但……我不认为这是一个谎言。

Liang Yue: Back at the hospital, the best lie she could come up with was "a hamster riding a stethoscope." I kind of doubt she's a master manipulator.
梁月：一个能说出“仓鼠骑着听诊器在天花板上飞”的嫌疑人……想必还欠缺一点谎言需要的智慧。

抽丝剥茧论
Unraveling the Mystery SC-10

Liang Yue: Let me sort things out.
梁月： 请让我重新整理一下吧，两位。

Liang Yue: Ms. Loggerhead, you said you could record and save your memories using a special type of film developed by Laplace.
梁月： 空脑袋小姐，你提到你能够使用拉普拉斯科算中心开发的特制胶片，以“拍摄”的方法记录你的记忆并备份。

Liang Yue: Which means that, even if you don't recall taking anything from the Arcanum Containment Department, your film should show whether you did or not.
梁月： 所以虽然你本人并不记得自己是否曾经将神秘学藏品管理部的危险神秘学管理品流出到外界，但按理来说，你的记忆胶片中应当记录了一切。

Liang Yue: But the fact is, the films are gone. Isn't that right?
梁月： ——然而，那些胶片却不见了。
是这样吗?

Loggerhead: Yeah. I usually carry my most important memories with me and leave the others in my room.
空脑袋： 是呀……通常我会把重要的“记忆”随身携带，将其他记忆放在自己的房间里。

Loggerhead: The Foundation staff checked the visitor log after the stuff was stolen. Turns out I was the only one who visited the office that day, so they sent people to my room and checked all my film, but they didn't find anything.
空脑袋： 基金会发现失窃当天出入管理部的只有我后，派人前往我的房间进行了搜查。可他们却没有发现能够证明我清白的、失窃当天的胶片。

Loggerhead: Then they said they already had other evidence, so ...
空脑袋： 再加上说是有什么其他的证据……

Loggerhead's voice trails off, and someone else completes her words.
空脑袋的声音低了下去，在场的另一个人义愤填膺地补完了她未说完的话。

Scott: So they just declared Loggerhead guilty.
斯考特： ——所以他们就断定空脑袋是犯人。

Scott: But that doesn't make any sense to me. Something must be wrong.
斯考特： 但在我看来这根本不可能，一定是哪里出了错！

The Foundation employee, who claimed to be hunting Loggerhead, received a call from Liáng just ten minutes ago.
这名自称为追捕莱瑟姆而来的基金会职员，在十分钟前接到了梁月的一通电话。

But the moment she stepped into the "clue-filled" hotel room and laid eyes on Loggerhead, she blurted out, "You're still here?" And just like that, the final piece of Loggerhead's testimony was confirmed.
当她进入梁月称“找到了线索”的房间，见到空脑袋时脱口而出“你怎还没走”后……空脑袋的另一部分证言也得到了印证。

Liang Yue: *sigh*
梁月： ……唉。

The two girls sitting on the bed lower their heads in silent understanding.
梁月的叹息声，让端坐在床上的两名少女默契地低下了头。

Liang Yue: So, when you found Ms. Latham, you bought her a train ticket instead of putting her under arrest.
梁月： 所以在找到莱瑟姆小姐后，你并没有对她实施抓捕，而是为莱瑟姆小姐安排了逃亡的车票。

Scott: I know I've gone against orders, but I'm sure Loggerhead didn't do this. She's my friend. I can't just arrest her and have the Foundation lock her up.
斯考特： 我知道这不合规矩，但空脑袋不可能是犯人，一定是哪里搞错了。
作为朋友，我不能就这样将她绑回基金会，坐视她被草草定罪。

Scott: I'm sorry for keeping all this from you, but you're a vigil. I had to be careful.
斯考特： 刚才我向你隐瞒了这一切……我感到非常抱歉。
但因为你是夜巡特遣管理局的人，所以我想我必须不能露出破绽……

Scott: So, if it's not crossing a line, Ms. Liáng, Ms. Poitier, can I ask you to keep this between us? You can report it after we find out who's really done this.
斯考特： 如果可以的话，梁小姐，波蒂埃小姐，我希望你们能够替我与空脑袋保密。
等我们查出犯人究竟是谁，再向上面汇报也不迟。

Loggerhead: Could you? Please?
空脑袋： 可以吗？求求你们了？

Scott's eyes gleam pleadingly, and Loggerhead's lens gleams as she stares at the officers in expectation.
斯考特的眼神中透出恳求，而一旁的空脑袋也同样用晶莹剔透的摄像头期待地盯着梁月与波蒂埃二人。

The pitiful expressions on both their faces would tug at anyone's heartstrings. Liáng almost feels as though she's tormenting some kind of harmless creature. But this unofficial interrogation isn't over yet.
两名少女可怜兮兮的模样让人心生怜悯，甚至让梁月产生了一种自己似乎正在虐待某种无害小动物的错觉……但这场非正式的审讯还没有结束。

Poitier: We'll talk about that once we figure out what the hell's going on.
波蒂埃： 这件事等我们把事情弄清楚后再讨论也不迟。

Poitier: Back to the case. You said she gave you a train ticket. What're you still doing here?
波蒂埃： 刚才说到这个眼镜妹给了你去其他城市的车票，但你为什么还在这里？

Loggerhead lets out an awkward laugh.
空脑袋尴尬地笑了笑。

Loggerhead: Actually, while I was on my way to the train station, a car on the other side of the street lost control and hit my cab.
空脑袋： 谁能想到呢？在我乘坐出租车去车站的路上，对面的司机好像突然发了疯，直接越过实线和我们撞在了一起。

Loggerhead: Thankfully, it crashed into the passenger seat where I was sitting. My metal's much stronger than human flesh.
空脑袋： 幸亏撞到的是我坐的副驾驶席这侧。
我的身体结实，但那个司机可是肉体凡胎。

Liáng searches her memory for a moment.
一旁的梁月略作思索，挖掘出储备在记忆中的某条信息。

Liang Yue: That's right. There was a car accident yesterday morning. The driver suffered some kind of unknown mental abnormality while he was on the road. Maybe he's fallen victim, too.
梁月： 昨天上午的交通事故……我看过记录，那名肇事司机身上也出现了原因不明的精神异常，说不定他也是事件的受害人。

Liang Yue: What happened next?
梁月： 在那之后呢?

Loggerhead: I was sent to the hospital, and you showed up. I thought you were gonna arrest me, so I ran as fast as I could.
空脑袋： 我被送到了医院，然后就遇到了你嘛。
那个时候我还以为你就是来抓我的人，所以连忙跑了。

Loggerhead: I threw away my cell phone and contact device as soon as I left the Foundation. Scott said they could use them to track me down. I couldn't get ahold of anyone and didn't know what to do.
空脑袋： 斯考特说带着手机和便携联络装置会被定位，所以我早早就把它们丢掉了，可这下我也联系不上她，不知道该如何是好。

Loggerhead: And, even though I don't know for sure, I really don't think I'm guilty. It's super weird to be on the run when you feel like you're innocent.
空脑袋： 而且……说实话，虽然没有记忆，但我总觉得自己并没有干那些坏事。
就这样离开总觉得怪怪的。

Loggerhead: So, I went back to Chinatown to ask Director Noire for help. She was the only one I could contact directly.
空脑袋： 所以我就又回到了唐人街，去找菲林士多导演帮忙了。
毕竟她在这里拍电影，就算没有手机，我也能找到她。

A crucial name.
空脑袋提到的那个名字十分关键。

Liang Yue: Noire ... Could you tell me how you got to know her?
梁月： ……你提到你和菲林士多相识，能讲讲当时的经过吗?

Loggerhead: Of course.
空脑袋： 当然啦!

Loggerhead: Let me see. Walk of Fame ... Walk of Fame ... Okay. Now I just need to turn left.
空脑袋： 让我看看，星光大道……星光大道……
有了！在这里，它在左边!

Loggerhead: Wait, which way is left again? It changes every time I turn, right? Gosh, how the heck do people read maps?
空脑袋： ……但左边是哪里？当我转身，我的左边就会变一个方向……不是吗?
大家都是怎么使用地图的?

Noire: Are you alright? It seems you could use some help.
菲林士多： 发生什么了？你看起来需要帮助。

Loggerhead: Noire stopped to help me. She was really interested in my head, so we had a little chat, and I found out she was a director.
空脑袋： ——是菲林士多女士帮助了迷路的我，她说她对我的脑袋很感兴趣。
而聊了几句后，我发现她居然是一名导演!

Loggerhead: She offered to take me to the Walk of Fame. We talked a lot about movies on our way there. Then, I told her I was traveling alone, so she invited me to join her movie shoot in Chinatown.
空脑袋： 在送我去星光大道的路上，我们聊了很多关于电影的话题。在听说我是一个人来旅游、没有什么特别的安排后，她就邀请我一起来唐人街这边拍电影。

Loggerhead: How could I say no? I mean, she's a famous director. There's no way I'd miss a chance like that.
空脑袋：这我怎么能拒绝呢?
这可是大导演亲自指导拍摄的片场，我绝对不会错过的。

Liang Yue: Interesting. That was the same day that odd things started happening in Chinatown.
梁月：但菲林士多女士带领你和剧组成员来到唐人街的那一天，正好是唐人街一带开始出现异常神秘学事件的时间。

The head that was bobbing excitedly comes to a hesitant stop.
那颗激动得晃来晃去的脑袋迟疑地停住了。

Loggerhead: Hmm. Well, I'm not sure about that.
空脑袋：这……这我就不知道了。

Liang Yue: Did anything strange happen that day?
梁月：那一天有发生什么奇怪的事吗?

Loggerhead's lens flickers. It seems something has surfaced in her mind.
摄像头闪了闪。“空脑袋”的脑袋里似乎浮现出了什么东西。

Loggerhead: Let me see. I did find a strange film reel when I was unpacking that night.
空脑袋：说起来，那天晚上在来到唐人街后，我住进这个房间收拾行李，发现了一张奇怪的胶片。

Liang Yue: A strange film reel?
梁月：奇怪的……胶片?

Poitier: Wait. Could that be ...?
波蒂埃：等等，难道说那个就是……?

All three of the others immediately perk up at the mention of those words.
胶片二字让在场的另外三人都提起了注意力。

But perhaps due to the limited field of vision of her camera lens, Loggerhead remains oblivious to their gazes.
但不知道是否因为摄像头的视野范围不够宽，瞬间成为视线焦点的那名意识唤醒者少女并没有察觉到众人紧张的凝视。

Instead, she pulls her backpack toward her, muttering to herself as she leisurely rummages through it.
只见她放下自己沉甸甸的背包，一边在口中念叨着，一边悠哉游哉地翻找起来。

Loggerhead: Yeah, a strange film reel. I've gotten into the habit of labeling my films, like "Check every day" or "Check from time to time," so that I know what to watch to keep important things in my mind.
空脑袋：是呀，我会给记忆胶片们贴上标记，“每天都要看的”“要经常看看的”……经常复习，才不会忘记重要的事。

Loggerhead: I was gonna do a review that night, but when I looked through my film, there was a roll without a label on it.
空脑袋：在住进这间房间后，我也打算来一次“定期复习”，却发现我的胶片里有一张没有贴任何标记。

Loggerhead: It couldn't have been mine, cause it was made of a different material. I was so curious about it, you know? So I played it.
空脑袋：仔细一看，那盘胶片的材质也不对，它不是我的记忆胶片。
我觉得很奇怪，就用自己放映了它。

Liang Yue: What did you see?
梁月：胶片中的内容是什么?

Loggerhead: It was a movie, I guess. But it was pretty short, more like a demo or a trailer or something.
空脑袋：那好像是一部电影，但是很短，像是片花。

Loggerhead: But it was so weird. Like a jumble of pictures and sounds. It didn't make any sense to me. I dunno. Maybe it was a prank or something. Hm?
空脑袋：奇怪的是里面的内容根本不知所云，有很多莫名其妙的画面和声音，我猜可能是谁的恶作剧……奇怪。

She halts her search and looks up blankly.
她停下了手上翻动背包的动作，茫然地抬起头来。

Scott: What's wrong?
斯考特：怎么了吗?

Loggerhead: The film. It's gone.
空脑袋：那盘胶片……不见了。

Poitier: What?
波蒂埃：——你说什么?

Loggerhead shrinks nervously once again.
诧异令波蒂埃抬高了嗓门，空脑袋被吓了一跳，心虚地缩了缩身子。

Loggerhead: I can't find it. It was right here, in my bag.
空脑袋：反正我没有找到……之前我就是放在包里的。

Poitier: Give it to me.
波蒂埃：给我，我来找!

In one swift motion, Poitier snatches Loggerhead's backpack and upends its contents onto the bed.
波蒂埃抓过空脑袋的那只鼓鼓囊囊的背包，将里面的东西一口气都倾倒在了床上。

Poitier: Damn, first time I've seen a bag messier than my sister's. Do you ever organize your stuff?
波蒂埃：你的包怎么比我妹妹的还乱？你都不整理的吗?

Like a whirlwind, Poitier tears through Loggerhead's things, ignoring her shrieks of "I just forgot to throw that away!" and "I still need that!" as she ransacks not only the backpack but the entire room.
如龙卷风般，波蒂埃在空脑袋诸如“我只是忘记扔了”“那个还有用”的尖叫声中，将她的背包连同整个房间都搜刮了一个遍。

Finally, she has no choice but to accept a rather disheartening conclusion.
最终，她不得不得出那个令人绝望的结论。

Poitier: Nope. Nothing.
波蒂埃：——没有！哪里都没有。

Poitier: You didn't take it out and lose it somewhere, did you? Mistake it for a tip for your pizza guy or something?
波蒂埃：你这个空脑袋，不会是不小心把它带出门弄丢了，或者和交给披萨外卖员的小费弄混了之类的吧?

Loggerhead: I forget things, but I'm not an idiot. I didn't lose it. Check my film if you wanna prove it. It just disappeared into thin air.
空脑袋：就算是我也不会把胶片和钱弄混啦!
我这几天的记忆胶片可以证明，我没有把它弄丢，它就是这样自己消失了!

Liang Yue: But your film only records what you saw. Someone might have taken it when you weren't looking.
梁月：记忆胶片只能记录到你所见到的场景，也许是有人在你的摄像头所照不到的地方拿走了它。

Liang Yue: Does anyone else know about this film reel? Did you have any visitors or notice anything suspicious after you played it?
梁月：还有任何人知道这张胶片的事吗？在你播放那盘胶片后，有谁曾经造访，或是发现过什么可疑的事吗？

Loggerhead: Suspicious? I don't think so. At least I didn't see anything.
空脑袋：可疑的迹象？我想应该没有……至少我没有发现。

Loggerhead: The only person who visited me afterwards was Scott. She came to tell me I was wanted by the Foundation.
空脑袋：在我播放完那盘胶片之后，除了斯考特来通知我被基金会当作犯人的消息之外，也没有什么可疑的人来过。

Loggerhead: Oh. But actually, I wasn't alone when I played it. Noire was with me. She said she was interested in my memories, so she came and ...
空脑袋：哦！不过在放映的时候，菲林士多导演也和我在一起。
因为她说对我的记忆胶片很感兴趣，所以就来了我的房间……

The others stare at Loggerhead as if she's grown a second head. She nervously swallows the rest of her sentence.
另外三个人见了鬼一样的目光，让空脑袋怯生生地咽下了剩下的话语。

Loggerhead: What's wrong?
空脑袋：……怎么了吗？

Scott: So, it was Noire who took the film?
斯考特：所以……是那个菲林士多导演偷偷拿走了胶片？

Actor: What are you—Ugh!
演员：你做什么——呃啊！

A solid punch sends the man flying.
一记重拳，男子被狠狠打飞。

At least, that's what was supposed to happen.
——本该是这样的。

Actor: Sorry, director. I'll try again.
演员：对不起导演，我再来一次。

Noire: Don't bother. Clearly, your martial arts skills are severely lacking. I don't want you to hit your head when you fall to the ground.
菲林士多：你没有武术的功底，倒地的时候容易磕到头部，叫你做那个动作还是太危险了。

Noire: Go. Take a break.
菲林士多：去休息吧。

The disheveled actor still wants to argue his case, but everyone knows that once this director makes a decision, she won't change her mind easily.
一身狼狈的演员本还想继续争取，但所有人都知道这名看似温和的导演一旦做出决定，就不会轻易改变主意。

In the end, he simply sighs and steps aside.
他张了张嘴，最终还是满脸歉意地依言走到了一旁。

Assistant: That was the last one, director.
助理：这就是最后一个人了，导演。

Assistant: There are far fewer stunt performers with martial arts experience here than in Hong Kong. Master Lau and his men will arrive in a few days. Perhaps we could shoot this scene then?
助理：这里不像香港，没有那么多现成的龙虎武师可供我们选择。
刘老师和他的弟子们再过几天就会到了，要不这场戏稍微等一下?

Noire: Nicolas is on a tight schedule. I doubt he'll change it. Let me see what I can do.
菲林士多：凯斯那边没有档期。
让我想想，还有什么其他的方法……

A single sentence is far from enough to capture the many difficulties the famous Hong Kong director has faced since working overseas.
短短一句话，自然道不尽这位香港名导远渡重洋后面临的诸多难题。

Leaning back in her wheelchair, she discreetly scans the set, searching for the missing piece of the puzzle.
她放松身体，让后背靠在轮椅的椅背上，用微微垂下的双眸不着痕迹地扫过整个片场，寻找破局的一子。

Noire: Hm? Her again?
菲林士多：……嗯？是她?

Lin follows Noire's gaze.
阿琳顺着菲林士多的目光看去。

Assistant: Oh, that young officer?
助理：那是……白天的那名小女警?

Extra: What do you want? Listen, I don't know what you're trying to do, but can't you just leave us alone?
龙套演员：你又来做什么？听着，我不知道你们警察找菲林士多导演究竟是为了什么，但可以不要再打扰我们拍摄了吗?

Crew Member: Sorry, ma'am, this is a closed set. If you don't have a warrant, please leave.
工作人员：我们这里并不允许外人参观，如果您没有搜查令的话就请回吧。

Loggerhead: Guys, guys, relax. Liáng isn't as mean as she seems.
空脑袋：大家不要这么凶嘛！
梁并不是坏人，只是偶尔看起来有些可怕而已……

Clearly, the arrival of a certain vigil cadet is unwelcome. So much so, that even Loggerhead is being eyed with suspicion.
显然，某位见习执夜人少女的到来并不受欢迎，连带着走在她身旁的摄像头脑袋也遭到了一些质疑。

But Liáng ignores them. She locked onto her target the moment she scanned the set and is already striding straight toward her.
但梁月没有理会旁人。在进入片场环顾一周后，她便已经锁定了她的目标，径直向那个方向走去。

She stops a few paces in front of the person in question.
梁月在目标人物的面前站定。

Noire: I must say I didn't expect to see you so soon, officer. Is there something else you wanted to ask me?
菲林士多：没想到我们这么快就又见面了，警官小姐。
您是还有什么其他的疑惑吗?

Noire: I think I made myself perfectly clear this morning. I know nothing about your case.
菲林士多：我想我白天应当已经说得很清楚了，我对您目前正在调查的案件一无所知。

Liang Yue: No, madam. I'm here to help.
梁月：您误会了，菲林士多导演。这次我是来帮忙的。

Noire: Help with what?
菲林士多：……帮忙?

Liang Yue: Ms. Latham mentioned that you're looking for a qualified stunt performer for your movie.
梁月：我听莱瑟姆小姐说，您正在为缺少身手出众的龙套演员而发愁。

Liang Yue: I'd like to help with that, if you don't mind, as an apology.
梁月：如果您不介意，我想也许我能够帮上您的忙。

Noire blinks.
菲林士多错愕地眨了眨眼睛。

Noire: Hmm. You surprise me again.
菲林士多：……这我倒是没有想到。

一次复检搜查
Double Check 小径

A bullet is among us, right under this roof. It serves no army, no country, only peace.
???: 一枚无国籍子弹正躲在这个屋檐下，它不属于哪个国家，只为了掌握和平而战。

The heavy rain at the end of the century dissolved and washed away many of its comrades, but it was lucky enough to survive. Its pointy end still shines silver, ready to drill a hole into its enemy.
???: 世纪末的大雨冲走了它无数的伙伴，它却幸运地回避了雨水的侵蚀。锐利的弹头仍旧散发着寒光，时刻都准备上膛，然后被击发，燃烧自我去给敌人身上开个洞。

Sadly, its bulky colleague stole its thunder in this war. One push of the button, one big explosion. There was no need for the rest of the ammunition.
???: 但可惜不是这次，它的大块头同事抢走了所有的风光，一个按钮，一场大爆炸。包含它在内的所有弹药储备，可就只能等着受潮咯。

选项 / Choices

1. Good, we saved a lot of bullets.
1. 减少消耗，这是好事

2. Good for them. They don't have to work for a while.
2. 不用工作还不好么?

分支 1 / Branch 1

It seems someone has become more budget-conscious after working with the mathematicians.
???: 看来与数学家的深度交流令你养成了对数字的敏感性，亲爱的。

Saving ten bullets is better than saving one. Saving a hundred bullets is better than saving ten. It's simple math.
???: 这是自然，一要小于十，十要小于百，面对这样简单的算术题，很少有人得不出正确答案。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Certainly, who doesn't want a life without the need to work? Few would hesitate to choose a life of freedom over the achievement and satisfaction of a job.
???: 不劳而获总是令人感到侥幸，但谁又能不喜欢呢？如果让一个人在荣誉与自由的生命中作选择，恐怕他不会犹豫超过三秒。

Given the short lifespan of a bullet, why would it choose anything else?
???: 更何况是一枚单纯的子弹呢？三秒已经足够涵盖子弹的一生了。

But its boss, the general, has more to think about. What are they going to do next time? Will this bullet be put to use when the rain comes again?
???: 但正如它的上司所想的一样，下一次怎么办呢？下一次大雨时这枚子弹还能平安无事么？

选项 / Choices

1. The general? Who's that?
1. 又是哪位要我认识的大人物?

A big shot, dear. A wise man of the most insightful kind. You should talk to him if you have the chance.
???: 这位大人物可是个狠角色了，亲爱的。一位英明神武的将军值得你去结交。

But he's been in a gloomy mood lately. Be careful not to mention anything related to the conservative battle tactics used in 1999, the missile that would have been launched, and especially anything about the bullets lost in that battle.
???: 不过他近来一直心情不好，在和他聊天时可不能提到 99 年的保守战术与没能发射的大块头，特别是不要提及那一年牺牲的子弹们。

He has paid a great price for the future, but you see, the future is sneaky.
???: 他为未来付出了太多，但未来实在是太卑鄙了。

Every time you think you can grasp it, it takes a step away from you, nullifying every effort you've made to get near it. Even a bullet isn't fast enough to catch up.
???: 每当你以为已经追上它时，它就往前踏出一小步，你的一切努力与牺牲便成为了过去。即便迅猛如子弹，又如何才能抓到一个从不停下的未来呢?

选项 / Choices

1. Then we must keep pursuing.
1. 只有不断追赶

2. Perhaps bullets won't be needed in the future?
2. 也许未来不需要子弹?

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

Pursuing the future. How romantic, dear. As long as we continue to close the gap between us and the future, it will eventually be reduced to zero.
???: 追赶未来，多么浪漫啊，亲爱的。只要不断追赶下去，距离就会无限缩小，终有一刻那距离将归于零。

But know that, as time goes by, we are only moving slower and slower in the race. Technology is regressing, and we have switched from AKs to Mosin-Nagants. The bullets won't be as fast as they used to be. The future is drifting away from us, and the past is catching up.
???: 但追赶者的速度正在下降，亲爱的。莫辛与纳甘重新取代了卡拉什尼科夫，子弹已经不如当年那般迅猛。未来越来越远，过去却越来越近了。

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

Shhhh ... Don't say such things out loud. Especially not near the general, sweetheart.
???: 嘘……可别让别人，特别是子弹的上司听到你在说什么，亲爱的。

The bullets have paid a great price in order to find their way back to the future. If they hear you say they won't be needed anymore, you'll end up with quite the ammunition bill.
???: 子弹为了追上未来已经付出了太多，如果你现在宣布不需要它了，那弹药费用的账单可就要往你家里寄了。

Alright, let's leave this bullet to itself. Solitude may help alleviate its anxiety about the future.
???: 好了，让这枚子弹自己待一会儿吧，希望一小段独处时光能帮助它缓解对将来的焦虑。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Excerpt from the New York Times

《纽约新闻报》节选

英文 / ENGLISH

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.

The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.

On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

中文 / CHINESE

前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。

于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

喂，跑龙套！

Hey, Kelefe! SC-11

Noire: You mean to say that you're a stuntwoman? Seriously?

菲林士多：做我的演员？你吗？

Noire chuckles and shakes her head before turning her wheelchair in disinterest.

菲林士多摇头笑了笑，随即便像是并无太多兴趣般调转了轮椅的朝向。

Noire: Thank you, officer. Well, judging by your uniform, you're from the Vigiles Bureau, aren't you?

菲林士多：多谢您的好意，警官小姐——不，看您的制服，我想也许我该称呼您为执夜人小姐？

Noire: I appreciate the gesture. It's true that we may be able to attract more viewers if we have a vigil on the cast list.
菲林士多：您的提案令我受宠若惊，若是能有夜巡特遣管理局的人参与这部电影的拍摄，想必我们也能够吸引到更多的观众进入影院。

Noire: But filmmaking isn't as easy as you think. Maybe I can fit you in next time.
菲林士多：但也许您对拍摄电影有些误解，它并不是一件容易的事，您的好意我心领了。

Rejection. But refusal is not an option in this operation.
这意味着拒绝。但显然作战中并不包含“被拒绝”这一环。

Liang Yue: I'm familiar with movies, especially yours. I'm actually a big fan.
梁月：我对电影略知一二，也十分喜欢和熟悉您的作品。

Liang Yue: And I saw the performance just now. Not to be rude or anything, but I think I can handle the stunt.
梁月：我看了刚才您手下其他人的表现，无意冒犯，但——对于那些武戏的部分，也许我可以试一试。

Liang Yue: "For the betterment of the movie." That's what Ms. Latham said you were after. Is that right?
梁月：“做更好的电影”——莱瑟姆小姐告诉我，这就是您所追求的东西，不是吗？

Her words stir up a storm.
这番话再次掀起一番惊涛骇浪。

Actor: What? Does she even know what she's talking about?
演员：什么？她在说些什么？

Crew Member: Hmph. That's some pretty big talk.
工作人员：口气倒是不小……

Even Noire can't help but let out an amused chuckle at Liáng's words. Even so, her wheelchair comes to a stop.
菲林士多似乎也因梁月的这番话哑然失笑，但至少——那架原本逐渐驶离的轮椅，此刻停了下来。

Noire: That's true, but are you certain that you'll make my movie better?
菲林士多：这话倒是没错，但……你就这么确定，你就是能够让我的电影变得“更好”的那剂调味料？

Liang Yue: Yes.
梁月：是的。

To be honest, no.
说实话，不。

Liáng knows that filmmaking is far more complex than it appears. Her answer is far from the truth.
梁月知道电影的拍摄绝不像是看上去的那样简单，这绝非她的真心话。

But if she's going to uncover the truth, she has to act the part.
但为了查清真相……她必须成为一个好演员，正如此刻这般。

Noire: Hmm. Interesting.
菲林士多：……有趣。

Noire: Since you insist, let's give it a try. Show me what a vigil can do.
菲林士多：既然你都说到这个份上了，那么就让我们试试吧，执夜人小姐。

It isn't a particularly clever trick, but fortunately, Latham's words weren't false.
这并不是一个多么高明的计谋，值得庆幸的是莱瑟姆所言不虚。

Noire would never turn down an opportunity to improve her films.
菲林士多永远不会拒绝让她的电影变得“更好”的任何一个可能性。

Noire: Excellent! Bravo!
菲林士多：——很好，很好！

Noire: Exactly as you claimed, no, even better. Really spectacular work, a perfect take.
菲林士多：你真的做到了你所声称的事，这一条的确更好——堪称完美！

Liang Yue: I'm flattered, director.
梁月：……您过奖了，菲林士多导演……

Noire's eyes glisten as she watches the playback of the shot. Meanwhile, after nearly twenty failed takes, Liáng returns to the dressing room, her costume drenched in sweat.
菲林士多看着摄像机中的回放赞不绝口。
而 NG 了将近二十次，一旁梁月的临时戏服已经被汗水浸湿。

When she emerges back in her Vigiles uniform, a bottle of water is handed to her.
她从片场临时搭建的更衣间走出，换回了平日所穿的执夜人制服。
正感到口干舌燥之时，一瓶矿泉水被贴心地递到了她的面前。

Actor I: Here. It's not open.
演员 I：喝这个吧，没打开过的。

Liang Yue: Thank you.
梁月：……谢谢。

Actor I: Didn't expect you to pull it off. That was a dangerous stunt. Scared the crap outta me.
演员 I：没想到你表现得还挺不错的。那个动作那么危险，真亏你敢做，看着我都害怕。

Actor I: Alright, alright, so you did a good job one time. But let me tell you, it takes a lot more than that to win recognition in this industry.
演员 I：不过我得提醒你，如果你觉得每次都只是不要命，就能获得菲林士多导演的认可，那就大错特错了！

Actor II: You've really gotta hone in on the dramatic scenes if you wanna move out of the stuntwoman box. You're good-looking, and you took that scene pretty seriously. You interested in doing that?
演员 II：文戏才是考验一个演员的最重要的指标。你的外形不错，看你刚才拍戏也很认真，是不是真的对这一行有兴趣?

Actor II: If you are, then I'll suggest you be a little more humble. There's always room for improvement, you know.
演员 II：如果是的话，年轻人，我劝你最好更虚心一些，这样才能有机会真的让更多人看到。

Liang Yue: I ... You're right. I'm sorry.
梁月：我……您说得对，我很抱歉。

Liang Yue: But I'm not even a stuntwoman, let alone an actress. This is all just a bit of fun for me.
梁月：不过我的本职并不是演员，未来也没有在这一行发展的打算，电影只是……我的爱好。

Noire: Is that so? Oh, what a shame.
菲林士多：哦？那可就太可惜了。

The queen of the set rolls over in her chariot, stopping beside Liáng.
片场的女王乘着她的座驾来到了梁月的身边。

Noire: I appreciate your sincerity, but I'd be even more appreciative if you were willing to do a few more scenes.
菲林士多：你的歉意我感受到了，它非常诚恳，我很满意。
但如果你愿意提供更多，我会更高兴的。

Liang Yue: If it's just for a short time, I'd like to help in any way I can.
梁月： 如果只是短时间的话……我愿意尽我所能提供帮助。

Noire: Fantastic! Follow me. We can have dinner and look at the script together. I have a few changes I want to make to the story.
菲林士多： 这是我今天听过的最好的消息了！
跟我来，差不多到晚饭时间了，正好带你看看剧本——顺便改改剧本。

Noire: Trust me, the audience will be more than happy to hear a line or two from you.
菲林士多： 相信我，我们的观众一定会期待听到至少一句你的台词的。

Liang Yue: Lines? Okay.
梁月： 台词……是吗?

Things seem to be taking an unexpected turn.
——但事情的发展似乎开始超出预计的范围了。

Noire: That's all. Well? Have you memorized them?
菲林士多： ——就这些吧，怎么样，记住了吗?

Liang Yue: Yes, every word. But ...
梁月： 是的，我都背下来了。但……

Liang Yue: Aren't there too many?
梁月： 这不止一句台词吧?

The blank spaces in the script spread out on the table are filled with Noire's flamboyant pen strokes.
桌上摊开的剧本中已经多了几道写写画画的痕迹，潇洒飘逸的字迹在空白处笔走龙蛇。

Assistant: She's got a point, director. The investors might not approve them. They already told us not to change the script like we did in Hong Kong.
助理： 投资人要是知道了，可不一定会同意。
他们之前不就说过，咱们在香港那一套不能照搬，不可以边拍边改剧本吗?

Noire: Relax. We've done this before. They never read the script anyway.
菲林士多： 放心吧，我都改了多少了。
他都不看剧本，不会知道的。

Noire: Besides, I'm not exactly asking for a monologue here. It's only three lines. Just what's needed to make the character complete.
菲林士多： 而且这样角色塑造才完整。一句话虽然也可以，但这样的效果更好。
也不多，只有三句而已嘛！

Lin gives a helpless sigh. She knows all too well how pointless it is to try and change Noire's mind.
助理阿琳无奈地摇了摇头，像是知道劝不动菲林士多，不再言语。

Liang Yue: I'll keep practicing until filming starts.
梁月： 我会在开拍之前将它们练习好的。

Noire: I look forward to your performance.
菲林士多： 我期待着你的表现。

Liang Yue: By the way, I saw some deity dolls and sedan chairs on the set. The Dùshuò Festival is coming up, right? Is the crew joining the Shèhuǒ Parade?
梁月： 说起来我刚才在片场见到了一些神偶和神轿，我记得应当马上就到度朔节了，剧组的人也要参加社火游行吗?

Noire: Those are our props.
菲林士多： 那些是拍戏用的。

Noire: Our final scene is set at the Shèhuǒ Parade. I already spoke with the organizers in Chinatown. They've allowed us to shoot during it.
菲林士多：这次电影里的结局，会是一场在社火游行中的戏。
我和这边的组织者们打了招呼，直接让剧组参与进去，借景拍摄。

Liang Yue: Really? The last C07 movie ended with a Shèhuǒ Parade, too.
梁月：在社火游行里的戏？我记得 C07 的最后一部的结局，也是在社火游行中。

Noire's eyes light up. She smiles.
菲林士多的双眼一亮，向她露出一个笑容。

Noire: Good memory. Looks like you meant it when you said you were a big fan.
菲林士多：记忆力不错嘛，看来你说你熟悉我的片子并不是在吹牛。

The restaurant owner serves their meal, pausing their script discussion for the time being.
老板娘端上了她们的餐食，剧本会议暂时告一段落。

Noire and her assistant pick up their chopsticks, but Loggerhead remains still.
菲林士多和助理小姐都拿起了筷子，但这张四人餐桌上原本最贪吃的那个人却并没有立刻对桌上的美食做出什么反应。

Loggerhead: So, did you find anything?
空脑袋：所以……你发现什么了吗?

Loggerhead: You said that your beastie friend could detect things tainted with evil, right? So did it sense anything wrong with the director?
空脑袋：你说你的“险道兽强梁”有很大概率能够识别出有邪恶气息的物品是否在附近。
在菲林士多导演的身上你有什么发现吗?

While Loggerhead speaks in a hushed tone, the conspicuousness of her head makes talking in secret a near impossible task.
虽然空脑袋将自己的扬声器调低了音量……但说实话，她那颗颇引人注目的脑袋很难完成“凑到别人的耳边说悄悄话”这种行为。

Feeling Noire and Lin's subtle glances, Liáng squirms in her seat.
感受着菲林士多和助理王琳有意无意瞟过来的目光，梁月如坐针毡。

Liang Yue: No, but that doesn't mean—
梁月：……没有。但这并不代表——

Loggerhead: Yes! I told you she'd never do that.
空脑袋：太好了!
我就说吧，菲林士多导演是不会那么做的!

Liang Yue: Hey! She can hear you, you know.
梁月：喂……别那么大声啊!

The situation is already beyond repair.
现在亡羊补牢显然已经晚了。

Noire: I'd never do what?
菲林士多：我不会怎么做?

Liang Yue: ...
梁月：……

For a brief moment, Liáng feels a splitting headache. She shoots a mildly accusatory glance at Loggerhead, causing her to visibly shrink.
有那么一瞬间，梁月产生了一种头疼欲裂的感觉……她忍不住略带责怪地看了身旁的空脑袋一眼，对方明显瑟缩了一下。

Loggerhead: Sorry, I don't like skirting around things.
空脑袋：抱歉……但，我就是不喜欢遮遮掩掩的嘛。

Loggerhead: Can't we just ask her straight up?
空脑袋：有什么事我们不能当面问清楚吗?

Liang Yue: Not really. If every criminal just confessed to their crimes, the Vigiles wouldn't exist.
梁月：如果每个犯人都会把自己干的所有坏事全部老实交代，这个世界上就不需要我们这个职业了。

No clumsy cover-up will fool the director now. There is nothing for it but to be upfront.
但事已至此，梁月不认为蹩脚的掩饰能够将坐在对面的女子糊弄过去，打开天窗说亮话似乎是仅剩的选择了。

Perhaps this is for the best anyway.
而这也许并不是最坏的选择。

Liang Yue: Actually, I didn't just come here to apologize. There's something I want to ask you about.
梁月：……除了向您表示歉意之外，实际上我这一次来找您还有一些其他的目的。

Noire: What is it?
菲林士多：是什么呢?

A perfectly measured balance of curiosity and confusion, yet no real surprise.
恰到好处的疑惑与好奇，却并无意外之色。

A renowned director having a knack for acting isn't exactly shocking. In fact, it's about as surprising as an amateur failing miserably to do the same thing.
一位著名的导演在演技方面颇有造诣，也并不是什么令人意外的事情。
外行人的班门弄斧无法取得预期的成效，也应当在预料之中。

Liang Yue: It's about the strange things happening in Chinatown these days.
梁月：是关于最近唐人街发生的那些怪事。

Assistant: Wait, so all this was just to butter us up so you could investigate your case?
助理：等等……警官小姐。
难道你刻意接近菲林士多导演，实际上还是为了之前那件事?

The assistant, who was all smiles moments ago, suddenly falls silent. Despite her careful preparation, the situation is difficult for Liáng.
方才还对她们有说有笑的助理小姐收起了嘴边的笑意。
尽管早有心理准备，但这并不会让梁月更加好受。

Liang Yue: Sorry, madam, but it's my job.
梁月：请原谅。这是我的工作。

Liang Yue: As I said, strange things have been happening in Chinatown—things that bear a striking resemblance to the "film incident" that you were involved in eight years ago, Ms. Noire.
梁月：正如我此前所说，唐人街一带发生了许多怪事，而这与数年前在菲林士多导演身边发生过的“映像事件”极其相似。

Liang Yue: The case document stated that the origin of these events is a film reel titled Reunion of the Three Swallows—a movie created by your friend, Hé Rìjūn.
梁月：当年的调查显示，引发事件的罪魁祸首是菲林士多导演的好友——编剧何日君生前拍摄的一部暂定名为《三燕归巢》的电影片花。

Liang Yue: Ms. Latham said you watched a film with her in her room a few days ago. Do you have any idea where that film reel is now?
梁月：——而在数日前，您应该和莱瑟姆小姐一起在她的房间观看过一部影片。
您对当时放映的那部胶片的去向有什么头绪吗?

Noire: That film reel?
菲林士多：……你是说当时的那盘胶片？

Liang Yue: Did you not know what it was?
梁月：您不知道？

Noire: I had no idea.
菲林士多：我不知道。

Noire's expression darkens. Clearly, she's realized why Liáng has brought up that film reel.
菲林士多的表情沉了下来。
显然她已经意识到了梁月提起“那盘胶片”的原因。

Noire: That film we watched together ... Well, to put it mildly, it had nothing of interest. It didn't seem to have any semblance of a story, even.
菲林士多：那天晚上我们观看的影片……就算用最委婉的说法，也绝称不上是一部有趣的片花，甚至连“故事”都称不上。

Noire: It couldn't have been one of Teresa's.
菲林士多：那就是泰瑞莎拍摄的东西？绝不可能。

Liáng recalls that the archive on Reunion of the Three Swallows cited "Teresa" as the English name of its creator, Hé Rìjūn.
从记忆中的某个角落，梁月记起《三燕归巢》的档案中曾提到“泰瑞莎”正是其创作者何日君的英文名。

Noire and Hé Rìjūn had been friends since their days studying abroad, and it seems Noire still uses that name even now.
菲林士多与何日君是留学时结识的好友，而听起来菲林士多至今仍在用当时的名字称呼对方。

Rumors, investigation reports, and speculations flicker through Liáng's mind. But seeing the somber look on the woman before her, she decides to set them aside for now.
那些真真假假的传闻与调查报告中未经证实的猜测闪过梁月的脑海……但面前女子愁眉不展的模样，让梁月决定暂时将它们丢到脑后。

Liang Yue: Maybe the original content has been contaminated. According to the Foundation's records, the film reel has two abilities: play and record.
梁月：……也许是它原本的内容遭到了污染。基金会的档案中记载，神秘学管理品《三燕归巢》拥有“放映”与“重摄”两种能力。

Liang Yue: The play ability allows it to conjure its contents into reality in a form similar to a movie image, which accounts for the hallucinations and phantoms the victims mentioned.
梁月：“放映”能力让它能够将胶片中的内容，用类似电影映像般的形式在现实世界中再现，我猜测这正是受害者们提到的“幻觉”“鬼影”的真身。

Liang Yue: The record ability captures the souls of those in the same effective range as play, and the victims lose a part of themselves, like their sanity or their memories.
梁月：在“放映”生效的范围内，受害者会被“重摄”现象捕获，损失一部分神智和记忆。

Liang Yue: The case document doesn't mention anything about contamination, but my guess is that the souls recorded by the film have polluted the original content of the film.
梁月：档案中虽然没有明确记载，但我猜测正是那部分被“重摄”进入胶片的精神能量，干扰了胶片中的原有内容。

Noire: Shame on them—whoever's behind this.
菲林士多：不管到底是谁或是什么东西导致了这一切——真是没品味。

Noire mutters a curse, and both she and Liáng fall into silence. Meanwhile, Lin and Loggerhead look utterly lost.
低声咒骂了一句后，菲林士多和梁月默契地陷入了沉默，但显然一旁的空脑袋和助理小姐却是满头雾水。

Loggerhead: Wait, wait. What are you talking about? Can you explain it to me simply, please?
空脑袋：等一下，等一下……你们在聊什么？知道什么？
你们不要打哑谜呀！

Liang Yue: Ms. Noire didn't know that that film was Reunion of the Three Swallows, so naturally, she didn't take it.
梁月：菲林士多导演并不知道那盘胶片很可能就是《三燕归巢》……
她也并没有将它拿走。

Liang Yue: I think she's telling the truth.
梁月：我想……她说的是真的。

Loggerhead: Really? That's great news.
空脑袋：真的？那这真是个好消息！

No one responds. Loggerhead looks around and slowly lowers the arm she raised in premature celebration.
没有人附和她。空脑袋迟疑地放下了为庆贺而高举的手臂，后知后觉。

Loggerhead: Oh, right. The film's still missing, so it's not great news.
空脑袋：哦，对了，胶片还下落不明，所以这称不上是好消息……

Loggerhead: But, at least, Noire wasn't up to something when she made friends with me, right? That's definitely good news for me.
空脑袋：但至少菲林士多导演接近我并不是别有目的之类的，对吧?
对我来说，这就是好消息了。

She turns to Noire.
她看向菲林士多。

Loggerhead: That means we're still friends. And friends help each other. Liáng said that the film reel could cause some problems for you. Let me help you find it.
空脑袋：这意味着我们还是朋友！是朋友就可以互帮互助。
我听梁说，那盘胶片可能会对你造成威胁，那么也许我们可以一起去寻找它。

Loggerhead: I'll catch that thief and take the film back to the ACD.
空脑袋：等找到后，我们就将它送回神秘学藏品管理部去，顺便再抓住那个偷偷将胶片从神秘学藏品管理部偷出来的坏蛋。

Loggerhead: Then you'll be safe, I'll clear my name, and the problems in Chinatown will be solved. That's three birds with one stone. Genius, right?
空脑袋：这样你也可以放心，我也可以洗清嫌疑，唐人街的麻烦也解决了……一举三得！怎么样，是不是个好主意?

Noire: You know, Ms. Latham, this is what I like about you. You always speak your mind.
菲林士多：……你知道吗，莱瑟姆小姐?
这就是我最喜欢你的一点。

Her eyes squint a little as she curves her mouth into an unexpectedly gentle smile.
菲林士多眯起眼睛笑了笑，没有给予空脑袋肯定的答复，但嘴角的弧度却十分柔和。

Noire: Our relationships are so complex, aren't they? That's what makes them so intriguing, captivating, really. A constant source of inspiration.
菲林士多：人与人之间的事总是很复杂，这让它们足够有趣，总能够为我提供源源不断的素材和灵感，令我着迷。

Noire: But sometimes I feel that life is better kept simple. Wouldn't you agree, Ms. Vigil?
菲林士多：但有的时候……我也会想，也许简单些更好。
你觉得呢，执夜人小姐?

Liang Yue: Agreed.
梁月：……我也有同感。

There are certainly simpler ways to say "I'm suspicious of you" and "I have no intention of cooperating."
“我怀疑你”和“我并不打算与你们合作”的确都各自拥有更加简单的表达方式。

Liang Yue: May I ask you another question?
梁月：……我还能再问您一个问题吗?

Noire: Please.
菲林士多：请。

Liang Yue: The rumors about C07, which ones are true?
梁月：关于 C07 的那些传闻……它们哪些是真的，哪些是假的?

Noire: I don't think a few old stories will help you solve the case.
菲林士多：我并不认为这些陈年旧事，是破获你手头的案件所必须的。

Liang Yue: It's not only for the case, but for my own curiosity.
梁月：……不仅仅是为了调查案件，也因为我想要知道。

Liang Yue: I wasn't lying when I said I was familiar with your works. I really like them.
梁月：我之前说我很熟悉您的作品……也很喜欢它们，那并不是在说谎。

Liang Yue: And this question matters a lot to me as a fan.
梁月：作为一个曾经的观众，这些事情的真伪对我而言很重要。

Noire: Oh. I see.
菲林士多：……原来是这样。

Noire ponders for a moment.
菲林士多迟疑了片刻。

Noire: In that case, I really don't think you should know the truth, for your own good.
菲林士多：那么我想你还是不知道为好。

Noire: I appreciate your love for my works, but it's not a good idea to dig too deep into what went on behind the scenes.
菲林士多：我很感谢你对我们的电影的喜爱，但……也许过于接近银幕后的人并不是一个好主意。

Noire: Just enjoy the stories for what they are. Otherwise, the magic will be ruined.
菲林士多：只享受故事，才不至于消磨了乐趣。

She gives a slight shake of her head, but a flicker of contemplation passes through her downcast eyes.
她轻微摇了摇头，垂下的眼眸中却闪过几分思索。

Noire: Well, I can tell you one thing that might interest you, though.
菲林士多：不过作为补偿，也许我可以提供另一条你应当会感兴趣的消息。

捕鼠器
Mousetrap SC-12

Night has deepened, and the little restaurant on the corner outside of Chinatown is almost empty. The doorbell chimes, and two people walk in.
夜色渐浓，唐人街外转角处的餐厅中，顾客已寥寥无几。
但此时店门拴着的铃声响起，又有二人推门而入。

Loggerhead: Scott, and Tall Officer, over here.
空脑袋： 斯考特！还有……高个子警官，这边！

Poitier: Again, it's Poitier. Have you seriously already forgotten my name? It's only been three hours.
波蒂埃： 是波蒂埃。
只过去了三个小时，你就已经忘记了吗?

At Loggerhead's call, the two newcomers take a seat at her and Liáng's table.
在空脑袋的招呼下，新进门的那两人来到梁月与空脑袋的这一席上落座。

Liang Yue: What's your status?
梁月： 怎么样?

Scott: Couldn't find anything useful. Sorry.
斯考特： 抱歉……我这边没有什么收获。

Scott: I already asked the investigators who came with me to track down the other missing items, you know, to cover up for Loggerhead, but so far, they haven't found anything.
斯考特： 为了不暴露空脑袋的事，我打发一起跟来的职员去追查其他神秘学管理品的线索了，但除了那件“发条玩具”之外，另外几件至今都下落不明。

Scott: As for the person who stole the item, I haven't a clue.
斯考特： 至于真正将这些神秘学管理品从神秘学藏品管理部流出的犯人……更是毫无头绪。

Loggerhead: Well ...
空脑袋： 是吗……

Loggerhead: At least there haven't been any reports of arcane explosions or earthquakes. No news is good news, right?
空脑袋： 不过也许没有消息就是最好的消息，至少其他那些丢失的神秘学管理品还没有把哪座城市炸出一个大洞来之类的。

Poitier: What about you? Any leads?
波蒂埃： 你们怎么样?

Liang Yue: Ms. Noire didn't take the film, but she refused to tell us anything about its curse or the former owner, Hé Rìjūn.
梁月： 菲林士多并没有拿走胶片。但她拒绝向我们透露更多有关那张“被诅咒的胶片”《三燕归巢》和它的创作者何日君的事。

She lets out a deliberately dejected sigh, withholding the final message Noire gave her.
她故作低落地叹了一口气，并未说出菲林士多最后附赠的那条消息。

Poitier: Looks like I'm the only one who has good news.
波蒂埃： 那看起来只有我这边有好消息了。

Liang Yue: You do? What about?
梁月： 真的？……哪一边?

Poitier tilts her head, gesturing past Scott to the darkened street outside the window.
波蒂埃扬了扬下巴，越过桌对面的斯考特，指向窗外漆黑的街道。

Poitier: The illegal trade of arcane items. You told me to keep an eye on it.
波蒂埃：你让我关注的神秘学物品非法交易这条线。

Poitier: I contacted my guy who tracks all that stuff. Told me about this trader called Pug Dog, a middleman in the black market.
波蒂埃：我联系了科里负责这方面的家伙，他告诉我说一个绰号叫“癞皮狗”的黑市中间人行迹古怪。

Poitier: He was pulled over for speeding this morning, but he actually paid the ticket right away. Can you believe that? I wouldn't be surprised if he shot the police car and ran away there.
波蒂埃：早上那家伙因为超速被拦下来了，但他居然老老实实地交了罚单——放在平时，那可是会当街开枪的主。

Liang Yue: An outlaw suddenly behaving himself ...
梁月：一个无法无天的犯罪分子忽然表现得很老实?

Liang Yue: He must be up to something important. Something big enough to make him avoid getting into trouble over a speeding ticket.
梁月：这代表……他很可能有些更重要的“预定”，所以不能让那些“小麻烦”阻碍了计划。

Poitier: The officers thought the same, so they tracked him to this stolen car, right? Well, guess where it's headed—here, Chinatown.
波蒂埃：我们的人也这么想，于是就标记了那个家伙，结果发现就在刚才，他开了一辆报告为失窃车辆的雪佛兰到了这里——唐人街。

Pug Dog: ...
癞皮狗：……

A man with a deep, jagged scar across his brow saunters under the moonlight.
眉间一道狰狞疤痕的男人踏过皎洁的月光，最终在钻入一条漆黑的小巷后停下了脚步。

At last, he stops, slipping into a darkened alleyway. He has no idea that four silent pursuers are lurking nearby, hidden under a rookie vigil's Silent Shadow arcane skill.
——他并没有发现缀在自己身后、藏身在见习执夜人施展的“静谧无声”神秘术下的四条小尾巴。

Loggerhead: What's he doing?
空脑袋：他要做什么?

Poitier: Waiting for someone's my guess.
波蒂埃：看起来是在等待什么人。

Scott: A middleman for the arcane black market. So, he probably has the cursed film, and now he's planning to sell it to someone.
斯考特：一个从事非法神秘学物品交易的黑市中间人……意思是那张“被诅咒的胶片”很可能在他的手上，而他正要和什么人做交易?

Scott: We should get him now, before the film's sold off. Come on, this is our chance.
斯考特：我们应该立即抓住他，防止东西再次丢失！这是唯一的机会了——

Scott: Hm? Mmm.
斯考特：唔……唔?!

Liáng clamps a hand over her mouth just in time, muffling her outburst.
好在敏锐的少女及时堵住了她的嘴巴，让声音再透不出半点儿。

Liang Yue: Shh. Someone's coming.
梁月：嘘！别动，有什么人来了。

From the depths of the shadows, a figure emerges.
从更加浓重的黑暗之中逐渐浮现出一个身影。

Not walking toward Pug Dog, but riding something. Perhaps—a wheelchair.
她并非向癞皮狗走去，而是乘着什么东西，例如——轮椅。

Noire: Good evening, sir. I hope I didn't keep you too long.
菲林士多：晚上好，尊敬的先生。
我希望您没有等待太久。

Pug Dog: You got the dough?
癞皮狗：钱带来了吗?

Noire: Of course.
菲林士多：当然。

Noire pulls a rectangular object from her coat.
菲林士多从怀里掏出一件长方形的物品。

Poitier: It's an envelope. Looks pretty thick.
波蒂埃：是个信封……看着可不薄。

Poitier is right. Pug Dog takes the envelope and pulls a handful of bills from it before nodding in satisfaction.
波蒂埃所言无误，因为癞皮狗接过信封后数清了钱，满意地点了点头。

Pug Dog: All here. Dontcha worry, alright? You can trust me. Everyone in L.A. knows Pug Dog.
癞皮狗：数量没错。
不用担心，我癞皮狗的信誉放眼全城都是有口皆碑的。

He stuffs the bulging envelope into his pocket before pulling an item from his jacket.
癞皮狗将那一个鼓鼓囊囊的信封放进口袋，转而从夹克的内袋中取出了另一个物件。

Pug Dog: Here's your stuff.
癞皮狗：你的东西在这里。

The item cuts an arc through the darkness, landing precisely in Noire's waiting hands.
那东西在黑暗中划过一道并不明晰的弧线，被菲林士多准确无误地接住。

Pug Dog: Heh. I like customers like you, generous and to the point. Alright, I'm outta here. Pleasure doin' business with ya. And hey, feel free to call me again.
癞皮狗：行了，交易已经完成，那我就撤了。
您出手阔绰，人也爽快，是那种我还会愿意再合作的客户。

He scans the area before turning back to Noire, lowering his voice.
他四下望了望，随后再次望向菲林士多，压低了声音。

Pug Dog: Seein' as you're a good customer o' mine, here's a bit of advice: Watch your back on the way outta here.
癞皮狗：看在这个份上……我给您个忠告，回去的时候您最好注意些。

Noire: What do you mean?
菲林士多：您这是什么意思——

But Noire doesn't get the chance to press further.
癞皮狗话语中暗含的警示之意让菲林士多不由得追问，但她的话并没能说完。

The moment has come. Liáng strides out from the shadows.
时机已到，从暗处大步走出的梁月打断了这场见不得光的谈话。

Liang Yue: Sorry to interrupt, but neither one of you will be making your own way home. Ms. Noire, Pug Dog.
梁月：请原谅我冒昧打断你们的谈话，但——我想不论是菲林士多导演还是这位先生，都暂时不需要考虑“回去”的问题了。

Liang Yue: I'm afraid you'll be coming to the Arcane Affairs office with me.
梁月： 因为我恐怕二位需要跟我们一起去神秘学犯罪科走一趟。

Pug Dog: F**kin' cop!
癞皮狗： 该死，是条子！

Pug Dog: Ow! Easy, easy.
癞皮狗： 疼疼疼！轻一点！

Poitier: Shut up and stay down!
波蒂埃： 别废话，老实点！

Pug Dog's attempts to fight back have been utterly useless.
尽管癞皮狗意欲反抗，但不消片刻便被按在了地上。

Liang Yue: Ms. Noire, could you show me what he gave you?
梁月： ……菲林士多导演，我能请您让我看看他交给您的那件东西吗?

Noire: Go ahead.
菲林士多： 请。

She hands a dusty gray box to Liáng.
那只灰扑扑的小盒子被递到了梁月的面前。

Inside is an ordinary-looking film reel. But Liáng can feel the vessel containing Qiángliáng growing warm against her skin.
盒子中装的是一盘看似平平无奇的胶片，但梁月却意识到怀中寄宿着险道兽强梁的祭器在隐隐发烫。

Liang Yue: Super 8 mm. This must be it. Reunion of the Three Swallows. Hé Rìjūn's final work.
梁月： ……我想就是它。尺寸也没有错，超 8 毫米。
这就是编剧何日君的遗作，“被诅咒的胶片”《三燕归巢》。

Liang Yue: The culprit behind the strange happenings in Chinatown.
梁月： 也是唐人街一系列怪事的罪魁祸首。

Yet for now, it lies quietly in her grasp, docile and unthreatening.
但此时它却只是安静地躺在梁月的手中，乖顺而无害。

Poitier: Well, that was easier than expected. Half a day, and we've already tracked it down.
波蒂埃： 很好，虽然多了许多波折，但事情的进展比我想象中的要顺利很多嘛！
我们只花了一天，就找到了罪魁祸首。

Poitier: Now all we gotta do is stop it from doing its arcanum-y thing. But how? Smash it?
波蒂埃： 接下来就只剩下让这盘胶片收起它的神通了。
要怎么做？例如……把它掰了？

Before Liáng can respond, Noire voices a polite opposition.
在梁月回复之前，有人率先对这个提案表示了委婉的反对。

Noire: I don't think that's a good idea.
菲林士多： 我并不认为这是最好的办法。

Liang Yue: I have to admit, Ms. Noire's right.
梁月： 关于这一点，必须承认菲林士多导演说的是对的。

Liang Yue: Arcane items need to be handled with the utmost care. No one knows what will happen once it's broken. We could make things worse.
梁月： 面对危险神秘学管理品，应当更加谨慎地处理，目前谁也不知道如果破坏它，是会让事情好转……还是恶化。

Poitier: Fine. Let's take these two back to the office first.
波蒂埃： 好吧……看来我们只能带着这张胶片回去从长计议了。

Poitier: On your feet, tough guy! We gotta go.
波蒂埃：站起来吧老兄！我们该走了。

Pug Dog: Ugh. Damn it. How'd ya find me? Some asshole sell me out?
癞皮狗：呃……该死，事情是怎么暴露的？难道是哪个混球告了密？

Pug Dog is yanked up from the ground. He reluctantly follows Poitier, grumbling and cursing under his breath.
癞皮狗从地上被波蒂埃一把拽了起来，他一边骂骂咧咧，一边不情愿地向外走去。

But as he passes Liáng, he stops.
——但在走过梁月的时候，他忽然停住了脚步。

Pug Dog: Wait. You!
癞皮狗：等等……你?

He stares.
他用充满不可思议的眼神瞪向梁月——不。

Not at her, precisely, but at the figure cowering behind her.
准确来说，他瞪着的是梁月身后的那个躲躲闪闪的身影。

Pug Dog: It was you! You f**kin' traitor! I shoulda known you were workin' with the cops.
癞皮狗：——是你，是你！该死的，是你出卖了我！
原来你和警察原本就是一伙儿的！

Loggerhead tilts her head in confusion.
空脑袋疑惑地看向那个人。

Loggerhead: Huh? What are you talking about?
空脑袋：……嗯？你这话是什么意思?

Scott: Uh, wait, let me explain. This is just a misunderstanding.
斯考特：呃……不，听我解释，这是个误会……

Liang Yue: Don't worry, Ms. Scott. You're right. There has been a misunderstanding between you and him. Allow me to explain.
梁月：请不要担心，斯考特小姐。
这位先生的确误会了，我会向大家解释的。

Scott heaves a sigh of relief, only for Liáng's next words to hit her like a thunderclap.
斯考特闻言刚松了一口气，但梁月的下一句话却直接让她如遭雷殛，呆立在了原地。

Liang Yue: You never had the intention of betraying him, nor were you working with us.
梁月：你的确并没有出卖这位先生的意思，也并没有与我们合谋。

Liang Yue: You simply gave him the item you wanted to sell. That's it.
梁月：你只是诚实地将要出售的物品交给了他——仅此而已。

A 计划外 · 1/2
A Project Gone Awry · 1/2 SC-13

Loggerhead: What? What do you mean?
空脑袋：我……不明白。

Loggerhead turns to her friend, then to Pug Dog, then back to Liáng. She remains totally expressionless.
空脑袋看向自己的好友，又看向义愤填膺的黑市中间人，最后茫然地望向眼前面色平静的梁月。

Liang Yue: The truth was always there—hidden beneath the lies and distractions. All you have to do is whittle them down, one by one.
梁月：谜底其实并不复杂，虽然我们遭遇了许多干扰项……但只要排除它们，就不难看清真相。

Liang Yue: The probable cause of the events in Chinatown is the Reunion of the Three Swallows film reel, and apparently, Ms. Noire has a history with it.
梁月：导致唐人街怪事频发的直接原因是神秘学管理品《三燕归巢》，它的确和菲林士多导演有着极深的渊源……

And yet, the specifics of this history remain unclear. Liáng glances at Noire, only to be met with her signature unreadable smile.
而这份“渊源”的具体情况暂时还并不明晰。
梁月向菲林士多的方向看了一眼，只得到了一张菲林士多招牌式的笑脸。

Liang Yue: But Ms. Noire doesn't have anything to do with the Foundation. There's no way she could sneak into the ACD and steal the film. The same goes for this gentleman or any other outsider.
梁月：……但无论如何，菲林士多导演和基金会并没有什么关系，她绝不可能自己潜入基金会盗出《三燕归巢》，这位先生或是其他人也是一样。

Liang Yue: So, the thief who wants Ms. Latham to take the fall must work for the Foundation.
梁月：将《三燕归巢》等神秘学管理品盗出，并嫁祸给莱瑟姆小姐的一定是基金会的内部人士。

Liang Yue: In fact, since they stole the item without being noticed, they probably work for the ACD.
梁月：这一人物很可能是神秘学藏品管理部的人，这样才能够不为人知地盗出藏品。

Liang Yue: And they must be close to Ms. Latham to know enough about her amnesia to be able to take advantage of it.
梁月：这一人物也必定是莱瑟姆小姐身边的人，这样才会知道莱瑟姆小姐特殊的“健忘症”体质，将她选为自己的替罪羊。

Loggerhead: But loads of people at the ACD know about my condition. You can't pin it on Scott just from that.
空脑袋：——但神秘学藏品管理部有很多人，知道我情况的人也有很多，不能这样就断定是斯考特呀！

For the first time, the ever-cheerful Loggerhead takes on a harsh, indignant tone.
这个始终一副傻乎乎好脾气模样的意识唤醒者，第一次采用了强硬的语气与激烈的言辞。

She stamps her foot and turns to her friend.
她气愤地说完后，望向自己的好友。

Loggerhead: That's way too harsh, right, Scott? Right?
空脑袋：对不对，斯考特？这样说你也太过分了，也说点什么呀！

Loggerhead: Scott? Say something, will you?
空脑袋：……斯考特？你为什么不说话？

Scott: ...
斯考特：……

Scott only stares at the floor as she tries to calm her quivering breath.
她的好友低着头，没有回答这名茫然的意识唤醒者。

Scott: How long have you known?
斯考特：……你是什么时候发现的?

Scott has finally managed to force out a few words.
斯考特终于挤出了她的第一句话。

Liang Yue: Since Ms. Latham said you were good friends. With all due respect, your plan was far from perfect.
梁月：从莱瑟姆小姐告诉我你们是很好的朋友时。
恕我直言，您的计划有许多漏洞。

Scott: Ugh, I knew it. You brought me along so this guy would call me out.
斯考特：……唉，我就知道。
你们把我拉到这里，其实就是想让这个男人指认我。

After a long sigh, Scott lifts her head, speaking with a resigned kind of ease.
长叹一声后，斯考特抬起了头，语气中带着一种自暴自弃般的舒畅。

Scott: You're right. I messed up. My plan was far from perfect because, well, I couldn't stick to the so-called plan since the very beginning.
斯考特：你说得对，我搞砸了。你说我的计划有很多漏洞……那是当然的，因为所谓的“计划”从一开始就被打乱了。

Scott: I didn't know the Foundation was already investigating the theft until after I'd hidden the items in Loggerhead's room.
斯考特：我把东西藏在空脑袋那里后，才得到基金会已经发现了我所作所为、开始调查的消息。

Scott: Then I had no choice but to use this idiot as the scapegoat. I never thought she'd accidentally bring the film to L.A., or that I'd be ordered to investigate the case.
斯考特：我只好故意把嫌疑引向这个笨蛋，但没想到那盘胶片居然被她不小心装进了行李里，带来了洛杉矶……而我居然被委派成了追查这件事的人。

Scott: I got in touch with this guy a long time ago, and the trade site happened to be in L.A. too. So, my plan was to get the film back and sell it right afterwards.
斯考特：我早就联系好了这个中间人，交易的地点正好是洛杉矶，我想这也许是个机会，能够让我按照原计划把胶片出手……

Scott: But things didn't go as smoothly as I thought. I shouldn't have gotten greedy, or been so nice to this dummy.
斯考特：但现在看来，正是这份贪婪……和对这个笨蛋的优柔寡断，导致了节外生枝。

She shoots a piercing glare at Loggerhead before quickly looking away—whether out of disdain or avoidance is unclear.
她剐了空脑袋一眼，但很快移开了目光，像是不屑，又像是躲闪。

Loggerhead: But, but ...
空脑袋：可是……可是……

Loggerhead: We're friends, aren't we?
空脑袋：我们不是朋友吗?

Her voice is as fragile as brittle glass. Scott shatters it with a scoff.
她的声音很轻，就像是易碎的玻璃。
但斯考特冷哼一声，毫不犹豫地将它摔了个稀巴烂。

Scott: Friends? Don't be ridiculous. I don't know how you can act like nothing's wrong when literally everyone is laughing at you. And the fact that they thought that I was one of your kind.
斯考特：谁和你是朋友？整天被人调侃，你居然还笑呵呵的……当我和你走在一起的时候，所有人都觉得我们是一个档次的！

Scott: Ugh! What an insult! I only hung out with you because ... because I had no choice.
斯考特：这简直是侮辱！
我和你来往只是因为……只是因为没有其他的选择而已！

Scott: You're an idiot who forgets everything every three days. It's your own damn fault. Anyone looking for a scapegoat would immediately think of you.
斯考特：一个记忆只能够维持三天的健忘笨蛋……这不怪我，任何人如果想要做些坏事，并且需要一个替罪羊的时候，毫无疑问都会第一时间想到你。

Poitier: Quit it! I don't wanna hear any more of your BS.
波蒂埃：嘿，闭上你的嘴，少说那些混账话！

Scott scoffs once more, refusing to look at her "friend" for even a second.
在波蒂埃的呵斥下，斯考特冷哼一声，不再分给一旁呆若木鸡的“好友”分毫目光。

Liang Yue: Hands up, Ms. Scott. Anything you say can and will be used against you in a court of law.
梁月：伸出手来吧，斯考特小姐。
您方才所说的所有话，都将成为呈堂供词。

Liang Yue: Wait, you're still going to fight?
梁月：还是说——您打算负隅顽抗?

必胜法
Calculated Maneuver 小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.
???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
2. 我要前进到未来

分支 1 / Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.
???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...
???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……

分支 2 / Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.
???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—
???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.
???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。

选项 / Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.
1. 好了，开始胡扯吧

2. No. I'm tired of you.
2. 不，我已经厌倦你了

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.
???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.
???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

A Vigile's Correspondence
某执夜人的折纸信

英文 / ENGLISH

This letter was tucked inside a folder of interrogation records, it appears to have been exchanged silently between two Vigiles agents during an interrogation. The two distinct handwritings reflect their unspoken dialogue:

"She's tight-lipped about it."

"But she seems unaware that we've already figured out everything."

"Fascinating, like a mouse in a lab experiment—arrogant yet clueless."

"There's still one thing left to figure out: how exactly did she learn to crack the anti-theft arcane seal?"

"All her lies and disguises fall apart under scrutiny, but she hasn't given up a single clue about this. Even our artificial somnambulism couldn't uncover anything ..."

"Could it just be sheer dumb luck?"

"Disappointing. I've taught you better—never rely on million-to-one coincidences. Always consider the more plausible scenario."

"You mean ... she's being controlled by someone else? And they've erased her memory, so she can't betray them?"

"Exactly. That slippery merchant gave up Scott, but there's no way a minor employee could pull off something like this. Rejoice, we've hooked a big fish."

"So ... we're letting her go?"

"Yes, but not without loosening her strings first."

"Understood. I'll notify Mr. Pedra. I trust he'll ensure Miss Scott feels completely at ease after some ... subtle adjustments."

"Good. You're a reliable assistant, Billy."

The second writer seemed about to reply but left only a hesitant pen stroke.

中文 / CHINESE

这封信被夹在了审问记录的文件夹中，显然这次对话发生在两名执夜人的审讯期间，上面的两种笔迹记录了两人间无声的对话。

“她嘴还挺硬的。”

“但是她似乎并不知道她的一切都被我们摸清楚了。”

“真有趣，就像是在实验箱里的老鼠一样，自以为是却又毫不自知。”

“可我们还是没能弄清那剩余的唯一一个疑点——她究竟是从哪里知道破解防盗术式的方法的?”

“她那自以为天衣无缝的狡辩和伪装都漏洞百出，可唯独在这一点上没有透露出半分信息，就连我们的人工梦游都未能探出其中究竟……”

“难道真是瞎猫碰上了死耗子?”

“这可真让人失望。我教过你，比起无能地寄希望于那些几率只有百万分之一的巧合，我们总是应当考虑可能性更高的情况。”

“您是说……她是被什么人所操控的？而她甚至被对方拿掉了这段记忆，所以才绝不会将幕后人供出。”

“当然。那个狡猾的商人供出了斯考特，但一个小小的员工可不会有那么大的能耐。欢呼吧，我们有一条大鱼要钓了。”

“您是说要将她放回去?”

“没错，但是也不能就这么放了，我们还得帮助她松松弦。”

“明白。我会去通知佩德拉先生那边，我相信他会以一些小小的运作就让我们的斯考特小姐彻底放下她那颗紧张的心。”

“有劳。你真是我的好帮手，比利。”

另一个笔迹的主人似乎还想要回复些什么，但最终只留下了一道欲言又止的笔画。

A 计划外 · 2/2
A Project Gone Awry · 2/2 SC-13

At last, Scott gives up her resistance. Liáng pushes her toward Poitier's patrol car parked around the corner.
年轻的基金会职员最终放弃了反抗，梁月推着她向波蒂埃停靠在唐人街外的警车走去。

As they're about to step out of the alley, Loggerhead calls out.
就在她们即将踏出小巷时，空脑袋喊住了她们。

Loggerhead: Wait. Scott!
空脑袋：等等，斯考特！

Loggerhead: I have to know, why did you steal from the Foundation?
空脑袋：告诉我……你为什么要这么做？为什么要偷走基金会的东西？

Scott: Does it matter?
斯考特：事到如今你问这个做什么？

Scott turns back, laughing coldly in disbelief.
斯考特回过头，诧异地冷笑了一声。

Scott: Would you feel better if I had a reason? Oh, please! Your ignorant, stupid little brain makes me sick.
斯考特：难道如果我有什么苦衷，会让你更好受一些？
歇一歇吧，最让我讨厌的就是你那颗天真的傻脑瓜子。

Scott: It was for the money, of course. And to prove to the others that I'm not a bloody fool like you.
斯考特：当然是为了钱，也是为了证明给那些小看我的人看，让他们知道我决不是个一事无成的废物。

Scott: Imagine the shock on their faces when they discover that I did what none of them could. Those so-called unbreakable arcane security skills were easy to deal with as long as I ...
斯考特：我会做到他们都做不到的事，让他们大吃一惊。
那些号称万无一失的防盗术式根本不堪一击，只要——

Scott: I ...
斯考特：只要……？

Her words trail off, and a puzzled expression crosses her face.
她的话说到一半就止住了。斯考特的脸上逐渐浮现出疑惑的神情。

Liang Yue: You what? How did you bypass the Foundation's security?
梁月：只要怎样？你是怎么骗过基金会和神秘学藏品管理部的防盗术式的？

Scott: I don't remember. That's weird. How could I forget? All I remember is that an office lady talked to me in the corridor.
斯考特：我……不记得了。奇怪，怎么会这样？
我只记得在走廊，有个女职员和我搭话……

Liang Yue: An office lady? When? What did you talk about?
梁月：一个女职员？
那是什么时候的事，她和你说了什么？

Scott: She ... She showed me something. It was a bit dazzling, but very beautiful. It was ...
斯考特：她……她拿出了一个东西给我看。
有些晃眼，但很漂亮，那是……

Scott: Oh, oh, right. It was a ...
斯考特：对了……对了！
那是一颗——

A razor-sharp silver needle slices through the air, cutting her off in an instant.
尖细而锐利的银色丝线切割了空气，斯考特的话语戛然而止。

Scott: Ahhhh—?
斯考特：咕、呃……?

She raises a dazed hand, her fingertips touching the foreign object lodged in her throat, not understanding why her voice has suddenly vanished.
她茫然地抬起手，触碰扎入自己脖颈中的异物，不明白自己为何突然失去了声音。

By the time she's realized she can no longer breathe, her eyes roll back, and she falls to the ground.
当意识到自己呼吸的能力也同样被剥夺时，她已经栽倒在了地上。

Silence falls in the starlit alley. Then, another flash of silver whistles by.
皎月隐去了踪迹，只剩下聊胜于无的点点星光洒落在小巷之中，一切在转眼间归于了寂静，只有一个声音异常刺耳。

Liang Yue: What?
梁月：……什么?

A sharp pain blooms in her palm. She looks down to see a sharp silver needle pierced in it. The film slips from her grasp.
手掌处传来抽痛，梁月这才意识到有和刺入斯考特咽喉中相似的东西，刺入了自己的掌心，令胶片从她的手中滑落。

The reel rolls across the ground, clicking as it hurtles into the darkness, until a gloved hand picks it up and brushes it off.
塑料制的片盘碾过冰冷坚硬的地面，伴随着咔哒咔哒的声响滚向黑暗的深处。直到一只带着皮质手套的手将它捡了起来，轻柔地拂去上面的尘土。

???: Phew! Still intact. You've got no idea how long I've been looking for this.
???: 真是的，幸亏没有摔坏，不然可就麻烦了。

Liang Yue: You're ...
梁月：你……是……

Qi Xing: Hey there, kid. We meet again.
奇星：你好，警探小姐，我们又见面了。

The once-famous star smiles at Liáng with an easy, friendly charm.
那位曾经名噪一时的明星女演员，向梁月露出了一个明快而富有亲和力的笑容。

Loggerhead: Scott! Scott!
空脑袋：斯考特……斯考特!

Pug Dog: No f**king way. She dead?
癞皮狗：我的天哪，她是死了吗?

Poitier: Not yet, but I doubt she can hold on much longer. I'll call an ambulance, and we're gonna need backup.
波蒂埃：还活着，但……过一会儿就不一定了!
我这就呼叫救护车和增援!

Liang Yue: ...
梁月：……

Loggerhead's scream, Pug Dog's cry, and Poitier's tense voice all ring in Liáng's mind.
空脑袋的尖叫、癞皮狗的惊呼，以及波蒂埃紧张的声音钻进梁月的脑海中，激起了少许涟漪。

Liáng's rationality has already grasped the reality of the situation, but her emotions are refusing to let her shape the conclusion into clear words.
梁月理性的那一侧已经察觉到了眼下情形所代表的真相，感性的一面却在阻挠她将自己的结论整理成有条理的语言。

Liang Yue: Why are you doing this?
梁月：……为什么你要做这种事?

When Loggerhead posed a similar question to Scott, Liáng had questioned the inquiry.
就在方才，空脑袋曾经对斯考特发出过类似的质问。
当时的梁月曾在心底质疑过这个问题的意义。

There is no need to ask why evil chooses to do evil. What's wrong is wrong. Evil must be eradicated. Ghost plagues must be purged. That was the doctrine drilled into Liáng since childhood.
无需追问恶人为恶的理由，错了就是错了。邪恶需要被消灭，鬼疫需要被驱逐，仅此而已——这就是梁月自小接受的教诲。

But now, she finds herself forced to ask the same thing.
但现在她却无法不做出同样的事。

Liang Yue: Tell me. I need a reason.
梁月：告诉我。我需要知道原因。

Qi Xing: It's my old friend that you should be asking.
奇星：……这就要问我的这位老朋友了。

Liáng watches as Qí Xīng's smile fades and her face turns steely.
梁月看着奇星敛去笑容，用和望向自己时截然不同的冰冷目光看向一旁。

Qi Xing: Long time no see, Noire.
奇星：——好久不见，菲林士多导演。

Noire: Yeah, it's been a while.
菲林士多：……是呀，的确很久了。

Noire: The last time we saw each other was in front of her grave, if memory serves? We really should keep in touch more often.
菲林士多：上次见面还是在她墓前的那回吧?
我们应该多联系的。

The air in the alley is sharp as a needle. Noire continues to smile, but a wariness lurks behind her eyes.
小巷中的空气如针刺般扎人。
菲林士多面色如常地笑着，眼底却带着戒备。

Noire: But you've gone too far this time, my friend.
菲林士多：不过，你这就做得有些过分了。

She glances at Scott's fallen body and gently shakes her head.
她看向倒地的斯考特，微微摇了摇头。

Noire: This isn't part of our story.
菲林士多：我可不记得有排这么一场戏。

Qi Xing: This isn't a set, director. It's not your call.
奇星：不是什么事情都要按照你的安排来的，导演。

She raises a hand, and a flash of silver pierces through the darkness.
奇星的话音未落，梁月便看到她抬起了手。
银光如闪电般刺破黑暗——

Liang Yue: Careful!
梁月： 小心——！

She leaps forward, deflects the needles, and stands firm in front of the wheelchair.
少女挡开银针，岿然站在轮椅面前。

Qí Xīng shows no surprise. She narrows her eyes a little, as if she foresaw this outcome.
而奇星并不诧异。她微眯着眼睛，就像早已料到一切。

Qi Xing: That's the spirit. This should be fun with you here, little vigil.
奇星： 是的，就得这样才行。
执夜人小姐，很高兴在这里遇到您。

Qi Xing: Let's all play our roles, shall we?
奇星： 这一次，就让我们饰演好彼此的角色吧。

荧屏正发光
Lit Screen, Lit Eyes SC-14

Poitier: The hell?! I thought movie stars were just empty suits.
波蒂埃： 该死！这是电影演员该有的水平吗?!

Another volley of silver needles streaks through the air, forcing Liáng and Poitier back.
银色的锐利光雨再次斥退了梁月与波蒂埃二人的攻击。

Qí Xīng stands at the center of the alley. Though seemingly trapped between Liáng and Poitier, she skillfully uses their positioning to her advantage.
奇星占据了小巷中间的位置，看似置身在梁月和波蒂埃的前后夹击之中，实则利用二人一前一后的位置关系进行牵制。

Neither officer can risk injuring the other by firing their gun or using an arcane skill, leaving the battle at a deadlock.
两名执法者难以顶着误伤同伴的风险开枪或是使用高杀伤力的神秘术攻击，战局僵持不下，几次都险些让奇星抓住破绽脱身。

Liang Yue: We're not going to last much longer. I have to do something. Poitier, cover me.
梁月： 这样下去等不到支援到达了……波蒂埃教官，请掩护我！

Liang Yue: Arise Qiángliáng, swift and fierce!
梁月： ——强梁既出，罔有不韪。

With the ritual vessel of Qiángliáng in her hand, Liáng recites the ancient incantation, each syllable clear and deliberate.
险道兽强梁的祭器出现在了梁月的手上，古老的咒语被一字一顿地念出。

Qi Xing: ...!
奇星： !

Qí Xīng looks momentarily stunned.
她看到那个人猛地转向了自己的方向，抬起了手。

This is the beginning of an incantation. Liáng knows that more silver needles could come flying at her at any moment.
——那是神秘术的起手式，梁月知道那些锐利的银光即将飞射而来。

Liang Yue: Banish all evil ...
梁月： ……斩杀凶咎——

For a brief moment, hesitation creeps over her.
有一瞬间，她的心中产生了动摇。

As a child, she sat before the screen and watched this figure over and over again, her eyes filled with admiration. She had mimicked her arcane skill countless times.
她曾经在儿时一遍又一遍地用憧憬的目光看着荧幕中那潇洒的身影，也曾不知道多少次模仿过电影中那分外飒爽的神秘术技巧。

But she never imagined that, one day, those dazzling silver needles would be aimed at her.
但她从来没有想到过有一天那些耀眼的银光会刺向自己。

Liang Yue: ... and cleanse this place!
梁月：枭截不祥！

Yet, she still speaks the final words of the incantation.
——但梁月还是念出了最后几个字。

With these words, an ancient contract will be upheld, and the Xiǎndào Beast will be called upon to devour all evil. As is her right as a descendant of the Liáng family.
随着最后的话音落下，文字将唤醒古老的契约，险道兽将应召前来。
它将为梁氏后人所驱役，吞食世间诸般邪祟。

At least, that's what's supposed to happen.
——本该是这样的。

Liang Yue: What?
梁月：咦……？

But the alley remains as empty as it was before.
身旁仍一片空荡。

Qi Xing: Hey!
奇星：……！喂！

Poitier: Rookie, watch out!
波蒂埃：菜鸟，快躲开啊！

Someone pushes her aside. She hits the ground hard. A flash of silver. The sound of shouting.
有人推开了她。她重重地摔在地上。
紧随其后的是冲击。映入眼帘的是银光。钻入耳中的是什么人的喊叫。

Then, blood. A body falling. A sticky sensation. Warmth. Chaos ...
然后是鲜血。倒地的声音。粘稠的感觉。温度。骚乱声……

...
……

The events that follow are hazy in Liáng's memory.
那之后的事情，梁月记得不是很清楚了。

Enraged Man: Training isn't over! Stand firm!
男子：时辰还没到，站稳！

A sharp reprimand shatters her haze, pulling her back to focus.
严厉的呵斥声刺破混沌的薄膜，令意识突兀地接续了起来。

Liang Yue: That's ...
梁月：那是……

A familiar courtyard. A man with a familiar face.
令人眼熟的小院。一个有着熟悉面孔的男人。

In front of him, a little girl stands in horse stance, sweat rolling down her forehead. Her legs are trembling.
他的面前正站着一个小女孩。
她扎着马步，汗水从额前滑落，腿已经力竭，开始晃晃悠悠地打颤。

Yet, the man's ebony ruler comes down mercilessly on the girl's shoulder.
但男子手上的黑檀木戒尺仍然毫不留情地拍在了女孩的肩膀上。

Enraged Man: Wrong! Shoulders and elbows down! Relax your body and mind. How many times do I have to repeat myself?
男子：不像样！
和你讲了多少次，要沉肩坠肘，心静体松！

Two small heads peek over the courtyard wall, giggling and whispering to each other.
院子围墙上，露出了几个小脑袋，正边笑边捂住嘴巴，不时窃窃私语。

Boy: Shh. Look, she's gonna fall any second.
男孩：嘘……看，她就要撑不住了。

Girl: Heh heh, that's what she gets for saying that to the teacher.
女孩：嘻嘻，活该！谁叫她向老师告密的。

The boy makes a goofy face at the girl holding the stance. The girl, already exhausted, finally loses her balance and collapses to the ground.
他对着扎马步的女孩歪斜着表情，做出了一个大大的鬼脸。
女孩本就早已疲惫不堪的双腿一垮，终于支撑不住，整个人仰倒在地上。

Enraged Man: You don't come to training, you're distracted, and you're lazy. How could Qiángliáng obey such an undisciplined master?
男子：疏于练功，三心二用，你看看你怠惰了多少……
以这样的体魄，强梁又如何能服从你?

Enraged Man: Get up. I'll come back later. If you can't do it by sundown, there will be no dinner tonight.
男子：继续站，我等一会过来检查。
扎不稳马步，今天晚上就不要吃饭了！

The man, her father, shakes his head in disappointment and walks away, leaving the girl gasping for breath on the ground.
父亲失望地摇着头离去，只留下女孩躺在原地，气喘吁吁。

Girl: Let's go. She's gonna be there all day. Wanna go to the theater?
女孩：走吧走吧，没意思，她又要站一天了。
要不要去录像厅?

Boy: Sure! The one on the corner's playing Detective C07 today.
男孩：好呀！去街角那家吧，今天他们家放《神秘警探 C07》!

The children hop down from the wall, laughing as they scurry off.
墙头上的孩子们也失去了对她的兴趣，嬉笑着跳下墙根跑走了。

Liang Yue: The theater? I want to go, too.
梁月：……我也想去录像厅。

No one hears her voice.
谁也没有听到女孩的声音。

No one but herself.
除了她自己。

Liang Yue: I remember it now. I hated Qiángliáng when I was little.
梁月：我想起来了。
那个时候……我很讨厌强梁。

Liang Yue: Father was always trying to teach me something, about the Twelve Zhènzǐ, the Master of Qiángliáng, fighting the wicked and dispelling evil, fulfilling the duty of my inheritance. I was only a child. It was all too difficult for me to understand.
梁月：什么十二侲子之后、强梁之主，什么惩奸除恶、驱除鬼疫、光宗耀祖、履行使命……这些对一个孩子来说，都太过遥远了。

Liang Yue: The other kids hated me. I was a traitor, a class president who took the side of the adults and enforced the rules. They'd all hang out and have fun together while I was left alone. I envied them.
梁月：没有孩子喜欢告密者和总是板着脸的小班长。当他们成群结队地嬉戏玩闹时，我只能一个人在一旁看着，假装自己并不在意。

Liang Yue: Their lives were simple. I wanted that.
梁月：……但其实，我也想要跟他们一样。

Liang Yue: One cent, two cents ... five ...
梁月：一角、两角……五角……

Her piggy bank lies smashed on the ground as she picks through the shards to count every coin.
小猪存钱罐被狠心地摔碎在地。女孩从它的残骸中一枚一枚地数出里面的硬币与一张张皱巴巴的纸钞。

Amidst the broken porcelain, half of a shattered face stares up at her innocently.
瓷片的残骸中，半张破碎的面孔睁着无辜的双眼看着她。

Liang Yue: I'm sorry, Piggy.
梁月：对不起，小猪……

She gently brushes her fingers over its face in a gesture of comfort—or farewell.
女孩伸出手，小心翼翼地摸了摸小猪的面孔。似乎是在安抚，也像是在道别。

Liang Yue: That day, I disobeyed Father, gathered up all my savings, and headed to the theater.
梁月：那天我没有理会父亲的要求，独自拿着积蓄找到了那些孩子说的街角的录像厅。

Liang Yue: That was the first time I watched Detective C07. It was amazing.
梁月：那就是我第一次看《神秘警探 C07》。
它的确很有意思，在观看的过程中，我也的确很开心。

Liang Yue: But I knew. It was just fiction. Just an escape.
梁月：但我也知道，电影里演的都是假的。

Liang Yue: It wouldn't change anything in my real life. Once the movie was over, I'd have to go back to the same home I had just left.
梁月：一部电影无法改变任何事。
等电影结束后，我还是得回到那个院子里去。

Liang Yue: I didn't want to leave, so I stayed in my seat for the closing credits.
梁月：……我不想回去。
所以直到片终字幕开始滚动，我也没有离开。

Liang Yue: But the lights didn't come on when the credits ended. Rather, the silver screen lit up again and played something.
梁月：当那些字幕滚动完后，录像带仍在播放，屏幕重新亮了起来。

Liang Yue: It was an interview with Ms. Qí Xīng.
梁月：那是电影的花絮，作为主演的奇星，正接受记者的采访。

Reporter: Ms. Qí Xīng, many children love your work and see you as their hero.
记者：奇星小姐，有好多小观众喜欢你的作品，把你当作他们的英雄。

Reporter: Yet some adults say that the story of Detective C07 is too unrealistic because she always beats the villain.
记者：但另一方面，不少成年人觉得你所饰演的警探 C07 每一次都能够击败恶人的结局过于理想化，反而缺乏了真实感。

Reporter: What's your opinion on this subject? Is it a flaw of the movie?
记者：对此你怎么看呢？你觉得这会是警探 C07 系列电影的遗憾吗？

Qi Xing: The real world's already a cruel and unfair place. Our movie's idealistic, yes, but it shows us a world where good is rewarded and evil is punished. We need that.
奇星：现实世界已经足够残酷，因此我们才会在电影的世界中寻求一个圆满的结局，寻求一个善有善报、恶有恶报的理想世界。

Qi Xing: If we can't accept justice and truth even in a fictional world, then what hope do we have for reality?
奇星：如果连在大荧幕上，我们都不被允许相信正义与公理，那么我们又还能相信什么呢？

Qí Xīng gazes into the camera, but also beyond it, her smile carefree, her eyes shining even brighter than the stars.
她注视着镜头，也注视着画面之外，笑容明媚而潇洒，眼神比星光还要明亮。

Qi Xing: C07 is justice, a hero who fights evil and cares for the weak. She'll always bring a happy ending, no matter what she's faced with.
奇星：C07 是正义的代言人，是锄强扶弱、匡扶正义的英雄，是在无论怎样的危机与险境之下，都能带来那个大家所期盼的圆满结局的人。

Qi Xing: One of our goals with this movie, and with the character, was to inspire and encourage our viewers.
奇星：——我希望我们的电影和 C07 这个角色能够带给银幕前的观众们力量与勇气。

Qi Xing: We know that most people can't become a C07 in the real world. After all, it's an incredibly difficult path to take.
奇星：也许并不是每一个人都能够在现实世界中成为一个真正锄强扶弱的战士，这毕竟是一条十分艰难的道路。

Qi Xing: But we hope that we can at least inspire people to become heroes in their own lives, to create happy endings for themselves and the people around them.
奇星：但我希望我们的电影和 C07 这个角色，至少能够让大家成为在生活中，给自己身边的人带来“圆满结局”的英雄。

Liang Yue: It was just a short interview like any other, but I still remember every word she said.
梁月：那是个夹杂在片终字幕中的很短一段采访，但当时奇星说的每一个字我都记忆犹新。

Liang Yue: "As the master of Qiángliáng, you must use your power to fight the wicked and dispel evil. It is your duty to maintain the peace of the world."
梁月：“身为强梁之主，应驱使险道兽强梁惩奸除恶、驱除鬼疫、守护世间安宁……”

Liang Yue: Qiángliáng, the powerful being that had always been a blur to me, suddenly became clear.
梁月：父亲无数次的耳提面命中所描绘的、那个没有面孔的形象终于清晰了起来。

Liang Yue: I realized that I could be more than just a hero who creates happy endings for herself and the people around her. I could be the hero who creates happy endings for everyone, just like Co7.
梁月：我意识到，我不仅仅可以成为那个“给身边人带去圆满结局的英雄”……而且可以成为和电影里的 C07 一样，“给所有人带去圆满结局的英雄”。

Liang Yue: She was right. Not everyone can do that, but I could, because I was Yuè of the Liáng family, the master of Qiángliáng. On that day, the burden that had been crushing me suddenly became a blessing.
梁月：别人也许不行，但是我可以。因为我是梁家之后，强梁之主——那份令我不堪重负的诅咒，在那一天成为了一份祝福。

Liang Yue: ...
梁月：……

Liang Yue: So, what went wrong?
梁月：那么，到底是哪里出了错呢?

The image fades as another silver flash brings her back to reality.
意识开始被撕裂，刺目的银光无情地将她吞没。

Sirens. An ambulance. Blood. Blood. Endless blood. It seeps through the fabric of her uniform, drenching her hands.
警笛声。救护车的声音。血。血。血。止不住的鲜血。
浸透警服的布料，淹没她的手。

She hears someone shouting.
她听到什么人在喊叫。

Liang Yue: Stay with me, Poitier. Please!
梁月：——坚持住，波蒂埃教官！求求您！

Liang Yue: Why? Why did you do that?
梁月：为什么……为什么您要这么做?

Liang Yue: I-I thought you hated me.
梁月：我以为你……我还以为你们讨厌我。

Liang Yue: People always hate me.
梁月：总是这样的。

Now she can hear clearly, she realizes it's her own voice, hoarse with desperation.
现在梁月听清了。那是她自己的声音，是她在狼狈地喊叫着什么。

What did Poitier say to her back then?
那个时候波蒂埃教官是怎么回答的来着?

Blood bubbles from her mouth and nose with each painful breath.
血随着她艰难的呼吸，从口鼻中化作血沫被咳出。

Poitier: *cough* You could tell, huh?
波蒂埃：咳……原来你知道啊。

Poitier: But that's—*cough*—that's in the past. Forget it.
波蒂埃：但那是……忘了吧，那是之前的事了。

Poitier: We just didn't know you yet.
波蒂埃：那个时候我们不是还不了解你嘛……

A bloodstained hand weakly pats Liáng's cheek before falling limp.
满是鲜血的手无力地拍了拍梁月的脸颊，随后落下。

Liang Yue: Poitier?
梁月：……波蒂埃教官?

Liang Yue: No! No!! Please! Poitier!
梁月：等等，不要……波蒂埃教官——!

Poitier: Ugh, will you shut up? I'm not dead yet.
波蒂埃：叫那么惨做什么，我还没到要你来鸣枪礼的地步！

Liang Yue: Ugh!
梁月：呃……?!

A thunderous smack, unbelievable from someone confined to a hospital bed, jerks Liáng awake from her nightmare.
难以想象是来自因伤卧床病号的雷霆一击，让梁月从睡梦中惊醒。

Liáng's head throbs. Dazed, she looks around, taking in the sterile white of the hospital room and the irritated face of her instructor.
额头被弹过的地方一阵发痛，梁月茫然地环顾四周，映入眼帘的是素净的病房和一脸愠色的自家教官。

Poitier: The hell you doing sleeping on my thigh, huh? Ugh, my leg's gone numb. And clean up the drool on your chin.
波蒂埃：怎么会有人来探望伤员，然后自己趴在这里睡着了的?
我的腿都要麻了……还有，擦擦你的口水。

Liang Yue: What? Ah. I'm sorry.
梁月：什么？抱歉——

Poitier: Just kidding, boo. You're not drooling.
波蒂埃：逗你的，你没有流口水。

Liang Yue: ...
梁月：……

Poitier: Alright, turn on the TV for me. I was bored out of my mind waiting for you to wake up.
波蒂埃：好了，帮我把电视打开吧，在你睡得正香的时候，我都快闷死了。

信息差对齐
Syncing Up 小径

My dear child, look at you, you're exhausted. I couldn't be of help then, but it's ok, the "party" is over now. At least let me brush your hair, darling.
???：亲爱的，你瞧上去这样疲倦，可真叫人担心。好在宴会已经结束了，尽管帮不上多少忙……至少让我替你拢一拢头发吧，孩子。

Or your hair will get all knotted, and it will hurt you when you try to untangle them.
???：如果不花些时间打理，它们是会打结的，解开时难免教人脑袋发痛。

选项 / Choices

1. Indeed. It happened more than once.
1. 我见识得够多了

I'm not surprised. An old friend of ours, "knot." Often we learn our knots before we even know how to read and write.
???：是啊，“结”是大伙儿的老朋友，比起写字和说话，我们认识它恐怕还要更早。

A knot could be an obstacle that breaks the consistency of a flow, and also a reminder of forgotten things.
???：在一条直线上出现的停顿，常意味着中断、阻塞，但更多时候充当着路标，将那些容易忘在角落里的东西拎到台面上。

You can use just about anything on hand to make a knot: leaves of grass, the fur of an animal, even fallen hair ... But the sturdiest knots are tied with rope.
???: 顺手抓过的草叶，野兽的尾巴，掉落的头发……能用于打结的材料可真够多的！当然啦，最方便存放的还是——绳结。

Knots are to be found in many stories. Signify promises, counting and measuring, an instrument of salvation and one of execution.
???: 它在各种传说中出现，忙得不可开交。有时候象征一个承诺，有时候用于计数，有时带来康复与终结。

选项 / Choices

1. What else can these knots really do?
1. 还有什么?

Oh, I could go on all day! The influence and power of knots can't be overstated...
???: 噢，这可讲不完！绳结承担的作用如此多，影响又如此之大。

It is said that it was in the cutting of the Gordian Knot that Alexander became "the Great"; just touching the meters-long rope provides blessings to the faithful in Belem; and tiny knots on strings can carry the history of an entire people.
???: 或许真是那一剑令格尔迪奥斯之结断开，也成就了一位国王；在庆典上抓紧长绳行走的人们，可能真的为他们的城市请来了神圣的目光；成串的绳索大概的确承载了整个国度的历史，连半只鞋子都未被遗漏在旁。

The ancient Inca called it "Quipu." The intricate variations of hundreds of fabrics, colors, and lengths of strings were used to record their stories through the ages. And to think, Shakespeare only had 26 letters to create his masterpieces.
???: 印加人管记事绳结叫“奇普”，从一根主要的绳上蔓延出许多小分支，所用的材料、绳索的色彩、打结的方式……这些变化当然已经足够记录任何东西。要知道，莎士比亚在创作时也不过只使用了 26 个字母。

选项 / Choices

1. Isn't there something a bit more practical?
1. 说些更实际的

Just look around you: don't sailors use knots to mark depths and mend sails; or coachmen tying knots to rein their horses; and any respectable lady or gentleman knows the knots they must tie about their necks to stay in fashion.
???: 朝周围瞧几眼——水手与海员利用绳结做标记，固定物件；车夫栓马时用上最结实的打结方式；体面的先生小姐也总关注着当下最为流行的花结，好及时调整自己的领巾与帽带。

Or consider the knot-like helix structure of DNA, and the changes in states of matter ... Invisible to the naked eye, these knots carry some hint at a universal law.
???: 而在肉眼瞧不见的地方，我们的基因排序、物质的相变……看似毫不相关的几个结也被某种统一的规律串联。

That there might be a string, like the Quipu, an endless rope that records in its knots everything in the world. One that can't be seen, yet there it is, everywhere, all at once.
???: 您瞧，或许真有一根丝弦、一条无尽的绳索，万事万物都系在其上。它不起眼，却无处不在。

Maybe you can tie this knot yourself. Use your hair, then form a loop, pass the end through it, and tighten it up. There you go.
???: 眼下您也可以试上一试。拿起这根头发，仔细地弯折，轻轻拽紧——成了。

I hope you keep this knot as a record of the words we shared here.
???: 这枚结会提醒您，我们曾在这儿谈话。

Excerpt from the New York Times
《纽约新闻报》节选

英文 / ENGLISH
Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson
中文 / CHINESE
前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。
于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。
火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

紧急播报
This Just In SC-15

Loggerhead: Tall Officer, are you up? I got you guys Chinese food. You must be hungry.
空脑袋：听说高个子警官小姐醒了？我给你们带了中餐外卖，你们一定饿了——

Poitier: Shh.
波蒂埃：嘘。

The two officers are both staring intently at the television screen.
病房中的两位警官，正全神贯注地盯着电视机屏幕里的画面。

The paper cups in their hands are crumpled tight.
她们手里的纸杯子，正被握出一圈圈褶皱。

Reporter: Almost 20 suspects in the holding cell were injured. Most were found unconscious at the scene and are now in critical condition at the hospital.
记者：现在近二十名待定罪的嫌疑犯，多数已经失去意识，正在紧急抢救。

Reporter: The victims include arcane black market dealer Caster and Chicago gang leader Jason the Coyote, both of whom have since been acquitted of their crimes.
记者：据说将无罪释放的炼金黑市操盘手“卡斯特”、芝加哥黑帮头目的亲信“郊狼杰森”也在其中……

Behind the reporter, thick black smoke billows from the scene of a car accident. Flames lick at the oil spilled on the road, sending waves of searing heat into the air.
在记者的身后，是黑烟滚滚的车祸现场。
火焰舔舐着地面上的机油，令路面升腾起一阵阵可怕的热浪。

Medical Staff: Cameras, out of the way, out of the way! The ambulance needs to come through. We need banana bags stat, or these people could go into shock.
医护人员：别挡道，别挡道，挪开你们的摄像机！救护车，开过来一点！这些病人需要立即静脉通道补液，防止休克！

Injured Suspect I: Ah. My skin. It burns. Help, help!
受伤的嫌疑犯 I：啊、啊啊——！我的皮肤好烫！救救我，救救我！

Injured Suspect II: Whoever you are who did this, just wait and see. I'll, I'll tear you apart, you asshole!
受伤的嫌疑犯 II：干了这件事的王八蛋，无论你谁……你等着！我一定要扒了你的皮！

Medical personnel shove past the journalist as they hurry over with a stretcher.
医护人员推开记者，大汗淋漓地推着担架床。

The cursing and wailing of the deranged man behind the reporter echo in the background. It sends a chill down their spines.
嫌犯夹杂着痛哭哀号声的咒骂与怒吼被电视台的麦克风捕捉，那些声音中饱含的痛苦与怨毒令听者不禁寒毛直竖。

Reporter: The fire is speculated to have been started by a victim of a Nightpiercer attack who displayed signs of mental instability.
记者：事故的原因被推测是遭遇“针人”袭击的受害者，因不明原因出现了精神异常的症状，纵火点燃了法院的羁押室。

Reporter: At the same time, similar incidents have occurred at the Liber Street Detention Center and the Chinatown Police Station. The situations at both sites are similarly concerning.
记者：然而与此同时，利贝尔街区的拘留所与唐人街警局也发生了相似的事件，另外两个现场的状况同样不容乐观。

Reporter: It has been reported that the Division of Arcane Affairs is considering the potential connections between these incidents. The mysterious figure behind the unresolved Nightpiercer attacks remains their top suspect.
记者：据悉，负责调查此事的神秘学犯罪科正在考虑这些事件的关联性。始终未能告破的“针人”连续袭击案件的嫌疑犯有着重大嫌疑。

Reporter: As with the previous attacks attributed to the Nightpiercer, the victims of these incidents are once again notorious criminals with extensive records.
记者：和以往“针人”制造的袭击案受害者相同，这一次事件的受害者仍均为恶迹斑斑的犯罪分子。

Reporter: However, in light of the Nightpiercer's escalating criminal activities, support for the figure is dwindling as concerns for safety rise.
记者：然而面对“针人”明显升级的犯罪行为，支持“针人”的声音逐渐减少，越来越多的市民担忧日常生活及生命安全受到威胁。

Reporter: In response to ongoing skepticism regarding the lack of resolution in the Nightpiercer case, Deputy Chief Elden of the Division of Arcane Affairs stated during the press conference that—
记者：面对“针人”事件长期未得到破获的质疑声，在此次案件的新闻发布会中，神秘学犯罪科的埃尔登警长表示——

Poitier slams the power button on the remote before flicking it aside.
电视遥控器上的关机键被躺在床上的病号毫不留情地按下。

She yanks the IV needle from her hand and grabs her uniform from the bedside.
随后她将遥控器丢到一旁，粗暴地拔掉手背上的输液针头，抓起床边自己的制服就往身上套。

Poitier: F**k! I pass out for half a day, and Qí Xīng's already turned the city into her personal playground?
波蒂埃：该死的，在我晕过去的那么一小段时间里，奇星就已经把整座城市都要搅得天翻地覆了吗！

Poitier: Grab your stuff, rookie. We're hitting the road. Gotta find this b**ch before she kills someone.
波蒂埃：菜鸟，拿上你的东西，现在可不是在床上睡大觉的时候了，我们也去加入调查——

Poitier: What, your feet stuck to the floor or something?
波蒂埃：你为什么不动?

Poitier stops only when she notices Liáng still sitting motionless. Liáng purses her lips, struggling to speak under Poitier's skeptical gaze.
风风火火的波蒂埃，看到梁月仍然僵坐在原地，这才停下了动作。
而梁月抿了抿嘴唇，在波蒂埃狐疑的注视下艰难地开了口。

Liang Yue: Deputy Chief Elden took us off the case. It was an official order.
梁月：……其实，埃尔登警长已经下达了指令，将我们排除在作战计划之外了。

A few hours earlier, the L.A. office for the Division of Arcane Affairs fell into an eerie silence.
事件需要倒回到数小时前，神秘学犯罪科的办公室中一反往日的喧嚣，安静得落针可闻。

Deputy Chief Elden: Early this morning, Constance Scott, a staff member of the Foundation's Arcanum Containment Department, was assaulted during an illegal arcane object trade. She's still in critical condition.
埃尔登警长：——昨日深夜，来自圣洛夫基金会神秘学藏品管理部的康斯坦丝·斯考特小姐在一场非法神秘学物品交易的现场遭遇了袭击，如今仍未脱离生命危险。

Deputy Chief Elden: Forensic Services has confirmed that the arcane skill traces found at the scene of the attack match those left by the suspect in the ongoing Nightpiercer case.
埃尔登警长：经过鉴识科的确认，袭击者在现场残留的神秘术痕迹，与被命名为“针人”的连续袭击案犯人留下的痕迹一致。

Deputy Chief Elden: Thanks to Noire and our Vigiles cadet Liáng Yuè, who were both at the scene of the attack, we've been able to confirm the identity of the Nightpiercer.
埃尔登警长：根据在场的菲林士多女士以及见习执夜人梁月的指认，我们已经确认原 B 级通缉犯“针人”的真实身份。

Deputy Chief Elden: Name's Qí Xīng, a 29-year-old former movie actress from Hong Kong. She played the lead role in the Detective C07 series, where she gained a reasonable amount of fame.
埃尔登警长：真名奇星，女性，29 岁，出生于香港，原电影演员。
她曾出演过《神秘警探 C07》系列的主角，算是小有名气。

Deputy Chief Elden: She was in a few more movies after that, but no big hits. She officially retired from acting a few years ago.
埃尔登警长：但在这个系列结束后，她的事业却并不顺利，出演的几部电影都反响平平，最终于数年前息影。

Deputy Chief Elden: The BAU's come to the conclusion that she's confused herself with her movie character—possibly a result of a mental imbalance caused by the setbacks in her career.
埃尔登警长：行为分析科认为，是事业失败导致的落差让她的心理失衡，将电影中自己饰演的角色和自己混淆了。

Deputy Chief Elden: She thinks she's the real-life C07, the hero who fights evil and cares for the weak. In short, we have a "vigilante" on our hands.
埃尔登警长：她错以为自己是电影里那个“锄强扶弱的正义英雄”C07，对自己认为是邪恶的存在予以“制裁”，是义警型的犯罪者。

Deputy Chief Elden: Thanks to a minor mistake from the Foundation's Arcanum Containment Department, we also have a dangerous arcane item, a cursed film reel called Reunion of the Three Swallows, somewhere in the city.
埃尔登警长：雪上加霜的是，基金会神秘学藏品管理部的“小小纰漏”导致危险神秘学管理品——“被诅咒的胶片”《三燕归巢》流落到了我们的城市中。

Deputy Chief Elden: Liáng has confirmed that Constance Scott, the staff member who was assaulted by Qí Xīng yesterday, is the perpetrator of the theft.
埃尔登警长：经过见习执夜人梁月的调查，昨日遇袭的康斯坦丝·斯考特小姐被证实正是监守自盗的犯人。

Deputy Chief Elden: As you're all aware, there's been an explosion in mental disorders in Chinatown. We now know that their source is the cursed film reel.
埃尔登警长：唐人街近日出现了大量精神状态异常的患者，被意外触发的神秘学管理品《三燕归巢》正是罪魁祸首。

Deputy Chief Elden: It's currently in Qí Xīng's possession, which makes her even more dangerous.
埃尔登警长：如今它落入了奇星之手，这让我们的嫌犯的危险度又上升了一个台阶。

Deputy Chief Elden: Having learned about the history behind this arcane film, we have reason to believe that obtaining it was one of her motives.
埃尔登警长：它是一件与嫌犯颇有渊源的物品，我们有理由怀疑获得《三燕归巢》本身就是她的目的之一。

Deputy Chief Elden: Since the film's been in her possession, there have been multiple assaults around the city, all matching the patterns of the Nightpiercer.
埃尔登警长：在昨晚危险神秘学管理品《三燕归巢》落入嫌犯之手后，城中已经出现了多个符合“针人”作案规律与习惯的袭击事件。

Deputy Chief Elden: But there's one key difference. This time, the victims all showed the same mental disorder as the victims of the film.
埃尔登警长：不同的是，这一次我们的受害者不仅遭到了身体上的折磨，还陷入了和《三燕归巢》受害者症状相似的精神异常状态。

Deputy Chief Elden: We believe that the suspect is able to control the film's power to some extent, and she's using it to commit escalating crimes at a much higher frequency.
埃尔登警长：嫌犯疑似能够一定程度上操控《三燕归巢》的力量为己用，而她的作案频率和力度也正在急速上升。

Deputy Chief Elden: We need to act before the situation gets out of control.
埃尔登警长：趁她采取更极端、危险的手段之前，我们必须先一步行动。

Deputy Chief Elden: Reinforcements from the Foundation and the Vigiles Bureau are already on the way. We will do whatever we can to protect our city before they arrive.
埃尔登警长：基金会和夜巡特遣的援兵已在路上，但在他们赶到之前，我们需要自己保护我们的城市。

He pauses for a moment as he sweeps his gaze over the officers before him.
他停顿了片刻，目光扫过面前的每一个身影，一个又一个名字从他的口中被点出。

Deputy Chief Elden: James, Carter, I'm putting you on the case. You'll be taking direct orders from me. The rest of you stick to your posts.
埃尔登警长：……最后还有詹姆斯以及卡特，你们负责专门处理这件事，我亲自带队。
其他人的工作安排不变，坚守你们的岗位。

Liang Yue: Excuse me, Deputy Chief Elden. I need to ask you something.
梁月：埃尔登警长，我想要请问——

Deputy Chief Elden: I already know what it is.
埃尔登警长：我知道你要问什么。

Before Liáng can speak, Elden cuts her off. His tone is calmer than she expected.
在梁月开口之前，埃尔登抢先了一步。
他的开场白和梁月预想的不同，语气甚至称得上是平和。

Deputy Chief Elden: You and Poitier saw that something was going on in Chinatown and started an investigation yourselves.
埃尔登警长：你和波蒂埃率先察觉了唐人街一带发生的事件，并立刻进行了调查。

Deputy Chief Elden: You found the culprit behind the ACD theft and stopped an assault that could've ended much worse.
埃尔登警长：你们找到基金会神秘学藏品管理部监守自盗案件的真正犯人，并且阻止了一场本可能走向更糟糕后果的袭击事件。

Deputy Chief Elden: You've done a great job.
埃尔登警长：在这一点上，你们做得很好。

But then his tone shifts.
但他的话锋一转。

Deputy Chief Elden: But there's one key thing you failed to do. You had a chance to apprehend the Nightpiercer right then and there, but somehow she slipped through your fingers.
埃尔登警长：然而在袭击事件发生的当时，你本有机会当场抓捕嫌犯，却没能做到。

Deputy Chief Elden: According to your report and the witnesses' statements, you failed to summon your legendary beast when you confronted the suspect.
埃尔登警长：根据你的报告和目击者的证言，你未能在和嫌犯对抗时成功施展神秘术召唤出自己的密友“险道兽强梁”。

Deputy Chief Elden: As a result, not only did the suspect get away, but your partner sustained an avoidable injury. I need my best, most reliable officers on this case.
埃尔登警长：你的失误导致了抓捕失败，也令你的搭档承受了计划之外的伤害。
而在抓捕“针人”的行动中，我需要的是更加稳定、更加可靠的警员。

After a brief pause, he delivers his final verdict.
停顿片刻，他做出了最终宣判。

Deputy Chief Elden: Sorry, Liáng, but you don't make the cut. The two of you will be excluded from the operation.
埃尔登警长：——所以很抱歉，梁。
这一次的作战计划中，不会有你们的位置。

Poitier: This is bulls**t! He can't cut us out. This is our case!
波蒂埃：这根本胡扯！这可是我们的案子，结果我们要被排除在外?

Poitier: No. We're doing this.
波蒂埃：我不接受！

Loggerhead: Calm down, Ms. Po ... Ms. Potty! Even if you feel fine, the doctor said you had to stay in bed for at least a few days.
空脑袋：你不要乱来呀！波……波波警官！
医生说虽然你没有什么大碍，但还是需要卧床一段时间休养呢！

Poitier: The name's Poitier. And I'm fine, okay? Stop trying to—
波蒂埃：我叫波蒂埃！而且我好得很，根本不需要什么休——

Poitier: *cough*
波蒂埃：咳、咳咳咳！

Facts speak louder than words. Liáng gently leads Poitier back down onto the bed. This time, Poitier doesn't resist.
事实胜于雄辩，梁月将套上警服正欲蹦下病床的波蒂埃又按了回去，这次波蒂埃没有反抗。

Poitier: Damn it. So what went wrong? How come your friend, Tángláng, was it?—didn't show up?
波蒂埃：该死……所以到底是怎么一回事，为什么那个时候你的强梁没有出现?

Liang Yue: Qiángliáng must've sensed my hesitation and refused my summon. You see, if its master can't overcome their selfish desires with an unwavering heart, it can turn on them. Father used to warn me about it.
梁月：若心智不坚，私欲不克，强梁恐会反噬其主——我的父亲总是对我再三叮嘱，但看起来强梁识破了我的动摇。

Liang Yue: But that won't happen again, I promise.
梁月：——但我保证，这样的事绝不会再发生。

Poitier narrows her eyes as she studies Liáng for a moment.
波蒂埃眯起眼睛，注视了梁月片刻。

Poitier: Heh heh. If you say so, what're you gonna do now?
波蒂埃：……好吧，既然你这么说。
所以你是什么打算?

Liáng takes a deep breath.
梁月深吸了一口气，给出了她的答案。

Liang Yue: I'll continue with the investigation. I need to find Qí Xīng.
梁月：我会继续追查这件事，亲自找到奇星小姐。

Loggerhead: What? But that angry grandpa already pulled you off the case.
空脑袋：咦?
但是那个凶巴巴的大叔不是说不让你参加作战计划吗?

Liang Yue: I have to do this.
梁月：我必须要这么做。

Poitier: What for? Because of your duty to fight evil as the master of Qiángliáng?
波蒂埃：为了什么？为了完成你身为那强梁之主、惩奸除恶的职责吗?

Poitier furrows her brow. But to her surprise, Liáng shakes her head.
波蒂埃皱起了眉，显然她并不喜欢自己的这个推测。
但梁月却出乎她意料地，摇了摇头。

Liang Yue: I've always had two things guiding me: my duty as a member of the Liáng family and the spirit of C07.
梁月：不管所谓家族的使命，还是“警探 C07”，它们都曾一度是我的路标。
因为有了它们，今天的我才会站在这里。

Liang Yue: But now, Qiángliáng has ignored my summon, and Qí Xīng has turned out to be anything but a hero. They were once the beacons of my life, but not anymore.
梁月：但如今强梁一度无视了我的呼唤，C07 和奇星小姐的形象也已不再光辉，那些引领我来到此处的东西都已经不再确凿坚实。

Liang Yue: This could be a setback, yes, or, it could be an opportunity.
梁月：正因为如此——也许这是一个机会。

Liang Yue: For the first time in my life, I can think about what I really want without having to consider anything else.
梁月：是我有生以来第一次能够抛开其他所有，只专注于寻找“我”想要做什么的机会。

After a brief moment of surprise, Poitier lets out a laugh.
短暂的错愕后，病床上的警员笑了出来。

Poitier: You know what, rookie, it always grinds my gears when you talk about your duty and all that stuff.
波蒂埃：你知道吗，菜鸟。
每次你说那些什么强梁之主的使命云云的话时，我都觉得别扭得不行。

Poitier: But what you're saying now? I like it.
波蒂埃：但你现在这样，就挺顺眼的。

Liang Yue: Aren't you going to stop me?
梁月：您……不阻拦我吗?

Poitier: Why would I? It's our case, isn't it? There's nothing wrong with doing our job.
波蒂埃：为什么要阻拦?
说到底这本来就是我们开始的案子，跟到最后又有什么不对?

Poitier: If Elden b**ches about it, just tell him you bumped into the crook when you were strolling around the city.
波蒂埃：如果埃尔登问起来，你就说你刚好路过发现了嫌犯，顺手制服了就行了呗!

Liang Yue: Seriously?
梁月：……还能这样?

Poitier: Yeah. Nothing wrong with that, is there?
波蒂埃：有什么不能的?

Poitier: So what's the game plan, huh? What're you gonna do?
波蒂埃：——那么现在，和我说说你的计划吧。
你打算怎么做?

Arcane Affairs Officer I: This scene again? They must've done a dozen takes already, right?
神秘学警察 I：……怎么还是这一幕，拍了得有十几遍了吧?

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Yeah. I'm no movie expert, but even I can tell the actor's nervous as hell.
神秘学警察 II：是啊，我不懂演技和电影，但我看得出来那个演员太紧张了。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Of course, he is. Anyone would be nervous if they knew a wanted criminal could show up at any time and mess you up with arcanum.
神秘学警察 I：换了谁能不紧张呢?
一个危险通缉犯，带着一个同样危险又诡异的神秘学管理品……

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Elden tried to keep the details of the case a secret, but that director from Hong Kong told her crew about it as soon as she came back.
神秘学警察 I：埃尔登为了避免恐慌，没有公开那张“被诅咒的胶片”和其他详细消息，但那个香港导演居然一回来就和剧组的人说了。

The two uniformed figures stand in a narrow alley in Chinatown.
唐人街的某条小巷中，两个身着警服的身影分外显眼。

They came to protect the potential target of an attack, Noire, but were politely turned away on the grounds of "disrupting filming." Now, they can only confirm the situation inside the set by peering through the slightly ajar door.
他们为保护潜在的被袭击目标菲林士多而来，但却被以“可能妨碍拍摄”为由委婉地拒之门外，如今只能够透过微敞的大门确认片场内的情况。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: I mean, I guess they have the right to know, and to run. Half of the extras got the hell out as fast as they could, and look at the other half. They're too nervous to work.
神秘学警察 I： 虽然他们的确是有知情权没错啦……但她这么一搞，剧组的那些临时演员立刻就逃跑了近一半，剩下的那些必然也没有心思投入拍戏了。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: I know. Hey, that's the Vigiles cadet, isn't it? What's she doing here?
神秘学警察 II： 可不是嘛——咦，那不是那个见习执夜人女孩吗？她来这里做什么？

Noire: The officers said you're here to help. Is that right?
菲林士多： 我听门口的那两位警官说了，你们是来履行协助我拍摄的约定的。

Noire: Excellent. We could really use a hand right now. Come, let's get you in costume.
菲林士多： 这可真是太棒了，我这边正缺人手。
跟我来，我们先去把戏服换上。

Noire greets her guest with her usual amiable smile.
大名鼎鼎的菲林士多导演带着一如往日的和善笑容接待了她的客人。

Having reached an agreement with Liáng to cooperate in an arrest, Noire has not been charged for her illegal trading of the arcane object.
因提前与梁月达成了配合抓捕的协议，菲林士多并未被以涉嫌参与非法神秘学物品交易的罪名起诉。

After being released from custody this morning, she immediately returned to filming.
听说今早她自警局返回了片场后，做的第一件事就是照常拍摄。

Liang Yue: I'm more than happy to help, but first, I have something important to ask you.
梁月： 我十分愿意配合您的拍摄，但现在……我有些更加重要的事想要询问您。

Noire pauses.
菲林士多停下了将轮椅调转方向的动作。

Noire: Right to the point this time, I see.
菲林士多： 这次你倒是开诚布公。

Liang Yue: I don't think there's any need to tiptoe around each other anymore. Could you answer me directly this time?
梁月： 我不认为事到如今还有遮遮掩掩的必要。
事已至此，您能够回答我当时的那个问题了吗？

Liang Yue: What happened between you, Qí Xīng, and Hé Rìjūn, the creator of Reunion of the Three Swallows?
梁月： 当年在您、奇星小姐以及那张“被诅咒的胶片”《三燕归巢》的制作者何日君小姐之间，究竟发生了什么？

Liang Yue: How did she die? Why do you and Ms. Qí Xīng both want that film? And why is she doing this?
梁月： 为什么何日君小姐会死？为什么您和奇星小姐都想要得到《三燕归巢》？
又为什么……奇星小姐会做出这样的事？

Noire looks at Liáng, her usual smile fading slightly.
菲林士多看着梁月，脸上那种习惯性的笑容淡去了几分。

Noire: What do you plan to do with my answers?
菲林士多：知道之后，你想要做什么呢?

Liang Yue: To Qí Xīng, I'm probably just another fan.
梁月：……对奇星小姐来说，也许我只不过是成千上万看过她电影的人中的一个。

Liang Yue: But to me, she and her character mean something.
梁月：但对我来说，她和她曾经扮演的角色有着特殊的意义。

Liang Yue: I need to know why. I have to arrest her and find out the truth.
梁月：我想要问她为什么。
我要亲手抓住奇星小姐，问她为什么要这样做，弄清楚真相。

Liang Yue: Maybe I can still fix things, but, Ms. Noire, I need your help if I'm going to do it.
梁月：也许……一切还能够挽回。
为了做到这一点，菲林士多女士，我需要您的协助。

This time, Liáng says exactly what she's thinking. She holds her breath as she awaits Noire's response.
这一次，梁月不再有所保留。
说完这些后，她屏住呼吸，等待着菲林士多的回应。

Noire: You mean, you want to know more about her.
菲林士多：所以你的意思是说，你想要了解她。

Noire: To peek behind the scenes—learn what really happened behind all the movie magic. I told you it's not a good idea.
菲林士多：你想要了解电影幕后，那些演员和剧组人员真正的模样……
我曾经告诉你，这并不是我会推荐的行为。

Noire: We create works not just to express ourselves, but to entertain. And when we release them to the public, we open ourselves to all kinds of commentary, whether they be sweet or bitter.
菲林士多：我们的作品之所以诞生，既是为了表达自身，也是为了给人欣赏品评。无论是掌声与赞美，还是鄙夷与唾骂，我们早已做好了心理准备。

Noire: But the people behind the characters, behind the production, they are not for entertainment. Their lives are not fiction.
菲林士多：但作品背后那些活生生的人，却没有被搬到放大镜下供人观赏取乐的义务。
他们并不是为此而被谁刻意制造出来的。

Liang Yue: Is that a no?
梁月：所以……您的意思是拒绝?

Noire: I haven't finished.
菲林士多：我还没说完呢。

She raises an eyebrow, a hint of mischief growing behind her smile.
她挑了挑眉，笑得从容，又似乎带着几分调皮。

Noire: Though I don't advocate trying to cross the line between on and off screen, if we cast aside your relationship as fan and actress and treat you simply as individuals ...
菲林士多：虽然对于试图跨越台前幕后界限的行为我并不推崇，但若是抛开这层身份，仅在两个个体之间讨论这个问题……

Noire: Saying "I want to know more about you" sounds rather beautiful. It's touching, really.
菲林士多：我想要了解你——嗯，真不错。
在我听来，这比什么样的情话都更加动人。

Noire: I'll answer your questions, Ms. Liáng. Follow me.
菲林士多：——我可以回答你的问题。
跟我来吧，执夜人小姐。

洛杉矶效率
L.A. Efficiency 小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.
???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
2. 我要前进到未来

分支 1 / Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.
???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...
???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……

分支 2 / Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.
???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—
???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.
???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。

选项 / Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.
1. 好了，开始胡扯吧

2. No. I'm tired of you.
2. 不，我已经厌倦你了

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.
???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.
???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Guidelines from the Vigiles Bureau on Recent Arcane Violence
夜巡特遣管理局关于近日处理神秘学暴力犯罪的指导建议

英文 / ENGLISH

Based on the latest Vigiles Bureau guidelines on recent arcanum-related violence, modifications and updates have been made to warrants and relayed to enforcement departments.

Details are as follows:

Wanted: Qi Xing, code name "Nightpiercer."
Threat level raised to "A."
Last seen in Los Angeles and surrounding areas. Any local institutions encountering this individual must notify the Vigiles Bureau immediately.

Wanted: Arcana, leader of Manus Vindictae.
Threat level: Maximum.
Any arcanist who encounters this individual must avoid engagement and immediately report to the Foundation and request military assistance.
(Revoked, confirmed deceased)

Wanted: Kimberly, "Ms. Kimberly."
Threat level: B.

Capture and detain upon encounter, then await Vigiles Bureau support.
(Revoked)

Wanted: Forget Me Not, officer of Manus Vindictae.
Threat level: A+.
Capture and detain upon encounter, then immediately contact the Vigiles Bureau for support.
Additionally, submit a report to the local Foundation office when reporting to the Bureau.
中文 / CHINESE
基于最新的《夜巡特遣管理局关于近日处理神秘学暴力犯罪的指导建议》内容，现进行通缉令修改与追加，传递至下游执行部门。
内容如下：
“针人”奇星，通缉中，危险程度上调至“A”，最近目击出现地为洛杉矶及周边地区，当地机构如遭遇此人应及时通报夜巡特遣以进行应对处理。
阿尔卡纳，重塑之手的领导人，通缉中，危险程度：最高。任何遭遇的神秘学家不得与其发生冲突转而应立刻上报基金会并请求军方协助消灭。（已撤销）（确认死亡）
金伯利，金伯利女郎，通缉中，危险程度：B。遭遇后立即逮捕并实行拘留，等待后续夜巡特遣的支援。（已撤销）
勿忘我，重塑之手干部，通缉中，危险程度：A+，遭遇后立即逮捕并实行拘留，等待后续夜巡特遣的支援。附：上报夜巡局同时抄送一份报告提交至当地基金会办事处。
……

小人物纪录
Before the Spotlight SC-16

Noire: Our story began 11 years ago. Life was tough, as it is for all young artists.
菲林士多：我想我们的事需要从十一年前说起。
那个时候我们还未成名，一切都很艰难，但也很美好。

Noire: But, like the beginning of many stories, there was a kind of beauty in it.
菲林士多：——就像所有故事的最初那样。

Guangfu Restaurant
广府饭店

Noire: "Another New Wave director has made a splash with her debut movie. Nitwit boasts an excellent foundation, but it may have reached a little too far with its bizarre and unconventional story ..."
菲林士多：“又一新浪潮导演处女作亮相，《糊涂》虽然底子极佳，但由于大胆创新过度，导致内容诡异颠覆……

Noire: "While some have praised its daring approach, it has proven too much for the general audience to appreciate, leading to a disappointing box office performance and living up to its title, Nitwit."
菲林士多：“即使业内有赞，但大众实在难以欣赏，最终票房惨淡收场，实属糊涂……”

Noire: Hah, what can I say? They've got no taste.
菲林士多：哈，我能说什么呢？没品味的东西。

She casually tosses the newspaper onto the table, the loud thud drawing surprised glances from the nearby diners.
那张报纸被她随手扔到了桌边，响亮的声音引来了邻桌人诧异的目光。

Noire: Okay. I guess compromise is inevitable if I want to sell more tickets, but that's not exactly my strong suit.
菲林士多：好吧，想要叫好又叫座，的确需要妥协一些内容。
可问题是我向来最不擅长，也不喜欢妥协——

???: Noire? Is that you?
???：菲林士多？是你吗？

He Rijun: What a surprise! It's so good to see you again.
何日君：真是巧，没想到会在这里碰到你。
这算是近期最让我开心的事了。

Noire: Teresa?! What are you doing here? When did you come back to Hong Kong?
菲林士多：你是……泰瑞莎！
你怎么在这里，你也回国了？

Noire: Teresa, or as you know her by, Hé Rìjūn ...
菲林士多：泰瑞莎——用执夜人小姐你所熟悉的名字来称呼的话，就是何日君。

Noire: ... was a dear friend of mine, the scriptwriter of Detective C07, and the creator of the cursed film—Reunion of the Three Swallows.
菲林士多：《神秘警探 C07》的编剧，我的好友，同时……
也是那张“被诅咒的胶片”《三燕归巢》的创作者。

Noire: Hmm. This is a pretty good script. Interesting.
菲林士多：咦？
这个剧本……确实写得不错。有意思。

Noire: Teresa and I met while we were studying abroad at a film academy. We took the same scriptwriting class.
菲林士多：我和泰瑞莎是在电影学院留学期间认识的，我们上同一堂剧作课。

Noire: We didn't talk much at first. She always sat in the corner on her own.
菲林士多：她总是一个人来上课，挑最不起眼的位置落座……所以最初我们并不认识。

Noire: I only got to know her after our teacher showed a script to the class as an example of excellent work.
菲林士多：最先见到她的名字，是在老师将她的剧本作为优秀范例发给我们看的时候。

Noire: The writer's name: Teresa.
菲林士多：作者的名字是……泰瑞莎。

Noire: Her stories could strike a balance between the details and the big picture. They were engaging, lighthearted, and warm.
菲林士多：泰瑞莎写的东西很细腻，却不会让人觉得小家子气。
她的故事总是轻松的、有趣的……也是温暖的。

Noire: So, in that moment, when we met again at the restaurant, I realized she was the one I'd been looking for.
菲林士多：所以当我们在那家小餐厅重逢的时候，我立刻就意识到——就是她了。

Noire: At that time, she was an editor at a small press. I invited her to join my studio, and three months later, she put the first edition of Detective C07 on my table.
菲林士多：那个时候泰瑞莎在一家小出版社做编辑，我直接把她拉到了我的电影工作室。三个月后，她拿来了《神秘警探 C07》第一部最初的剧本。

He Rijun: So? What do you think? Just tell me if you want to change anything. I can—
何日君：所以……你觉得怎么样？
要是你觉得哪里不好，我都可以改——

Noire: I'm thinking about who should play the heroine.
菲林士多：我在想主演要选谁。

He Rijun: Hmm?
何日君：嗯?

Noire: Your script is remarkable—even better than I expected. Let's shoot it.
菲林士多：这个剧本很好，比我想象中的要更好。
我们就拍这个。

Noire: So we had the script, but we couldn't decide who would play the heroine. We held endless auditions, even considered some famous actresses, but none of them fit.
菲林士多：剧本有了，但主演的人选迟迟没有定下来。我和泰瑞莎物色了许多演员，甚至也考虑过那些知名女星，但都觉得不合适。

Noire: Until that night.
菲林士多：——直到那一天的晚上。

He Rijun: What did you think of today's candidates? The last one seems okay to me.
何日君：刚才的那几个人，你怎么想?
我觉得最后的那个似乎还可以……

Noire: No. She's missing that edge. You can see it too, right?
菲林士多：她不行，少了那股锐气。你也看出来了吧?

Noire: We're not making lemonade from lemons. At least I'm not.
菲林士多：既然你也看出来了，就不要勉强自己同意。
我不想凑合。

He Rijun: But what if she doesn't even exist? What if our perfect actress only lives in our imaginations?
何日君：可是……万一那个完全符合我们想象的完美人选，并不存在呢?
万一她只存在于我们的想象中呢?

Noire: Then we'll keep looking until she's born.
菲林士多：……那我就会一直找。
直到她出生在现实世界中为止。

Hooligan I: Agh!
混混 I：诶哟!

Hooligan II: Y-You—What're you doing?
混混 II：你你你……你怎么打人?

???: I'm kicking your ass. Got a problem with that, perverts?
???：我是打你了，怎样?
手脚不干不净，这里不欢迎你们。

???: F**k off!
???：还不快滚?

Hooligan I: J-Just you wait! We'll come back! You'll see!
混混 I：你……你给我等着，这事没完!

After throwing out a few uninspired threats, the hooligans flee in disgrace. Behind the door, a worried face peeks out.
那几人留下毫无新意的无趣叫嚣后，狼狈地跑走了。
随后，他们被丢出来的门后探出一张忧心忡忡的面孔。

Restaurant Owner: You really shouldn't have done that. Those guys live in the neighborhood. They won't just let you off the hook after this.
老板：哎呀！这下可麻烦了，那几个人是附近有名的流氓，肯定不会善罢甘休。

Restaurant Owner: I know you just wanted to help that girl, but she didn't say anything. Why did you have to make such a scene? What if they come back and tear up the restaurant?
老板：我知道你看不惯那几个人对那个靓女说些不干不净的话，但……
人家都忍了，你生什么气啊？这下之后我这生意还怎么做？

Restaurant Owner: *sigh* You've gotten me into big trouble, Ā Xīng.
老板：阿星，你害惨我了呀！

Qi Xing: Don't worry, boss. I'll quit. If they come again, tell them to come find me.
奇星：……你放心，老板。
我会辞职，他们再找来，你就让他们来找我。

Qi Xing: Here's my key. Remember to open early. Your regulars don't like to wait.
奇星：……给，这是店门钥匙，以后您可记得早些来开门，否则那些老主顾们都要等了。

Restaurant Owner: Ā Xīng, what are you ... *sigh*
老板：阿星，你这……唉！

The restaurant owner resigns to taking the key in silence. Without a backward glance, the girl steps down from the door—only to be quickly stopped.
餐厅老板最终没有挽留。
那名少女头也不回地走下门前的阶梯——随后，被拦了下来。

Noire: Looks like you just lost your job.
菲林士多：看起来你丢了工作。

Qi Xing: Yeah, and what's it to you? What do you want?
奇星：……你是谁？关你什么事？

Noire: To offer you a new one. Are you interested in acting?
菲林士多：能给你一个工作的人。你对演电影有兴趣吗？

Noire: Ā Xīng was surprised when I made the offer. She said she needed to think about it, so Teresa gave her a copy of the script.
菲林士多：那时候阿星很惊讶，她没有立刻回复，说要考虑考虑。
泰瑞莎就把自己手上的那一部剧本给了她，让她回家先看看。

Noire: The next day, she knocked on our door and took the offer.
菲林士多：第二天她就找上了门来，说她做。

Noire: Later, we learned that Ā Xīng was born into a poor family. Her father was in prison, and her mother had mental issues. She'd been the breadwinner for the family since she was a kid.
菲林士多：后来我们打听了关于阿星的事，知道了她家里条件不好，父亲进了监狱，母亲的精神也有问题，十几岁起她就要养家。

Noire: Her father's reputation would often get her into trouble. So, usually, she was either on the way to a job or to a fight.
菲林士多：因为她父亲的关系，很多麻烦会不请自来……所以她每天最常做的事情不是打工，就是和人打架。

As memories surface, Noire lets out a sentimental smile.
旧事勾起曾经的回忆，菲林士多颇为感慨似的笑了笑。

Noire: The C07 you saw always had a confident smile on her face, but in actual fact, Ā Xīng almost never smiled at the beginning.
菲林士多：电影里的 C07 总是笑着的，自信又潇洒。
但其实最开始的时候，阿星从来不笑。

Noire: An actor should learn to commit to the moment in front of the camera and come back to reality behind it. But Ā Xīng didn't.
菲林士多：别的演员懂得该入戏时入戏，该抽离角色时就应当及时脱身……但阿星却没有。

Noire: She didn't come back to reality. She's never once stopped playing the role of C07 since then, 24 hours a day, 7 days a week.
菲林士多：她没有给自己设置那个“抽离角色”的逃脱按钮。
一年三百六十五天，她都在扮演 C07。

Noire: She started to smile the way C07 smiled. She went from brash and reckless to sly and methodical—just like C07.
菲林士多：她学会笑了，但却是像 C07 那样的笑。
她做事更机灵，而非过去那样横冲直撞——但却是像 C07 那样的“机灵”。

Noire: The Deputy Chief and the BAU made a mistake. Ā Xīng has not confused herself with her character.
菲林士多：警长先生和那些行为分析科的朋友们，弄错了一件事。
阿星并不是混淆了自己和角色。

Noire: After all these years in the movie industry, I've seen a lot of actors get carried away by the glitz and glamor of their characters.
菲林士多：在电影圈摸爬滚打这么多年，我见过不少这样的人。他们错以为自己真是那些他们短暂扮演的、光鲜亮丽的角色，于是忘乎所以。

Noire: But Ā Xīng is different. She values C07 even more than herself.
菲林士多：阿星却恰恰相反，她把 C07 这个角色看得比自己更加重要。

Noire: So much so that, ultimately, it eclipsed her own consciousness.
菲林士多：——为此，她不惜抹杀了自我。

Noire: Ms. Liáng, you asked me which rumors about C07 and the three of us were true. Now I can give you an answer.
菲林士多：执夜人小姐，你之前曾经询问过我，那些围绕着我和泰瑞莎以及阿星的传闻是否是真的。现在我可以回答你了。

Noire: Most of them were.
菲林士多：——是的。它们中的大部分都是真的。

Noire maneuvers her wheelchair to the desk, pulls out a file from the bottom drawer, and hands it to Liáng.
菲林士多操控自己的轮椅来到办公桌前，从最下方的抽屉中取出了一只文件袋，将它递给了梁月。

The file is heavy. Liáng opens it up to find an aged photograph.
文件袋颇有分量，里面躺着一本有些老旧的册子，但当梁月试图将它抽出来的时候，先摸到的却是一张同样有些年头了的照片。

Liang Yue: Is this ...?
梁月：这是……？

Three women pose together. Their identities are obvious.
那是一张三人的合照，照片中人的身份呼之欲出。

Noire: We drew a lot of attention after the release of Co7. Put a magnifying glass up to anyone, and you'll always find imperfections. We were no exception.
菲林士多：我们三个那时候小有名气，所以总有很多双眼睛盯着。
而人总是经不起用放大镜去看的——每个人都有缺点，我们也不例外。

Noire: Ā Xīng was as stubborn and uncompromising as I was. When we disagreed, it would blow up into a huge argument, neither one of us giving in to the other. Poor Teresa was always caught in the middle.
菲林士多：阿星太执着，和我一样不懂得妥协。我们两个产生分歧的时候，总是弄得惊天动地，让夹在中间的泰瑞莎很是难做。

Noire: I was too young, too bullheaded, to realize the consequences that this might cause. I tore a path forward, often ignoring the people around me.
菲林士多：那个时候的我也是一样，只懂得朝着锚定的方向一个劲走，却不懂得、也不屑于停下来看看四周。

Noire: Teresa, on the other hand, was kindhearted, perhaps too much so. She never got angry, no matter what people said. She just bottled it up inside and let it eat away at her.
菲林士多：泰瑞莎则是性格太好了。
别人说什么她都照单全收，憋在心里，最后把自己划得伤痕累累。

Noire gazes at the smiling faces in the photo, her expression tinged with nostalgia and the faintest hint of sorrow.
菲林士多望着照片上三人的笑脸，自己脸上的笑容却掺了几分感慨和一丝微不可察的伤感。

Noire: She didn't like taking photos. She was self-conscious about her appearance, so we only have a few together.
菲林士多：泰瑞莎不喜欢拍照。她总是对自己的外貌没有自信，所以我们的合照也没有几张。

Noire: This one was taken when we were shooting Co7 II. We were so close back then. Of course, we knew we'd have to part ways eventually, but we didn't concern ourselves with that.
菲林士多：这是在 C07 第二部拍摄期间拍的，那几乎是我们最好的时候。
虽然没有想过能够永远并肩，但我们也没有考虑过要在什么时候分道扬镳。

Noire: Even then, our shortcomings had started to hurt our relationship. But by the time we realized it, the damage had been done.
菲林士多：——可那些我们各自怀抱的缺陷，却在看不到的地方制造了无数龟裂。
等我们察觉到的时候，已经无法挽回了。

Qi Xing: No! This ending makes no sense. Co7 would never do that.
奇星：不行，这个结局还是太怪了。
C07 不应该是这样的！

Noire: When we were making Co7 III, Ā Xīng was up in arms about the ending.
菲林士多：……那是在拍摄 C07 第三部的时候，阿星看到那个结局便极力反对。

Noire: In the sequence, Co7 tracks a criminal through a Shèhuǒ Parade, hoping to finish him off herself. But when she finds him sitting at home with his family, she changes her mind.
菲林士多：电影的最后，C07 在社火游行中遇到了逃脱法律制裁的狡猾罪犯。她本想要亲自动手，却因为见到了对方和家人团圆的身影，最终放弃了。

Noire: Ā Xīng didn't like it.
菲林士多：——阿星并不喜欢这个结局。

Noire: She said that Co7 would punish the villain for what he's done, that she would never change her mind. We had countless arguments over this ending, and, of course, we never reached a conclusion.
菲林士多：她说 C07 会让恶人得到应有的惩罚，而不是最终无奈地被现实打败。
我们为此爆发了无数次争吵，最终也没能达成一致。

Noire: Alright, alright! Enough! We're not getting anywhere with this.
菲林士多：行了，行了！
到此为止吧，我们这样吵下去也没有意义。

Noire: I have an idea.
菲林士多：我有个提议。

Noire: So I cheated.
菲林士多：——所以我稍微用了一些手段。

Noire: Were I in the same position now, I'd solve the problem more delicately.
菲林士多：如果是现在的我，一定会选择更巧妙的方式解决。

Noire: But I was a jerk back then. The only thing that mattered was the movie. I couldn't care less about what people thought, including my heroine.
菲林士多：但那个时候的我是个混球，只把电影本身看作第一位。
除此之外的东西——例如主演的心情，并不在我的考量范围内。

Noire: I asked Teresa to write an alternative ending and told Ā Xīng that we'd shoot both endings and pick the better one together.
菲林士多：我让泰瑞莎又写了另外一个版本的结局。我哄阿星说两个版本都拍一条，最后大家一起来看看效果，再决定用哪一版。

Noire: She agreed.
菲林士多：阿星同意了。

Liang Yue: But you didn't keep your word. You released the movie with the original ending.
梁月：……但后来电影却直接上映了。
采用的结局，是最初剧本中写的版本。

Noire: It turned out to be very popular, but Ā Xīng saw it as a betrayal. At the premiere, she announced she was quitting the New Art Company that the three of us had founded together.
菲林士多：电影最后大受好评，但阿星却认为这是我和泰瑞莎的背叛。
她在首映式直接翻了脸，宣布退出我们三个一起成立的新艺术公司。

Noire: I didn't stop her.
菲林士多：而我没有阻止她。

Noire: Teresa tried to mend our relationship, like she always did.
菲林士多：——但泰瑞莎一直试图让我们重归于好，就像曾经的每一次那样。

He Rijun: I wrote a new story, not for Co7—a completely new one. If you're interested, maybe we can use it for our next movie.
何日君：我又写了一部剧本，不是 C07 的续作，而是一部新的故事。
如果你们觉得有意思，我们的下一部电影可以就拍它。

He Rijun: I made a sizzle reel. It's pretty short, probably not as good as the ones we usually make, but shall we watch it together?
何日君：我还自己拍了一部片花，虽然是很简单的东西，可能拍得也不好，但……也许我们可以一起看看。

Noire: It was her proof of concept for Reunion of the Three Swallows.
菲林士多：那部新的故事就是《三燕归巢》。

Noire: I knew Teresa had always wanted to put an end to the C07 series and write something she was really passionate about.
菲林士多：我知道泰瑞莎一直想要结束 C07 系列，写她自己想要写的东西。

Noire: Perhaps she thought a new story would help Ā Xīng move away from C07 and become herself again.
菲林士多：也许她也认为一个完全不同于 C07 的故事，可以让阿星从那个角色中走出来，重新找回自己……

Noire: Unfortunately, when she came to show us the script, Ā Xīng and I were in the middle of a fight.
菲林士多：但不巧，她来找我们的时候，阿星刚好和我大吵了一架。

Qi Xing: No! I'm not acting in any more of your movies.
奇星：不了，我不会再拍你们的电影了。

He Rijun: Ā Xīng, wait! Ugh!
何日君：阿星，等等——唔！

Noire: Ā Xīng had always been kind to Teresa, but on that day, she pushed her out of the doorway and stormed off.
菲林士多：从来在泰瑞莎面前都十分乖巧的阿星，当时推开了她愤然离去。

Noire: While I ... Well, as I said, I was a jerk. I flipped through her script, and a flurry of harsh words left my mouth.
菲林士多：而我当时……我说过了，那个时候的我是个混球，说话总是不客气。
我只是接过她的剧本，粗略地翻了翻。

Noire: Really? This type of story again?
菲林士多：……怎么还是上次的那个类型?

Noire: I told you this isn't your strong suit.
菲林士多：我说过了，你不适合写这种故事。

He Rijun: ...!
何日君：……！

The script, along with the reel, is shoved back into Hé Rìjūn's hands without a second glance.
那部剧本连带那盘胶片，被彼时的菲林士多塞回了何日君的怀中，再没有多看一眼。

Noire: In the end, neither Ā Xīng nor I cared enough to watch Teresa's sizzle reel, even though she tried so hard to present it to us.
菲林士多：无论是我还是阿星，最终都没有看到泰瑞莎拍摄的那部所谓“很简单的”片花究竟是什么样的。

Noire: That was the last time we saw Teresa.
菲林士多：而那就是我们最后一次见到泰瑞莎了。

Liang Yue: That fire ...
梁月：……那场大火。

Noire: Yes. That's why I'd pay any price to get that film.
菲林士多：没错。
这也是我在听说那盘胶片再次出现后，不顾代价想要将它弄到手的原因。

Noire: Her script was burned to ashes in the fire. I need to know what story she was trying to tell.
菲林士多：《三燕归巢》的剧本已经在火海中化为灰烬，我只是想要看看泰瑞莎当时究竟想要一个怎样的故事。

Noire: I suppose Ā Xīng feels the same.
菲林士多：我猜阿星也是一样。

Noire gestures toward the file.
菲林士多向梁月示意那只文件袋。

Noire: This is what you wanted to see last time you and your officer friend visited me.
菲林士多：这就是之前你和那位高个子的警官造访时，说想要看的东西。

Liang Yue: You mean the threatening letter?
梁月：您是说那封“威胁信”？

Noire: It's not a letter, actually.
菲林士多：这并不是信。

Liáng sets down the photo and pulls out the remaining contents of the file. It's an aged script, its cover yellowed by time.
梁月放下手中的照片，将文件袋里剩余的东西拿了出来。
那是一本有些年头了的册子，封皮已经泛黄。

As she flips through, familiar lines of dialogue meet her eyes. In an instant, she understands the significance of what she's holding.
翻动了两页后，熟悉的台词映入眼帘。
梁月立刻明白了手中的东西所代表的含义。

Liang Yue: It's the script of Detective C07 I.
梁月：这是……《神秘警探 C07》第一部的剧本。

Noire: The original—the one Teresa handed to Ā Xīng all those years ago.
菲林士多：初版。是泰瑞莎给阿星的那一本。

Liang Yue: ...
梁月：……

Liáng never imagined that, one day, she would be holding the origin of the very film that inspired her as a child.
在屏幕上观看过那部电影无数次，梁月从来没有预料到过有一天，一切的原点竟然会被自己捧在手中。

There is no doubt. Qí Xīng must have returned it to Noire. But why? What does this mean?
毫无疑问，是奇星将它还给了菲林士多。
但这又意味着什么呢?

She continues to flip through until her fingers meet an object tucked between the pages.
她继续翻阅着，直到游动的纸张被夹在剧本中的异物截停。

Liang Yue: Is this a poster of the Shèhuǒ Parade?
梁月：社火游行的宣传海报?

Liang Yue: Oh, right. It's almost time for the Dùshuò Festival. With everything going on these days, I almost forgot.
梁月：说起来马上就是度朔节了。这几天发生了太多事，我都忘了——

Liáng's expression suddenly shifts.
梁月说到一半，忽然变了脸色。

Liang Yue: Wait. Is Ms. Qí Xīng going to ...?
梁月：等等，难道说奇星小姐打算……

Noire: Your guess is as good as mine.
菲林士多：我和你有一样的猜测。

They exchange a glance, then both turn their gaze to the image of the Shèhuǒ Parade printed on the poster in front of them.
她们对视一眼，最终目光落在面前宣传单中社火游行的图景上。

度朔喜乐
The Joy of Dushuo 小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.
???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
2. 我要前进到未来

分支 1 / Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.
???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...
???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……

分支 2 / Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.
???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—
???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.
???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。

选项 / Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.
1. 好了，开始胡扯吧

2. No. I'm tired of you.
2. 不，我已经厌倦你了

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.
???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.
???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Chinese TV News Segment: Shehuo Parade
华语电视新闻选段：社火游行

英文 / ENGLISH

Our reporter brings you an exclusive frontline update:

"As the Dushuo Festival begins, Los Angeles's Chinatown is once again alive with the excitement of the Shehuo Parade. Humans and arcanists will soon come together to pray for a year of peace and prosperity."

"We are currently at the Chinatown Community Center, which houses 12 sacred arcane idols, marking the starting point of the parade."

"We're fortunate to be interviewing Principal Huang, who is this year's 'Summoning Official.' Principal Huang, could you tell us about your role in the festival?"

"Ah, the summoning official is responsible for reciting the summoning rites and inviting the idols. After lunch, the rotating God of Shèti, 'Xieqia,' will be placed on the palanquin. Some of the parade members have already gathered outside."

"That's right, we can see people carrying lanterns and flags preparing for the parade. Principal Huang, what's that large animal lantern over there?"

"That's a Lùshǔ, a Xiángruì. Later, it will join the Beast Lantern Team. The parade will be led by

the Five-Colored Banners and the Yingge Troupe, followed by the Xiandao Beasts and Xiángruì creatures—quite the spectacle!"

"The Xiandao Beasts, are those the legendary creatures said to ward off evil plagues?"

"Exactly. During the 'Plague-Banishing' segment, General Qianmo will shout the command, and three young men wearing Xiandao Beast masks will sing the Plague-Banishing Song, imitating the beasts to drive out evil."

"The musicians will accompany them with gongs and drums. The parade will go on until late at night—quite the festivity!"

"Thank you, Principal Huang. Though the parade has yet to start, we can see crowds waiting already. Stay tuned as we bring you live coverage of the Shehuo Parade."
中文 / CHINESE
本台记者前线独家报道

“度朔之际，洛杉矶唐人街再度迎来了热闹的社火游行。人类与神秘学家欢聚一堂，祈祷来年风调雨顺，合境平安。”
“我们现在所处的位置是唐人街的社区活动中心，这里供奉着 12 座摄提神的神偶，也是社火游行的起点。”
“我们有幸采访到了担任‘搬神公’的黄校长。黄先生，您可以为我们介绍一下‘搬神公’吗?”
“这个搬神公呢，就是朗诵请神表文，请出神偶的人。等会儿午饭之后，轮值摄提神‘协洽’的神偶就会在这里被请上神轿。除了我之外，现在外面也已经聚集了些游行队伍的成员了。”
“好的，我们在现场的确可以看到一些抬着灯笼和旗子的人在做准备。请问黄先生，那位黑衣服朋友手里好大的动物灯笼是什么呢?”
“那是鹿蜀，一种祥瑞，过一会要举起来的，你会在兽灯队里看到它。等一下五色令旗和英歌队会先开路，险道兽与祥瑞会跟在他们后面，那叫一个威风!”
“险道兽就是传说中能祛除恶疫的神兽吗?”
“是的。等到‘逐疫’开始，阡陌将军会大喊一声，跟着他的三个小伙子就得戴上险道兽的面具，一起唱‘险道逐疫歌’，模仿真正的险道兽祛除恶疫。”
“一路上我们的乐手都会吹吹打打，锣鼓的声音都能传到街那头去，游行会持续到深夜里，热闹得很!”
“好的，谢谢黄先生的介绍。虽然游行尚未开始，但我们可以看到街道上已经聚集了不少翘首以盼的群众。稍后，本台将为您实况转播社火游行现场的盛况。”

夜游者
Watchers, Protectors, Defenders SC-17

Enraged Man: Wow, look at all these people! We should've come earlier. I can hardly see a thing from here.
男子：好多人呀！早知道来早一点啦，可以去前排看。
幸好逐疫队还没来。

Woman: And whose fault is that? You're the one who took ages to get ready. Anyway, at least we haven't missed much. Looks like it just started.
女子：我早就说了，谁叫你在家拖拖拉拉不着急的?
算啦，这个位置也不错，队伍总会过来的。

Woman: I heard there's a new event this year. I wonder what it is.
女子：诶，说起来，我听说今年有新节目?

Enraged Man: Not an event. A film crew's shooting a scene during the parade. Apparently, they already talked to Mr. Zhōu and said they wouldn't cause any trouble.
男子：不是节目，是有个剧组打了招呼，要借咱们社火游行的景拍一场戏。
说是已经和老周他们说过了，不会碍着事的。

Enraged Man: Let's go check it out. Maybe we can get into one of the shots.
男子：那我们到时候过去看看？说不定还能上镜。
到时电影一上，我们还能上大银幕呢！

This is the busiest time of year in Chinatown. The streets are filled to the brim.
一年一度的盛会，唐人街中人声鼎沸，这是每年最热闹的时候。

But for those with keen eyes, some outliers can be spotted among the crowd.
然而，若是目光足够敏锐，便能够在人群中发现一部分“异类”。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: This is C2. All clear.
神秘学警察 I：这里是 C2，没有异常。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Copy. Group C, all clear. No sign of target. All units stay in position.
神秘学警察 II：收到。C 组各点位均无异常，没有发现嫌犯奇星的痕迹，各个单位继续待命。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: I wonder how the vigil girl and Elden are doing.
神秘学警察 II：……不知道那个小姑娘和埃尔登他们准备得怎么样了。

Having ended the transmission, the officer glances toward a Chinese restaurant at the street corner.
结束通信后，这名神秘学警察看向街角的那家中餐馆。

Despite the bustling crowd, the sign on its door reads "CLOSED."
——在这个人来人往的日子里，它的门口挂着的招牌却写着“CLOSE”的字样。

Deputy Chief Elden?: ...
埃尔登警长?：……

Deputy Chief Elden?: Do I really have to go outside like this?
埃尔登警长?：我一定要打扮成这样吗?

Deputy Chief Elden stands awkwardly in front of the mirror as he stares at the brightly colored traditional outfit he's adorned in.
疑似洛杉矶警署神秘学犯罪科埃尔登警长的人物，对着面前格外鲜艳喜庆的一身衣服犯了难。

The man across from him sneers, shattering his last shred of hope to be saved from it.
站在他对面的男子冷笑一声，毫不留情地打碎了他仅剩的希望。

Private Investigator: No, you need to paint your face, too. I'm not gonna let you join the parade looking like a weirdo.
民间侦探：不，你还需要涂面，否则我可不会允许你就这样不伦不类地加入到队伍里。

Private Investigator: You're the one who said that the parade needed guards in case there was an attack. Have you changed your mind? I'd be more than happy to kick you outta here.
民间侦探：是你们说可能有人要在社火游行中捣乱，非要进入社火游行中警戒……难不成你们改变了主意？那么我将会举双手赞成。

Private Investigator: Sorry, but your profiling and BAU report seemed like a load of crap to me. If someone does attack the parade, I'm sure we can handle it ourselves.
民间侦探：我打从一开始就不相信你们的那什么侧写和行为分析结果。
退一万步讲，就算有人想要在社火游行上捣乱，我们也能自己应对。

Deputy Chief Elden: Listen, I won't pretend to understand the meaning behind all this. But what I do understand is that this is one of the most important events of the year for the people of Chinatown.
埃尔登警长：……我们的确对你们的习俗缺乏了解，但我明白对唐人街的人们来说，这是他们期待了一整年的重要活动。

Deputy Chief Elden: The target could strike at any time, so we need to be prepared. No one wants to see a celebration turn into a nightmare.
埃尔登警长：既然存在嫌犯现身的可能性，我们就应当做万全的准备。
没人想看到一个本应该美好的夜晚成为一场噩梦。

Private Investigator: Why didn't you say that to your men? They are the ones who've ignored the Chinatown all this time.
民间侦探：之前你们这些外面的人对这条街道置之不理的时候，可不是这样说的！

Private Investigator: What a hypocrite.
民间侦探：假惺惺的……

He glares at the officers with clear distrust in his eyes. But before tensions can rise anymore, the girl beside him cuts in with a smile.
这名固执的神秘学侦探看向神秘学犯罪科警员们的目光仍然和“友好”二字相距甚远，但一旁的女孩笑着制止了他。

An-an Lee: Aiyah, Uncle Zhōu, today's our big day. That sour face of yours is gonna scare these guys straight off.
泥鳐的士：今天这样的好日子，周叔你却总拉着脸，怪不得后生仔都被吓跑了！
放宽心啦！

An-an Lee: Leave the past in the past lah. They are doing this for the right reasons. What've we got to lose?
泥鳐的士：之前是之前，现在是现在，阿 sir 他们也是好意。
就算最后什么事情都没有发生，那不是也挺好的嘛！

An-an Lee: Besides, we could really use a hand right now. They can make up for our manpower shortage.
泥鳐的士：最近出了不少事，街坊中能参加游行的人手不足，阿 sir 他们来了不是正好？

An-an Lee: Now, give me a biiig smile lah, before your long face scares off our good fortune.
泥鳐的士：今天是个好日子，周叔你总拉着脸，都要长皱纹了！
多笑笑嘛，不然福气都要被吓跑了！

Private Investigator: You. Always a sweet talker, aren't you, An-an?
民间侦探：你这个小丫头，总是这样油嘴滑舌的！

He huffs and glares but eventually waves it off.
他吹胡子瞪眼了一番，但最终还是泄了气，不耐烦地摆了摆手。

Private Investigator: Fine, but you've got to look the part if you're gonna be in the parade. I don't care what your mission is.
民间侦探：行吧行吧，我知道了。不过我可不会睁一只眼闭一只眼，不管你们有什么任务，这些衣服都得给我好好穿。

Private Investigator: Wai, you, Blondie! Tighten your belt, or your pants will fall down when you dance. And big guy over there! The lining should be under your coat.
民间侦探：你，那个金毛！裤腰带系得太松了，你这样跳起舞来没两步裤子就要掉了！还有你，那个大个子，你把外衣和内衬穿反了！

The famed Chinatown investigator yells corrections to the officers as they do their best to don the traditional attire. His tone is sharp but surprisingly patient.
板着脸的唐人街名侦探开始一个一个地纠正警员们的穿戴，虽然语气并不温和，但至少算得上耐心。

Seeing his "old friend" much mellowed from before, Elden removes his garish headpiece and turns to An-an.
看着这个“老朋友”和过去相比已经温和得多了的身影，埃尔登摘下额上鲜艳的头饰，望向一旁的少女。

Deputy Chief Elden: Thanks for all your help, Ms. Lee.
埃尔登警长：……泥鳋的士小姐，多谢，您帮了大忙。

Deputy Chief Elden: We never would've been able to join the parade unnoticed if you hadn't persuaded the residents to cooperate with us.
埃尔登警长：没有您协调唐人街的街坊们，我们想要在不引起嫌犯注意的情况下潜入社火游行，恐怕是痴人说梦。

An-an Lee: You're welcome lah, Ā sir.
泥鳋的士：别客气啦，阿 sir！

An-an Lee: Even though I only came here a few months ago, I've already gotten pretty close to the residents, so it was pretty easy to convince everyone. Don't worry about it lah.
泥鳋的士：我只不过是早来了唐人街几个月而已，但和这边的街坊们也算是混熟了。说一声的事情而已，不需要那么郑重啦。

An-an Lee: Besides, the Shèhuǒ Parade is for everyone. Whether they are here to watch or dance, we are always happy to have more people join the celebration.
泥鳋的士：再者说，其实这边的社火游行一直都很欢迎五湖四海的朋友们来参加的。
不管是做观众也好，参加游行也罢，其实都没有那么多讲究。

An-an Lee: Uncle Zhōu might be a little stubborn, but, you know gah-lah, that's just what he's like. Don't take it personally.
泥鳋的士：周叔他也许是有些苛刻了，但……
哎呀！他就是那个性格，阿 sir 不要放在心上。

She turns her head, gesturing toward a few unfamiliar faces at the other end of the restaurant.
她转头，示意餐馆中一些并非埃尔登熟面孔的身影。

An-an Lee: These guys are arcane detectives and influential people around Chinatown. I told them to all keep an eye out too.
泥鳋的士：我也通知了其他在唐人街这边活动的民间神秘学侦探，还有一些这边社区里能话事的人，让他们帮忙一起警戒。

An-an Lee: There's a saying in Hong Kong, "As stupid as the God of Longevity who hangs himself!" Hahah! That will be Nightpiercer if she comes anywhere near Chinatown.
泥鳋的士：加上阿 sir 们的人手，如果那个“针人”真的现身，那也是寿星公上吊——嫌命长啊！

Elden nods before gently shaking his head with a complex expression.
埃尔登点了点头，随即又略微复杂地摇了摇头。

Deputy Chief Elden: I know everyone here will be grateful if Nightpiercer doesn't show up, but then we'll still have a dangerous criminal with an equally dangerous arcane item on the loose.
埃尔登警长：如果一切无事发生，自然再好不过。
但这也意味着一名危险的罪犯和神秘学管理品仍然潜伏在民间，下落不明。

Deputy Chief Elden: Nothing's more dangerous than an unexploded bomb. I want to eliminate the threat once and for all.
埃尔登警长：最危险的是还没有爆炸的炸弹。就我个人而言，我的确希望我们那名神出鬼没的嫌犯在今天现身，这样我们才能够抓住机会逮住她。

Deputy Chief Elden: The question is, will she come? Was the little vigil right?
埃尔登警长：问题在于——她真的会来吗?
就像是那个执夜人小姑娘所预测的那样?

Late last night, Liáng knocked on Elden's office door. She had returned from her morning rejection with renewed determination.
埃尔登的办公室被梁月敲开是在前一天的深夜。当天早上梁月离开这间办公室时还是一副消沉的模样，但十几个小时后她再次造访时却斗志昂扬。

Liang Yue: The Shèhuǒ Parade, sir.
梁月：是社火游行，长官。

At that time, the Division of Arcane Affairs was still brightly lit, with most officers racking their brains to track down Qí Xīng without success.
那时神秘学犯罪科的办公室仍然灯火通明，大半警员为寻找奇星的行踪绞尽了脑汁，却并无太多收获。

That was when Liáng had stormed in with her "important collaborator," ignoring the puzzled glances from her colleagues, and slammed a thick stack of reports onto his desk.
而梁月就那样带着她的“重要协助者”，顾不上注意到她的警员们疑惑的目光，一路冲入了他的办公室，将厚厚一沓报告砸在了他的桌子上。

Liang Yue: Ms. Noire isn't like any of Qí Xīng's previous targets. She's much more important.
梁月：菲林士多导演并不是她的潜在袭击目标之一，她是奇星小姐最重视的那一个目标。

Liang Yue: Ms. Qí Xīng still can't accept the way Ms. Noire ended Detective C07 III. That's her motive.
梁月：奇星小姐对《神秘警探 C07》最后一部的结局耿耿于怀，那就是她心中的执念。

Liang Yue: The ending consists of two major elements: the Shèhuǒ Parade and a villain who should've been punished.
梁月：那个结局有两个最重要的元素——社火游行，以及一个应当得到惩罚的恶人。

Liang Yue: She now sees Noire as that villain, and she's going to attack her at the coming Shèhuǒ Parade.
梁月：恐怕在奇星小姐眼中，菲林士多女士就是那个人。
奇星小姐一定会在社火游行中现身，袭击菲林士多导演。

Liang Yue: That will be our chance to arrest her.
梁月：——而我们可以在那个时候抓住她。

Deputy Chief Elden: The Shèhuǒ Parade? Do you have any idea what you're suggesting?
埃尔登警长：社火游行？……你知道你在说什么吗?

The sheer thickness of the report is intimidating. Elden skims through it before casting a questioning look at the unexpected visitor Liáng had dragged in.
桌子上报告书的厚度令人生畏。他短暂翻看后，将狐疑的目光投向那个被梁月风风火火推进来的另一位访客。

The visitor nods.
那个人点了点头。

Noire: Don't worry, sir.
菲林士多：关于这一点您无需顾虑，警长先生。

Noire: I'd be happy to cooperate as bait.
菲林士多：我很乐意配合警方的行动，充当一个……诱饵。

Noire: Ā Xīng will come. I promise.
菲林士多：——放心吧，警长先生。
阿星会来的。

The sound of the back door opening breaks Elden's thoughts. He looks up to see Poitier pushing Noire's wheelchair inside, Loggerhead following closely behind.
餐馆后门开合的声音打断了埃尔登的回忆，他循声望去，见到自家下属和那个机械身体的女孩一起推着菲林士多的轮椅进了屋。

Noire: As far as I can remember, she's never been late to anything.
菲林士多：毕竟在我的记忆中，她从来没有迟到过。

Poitier: Chief, why aren't you dressed up? I've been looking forward to it all day.
波蒂埃：咦，警长你怎么还没有换好衣服?
真让人失望，我还想看看我们尊敬的警长先生大变装的样子呢。

Loggerhead: Wow! So many people! I'll make sure I capture some great memories of this.
空脑袋：好多人呀，看来这次我又能拍到很棒的记忆了！

Noire remains her usual unruffled self, while Poitier teases her colleagues, and Loggerhead eagerly looks around.
菲林士多照常是那副云淡风轻的模样，波蒂埃揶揄起四周的同僚，一旁的摄像头女孩也开始兴奋地左顾右盼。

Elden sighs and rubs his forehead.
埃尔登见状，不由得按了按眉心。

Deputy Chief Elden: I understand that the festival atmosphere is exciting, but you ladies need to remember that we're not here to celebrate. There's a tough fight ahead of us.
埃尔登警长：两位小姐，我明白你们被社火游行的氛围感染心情多少会有些雀跃，但请不要忘记今天我们并不是来玩的——有一场硬仗正等着我们呢。

Deputy Chief Elden: Poitier, you sure you're healed up?
埃尔登警长：波蒂埃，你确定你的伤已经好了?

Poitier: Of course, Chief. You've approved my participation in this operation. It's too late to take it back now.
波蒂埃：当然了警长。
你已经批准了我参加这次行动，现在可不许反悔了。

Elden looks her over. Clearly she's alive and well, but he still carries concern on his face. Eventually, he sighs and nods.
埃尔登见手下的这名年轻警员的确生龙活虎，虽然面上仍带有几分担心，但最终还是无奈地摇了摇头默认了她的加入。

Deputy Chief Elden: What about Ms. Latham?
埃尔登警长：……那么莱瑟姆小姐呢?

Deputy Chief Elden: You've been proven innocent, and I heard the Foundation told you to await orders. There's no reason for you to be here.
埃尔登警长：您的清白已经被证明，我记得基金会也已经向您传达了指示，让您暂时只需要待命即可。

Elden's words draw everyone's attention to Loggerhead. Her head twitches slightly.
埃尔登警长的话将众人的视线带向了那名着亮黄色衣裳的机械少女。
那颗沉重的金属脑袋闻言动了动，这一次却没有垂下去。

Loggerhead: Yeah, but it'd be weird to stay in my room alone when everyone's out here, don't you think?
空脑袋：话是这么说啦，但……真的叫我就这样老实待在房间里，总感觉很奇怪不是吗?

Loggerhead: Anyway, I'm waiting for Scott to wake up from her coma. I wanna ask her why she stole from the Foundation and pinned it on me.
空脑袋：斯考特仍然昏迷不醒。等她醒来之后，我想要问问她为什么要做那种事、又为什么要栽赃到我的身上……

Loggerhead: I need to know what she thinks about me and our friendship.
空脑袋：我想问清楚，她究竟是如何看待我和我们之间的友情的?

Loggerhead: If I let you guys do all the work while I just wait in my room, I won't be able to question her without feeling insecure.
空脑袋：但如果在这期间，我只是在等待着别人解决一切，自己却什么都没有做，总感觉去找斯考特的时候，心里也会少一些底气。

Loggerhead: I know I might not be all that helpful, but I'll do everything I can.
空脑袋：虽然我也许帮不上什么忙，但我会尽我最大的努力的!

The camera lens almost seems to flash with something resembling a plea.
她朝向埃尔登的摄像头中，竟然闪动着几分叫人能够理解为“恳求”的反光。一旁的菲林士多也开口帮腔。

Noire: Ms. Latham's being modest.
菲林士多：我想莱瑟姆小姐有些过于谦虚了。

Noire: As a staff member of the Arcanum Containment Department, she knows how to deal with that film reel better than any of us.
菲林士多：作为神秘学藏品管理部的职员，我认为她是我们之中对那盘胶片最为熟悉、最清楚应当如何应对的人。

Noire: She may forget things, but she still has a wealth of knowledge. Her experience might just make the difference between failure and success.
菲林士多：尽管她有着一些健忘的小毛病，但那些经验和技巧我想并不会消失。
在关键时刻，也许她将发挥重要的作用。

Deputy Chief Elden: Alright, you've got a point. Ms. Latham, thanks for lending us your expertise.
埃尔登警长：……好吧，您说的有道理。
那么就请莱瑟姆小姐发挥您的专业知识，助我们一臂之力吧。

Elden finally nods. Loggerhead lights up.
埃尔登最终点了点头。
那只摄像头立刻便亮了起来。

Loggerhead: Great! Just leave it to me. I can deal with the film.
空脑袋：太好了！和那盘胶片相关的事情就交给我吧。

Loggerhead: I've rewatched all my related memories, so I remember every detail, even down to the scratches on its surface.
空脑袋：我已经把所有相关记忆都复习了一遍，现在的我就连那盘胶片身上有几条划痕都记得清清楚楚!

With Loggerhead officially permitted to join, the final member of the operation team is the last to arrive.
在基金会神秘学藏品管理部的少女被允许加入后，作战计划中的最后一名成员也终于姗姗来迟。

Liang Yue: There you are.
梁月：……原来你们在这里。

Liang Yue: Everyone was gone when I left the changing room. I thought something was ...
梁月： 我换好衣服出来，发现你们都不在了，还以为出了什么变故——

Liang Yue: What's wrong?
梁月： ……怎么了？

An-an Lee: Waaah! The costume fits you so well. Fancy wor. It doesn't even look like a costume. Much fancier than that.
泥鳋的士： 哎呀，靓女，你这身衣服衬你肤色！
看着很讲究噢，不像是戏服？

An-an Lee: You're like the best parade dancer I've ever seen. There's no way the Nightpiercer will spot you.
泥鳋的士： 穿上这一身，你可比谁都像社火游行中的一份子。
就算那个嫌犯瞪大眼，在人群中瞧见你的时候恐怕也很难认出来。

An-an Lee: Look at her, Uncle Zhōu. So cool ah-hor?
泥鳋的士： 周叔！你看，是不是很好看？

The Chinatown investigator scrutinizes Liáng from head to toe before letting out a derisive snort.
泥鳋的士转过头，唤来终于结束了对警员们穿戴社火游行服饰的斯巴达式指导的男子。他用挑剔的目光将梁月周身打量了一个遍，最终冷哼了一声。

Private Investigator: Is that the Liáng's family ritual dress? Let me see. Hmm. Good, you're wearing it right. Nice to know that at least some kids remember their traditions. You better not dishonor your family wearing this, kid.
民间侦探： 是你们梁家祭祀用的服饰？穿得倒是没有毛病……难得你这小姑娘还没有忘本。只盼你不要给这身衣服丢了脸。

Deputy Chief Elden: My thoughts exactly.
埃尔登警长： 这一次我同意旁边这位侦探先生的看法。

Deputy Chief Elden: Everything's in place. You sure you can perform this time, vigil? I don't want a repeat of last time.
埃尔登警长： 潜入社火游行的准备已经妥当，但问题在于面对嫌犯时，你是否能够正常发挥出你的实力？我不想再接到和那天晚上一样的报告了。

Deputy Chief Elden: The alley out back's empty. Show us what you've got.
埃尔登警长： 后门连通的那条巷子没有什么人——让我们看看你的决心吧。

He gestures to the officers, motioning them to line up before Liáng.
他向身后连同波蒂埃在内的几名警员打了一个手势，将他们唤到身边，在梁月面前排成了一排。

Each officer stands tall and imposing, forming what feels like a solid wall before Liáng. Refusing to shy away, she squares her shoulders and meets their gazes head-on.
每个警员都人高马大，梁月感到面前就像是有一堵高墙。
但梁月选择光明正大地仰起头与他们对视，目光没有丝毫闪躲。

Liang Yue: Yes, sir. I will prove myself to you.
梁月： 当然，长官。我会向您证明我的决心。

After several rounds of trials, Liáng remains standing, her expression firm and determined, her gaze burning with resolve. Satisfied, Elden nods.
轮番几场比试过后，少女仍然挺立在原地，表情沉着而坚韧，目光满怀斗志。埃尔登终于满意地点了点头。

Deputy Chief Elden: Looks like I've got nothing to worry about. You're ready, kid.
埃尔登警长： 看起来你已经准备好了，那么我就没有什么好说的了。

He rolls up his sleeve and checks the time on his watch.
他挽起袖口，借大街上透过来的灯火照亮手表的表盘确认时间。

Deputy Chief Elden: Parade's starting soon. I'll go get dressed. The rest of you—
埃尔登警长：快到时间了，我回去把衣服换上。你们——

Noire: I need to talk to Ms. Liáng. Could you give us a moment?
菲林士多：我还有些话想要和梁小姐聊聊，警官们不妨先进去吧。

Poitier: Don't be late.
波蒂埃：……别错过时间哦。

Poitier glances at them before following the others back inside.
波蒂埃看了她们一眼，最终和埃尔登一样没再多说什么，转身先行进了屋。

The alley suddenly feels empty.
小巷一下子空荡了下来。

Liáng waits quietly for Noire to speak, but she never does. She simply stares at the distant lights, as if the revelry and noise belonged to another world.
梁月等待着菲林士多切入正题，却并未如愿。
她只是看着远处的灯火，那些热闹与喧嚣恍若隔世。

Eventually, Liáng can wait no longer.
最终梁月按捺不住先开了口。

Liang Yue: Why me, Ms. Noire?
梁月：……菲林士多导演，为什么是我?

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The cheers and laughter of the Shèhuǒ Parade echo through the alley, muffled and distant.
唐人街沉浸在一片社火游行的热闹氛围中，但那些欢声与笑语传入这条偏僻的小巷时，却已经像是隔着一面玻璃般不再真切。

Liang Yue: You could've just told Elden about what happened between the three of you. You could've shown him the threatening letter.
梁月：……奇星小姐和您以及何日君小姐过去的事也好，您收到的那封“威胁信”也罢，您本来可以直接告诉埃尔登警长他们的。

Liang Yue: Maybe then he wouldn't have made the order to shoot the target if necessary. Yes, Ms. Qí Xīng has committed multiple assaults, but she hasn't killed anyone.
梁月：我的确不支持长官他们“如有必要，将对嫌疑人予以击毙”的做法……
奇星小姐虽然已经屡次作案，但目前为止受害者中还没有出现死者。

Liang Yue: I don't think she deserves to die. So, as I promised, I will do my best to catch her alive.
梁月：我认为她罪不至死。
我会像答应您的那样，尽全力活捉奇星小姐，将其制服。

Liang Yue: That being said, if, and I mean if ...
梁月：但如果——我是说如果。

She takes a deep breath.
她深吸一口气。

Liang Yue: If drastic measures have to be taken, I will not hesitate.
梁月：如果出现了不得不采取极端手段的情况，我也绝不会犹豫。

Liáng's final words are anything but polite. She holds her breath as she awaits Noire's response. After a brief silence, Noire speaks.
梁月最后一句话说得并不客气。她屏住呼吸，等待着菲林士多的回复。
短暂的沉默后，菲林士多开了口。

Noire: Ā Xīng was a good actress.
菲林士多：阿星是个好演员。

Liáng anticipated all kinds of responses from Noire, but not this one.
梁月预想过菲林士多可能会有的诸多反应，但显然对方的这一句话并不在梁月的预料之中。

Liang Yue: ...?
梁月：……?

Noire: Yes, she was a skilled martial artist with remarkable control over her arcane skill, but that's not what makes a successful actress.
菲林士多：阿星能够火起来，靠的不仅仅是她擅长打戏、擅长神秘术。

Noire: Before we'd even start shooting, she'd have everything memorized—her lines, her movements, even the details of her expression. She'd take as many shots as were necessary to get the scene right.
菲林士多：每一个剧本她都会背得滚瓜烂熟，每一场戏她都会私底下练习无数遍……我喊的每一次NG，只有阿星从来不会有怨言。

Noire: As you know, I was a perfectionist, always taking it too far. Many of my crew quit halfway through my projects.
菲林士多：过去的我不知道分寸，想要精益求精，表现出来却是过于严苛，让很多人随我们走到一半就掉了队。

Noire: Even Teresa struggled sometimes. She told me more than once that she couldn't do it anymore.
菲林士多：就连泰瑞莎也常有脚步虚浮的时候，几次都提出说“撑不下去了”……

Noire: Only Ā Xīng could keep up with my pace. In fact, she'd often be a few steps ahead.
菲林士多：但只有阿星跟了上来。
她不仅仅跟了上来，有时甚至会与我并驾齐驱，甚至走得更快。

Noire: Because she shared my vision—that drive for something better, no matter the cost.
菲林士多：因为我们都想要“更好”的东西，为此不惜代价。

Noire: She was a good actress indeed.
菲林士多：——她是个好演员。

Noire: I know that we'll probably never be partners again, but I still don't want her to be treated like this.
菲林士多：也许我们这辈子不会再有合作的机会，但她也不应当被这样对待。

In Liáng's memories, Noire was always smiling.
在梁月的印象中，菲林士多似乎总是笑着的。

Sometimes friendly, sometimes distant, with the mischievousness of a child, or the cunning and unyielding pride of a woman totally in control.
或和睦，或疏离，有时会露出几分如同孩童般的调皮，偶尔又会透出叫人心生忌惮的狡猾与一切尽在把控之中的傲气。

But at this moment, when she turns her head, there is no smile. What burns quietly in her eyes is something akin to rage.
但此刻，当她转过头来时——那张面孔上却并无笑意。
在她的双眼中安静燃烧的，是某种近似于“愤怒”的意志。

Noire: You said you were going to figure out the truth. Well, it seems you and I agree that things aren't as simple as they appear.
菲林士多：当你来找我的时候，提到了要“寻找真相”……因此，我想你和我有一样的猜测。

Noire: The Arcanum Containment Department's security system should be almost unbreakable. So how is it that Ms. Scott, a regular staff member with no special skills, managed to break through it?
菲林士多：理应滴水不漏的基金会神秘学藏品管理部，为什么会被斯考特小姐那样看起来并无太多过人之处的小角色突破防护系统?

Noire: And why was she selected to go after Ms. Latham? What was she about to say before that needle pierced her neck?
菲林士多：又为什么偏偏是斯考特小姐被选中来追捕莱瑟姆?
在被阿星袭击之前，她当时又想要说什么?

Noire: Ā Xīng's actions don't make sense either. After all these years, why has she decided to take revenge now? Is it because she found the film?
菲林士多：在阿星的身上也同样有着诸多疑问。
时隔多年，她为什么选择现在行动？仅仅是因为《三燕归巢》重现人间吗?

Noire: There are simply far too many coincidences. If one of my writers wrote a script like this, they'd be fired on the spot.
菲林士多：若说这些都是偶然，未免过于巧合了。
要是有人敢在我的手下写出这样的剧本，我一定会把他扔出片场的。

Liang Yue: You mean there's something else going on behind all this.
梁月：——您是说在这一系列事件的背后，还有隐情。

Noire gives her a look of approval.
菲林士多给了她一个赞许的眼神。

Noire: The scene has been staged. I can feel it.
菲林士多：我能够感觉到舞台的存在。

Noire: The lights, the cameras, the cast, they're all in position, and when the clapperboard claps, the movie will begin.
菲林士多：摄像机和灯光都已经就位，演员们已在后台待命，只等着场记板开合和一声号令，一场好戏就即将上演。

Noire: And this time, I'm not sitting behind the camera, but in front of it.
菲林士多：和往日不同的是，我这个通常站在摄影机后面的人，也被拎到了镜头之下。

Noire: Ms. Liáng, I've been holding back. I apologize for that.
菲林士多：执夜人小姐，你前两次拜访剧组时，我并未坦诚相待，而是有许多保留。
我在这里向你道歉。

Noire: I hadn't figured out which role you'd play in this movie.
菲林士多：因为当时的我想要弄清楚，你究竟在这场戏中扮演的是什么样的角色。

Liang Yue: If you're saying this to try to get me to talk about the "behind the scenes" of my life, I'm afraid you'll be disappointed.
梁月：……如果您希望通过我得知更多关于“幕后”的信息，恐怕我要令您失望了。

Noire: No, of course not. You got me wrong.
菲林士多：不，当然不是这样的。
你误会了。

She waves a hand dismissively, her expression light, but her eyes still blazing.
她笑着摆了摆手，表情云淡风轻，眼神却极亮。

Noire: I'm a director. I don't act in movies made by others.
菲林士多：我可是导演，我不演别人导的戏。

Noire: Ā Xīng, Ms. Latham, Ms. Scott—the camera's focused on them, too. But none of us know where the story will go.
菲林士多：阿星、我的新朋友莱瑟姆小姐，还有那名基金会的职员斯考特小姐……我想她们也和我一样，被放在了镜头前，却并没有拿到属于我们的剧本。

Something stirs in Liáng's chest.
梁月的心中一动。

Liang Yue: You mean, Ms. Qí Xīng's being manipulated?
梁月：您是说……奇星小姐很可能是被什么人利用了？

Liang Yue: I've considered that possibility, but who's the one behind the camera? What do they want?
梁月：我也考虑过这个可能性，但……是被什么人，又是为了什么？

Noire: All I know is that if Ā Xīng continues down this path, there will be no happy ending for her.
菲林士多：我只知道一件事，那就是这样下去，等待阿星的并不会是什么美满的结局。

Noire: I understand that she's trying to reach something she's always strived for, but whoever's orchestrating this won't let her get it.
菲林士多：阿星希望找回她想要的那个结局。但在那不知名的幕后人手中的剧本里，恐怕故事最终并不会如她所愿那般发展。

Noire: I've done that to her before, and it was a huge mistake. I won't let that happen again.
菲林士多：……我曾经对她做过类似的事，而那是个错误。
我不会再让她遭到同样的对待。

Liang Yue: What are you going to do?
梁月：您打算怎么做？

Noire smiles.
菲林士多笑了笑。

Noire: Since coming to Hollywood, there's one thing I've found difficult to accept.
菲林士多：来到荷里活这边打拼后，有一件事让我很是不赞同。

Noire: The producers always stick to the script. They're obsessed with it. Changes are incredibly rare.
菲林士多：这边的制片人对电影是否完全忠实于剧本拍摄似乎有某种执念。
写好了的剧本，往往不允许半点修改。

Noire: But that's not how we do it in Hong Kong. The script's finished? And so what? Things will always come up during shooting. You have to be flexible if you want to make truly great art.
菲林士多：但那不是我们香港电影人的作风，剧本写好了又如何？
实际拍摄时，总会遇到各种情况，必须灵活应对。

Noire: If a moment of inspiration were to strike me and I weren't allowed to add it to the movie, then you may as well just kill me there.
菲林士多：若是灵光一闪，想到一个更好的主意，却不被允许将它拍出来……
哈，那还不如杀了我。

Liáng takes a moment to understand all this.
梁月微怔后，明白了她的意思。

Liang Yue: You want to change the script.
梁月：您想要修改剧本。

Noire: Precisely. But we have a small issue.
菲林士多：但这里有个小问题。

Noire gestures to her legs resting on the wheelchair.
菲林士多伸出手，示意自己摆放在轮椅上的双腿。

Noire: As you can see, I'm not exactly ready to jump to my feet and into the action. I'm better at working behind the camera than I am in front of it.
菲林士多：如你所见，我这副身体要活动起来还是不太灵活的。
更何况，比起站在镜头前，我更善于幕后工作。

Noire: So, I need a protagonist.
菲林士多：我需要一名主演。

Noire: One who's as eager as I am to change the script and find that perfect ending. Are you interested?
菲林士多：一名和我同样渴望修改这不知由谁人撰写的剧本，演绎一个圆满结局的主演。怎么样，有兴趣吗?

She reaches a hand out to Liáng.
她向梁月伸出手。

Liang Yue: It would be an honor.
梁月：……这是我的荣幸，导演。

And Liáng takes it in her own.
而梁月握住了那只手。

Deputy Chief Elden: Attention! Attention, please! Noire will be shooting her movie during the Shèhuǒ Parade as planned.
埃尔登警长：全体注意，全体注意。
菲林士多导演将依照原定的拍摄计划，在社火游行中进行电影拍摄。

Deputy Chief Elden: Let's go over the plan one more time. Group A will hide among the cast; group B, cameramen, and group C—you're in the crowd. Once Qí Xīng appears, close in and arrest her as soon as possible.
埃尔登警长：按照作战计划，A 组伪装为剧组演员，B 组混入拍摄的工作人员之中，C 组在人群中进行警戒。一旦嫌犯奇星露面，立刻予以抓捕。

Private Investigator: Got it. We're all set, too.
民间侦探：……收到，我们这边也准备好了。

Deputy Chief Elden: Good. Everyone, take your positions.
埃尔登警长：很好，那么全体各就各位——作战开始。

Qi Xing: Alright, Noire. The time has come.
奇星：……好了，差不多该开始了，菲林士多。

Qi Xing: This will be our final scene.
奇星：这是我们的最后一场戏了。

Tourist: Huh? What's going on? That light's so bright.
游客：嗯？怎么回事，灯好像有些刺眼……

Chinatown Resident: Woah. I'm feeling kinda dizzy.
唐人街居民：我好像有些眼花——

Child: Mommy, I-I'm scared.
孩童：妈妈，我……我害怕！

Liang Yue: That arcane fluctuation—it's from Reunion of the Three Swallows.
梁月：这股神秘术气息……是《三燕归巢》!

Liang Yue: But, how did she ...?
梁月：但……这怎么可能?

真心话
Truthful Exchange 小径

So, things went sideways. That's what happens when you put guns in the hands of amateurs.
???: “金手指”扣下了扳机。产生了远超预料的结果，非专业人士就是这样。

But you handled the water better this time. You controlled your breathing, kept your airways clear, and this time you remembered to lie back and float.
???: 降低心率、收缩喉管、关闭气道，与上一次溺水时相比，这次你做得不错，至少没那么狼狈了。

选项 / Choices

1. Who are you?
1. 你又是哪位?

Does it matter? I'm all you've got. We're at war—bullets flying, wounds festering, typhoid, cholera, and all the worst of it. It's a living hell, and only fools think there's any honor in it.
???: 我是谁不重要。设想我们身处于硝烟滚滚的边境，后方的军营里没有心理医生，军官们大声地谈论着伤寒、霍乱、疟疾和肝炎，只有傻瓜才会将开肠破肚视为荣誉的象征。

You never expect to see a familiar face again, not in times like these.
???: 这种场合的人员变动总是很快，你不能奢望来做报告的总是同一个人。

Now I need you to listen. There's something you should know.
???: 现在请听我说，有一件事需要汇报。

选项 / Choices

1. What things?
1. 什么事?

The raid on the river was a ploy, and its mastermind is an old acquaintance. As for the ones who carried it out—you already heard about them this morning.
???: 这次爆炸的背后藏着一场组织化的阴谋，档案袋的正面和反面分别写下了一个组织的名字。一个是你的老对头；而另一个你今早才有所耳闻。

They promised their followers they'd push south, and they did. With their supplies secured by a mysterious third party, they paraded through every town along the way, playing as "liberators" and taking out anyone they decided were their enemies.
???: 他们许诺了会向南去，于是便能靠着第三方的物资耀武扬威，把自己比作救世主，用暴力铲除异己，既无组织也无行动纲领，可笑。

They swelled in numbers, larger than any local gang or cult had ever gotten before.
???: 而更可笑的是他们借此收获了比以往更多追随者，一般的黑帮与宗教远不能及。

Now they swarm across the land like a school of red-bellied piranhas. Always hungry, ready to tear apart anything that crosses their path.
???: 现在他们就像是一批红腹锯脂鲤群，当地人称呼这种鱼为“食人鱼”。在河里就能闻到血的味道，给每艘船都咬出几个洞。

选项 / Choices

1. What happened to the others?
1. 其他人呢?

Chances are they're doing fine, just like you.
???: 既然连你都没事，你是否可以乐观地推断其他人都度过了这次危机?

Would've been nice if you caught what that little executioner and that "gold-hearted" gambler were talking about during their dice game. Guess you'll have to ask her later.
???: 遗憾的是，你没能听清小行刑官跟乐善好施的游客在骰子游戏之余的闲谈。你可以在稍后再质问她。

选项 / Choices

1. Why don't *you* tell me instead?
1. 正面回答我

Listen, I'm not here to run your errands or play your messenger boy, so ask nicely.
???: 我不是你的传令官，也不是你的亲兵，我也不想要这两个头衔，所以——

There's nothing more I need to tell you. For now.
???: 目前来说，我没有义务继续向你汇报。

Excerpt from the New York Times
《纽约新闻报》节选

英文 / ENGLISH

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

中文 / CHINESE

前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。

于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

因果定律 · 2/2
The Law of Causation · 2/2 SC-18

The lights on either side of the street blur, polluting the night sky, turning it into a swirling mess.
——街道两侧的灯光融化了。
它污染了纯净的夜空，让它变成了一片驳杂。

It's as if everything in sight has been tossed onto a painter's palette and smeared and blended. All definitions have been lost.
一切目之所及的景色都像是被丢入了调色盘之中，被一只无情的画笔搅动、混合，最终面目全非。

Chinatown Resident: What's happening?
唐人街居民：这是怎么回事?

Tourist: I-Is this part of the parade? How'd they do that?
游客：是什么社火游行里面的节目吗?
这是怎么做到的?

???: #$%&*(@!
???: ——

Chinatown Resident: Whoa, wait, what's this?
唐人街居民：等等，这是什么东西?!

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Stand back!
神秘学警察 I：小心，快退后——

A young officer rushes forward, positioning herself between the unknown monster and the Chinatown residents.
一名年轻的警员不假思索地冲上前去，挡在了那不知名的怪物与唐人街居民之间。

An-an Lee: Officer, head down!
泥鳐的士：靓女，低下头!

???: #$%&*(@!!!
???: ——!!!

An-an Lee: Ha! Easy.
泥鳐的士：搞定。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Phew. Thank you. They teach you that in Hong Kong?
神秘学警察 I：谢……谢谢你，香港小姑娘。

Private Investigator: That thing's nothing like the critters you're used to dealing with. What were you thinking rushing in like that?
民间侦探：刚才那东西和你们惯常处理的寻常魔精可不是一类东西，你这丫头知道怎么对付吗，就冲上去?

Private Investigator: Hmph! You're totally out of your league.
民间侦探：哼，自不量力!

Arcane Affairs Officer I: It was about to attack. What else was I supposed to do?
神秘学警察 I：事出突然，我怎么想得到那么多?

Private Investigator: *tut*
民间侦探：……啧。

He swallows whatever snarky remark he had planned, instead looking around at the eerie figures shifting in the shadows.
男子听到这个回答，吞下了原本那些打算冷嘲热讽的话语。
他环顾四周无数蠢蠢欲动的诡异人影，皱起了眉。

Private Investigator: They look like ghosts, but there's something different about them.
民间侦探：看着像是鬼魂，却不像是常见的任何一种……

Private Investigator: So, little ghost hunter, can that machine of yours tell us what they are?
民间侦探：怎么样，小丫头?
你的那套怪机器能辨出它们的底细吗?

An-an Lee: One second, Uncle Zhōu. Lily's working on it.
泥鳐的士：别急，周叔，Lily 正在尝味道了。

Under the bewildered gazes of the officers, the young ghost hunter's human-headed lily lets out a chilling, eerie laugh.
在警员诧异的目光下，年轻捉鬼人背后那朵拥有人形头颅的诡异百合发出了令人胆寒的怪异笑声。

An-an's expression changes.
然而在笑声过后，泥鳐的士也变了脸色。

An-an Lee: What?! You mean, that was a living man's soul?
泥鳐的士：什么？你是说……那是生魂?

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Just got confirmation that this thing's covering the whole of Chinatown. Comms are down, and we can't seem to leave either.
神秘学警察 I：已确认异常神秘术现象覆盖范围是整个唐人街!
和外界的通信无法接通，尝试离开的行动也以失败告终——

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Arcane humanoids spotted in all directions. Don't seem to be critters or the Beyond. Must be some kind of arcane creation.
神秘学警察 II：各处都出现了近似人形的神秘学个体，不像是魔精或是超自然者，我们认为这是某种神秘术的造物!

Arcane Affairs Officer II: They're everywhere and immune to regular bullets. Arcane skills and specialized bullets break them apart for a while, but then their bodies just morph back together.
神秘学警察 II：它们的数量极多，已经确认普通子弹对它们无效，神秘术和特殊弹虽然能够将其击破，但它们的身体很快就会重组……

Arcane Affairs Officer II: No casualties so far, but people are panicking. What do we do, Chief?
神秘学警察 II：目前还没有出现伤亡，但群众已经开始恐慌，这样下去……警长，请求指示!

???: #$%&*(@!
???: ——

Deputy Chief Elden: Sorry, not my type.
埃尔登警长：抱歉了，但你这副尊容实在不是我欣赏的类型。

The specialized bullets successfully repel the shadowy beings, but their supply is limited. Elden has to fall back, yelling into his chameleon comm as he does so.
特制的子弹击退了人形的怪影，但这种子弹数量有限，埃尔登不得不一边移动一边朝胸口的金属蜥蜴通信器怒吼。

Deputy Chief Elden: Everyone, keep calm. Groups A and C, protecting the public is your top priority. These things seem to follow anything that moves. Lure them away.
埃尔登警长：——所有人不要慌张！A 组和 C 组的最优先任务变更为保护市民，那些怪物看起来会追着人移动，将那些怪物引开!

Deputy Chief Elden: Ms. Lee, Mr. Zhōu. Gather as many civilians as you can and guide them to a safe place.
埃尔登警长：泥鳐的士小姐和周先生！
能请你们让你们的人帮忙引导居民，到安全的地方去吗?

He expected the private investigator to fire back with his usual sarcasm, but to his surprise, his response is immediate and to the point.
他本做好了会被那个一向对神秘学犯罪科有意见的民间侦探呛上几句的准备，但没想到通信器对面立刻就传来了干脆的回应。

Private Investigator: No problem. They know us. I'm sure we'll be able to calm them down.
民间侦探：没问题，交给我们吧。
我们这些熟面孔去说，相信也容易让大家冷静下来。

Private Investigator: I'll tell them they're special effects. They all know that a movie was being shot here. That should help. At least long enough to get them to safety.
民间侦探：我会和他们说这是在拍电影——正好街坊们原本就知道菲林士多导演要在社火游行上拍戏这件事——这应该对避免恐慌有些作用，但肯定撑不了太久。

Private Investigator: That means you guys are gonna have to figure this out yourselves. Show me what you've got, Arcane Affairs.
民间侦探：怎么解决这一切，恐怕就要看你们的了。
让我看看你们的能耐吧，神秘学警察。

Deputy Chief Elden: We won't let you down.
埃尔登警长：……没问题。我们不会让你失望的。

He takes another deep breath, filling his body with renewed strength.
他重新吸进了一口气，让空气与力气充满自己的肺和身体。

Deputy Chief Elden: Group B, hold your positions. Target's probably trying to distract us with these monsters. What's your status? Report immediately.
埃尔登警长：B 组，坚守岗位！这很可能是嫌犯吸引我们注意力的计策。
那边情况怎么样了？立即报告！

Poitier: This is Poitier. Same thing's happening at the rear of the parade. Noire's fine though.
波蒂埃：这里是波蒂埃，我们在的队伍后方也发生了同样的异象，但菲林士多导演没事！

Deputy Chief Elden: Keep it that way. The rest of you, keep your eyes peeled. The target could appear at any time.
埃尔登警长：很好，保护好她！
其他人都给我睁大眼睛——我们的嫌犯就在这里！

Deputy Chief Elden: Camera-head, any idea what's going on?
埃尔登警长：摄像头女孩，你能搞清楚发生了什么事吗?

The Arcanum Containment Department employee is the person most likely to understand the current anomaly.
这名神秘学藏品管理部的职员的确是最有可能，对眼下的异状给出一个解释的人了。

Loggerhead: I think Chinatown's been sealed inside an arcane barrier created by the film.
空脑袋：看起来……是整个唐人街都被拉进了《三燕归巢》制造的结界“胶片领域”中！

Loggerhead: There's nothing in the records about this, but these arcane fluctuations are definitely from the film.
空脑袋：档案中从没有记载过它有这样大的威力，
但这股神秘术气息的确属于那张“被诅咒的胶片”没错！

Deputy Chief Elden: What about those ghost things? I don't remember the file saying it could spawn spirits out of thin air.
埃尔登警长：那么那些像是鬼魂一样的东西是什么?
我可不记得档案里写过那张“被诅咒的胶片”拥有制造鬼魂的能力!

Loggerhead: Well, I don't know. Reunion of the Three Swallows can play and record, that's for sure.
空脑袋：这个……这个我也不明白,《三燕归巢》拥有的能力是“放映”和“重摄”没有错。

Loggerhead: But even if its power has been enhanced somehow, it probably wouldn't develop a completely unrelated ability.
空脑袋：按理来讲即使因为某些原因它的力量变强了，也不太可能进化出和原本毫无关系的能力来……

An-an Lee: You're right, because it's not unrelated.
泥鳐的士：——你说得对，那不是无关的能力。

An-an's voice crackles through the communicator. Even the usually carefree ghost hunter sounds a little tense.
通信器中传出泥鳐的士的声音。
似乎一向自在快活的捉鬼人少女，此时的声音中也带上了几分紧张。

An-an Lee: Remember the film's victims? Part of them was taken away by its record ability.
泥鳐的士：你们还记得那些“被诅咒的胶片”受害者吗?
那些被胶片的“重摄”能力夺取部分神智的人?

An-an Lee: What they lost was part of their spiritual energy and memories—their Saam Wan Chat Paak, or "three souls and seven spirits."
泥鳐的士：他们失去了部分精神能量和记忆，用我们的说法，就是丢了一部分“三魂七魄”。

An-an Lee: These monsters are actually the Saam Wan Chat Paak of the victims.
泥鳐的士：——你们面前的这些“怪物”，就是那些受害者丢失的精神能量和记忆。

Loggerhead: They're the victims' spiritual energy? But how did the film do that?
空脑袋：你是说这些东西是人们丢失的精神力量？但……怎么会变成这样?

The chilling appearance of the phantoms makes it difficult to connect them with what An-an has declared them to be.
那些徘徊在街道上的鬼影令人不寒而栗的尊容，让人很难将它们与泥鳐的士所宣告的存在联系在一起。

An-an Lee: Hmm. I'm not sure, but Lily's never wrong. So let's not try to eliminate these things.
泥鳐的士：具体原因我也不清楚，但 Lily 的舌头是不会出错的。
所以即使阿 sir 们找到了“消灭”这些东西的手段，最好也暂时不要动用。

An-an Lee: Or the victims will never get their Saam Wan Chat Paak back.
泥鳐的士：——如果我们还想要那些被胶片影响的受害者们，恢复原状的话。

An-an's voice, transmitted through the DAA communicator, reaches Liáng's ears.
泥鳐的士的话语通过神秘学犯罪科的通信器，自然也传入了梁月的耳中。

Liang Yue: Essentially, she's holding everyone in Chinatown hostage.
梁月：这相当于整个唐人街的人，都成为了人质。

Liang Yue: We certainly weren't expecting that.
梁月：我们的确没有想到这一点。

Liáng looks at the figure standing just a few meters ahead.
梁月看向站在前方数米之外的那人。

The frightened crowd clings to their family and friends, frantic and scared.
周围惊恐的人们各自与同行的亲朋好友聚在一起，在七嘴八舌的各式猜测中相互安慰着彼此。

And those who are alone gather with others near the dim glow of the shopfronts in search of any semblance of warmth and reassurance.
那些落单的人也凑到了同类的身边，在尚且能够发出正常光亮、给人以一种温暖感聊以慰籍的商铺旁等待着好消息。

They have no way of knowing that the one responsible for all this is standing just a few steps away.
——他们自然无从知晓，令他们身处如此险地的罪魁祸首就在咫尺之间。

Qi Xing: I didn't want it to come to this.
奇星：这并非我的本意。

Qi Xing: This was between me and Noire. But you just couldn't leave it alone, could you? So here we are.
奇星：原本是我和菲林士多之间的事，我没有想到会有这么多无关人士插手，只好出此下策。

Qi Xing: Sounds like you already know what this film reel is capable of. Good. Saves me the trouble of explaining it.
奇星：听起来你们知道这盘东西究竟有着什么样的能耐，这很好，可以省下许多让我多费口舌说明的工夫。

Qi Xing: Now, bring me Noire.
奇星：——把菲林士多带来吧。

恶与善的挽歌 · 1/2
False Dilemma · 1/2 SC-19

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Target spotted. I repeat, target spotted.
神秘学警察 I：发现嫌犯，重复，发现嫌犯！

Within moments of the plainclothes officer's words, the arriving police evacuate the crowd and seal off the street.
从第一个便衣注意到这里起不消片刻，四周的民众就被赶来的警员们疏散，整条街道被围了一个水泄不通。

The officers form an impenetrable barrier, trapping both the target and Liáng inside. They stand in a face-off.
警员们组成了密不透风的包围网，将那名堂而皇之现身的嫌犯，连同她面前的梁月一起围在了其中。

Chinatown Resident: What's going on? Who are they?
唐人街居民：发生什么了？那是谁?

The bystanders erupt into fervent speculation. Deputy Chief Elden steps into the containment zone.
被挡在外围的群众开始议论纷纷，最先踏进这条包围网的是梁月熟悉的身影。

Deputy Chief Elden: Impressive, Nightpiercer. This is a whole new level, even for you.
埃尔登警长：干得好，“针人”。
我没有想到你还能来上这么一出。

Deputy Chief Elden: Tell me, what did you pull to take control of that film reel?
埃尔登警长：告诉我，你到底是用了什么秘诀让那个东西这样听你的话?

Qi Xing: I didn't pull anything, officer.
奇星：我并没有使用任何的奇技淫巧，埃尔登警官。

Qi Xing: It chose to fulfill my wish. That's all.
奇星：——是它主动实现了我的愿望。

Liang Yue: Urgh ...
梁月： 呃……?!

Without warning, an excruciatingly sharp noise tears through her skull, sending waves of vertigo crashing over her.
毫无预兆的，令人头疼欲裂的尖锐噪音，伴随着天旋地转般的眩晕感钻入脑海。

For several agonizing seconds, she can hear nothing but the distant groans of the officers and bystanders suffering alongside her. It's a fight just to stay upright.
足足数秒，尽管隐约听到四周的警员和远处的居民们发出了痛苦的呻吟声，但梁月除了勉力支撑自己不软倒在地外，根本无法动弹。

When the assault on her senses finally subsides, the first thing she registers is a voice coming from her communicator.
对五感的残忍折磨终于褪去后，梁月首先捕捉到的是通信器中传来的报告声。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Chief! Something bad's happening.
神秘学警察 I： 不好了，警长——

The urgency in the officer's voice sets Liáng's nerves on edge, but then her tone shifts.
警员急迫的声音让梁月的心立刻吊了起来，但对面的人却话锋一转。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Wait, maybe it's good.
神秘学警察 I： 不，也许这是好事?

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Those things! Th-They've stopped moving. They're not attacking anymore.
神秘学警察 I： 那些人形的怪东西都停下了，它们……不再试图靠近，或是袭击市民了!

Deputy Chief Elden: You kidding?
埃尔登警长： 什么?

Liáng and Elden exchange a puzzled glance before scanning their surroundings. The shifting shadows have indeed stopped moving, and the reason is obvious.
梁月和埃尔登一同诧异地望向四周，见到那些影影绰绰的人形的确如报告中所说停止了行动，而原因显而易见。

Their wary gazes turn to their target. She's standing calmly in the middle of the street, unfazed by the array of loaded firearms aimed directly at her.
他们惊疑不定地看向那个身处包围圈中、被无数上了膛的手枪对准，却面不改色的嫌犯。

Qi Xing: I never wanted to get innocent people involved. As I said before, this is between me and Noire. Now, may I see my dear old friend?
奇星： 我说过，将无辜之人卷进来并非我的本意。
我已经展现了我的诚意，现在我能见见我的那位老朋友了吗?

Qi Xing: Heh, if you're worried about her safety, the little vigil can tag along.
奇星： 如果你们实在担心……这样吧，我可以允许那边的执夜人小姐陪同菲林士多一起。

Liáng and Elden exchange a look.
年轻的见习执夜人和她的临时长官交换了一个眼神。

Deputy Chief Elden: It's too dangerous.
埃尔登警长： ……太危险了。

Deputy Chief Elden: We've already put Noire at considerable risk, but pushing her right into the hands of a criminal? I don't think so.
埃尔登警长： 我承认在我们原本的计划中，菲林士多女士就已经承受了不小的风险。
但这和将她直接暴露在危险的神秘学家罪犯面前仍然是两回事。

Deputy Chief Elden: We can't put a civilian in danger like that. Besides, why would Qí Xīng let you go with her? You're walking right into a trap.
埃尔登警长：我们不能将普通人置于这样的险地。虽然奇星允许你护卫左右，但这反而更加蹊跷，其中恐怕有诈——

Noire: Trap or not, I'm afraid we don't have much choice.
菲林士多：但看起来我们也没有其他的选择了，不是吗?

Her voice isn't loud, but in this high-tension standoff, its slow and measured cadence feels completely out of place.
——那声音并不大，在眼下这番叫人精神紧绷的非常状况下，那人不徐不疾的嗓音是如此格格不入。

Poitier pushes Noire's wheelchair forward, placing her squarely in the spotlight.
波蒂埃推着菲林士多穿过人群，出现在众目睽睽之下。

Deputy Chief Elden: Poitier? What are you doing? I told you to hold position.
埃尔登警长：波蒂埃?!
我不是叫你原地待命，保护好菲林士多女士——

Noire raises a hand, smiling as she cuts off Elden's rising fury.
菲林士多抬手，笑着打断了大为光火的埃尔登的话。

Noire: Please don't blame Officer Poitier, sir. I forced her to bring me here.
菲林士多：请您不要责备波蒂埃警官，是我逼迫她带我来的。

Deputy Chief Elden: What? What the hell are you thinking?
埃尔登警长：你说什么?
好吧……你到底是怎么想的?

Noire: It's time I put an end to all of this.
菲林士多：我只是认为这一切应当做个了结。

Noire: No need to worry, officer. Our reliable vigil will keep me safe, isn't that right?
菲林士多：您放心，警长先生。
这位可靠的执夜人小姐会保护我的，对不对?

Liang Yue: Yes, of course. I will ensure Ms. Noire's safety, Chief. Leave it to me.
梁月：……当然。
请您放心将菲林士多导演的安全交给我吧，长官。

Elden studies Liáng's face for a moment before shifting his gaze to Qí Xīng. At last, he relents.
冷着脸的警长注视了梁月片刻，又看向不远处按兵不动、却随时可能发难的奇星，最终选择了妥协。

Deputy Chief Elden: Keep the target in check, Liáng.
埃尔登警长：稳住她，梁。

Keeping his eyes on the target, he leans in close to Liáng's ear and issues a low warning.
他凑到梁月的耳边，用余光示意那名被重重包围的危险嫌犯，低声耳语。

Deputy Chief Elden: James and the others are working on how to break this barrier we're in. Camera-head and that ghost hunter are helping them.
埃尔登警长：詹姆斯他们正在寻找打破结界的方法了，那名神秘学藏品管理部的机械女孩和基金会的捉鬼人女孩也在协助他们。

Deputy Chief Elden: Stay calm. We want to resolve this peacefully, if possible. Haven't forgotten what you learned in negotiation class, have you?
埃尔登警长：如非必要，没有必要冒险。
你肯定没有忘记你学过的谈判技巧吧，小执夜人?

Liang Yue: Of course not, sir. I got straight A's.
梁月：放心吧长官，那门课我拿的可是 A。

Poitier takes Liáng's other side and rests a firm hand on her shoulder.
波蒂埃也来到了梁月另一侧的身边，将手放在了她的肩膀上。

Poitier: Guard up, rookie, and straighten your back.
波蒂埃：小心点，菜鸟。但也挺起胸来，菜鸟。

Poitier: I get why you wanna wear this outfit, but you can get things done with or without it. Isn't that right, partner?
波蒂埃：我知道你为什么要换上这身衣服——但要我说，就算没有这身衣服你也能做到。对吗?

Liang Yue: Right, ma'am. I won't fail.
梁月：……当然，波蒂埃教官。
我会的。

Before pulling away, Poitier gives Liáng her usual rough pat on the back, but somehow, it causes Liáng's stiffness to melt away.
波蒂埃收回手前，又拍了拍梁月的后背，力度一如既往的略有些大，但梁月身体的僵硬却奇迹般地消失了。

Taking a steadying breath, she moves to Noire's side.
深吸一口气后，她来到菲林士多的身旁。

Liang Yue: Let's go, director. Time for the final scene.
梁月：——走吧，导演。
我们的最后一场戏即将开拍了。

Accompanied by Liáng, Noire wheels into the distorted world before them.
梁月陪同菲林士多乘着她的座驾，踏入面目全非的街道。

It's as if a surreal nightmare is unfolding before their eyes.
万物都似乎蒙上了一层不真实的色彩，目之所及的一切都像是一场噩梦。

Qi Xing: Look around you, Noire. Look at what we've done.
奇星：看到了吗，菲林士多?
这就是我们的所作所为。

Qí Xīng's gaze wanders over the bleeding lights and flickering shadows around her as she scrutinizes the cracks and distortions in this twisted realm unleashed by the cursed film reel.
她目不转睛地看着那些晕染的光与闪烁的阴影，盯着这片由“被诅咒的胶片”构筑的一方天地中的那些缺陷与污点。

But her expression holds no trace of admiration.
但她脸上的神情却和“欣赏”大相径庭。

Qi Xing: This is what her film, the very last work of our dearest friend, looks like now—tainted, twisted, and wicked.
奇星：这就是那盘胶片如今的模样。
那些肮脏的、扭曲的、罪恶的东西……污染了她生前留下的最后一部作品。

Qi Xing: All this is proof of our guilt—the blood on our hands.
奇星：这些污迹，就是我们的罪证。

Noire: So, what are you going to do about it?
菲林士多：……那么你又想要做什么呢?

Noire: Teresa's never coming back.
菲林士多：事到如今，泰瑞莎已经不在了。

Noire: She's dead.
菲林士多：她死了。

Noire doesn't shy away from the word. Though a note of sorrow lingers in her tone, she says it with a certain cold detachment.
菲林士多并没有避讳那个词，因此尽管她的语调中含着几分悲伤，听起来却也格外无情。

Noire: And you, playing hero, punishing those you deem evil. Does that make you feel better? You kill me, and then, what, kill yourself?
菲林士多：在现实中自诩为正义的代言人，惩罚那些你眼中的恶人……这会让你觉得更好受一些吗？现在你打算杀死我，然后呢？自杀？

Noire: That's how you'll atone for your failures? Forgive my bluntness, but how laughably naive you are.
菲林士多：这就是你赎罪的方式？
如果是这样，那么恕我直言——这未免过于偏执，也过于幼稚了。

Noire's voice has an uncharacteristic sharpness to it, but Qí Xīng shows no sign of wavering under her scrutiny.
菲林士多难得使用了尖锐的话语，但奇星却并未因她的质疑而动摇。

Instead, she smiles.
她反而笑了。

Qi Xing: Atone for my failures? Heh, you're way off.
奇星：赎罪？
不，不是这样的。

Qi Xing: You're right about one thing, though. She is gone. The person who cared for me more than anyone in the world ... dead.
奇星：你说的没错。那个待我无微不至、比我那亲生母亲还要关照我不知道多少倍的人……已经死了。

Qi Xing: When she gave me a shoulder to lean on, I pushed her away. I left her to die alone and in pain. How could I ever atone for that?
奇星：我沉溺在自己的苦恼中，推开了她。让她在孤独与痛苦中死去。
事到如今，赎罪又有什么意义呢？

Qi Xing: How could I ever expect her to forgive me? How selfish of me to even ask for that.
奇星：期待一个已死之人被感动，然后说“我原谅你了”？
那不过是自我满足而已。

Liáng furrows her brow in suspicion.
她话语中透露出的意思让梁月狐疑地皱起了眉。

Liang Yue: Then why can't you let it go?
梁月：既然你也明白这些道理，为什么不能放下呢？

Liang Yue: C07 is the hero who brings a happy ending, no matter what she's faced with. What you're doing now is anything but that.
梁月：C07 是给自己身边的人带来“圆满结局”的英雄，但奇星小姐……
你现在所寻求的，可不是什么“圆满结局”。

Qi Xing: "The hero who brings a happy ending, no matter what she's faced with." That's what I said in the behind-the-scenes interview of C07 II. I'm surprised you even remember that.
奇星：“圆满结局”……是第二部结尾花絮中，那次采访我说过的话？
真难为你还记得。

After a brief pause, she smiles again.
奇星微怔，随后笑了。

Qi Xing: But there'll be no happy ending for me.
奇星：对我来说，已经没有什么圆满的结局了。

Qi Xing: You probably heard that, after she died, I starred in a few movies with other directors.
奇星：也许你也知道……在何日君身死、我离开新艺术之后，我去了其他公司，与其他导演合作拍了几部电影。

Qi Xing: But they all went south, not because they weren't commercially successful or popular, but because I couldn't shake that feeling of disgust. I'd never felt that playing C07.
奇星：但它们都不尽如人意。不是票房的问题，而是我自己不满意——我没有办法找回拍摄 C07 那时候的感觉了。

Qi Xing: The cameras, the boom mics, the spotlights—the sight of them made me want to throw up, scream, do anything to run away from it all.
奇星：那些镜头，那些话筒，那些聚光灯……让我一见到，便会产生一种生理性的厌恶。我想呕吐，我想尖叫……我想逃跑。

Qi Xing: Eventually, I retired from acting. But that sense of disgust never left me. It haunted me wherever I went, whatever I did.
奇星：所以我告别了银幕。
但那种令人作呕的感觉仍然始终伴随着我，不论我走到哪里，都阴魂不散。

Qi Xing: I kept asking myself, "Why is this happening to me?" "Why can't I just act?" "Why?!"
奇星：所以我开始思考，为什么会这样?
事情为什么会走到今天这个地步？我又为什么会沦落到现在这个下场?

Qi Xing: Day and night, I wrestled with these questions. Until, one day, I found the answer.
奇星：我思考着这个问题。
一直、一直、一直思考着——然后终于有一天，我意识到了答案。

Her gaze burns with intensity, and yet, it carries a bone-chilling coldness. It is fixed firmly upon Noire.
她目光灼灼，眼神却冰冷彻骨，如同安静燃烧的烈焰，直指梁月身边的那人。

Qi Xing: It all began with a dire mistake, one that needs to be corrected.
奇星：——这一切都始于一个错误。因此它必须得到纠正。

Silver needles streak through the air in a sudden downpour.
银光乍现，将整个光怪陆离的世界切割开，如骤雨般袭来。

Liang Yue: Ms. Noire, get back!
梁月：菲林士多导演，请退后！

胶片之内
Inside the Film 小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.
???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。

选项 / Choices

1. Why a few years ago?
1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?

2. I want to move to the future.
2. 我要前进到未来

分支 1 / Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.
???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...
???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……

分支 2 / Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.
???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—
???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.
???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。

选项 / Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.
1. 好了，开始胡扯吧

2. No. I'm tired of you.
2. 不，我已经厌倦你了

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.
???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.
???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.
???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。

选项 / Choices

1. He must be respectable.
1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人

2. He might be powerful.
2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人

分支 2.1.1 / Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.
???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。

分支 2.1.2 / Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."
???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."
???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.
???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.
???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。

选项 / Choices

1. Where is she?
1. 她在哪儿?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.
???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.
???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.
???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?
???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."
???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.
???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.
???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.

???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.

???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Within the Film Reel: A New Born Consciousness

胶片之内：一个新诞生的意识

英文 / ENGLISH

Reel 1 – Scene 24 – Shot 9 – Take 3

Writer – He Rijun

Scene Description: An old house contested by sworn sisters is reduced to ruins in a fire. Covered in ash, the three lie amidst the rubble, drinking beer bought from a convenience store, and gazing out at the sunrise.

...

I must finish this film ... The film must be finished. Only then can I be whole.

...

Added Scene: An old woman drops her cane, crying tears of joy: "I'm cured! My family won't need to spend money anymore!" A classic technique—blending social issues with sentimentality.

...

Added Scene: A man kneels, crying out: "I'll kill that con artist! I'll avenge my mom!" A perfect emotional outburst for the film's midpoint.

...

Added Scene: A woman paces in her room after watching the film's teaser. She mutters, "This isn't your usual work. The reel has absorbed your hatred—it reeks of malice ... I'm not like the others, I believe sinners must be punished. This time, I'll ensure your film has a perfect ending. Purging sin with death? That's perfect—just right for the finale."

中文 / CHINESE

卷号：1 场号：24 镜号：9 次数：3

编剧：何日君

场景描述：结义姐妹所争夺的老房子在火灾中化为废墟，灰头土脸的三人躺在废墟上，喝着从便利店买来的啤酒，眺望远方的黎明。

……

我必须拍完这部电影……电影必须拍完，我必须变得完整。

……

新增拍摄片段：一个老婆婆丢了拐杖，喜极而泣：“我的病好了，家里不用花钱了！”经典技巧，社会议题与抒情相结合。

……

一个男人跪在地上哭泣，大声喊叫：“我要杀了那个骗子！替妈报仇！”一段适合插入电影中段的情绪爆发。

……

新增拍摄片段：一个看了片花的女人在房间里踱步，她喃喃道：“这不是你的水平。胶片吸收了你的怨恨，这是邪祟的气息……我和他们不一样，罪人必须受罚。这一次，我会为你的电影带来完美结局。以死净化罪人？这很好，正适合一部电影的结局。”

恶与善的挽歌 · 2/2

False Dilemma · 2/2 SC-19

Arcane Affairs Officer: Ammo's running low, sir.
神秘学警察：长官，特殊弹即将耗尽！

Deputy Chief Elden: They must be gaining power from this barrier we're in.
埃尔登警长：是身处主场之中，令它获得了更强的力量吗？该死！

Qi Xing: I hate you, Noire.
奇星：我从来不喜欢你，菲林士多。

Qi Xing: You were born with a silver spoon and exceptional talent. You took everything for granted. You looked down on everyone else.
奇星：打从一出生就有着立于人上的资本，所以理所当然般心高气傲、眼高于顶……

Qi Xing: I've always hated you.
奇星：我从来都不喜欢你。

Liang Yue: Ms. Noire, hold on!
梁月：菲林士多女士，抓住我！

Noire: That was close.
菲林士多：哇哦，这可真是……千钧一发。

Liang Yue: Ms. Qí Xīng, is this really what you want to do? Are you really going to kill Ms. Noire?
梁月：奇星小姐，你确定要这样做吗？
你真的想要将菲林士多女士……？

Liang Yue: You have to stop. This is completely meaningless.
梁月：你所做的这一切，都根本没有意义！

Qi Xing: Hah. Meaningless? No, this is exactly what needs to happen. Every story must have an ending, after all.
奇星：怎么会没有意义呢？
所有的故事都必须有个结局。

Qi Xing: The past has held me prisoner for far too long.
奇星：现在的我无法感知当下，也无法前往未来——过去囚禁了我。

Qi Xing: I need an ending, a conclusion, so I can finally leave it behind me. Only then ...
奇星：所以我必须给我的过去画上一个终止符，然后——

Qi Xing: ... can I reach my perfect grand finale.
奇星：——迎来我的“圆满结局”。

Qi Xing: Qiángliáng?
奇星：……险道兽强梁？

Qi Xing: Impossible! You didn't chant the incantation.
奇星：不对，明明你还没有念诵那个咒语……

Liang Yue: This time, I won't hesitate.
梁月：这一次我不会再犹豫，也不会再动摇了。

Liang Yue: You were my inspiration, Ms. Qí Xīng. Like the countless kids who were once lost, I found myself in C07.
梁月：奇星，我曾经憧憬过你，也曾经为你和 C07 所救赎。

Liang Yue: And that's exactly why I have to stop you.
梁月：——正因为如此，我会阻止你。

Liang Yue: Arise Qiángliáng, swift and fierce! Banish all evil and cleanse this place!
梁月：强梁既出，罔有不韪。斩杀凶咎，枭截不祥！

Qi Xing: ...!
奇星：……！

直至消逝的光
Until the Light Fades SC-20

A brilliant flash splits the darkened sky in two, and a thunderous roar scatters the shadows. All fear and unease are forgotten in an instant.
耀眼的闪光将浑浊的夜空一分为二，轰鸣的雷声斥退了鬼魅的细语。
所有的不安与惊恐，在此刻都被遗忘了。

Every head turns to the place where the lightning struck to see a colossal beast standing in solemn majesty. The crowd falls silent. Then, a single young voice cries out.
每一个人的目光都落在那雷光落下之处，凛然屹立着的巨兽身上。
街道鸦雀无声，直到一个稚嫩的嗓音惊喜地叫了出来。

Child: Mommy, look, it's Qiángliáng!
孩童：妈妈，我知道，那个是强梁！

The child raises a lantern excitedly.
他兴高采烈地高高举起手中的兽灯。

Child: It's just like the painting on my lantern.
孩童：看，一模一样，我一眼就认出来了！

The paper-crafted beast bears little resemblance to the mighty guardian towering in the distance.
那只纸扎的兽似虎非虎，鸱目蛇尾，圆滚滚的身材多少有些憨态可掬，乍一看实在与不远处那只威严的巨兽沾不上边。

Yet something in its stern, round-eyed face carries something of its righteous spirit. As the crowd shifts their gaze between the small paper lanterns and the guardian, their voices finally return.
但那怒目圆睁的兽面，仍然隐约透出一股与那只巨兽相似的凛然正气。
人们相继看向那小小兽灯与威严巨兽，终于取回了声音。

Enraged Man: You're right. It's the legendary Xiǎndào Beast. Look, it has the tail of a snake and the head of a tiger, just like the illustrations.
男子：咦，这么一说……真的很像是险道兽强梁！
你瞧，那尾巴，那老虎头，和书上画的一模一样！

Old Man: Has the legendary Qiángliáng come to save us? Does that mean that girl is its Zhènzǐ?
老者：难道是强梁神兽显灵，来救我们了？
这么说来，那个女孩就是这一代的侲子？

Woman: What are you two yapping about? Xiǎndào Beast? Zhènzǐ? Those are just fairytales. Didn't Mr. Zhōu say this was all part of a film shoot?
女子：怎么越说越玄乎了？什么险道兽、十二侲子……那都几百年没见过了？
老周不是都说了，这是拍戏呀！

Private Investigator: Th-That's right. I told you this was all for a movie. Why don't you guys believe me?
民间侦探：……对，对！不是和你们说了，这都是拍戏吗？
你们这些家伙，居然还不相信我！

Chinatown Resident: Come on, you're always full of hot air. That said, there's no way this is real. It must just be some fancy special effects. So I'll believe you this once.
唐人街居民：这……这还不是因为你这老头子平日里总是不着调嘛！
现在我信了，我信还不行嘛。

Tourist: Wait, so all those things were fake? I almost freaked out when those ghosts came out. Their costumes and makeup were so real-looking.
游客：所以……这些都是假的？老天，刚才那些像是鬼魂一样的演员出来的时候，真是吓死我了。我还以为真的出了什么事呢。

Tourist: Man, am I glad I came to Chinatown. This parade's been insane. I gotta take more photos.
游客：不过这效果可真是逼真！这次真是来对了，没想到唐人街的社火游行这么棒。我得多拍些照片！

The fear that once filled their hearts gradually fades. Those who understand the truth exchange knowing smiles.
人们纷纷议论起来，因突生异变而产生的那些不安与恐慌逐渐散去。
知情者们见状，不由得相视一笑。

An-an Lee: Whoa! That's Qiángliáng, huh? Looks totally awesome.
泥鳐的士：所以那就是险道兽强梁？
哇，够威风！

An-an Lee: I heard that a descendant of the Twelve Zhènzǐ joined the Vigiles Bureau, but this is the first time I've ever seen Qiángliáng in action.
泥鳐的士：我早听说夜巡特遣管理局去年来了一个十二侲子的后人，但还是第一次亲眼见到传说中的强梁大发神威。

Loggerhead: Phew, looks like they've got that actor lady under control.
空脑袋：看来梁和警长先生他们制服了那位演员小姐了，这下就没有问题了。

Loggerhead: Now all we need to do is grab that cursed film reel and break the barrier, and the victims will be sane again. It'll be happily ever after for everyone—
空脑袋：只要拿到了那盘“被诅咒的胶片”，我想我们应该就可以解除结界、释放它夺取的那些受害者的神智，让大家都恢复原状了——

Before she can finish speaking, her optimistic prediction is ruthlessly overturned.
这是一个乐观的推测。
未等她话音落下，它便被残忍地推翻了。

An-an Lee: What the ...? This again?!
泥鳐的士：咩鬼？这是刚才的……？

Loggerhead: Wh-What's going on? Didn't they finish the job?
空脑袋：发生了什么，不是已经解决了吗？

An anomaly even greater than the last crashes down upon them. Startled cries rise from the crowd.
比方才更甚的异象再一次侵袭了眼下的现实，尽管那看不见的风暴很快过去，但人群中仍然发出了不安的惊呼声。

Chinatown Resident: Look!
唐人街居民：看那边！

Chinatown Resident: Páifāng. Something's wrong with it.
唐人街居民：牌坊它……它好像不太对劲！

Something is very wrong indeed. What was assumed to be a mere optical distortion is now starting to seep into tangible reality.
那何止是不太对劲。那些映照在天空与远方的模糊虚影与扭曲影像，人们原本以为只是某种神秘术带来的视觉效果。

It is undeniably interfering with the physical world.
——但现在，它的的确确干涉到了触手可及的现实。

Loggerhead: I-Is that archway melting?
空脑袋：它……被分解了？

An-an Lee: It kinda looks like a burning piece of film.
泥鳐的士：看起来像是……像是胶片损坏了的影像一样！

They look at each other, finding the same alarm in each other's faces.
她们看向彼此，不约而同地在对方的眼中看到了愕然的惊慌。

An-an Lee: Wait, the barrier was created by that spooky film reel, right? Then, this means it's—
泥鳐的士：难道说，这个由胶片构筑的结界正在——

Loggerhead: It's falling apart. We need to get outta here.
空脑袋：它正在崩溃！这下糟了！

Deputy Chief Elden: Get everyone away from the edges of the barrier. The further they are from those twisting buildings, the better.
埃尔登警长：离开边缘区域！
把人们都往内侧带，不要靠近那些看起来出问题了的东西！

Private Investigator: Understood! But what the hell's going on? I thought you had the target locked down?
民间侦探：知道了！不过这到底是怎么回事，不是已经解决了吗？

Deputy Chief Elden: We do. But clearly, this isn't over yet. Ms. Latham, anything you can do?
埃尔登警长：我们正在调查！莱瑟姆小姐，你能否做些什么？

Loggerhead: Yes, sir! But I'll need a few of your men.
空脑袋：当然！
警长，请借给我一些人手！

Loggerhead: I can use the containment incantation they taught me at work, but I don't think it'll hold for long.
空脑袋：我能够施展神秘学藏品管理部教给我们的限制术式，但……我无法坚持太久！

Deputy Chief Elden: Just do your best. In the meantime, we'll eliminate the problem at the source.
埃尔登警长：我知道！
问题还是出在那盘胶片身上，我们会尽快从根源上解决这一切的！

Elden's furious gaze lands on Qí Xīng.
埃尔登愤怒的眼神指向倒地的奇星。

Deputy Chief Elden: Alright, Qí Xīng, whatever you're doing with the reel, stop it now, or I'll make you stop it.
埃尔登警长：……好了，奇星小姐，你也应当认清现状了。
无论你在做什么，立刻停下！

Qi Xing: I'm not doing anything.
奇星：我什么都没有做。

She stands, her hat a few feet away, her body slumped against the wall behind her as she barely manages to stay upright. She forces a crooked grin.
她的帽子掉了，狼狈地靠着身后的墙壁，才勉强能够站着。
面对埃尔登的咆哮，奇星艰难地扯起了嘴角。

Qi Xing: It's the film reel. It's reached its limit.
奇星：——是它已经到极限了。

From her coat, she pulls out the object responsible for all this chaos.
她从怀里取出了制造这一切异象的罪魁祸首。

Had Liáng not once held the film reel herself, she might not have recognized it at all.
若不是曾一度获得过那盘胶片，梁月恐怕完全无法认出它来。

Liang Yue: The Reunion of the Three Swallows? What's happening to it?
梁月：这是……“被诅咒的胶片”《三燕归巢》?
它发生了什么?

Liang Yue: Wait, there's something else here.
梁月：等等，这股气息是……

An-an Lee: No doubt about it! Evil spirits! An insane number of them!
泥鳐的士：——不会错，这是“邪祟”!
而且这个数量……根本匪夷所思!

An-an shoves through the crowd, rushing to Qí Xīng's side. With just one glance at the film reel, her face goes pale.
泥鳐的士匆匆挤过不明所以的人群，冲到奇星身边。
只看了奇星手中的胶片一眼，她便脸色大变。

Upon hearing An-an's words, Liáng's expression darkens.
听到泥鳐的士的话语，梁月的脸色也同样不好看。

Liang Yue: So you think so, too? We had a similar encounter at the City Hall not long ago.
梁月：李小姐，果然您也这么认为吗?
我们之前遇到过类似的情况。

Liang Yue: Mr. Wong must've lost some of his spiritual energy to the film reel, leaving his body open to wandering evil spirits.
梁月：那位在行政大厅中发狂的黄先生被《三燕归巢》影响，失去了部分的精神能量，所以才被那些游荡的魂灵乘虚而入。

Liang Yue: Since then, I've suspected that—
梁月：所以我一直怀疑——

The uneasy speculation lodges in her throat, but An-an voices it for her.
令人不安的猜测堵在口舌间，泥鳐的士替代梁月将它说了出来。

An-an Lee: Of course! Aiyah, I should've realized earlier.
泥鳐的士：是呀！我想漏了，居然没有提前意识到这一点!

The ghost hunter lets out a long, frustrated sigh, then furrows her brows in thought, her expression growing increasingly grim.
捉鬼人懊恼地长叹一声，随即拧起眉头作思索状，脸色越来越沉。

An-an Lee: Obviously, evil spirits would be attracted to the film reel. It's like leaving a pot of honey in front of a wasp's nest.
泥鳐的士：那些上了他身的东西，既然会被丢了“三魂七魄”的躯体吸引，那就更会被那些离开躯体的生魂吸引了!

An-an Lee: A living soul is a wandering spirit's favorite meal, so with the number of souls gathered in the film reel, it's like a total feast.
泥鰼的士：对它们来说，那可是最好味的饵料。这里不知道有多少被胶片吸来的生魂，当然会引无数孤魂野鬼过来了！

An-an Lee: All that evil spiritual energy must have the film reel bursting at the seams.
泥鰼的士：——这可不是这张小小的胶片能够承受得住的！

An-an scans her surroundings, alarm in her eyes. The collapse is approaching fast. It's as if reality itself is about to be swallowed whole.
泥鰼的士焦急地望向四周，“崩塌”的边缘越来越近，仿佛近在咫尺的现实即将被吞没。

Yet neither Liáng nor An-an can see a single wandering or evil spirit. A sudden realization strikes Liáng. Her gaze snaps to Qí Xīng.
但梁月和泥鰼的士并没有见到任何一个“生魂”或是“邪祟”的影子。
梁月猛地一惊，望向从方才起便一直沉默不语的奇星。

But upon seeing her, her eyes widen in shock.
——在她看清对方模样的那一刻，不禁大惊失色。

Liang Yue: Ms. Qí Xīng, your hand!
梁月：奇星小姐，你的手……！

Qi Xing: *cough* I must admit ...
奇星：咳……是啊。

Deep, jagged cracks have spread across the entire film reel and climbed up Qí Xīng's hand and arm like sinister veins.
那些撕裂现实的狰狞裂痕已经布满了整张胶片，一路攀上了奇星的手臂，令人触目惊心。

Qi Xing: The film reel isn't the only thing at its limit. I can't hold on much longer.
奇星：不仅是这张胶片，我也快到极限了。

The vessel containing Qiángliáng strapped around Liáng's waist starts to shudder. To Qiángliáng, the malevolent energy emanating from Qí Xīng must be eradicated.
梁月手中的祭器嗅到外溢的邪祟气息，开始躁动不安。
——在强梁的眼中，面前的女子正是应当被驱逐吞噬的“恶”。

Liang Yue: What does that mean?
梁月：那是什么意思……等等。

A thought flashes through Liáng's mind.
忽然间，一道灵光闪过，梁月产生了一个猜测。

Liang Yue: Could it be that the film reel has been out of control since the beginning?
梁月：难道说，“被诅咒的胶片”从一开始就失控了？

Qi Xing: That depends on how you define the beginning.
奇星：……这要看你如何界定“一开始了”。

Even though Qí Xīng avoids answering, Liáng knows she's right.
奇星并未正面回答她的问题，但梁月意识到她恐怕猜对了。

Scattered pieces of the puzzle find their place, and finally, the picture begins to form a whole.
纷繁杂乱的线索逐一找到了它们应当解开的锁，那些盘旋在她脑海中的疑云逐渐散开。

Liang Yue: Since the moment Ms. Latham played the cursed film, people have started to suffer from mental disorders. But if you think about it, the sequence of events doesn't make sense.
梁月：莱瑟姆小姐意外播放了胶片，它便在唐人街一带不断地制造受害者……但仔细想想，这件事本身就很奇怪。

Liang Yue: There were only five victims of the "film incident" in Hong Kong eight years ago. But this time, the number of victims was growing rapidly. That was until you got involved, Ms. Qí Xīng.
梁月：八年前在香港的事件中仅有五名受害者，但这一次在唐人街时，它却始终没有停下——直到胶片落入奇星小姐你的手上。

Liang Yue: Ever since you took possession of the film reel, only a small number of specific people have been targeted. We thought you were exploiting the reel's power to carry out your vigilantism, but in truth ...
梁月：随机发生的“映像事件”停止了，取而代之的是特定的目标遭到袭击。
我们当时以为是你借用胶片的力量，实现原定的袭击计划，但——

Liang Yue: You were trying to control the reel by limiting its victims to those you deemed as villains.
梁月：你只是在尽力控制胶片，将它制造的受害者，限定在那些“恶人”而非无辜者的身上。

Though disbelief still colors her voice, her words are not a question.
尽管语气中仍然带着难以置信的错愕，梁月的这一句话却并不是一个问句。

Elden and the others stare, caught between shock and suspicion, as they turn toward the woman they assumed was the true culprit.
一旁的埃尔登警长等人惊疑交加，同梁月一起，看向那个他们原本认为的罪魁祸首。

Deputy Chief Elden: Is that true?
埃尔登警长：……是这样吗?

Qi Xing: You flatter me, little vigil. I simply didn't want her legacy to become a tool of evil. That was never her intention.
奇星：执夜人小姐太抬举我了，我只是不希望好友留下的遗物，就这样成为作恶多端的邪物而已。这绝非她的本意。

Liang Yue: So that's why you did all this? You wanted us all at the parade because you were losing control of the reel?
梁月：所以你才做了这一切？在社火游行上将所有人都卷进来，是因为你已经逐渐开始无法控制胶片了？

Liang Yue: But isn't your goal to kill Ms. Noire? Was that also a setup?
梁月：可是你不是想要杀死菲林士多女士吗？难道那也是谎言？

Liang Yue: If the film reel wasn't part of your plan, then what was?
梁月：如果说利用胶片是临时起意，那么你原本的计划到底是——

Liang Yue: ...!
梁月：……!

A conclusion she herself once stated resurfaces in her mind, and she realizes she made a critical error.
一句曾经出自她自己口中的结论，重新浮现在了她的脑海中。
她意识到自己犯了一个巨大的错误。

Liang Yue: Ms. Qí Xīng still can't accept the way Ms. Noire ended Detective C07 III. That's her motive.
梁月：奇星小姐对《神秘警探 C07》最后一部的结局耿耿于怀，那就是她心中的执念。

Liang Yue: The ending consists of two major elements: the Shèhuǒ Parade and a villain who should've been punished.
梁月：那个结局有两个最重要的元素——社火游行，以及一个应当得到惩罚的恶人。

Liang Yue: She now sees Noire as that villain.
梁月：——恐怕在奇星小姐眼中，菲林士多女士就是那个人。

Liang Yue: Noire isn't the villain, is she?
梁月：……那个人不是菲林士多导演，是吗?

Liang Yue: In your perfect grand finale, the villain you intend to kill at the parade is none other than yourself.
梁月：为了完成你想要的那个“新的结局”，你打算在社火游行中杀死的那个“恶人”是你自己。

Qi Xing: It's a good ending for everyone. The big bad finally gets her comeuppance.
奇星：大家期望的结局，是穷凶极恶之辈得到应有的惩罚。

Qi Xing: And who better fits the role than me?
奇星：周围除了我之外，还有谁配得上这个名号?

Liang Yue: This is the grand finale you want to have? But why does it have to end like this?
梁月：我……我不明白，你为什么要这么做?

Qi Xing: Because this is the way it has to be.
奇星：因为我必须这么做。

Qi Xing: When a drop of ink falls onto paper, no matter how hard you wipe, it can never be spotless again.
奇星：就像一滴墨汁落在白纸上，无论用多少的清水去晕开、用颜料去覆盖都无济于事。它都永远无法恢复到纯洁无瑕的模样了。

Qi Xing: People say that "Every saint has a past, and every sinner has a future." Heh, what garbage. Some mistakes can never be forgiven.
奇星：人也是一样。
人们总说浪子回头金不换，但并不是所有的错误都能够被原谅。

Liang Yue: What happened to Hé Rìjūn was an accident. You shouldn't blame yourself for her death. It wasn't your fault.
梁月：你是说何日君小姐的事？但调查明明显示，她的死是一场意外，你没有必要为她的死如此苛责自己！你只是——

Qi Xing: But it was my fault. It was my stubbornness, my selfishness, that pushed my dear friend, who really, truly cared for me, toward the cliff.
奇星：只是沉溺在自己的偏执之中，一次又一次推开了真心关切自己的友人，对她的感受与想法视而不见。

Qi Xing: How can someone like me carry the title of C07? I don't deserve to stand in the spotlight ever again.
奇星：这样自私的人，怎么能够配得上 C07 的称号呢？又怎么能够再站在摄像机的面前?

Qi Xing: Heh, punishing those equally despicable pieces of scum made me feel better for a while, but it didn't last.
奇星：折磨那些同样令人作呕的渣滓，的确能够带来些许释放感与解脱感。
但那也只是暂时的。

Qi Xing: That sickening feeling inside, that disgust in myself, it wouldn't stop. I looked everywhere for a way to heal it. But then I realized ...
奇星：那种令人作呕的感觉始终如影随形，我四处寻找能够治愈自己的方法，但一直没有意识到——

Qi Xing: ... that the biggest piece of scum was me.
奇星：那个最应该得到惩罚的渣滓，就是我自己。

Qí Xīng looks up at the sky and lets out a long breath. For the first time, her expression softens, as if she has finally released a burden, and within her eyes, something new flickers—hope.
奇星望向天空，长舒了一口气。她的表情第一次放松了下来，充满了解脱感，那双始终昏暗的双眼中，甚至像是燃起了希望与期盼。

Qi Xing: The answer was so simple. I can hardly believe it took me so long to see it. And now, it's time to put an end to this nauseating nightmare.
奇星：这个再简单不过的答案，我居然花了那么久的时间才注意到。
现在，这种地狱般的日子总算能够结束了。

Liáng cannot understand it.
——而这让梁月完全无法理解。

Liang Yue: No, you're being too harsh on yourself. Hé Rìjūn doesn't blame you. I'm certain of it.
梁月：你没有必要这样的！你这样……对自己太严苛了！
我相信何日君小姐一定没有责怪你！

Qi Xing: Quit it, vigil. Look around you. Can you still claim that I'm not to blame?
奇星：收起你的那套话术吧，执夜人小姐。
她没有责怪我……你已经看到了这张胶片如今的模样，还能够这样说吗？

Liang Yue: I ...
梁月：我……

Noire: Well, I can. And let me tell you. Teresa was much stronger than you say she was.
菲林士多：——当然能。
你刚才的话，根本是对泰瑞莎的轻视。

Liáng turns to see Poitier helping Noire back into her wheelchair.
身后传来的另一个声音代替她回答了这个问题。
她转过头去，看到波蒂埃将菲林士多重新扶上轮椅后，推着轮椅向这个方向走来。

Noire: Yes, Teresa would cry often, but that made her no less determined of an artist, and before long she'd be at my door saying, "I made some edits. Take a look."
菲林士多：泰瑞莎的确是那种会自己在家偷偷抹眼泪的人——但每一次掉过眼泪之后，她都会重新振作起来，对我说“我又修改了一些，你看看这一版”。

Noire: You know that's what she was like. Do you seriously think she gave up dreams, her life, just because of a few harsh words?
菲林士多：明明这些你都也知道。但你却觉得泰瑞莎被说了两句之后，就放弃了她的梦想，放弃了她所热爱的生活？

Noire: No! I could never have a coward like that as a partner.
菲林士多：我可不会选择那样的胆小鬼做搭档。

Noire's face is twisted in a fury Liáng has never seen before. It sets a fire in the woman beneath her glare, making her frown in turn.
菲林士多的脸上写着梁月从未见过的愤怒。
这愤怒的火焰，点燃了她怒目而视的那人，让对方也拧起了眉。

Qi Xing: Whatever you say. Director or not, you can't tell me what to do anymore. I will have this ending.
奇星：随你怎么说。
这就是我想要的结局，这次我可不会听你的话了，导演。

Qi Xing: Come on, officers, finish the job. I'd do it myself if I had the strength.
奇星：——不要犹豫了，执夜人小姐、警长先生。
我已经没有了力气，否则也无需劳烦你们动手。

Her voice is unwavering.
她的语气斩钉截铁。

Qi Xing: I've learned a lot these past years. If you want to save this city, you'll have to kill me. Those spirits will disappear, and everything will be back to normal.
奇星：这么多年过去，我还是学了一些真东西的……只要杀死我，一切都会结束了。那些“不速之客”会和我一同被消灭，一切都会恢复原状。

Qi Xing: A perfect grand finale, isn't it? So, what are you waiting for?
奇星：一个圆满的结局，所有人都会满意，还等什么呢?

Deputy Chief Elden: Tsk, so it's come to this, has it?
埃尔登警长：……啧，该死。
只有这个方法了吗?

Elden swears under his breath as he reaches for the gun at his waist. Qí Xīng watches on, seemingly pleased.
埃尔登咒骂了一声，在奇星欣然的目光注视下摸上腰间的配枪。

Liang Yue: Wait, sir!
梁月：……等等，长官!

Lightning shoots through Liáng's body. Her feet, once nailed to the ground, suddenly feel weightless.
一股电流从上至下流经梁月的全身，她钉在地上的双脚忽然轻盈了起来。

She steps forward.
她向前踏出了一步。

Liang Yue: There's no guarantee that things will play out like Ms. Qí Xīng said.
梁月：没有任何证据能够保证，我们按照奇星小姐所说杀了她，事情就会解决。

Liang Yue: Please, let me try something. After all, exorcism is my and Qiángliáng's specialty.
梁月：请让我试试吧，毕竟驱逐鬼疫，吞噬邪祟——这可是我和强梁的专长!

Qi Xing: Wait, what are you—
奇星：等等，你要做什么——

Before either Elden or Qí Xīng can react, the film reel is already in Liáng's grasp.
未等埃尔登和奇星反应过来，那盘胶片已经被梁月抓在了手中。

Deputy Chief Elden: Liáng!
埃尔登警长：嘿，梁!

Poitier: You outta your mind or something?
波蒂埃：你在做什么?

Liang Yue: Yes, there are a huge number of evil entities bound within it.
梁月：……我能够感受得到，它的确吸收了太多不好的东西。

Liang Yue: And this is probably the most formidable opponent Qiángliáng and I have ever faced.
梁月：说实话，恐怕我和强梁从没有挑战过这样的对手。

Liang Yue: But I must confront this challenge.
梁月：——但让我试试看。

Liang Yue: Not to protect the honor of my family or to mimic C07, either. But because I want to. Because it's right.
梁月：这不是因为家族的使命，也不是为了模仿电影中 C07 的所作所为——而是因为我想要这么做。

Liang Yue: Every story has an ending, and I must act to create the best one for everyone.
梁月：所有的故事都必须有个结局……而我也有我想要的结局。

Liang Yue: Sorry, I don't have any flowery words or clever arguments, but if you're willing to help me ...
梁月：抱歉，这次我说不出什么义正辞严的大道理，只能给出这样任性的理由。
但如果你愿意的话——

Liang Yue: Please, Qiángliáng, heed my call.
梁月：——请回应我吧，强梁。

Liang Yue: Ugh!
梁月：呃……！

Liang Yue: Th-This isn't good. Is this the best I can ...
梁月：这可……不是什么好的迹象。
这样下去——

Liang Yue: ?!
梁月：?!

Liang Yue: Qiángliáng?!
梁月：……强梁?

Liang's Father: On the emperor's order, Fāngxiàngshì the Wise sought the assistance of the twelve gods of Shètí. Bestowed with their divine might, Fāngxiàngshì bound the creatures and turned their monstrous power to the service of the people. These creatures became known as the Xiǎndào Beasts, guardians of the perilous path.
梁父：……幸有大贤方相氏受天子之托，向十二摄提神请愿得巫舞之力，降伏恶兽、收为己用，更名为险道兽。

Liang's Father: However, even formidable creatures such as these couldn't defend against all the evil spirits across the continent.
梁父：然而险道兽一时能庇护的范围终究有限。彼时人间仍有诸多邪祟鬼疫肆虐，非人力所能敌。

Liang's Father: But the people never gave up, for they knew that as long as they kept fighting ...
梁父：但那时的百姓们却从未放弃过抵抗。因为他们知道，只要心怀希望与斗志到最后一刻——

Liang's Father: ... a Xiǎndào Beast would one day come to their aid, expelling the fiends and restoring peace and prosperity.
梁父：险道兽必将现身，逐除恶鬼、还人间一片太平。

Liang Yue: Qiángliáng, no!
梁月：等等，强梁——！

重映日
Rescreen SC-21

The storm clouds gradually disperse, and sunlight streams into the ward. In the corner, the television broadcasts a news report.
窗外盘踞在天空中的乌云逐渐散去，阳光洒入病房内。
角落电视机中，传来记者的新闻播报声。

Reporter: Last night, the Chinatown Shèhuǒ Parade drew hundreds as tourists and locals gathered for the Eastern spectacle.
记者：……唐人街的社火游行活动于昨夜举行。独具东方特色、神秘学气息浓郁的神偶巡街等活动，吸引了众多游客前来观看，场面热闹非凡。

Reporter: These photos, shared by an enthusiastic tourist, show the enormous holographic images that were created on-site using arcane skills to present a stunning performance of the Chinese folk tale, Qiángliáng's Exorcism.
记者：我们可以从参加者拍摄的照片中看到，在昨夜的社火游行中，主办方使用神秘术构建了巨大的立体映像，并上演了极其震撼的“强梁逐疫”的表演。

Reporter: The event has been deemed a well-organized success, with many promising to attend again next year. Locals have expressed their thanks.
记者：游客都对此次社火游行交口称赞，称明年仍然会前来参加。唐人街当地的居民们对此也表示十分欢迎。

Reporter: One spokesperson said, "It's been wonderful to share our culture with people from all around the world. Chinatown is always ready to welcome new friends from both near and far."
记者：被采访者称“很高兴和世界各地的人们分享自己的文化。希望更多唐人街外的人可以走进唐人街，希望更多唐人街内的人能够走出唐人街”……

Reporter: In other news, the arcane vigilante Nightpiercer, who has perpetrated dozens of attacks across the city, has been apprehended by the DAA.
记者：下面一则新闻。使用神秘术连续犯下数十起袭击案件的犯人，已被洛杉矶神秘学犯罪科逮捕归案。

Reporter: Nightpiercer was revealed to be Qí Xīng, a former Hong Kong movie star. Some members of the public have expressed continued support for the vigilante due to the questionable backgrounds of her victims.
记者：代号“针人”的该嫌犯真实身份为原香港影星奇星，由于其受害者大多劣迹斑斑，因此在民间亦有一部分支持其犯罪行动的声音。

Reporter: Deputy Chief Elden of the Division of Arcane Affairs gave his response:
记者：对此，神秘学犯罪科的埃尔登警长面对记者采访时表示——

Deputy Chief Elden: Vigilante justice is incredibly dangerous to our society. No individual has the right to bypass the law and enact their judgment on others.
埃尔登警长：将正义或是邪恶的判断交由个人是极其危险的，没有谁拥有决定另一个人命运的权力。

Deputy Chief Elden: Taking the law into your own hands will only lead to chaos, violence, and potential harm to innocent people.
埃尔登警长：如果每个人都依照自己的判断，肆意对自己所认为的“恶”动用私刑，我们的社会秩序将不复存在。

Deputy Chief Elden: We urge the citizens of Los Angeles to place their trust in us as we continue to dedicate ourselves to maintaining a safer society for everyone.
埃尔登警长：我保证，我们会始终竭尽全力，致力于让一切变得更好。
这正是我们的职责所在。

Deputy Chief Elden: If you share our passion for justice, we encourage all citizens to direct their assistance and feedback to the Division of Arcane Affairs.
埃尔登警长：但市民朋友们，如果你们也心怀正义与热情，和我们一样希望这个世界变得更好——我代表神秘学犯罪科，期待着来自你们的意见与帮助。

Reporter: The LAPD has just announced a plan to add a number of positions for Arcane Affairs Officers in the coming year to address the DAA's staffing shortage.
记者：洛杉矶警署发布公告，将于明年增加大量神秘学警察岗位，缓解神秘学犯罪科人手不足的问题。

Reporter: The St. Pavlov Foundation's Vigiles Bureau training program is also set to begin in the coming months. To apply, please dial—
记者：新一代的神秘学警察招募计划已经启动，圣洛夫基金会夜巡特遣管理局也将参与到培训计划当中，有兴趣的市民朋友可以致电咨询——

Hearing this news, the woman hops up joyfully and turns to the man sitting up in bed.
听到电视中的消息，女子欣喜地看向靠坐在床上的男子。

Woman: Hey, they're hiring Arcane Affairs Officers.
女子：哎呀，要招神秘学警察？这下可好了！

Woman: Hasn't it always been your dream to don the uniform? Looks like they accept older applicants, too. Why don't you give it a shot when you're better?
女子：你年轻的时候，不是就想要当警察吗?
刚好你还没有超过上面的限制年龄，等出了院，要不要去问问?

Enraged Man: Knock it off! I've been a greengrocer for twenty years. There's no way I could be a cop, right?
男子：乱讲什么呢！
我已经卖了二十年蔬菜水果了，事到如今，怎么可能做得了警察?

He waves off his wife, but as he does so, he turns to the man beside him with a nervous look on his face, expecting the idea to get shot down.
病床上的男子连连摆手，一边朝妻子挤眉弄眼，一边不安地望向床侧的另一名男子，料想他必然会破口大骂。

But the reaction he gets is unexpected.
但对方的反应却出乎他的意料。

Private Investigator: What are you staring at me for? If you wanna do it, just do it. I'm sure the neighborhood would be glad to see you wearing the badge.
民间侦探：……看我做什么？想做就试试呗。
有更多自己人穿上那身制服，街坊们遇到事情时，也会免去很多烦恼。

Private Investigator: Besides, I spent some time with the officers at the parade. I'm sure that you'll be just as capable as them. You're gonna have to toughen up a little, though.
民间侦探：我看他们那个警署里也有不少一把年纪，胳膊上却一道杠都没有的家伙。
你这老好人除了有时候太好说话外，没什么缺点，不一定比他们差。

Liáng, who has been watching the exchange, smiles.
一旁的梁月见状笑了笑。

Liang Yue: Mr. Wong, you're strong, healthy, and have a natural talent for arcane skills. With a little training, I'm sure you'll become an outstanding officer.
梁月：是呀，黄叔叔。我看您的身体很好，在神秘术方面也很有天赋，通过培训对您来说应当并不是一件不可能的事。

Liang Yue: There's a lot that goes into being an officer, but I believe what matters most is the heart to pursue justice and the courage to protect others.
梁月：成为警察并不容易，但也并没有那样困难——我想最重要的，是一颗向往公平与正义的心，以及保护他人的勇气与爱。

Liang Yue: The doctor said you can be discharged soon. You should seriously consider applying for the position.
梁月：医生说您的身体已经恢复，不久后便可以出院。
如果您有兴趣，不妨来试一试。

Enraged Man: Well, in that case, I'll think about it.
男子：这……既然小梁警官这样说，那我会考虑的。

Woman: Thank you so much, young lady. I heard you were the one who got rid of the curse and saved everyone.
女子：这次多亏了你了，姑娘！听说是你让大家伙都恢复了原样。

Woman: You're our hero.
女子：你是我们的大恩人呀！

She clasps Liáng's hand tightly in a warm grip. This time, her hand is steady. Liáng returns the handshake.
女子抓起梁月的手，热切地握住。
这一次她的手不再颤抖，梁月回握时也不再犹豫。

Liang Yue: You're too kind, madam. I was only doing my job.
梁月：您过奖了，这是我应该做的。

Liang Yue: And I didn't do it alone. It was a combined effort.
梁月：而且这也不是我一个人的功劳——是大家的。

Poitier: Well, that's that. No more cursed film crazies. Almost all the victims have recovered.
波蒂埃：这下放心了吧？我告诉过你了，那些因为被卷入《三燕归巢》制造的神秘学现象而精神失常的无辜受害者们，都恢复了原样。

Poitier: Most of them have already been discharged, too. Just a few poor saps who got hit harder still around, but they should be out of here before long.
波蒂埃：症状轻些的已经活蹦乱跳了，像里面那个倒霉鬼那样严重些的，状况也大为好转，想来再过段时间，就能恢复如初了。

Poitier: Same goes for the victims in the parade. They've all regained their Saam W-Wer—uh—what's it called again?
波蒂埃：奇星持胶片袭击的那些人也一样，他们丢失的——呃，你那个说法叫什么来着？

An-an gives a helpless sigh.
一旁的泥鳋的士无奈地摊了摊手。

An-an Lee: It's Saam Wan Chat Paak ah, madam. Just call it spiritual energy or something like that.
泥鳋的士：是“三魂七魄”啦，madam。
如果你实在记不住这个发音，就叫它“精神力量”或是“神智”就可以了。

An-an Lee: I heard that those crooks who were taught by a thing or two by Qí Xīng have also recovered, well, mentally lah. They're pretty physically messed up, so they'll have to stay here for a while, I think.
泥鳋的士：那些被奇星借胶片力量修理的坏家伙们也恢复了正常——不过，这里仅指他们的精神。那个靓女下手不轻，恐怕他们还要在医院躺一阵子呢。

Liang Yue: So many victims and not a single death. That's a blessing.
梁月：但至少最终在这一连串事件中，并没有出现死者……我想这是不幸中的万幸。

Poitier: Qí Xīng pulled her punches, apparently. I guess deep down she wasn't the "deliverer of justice" she claimed she was.
波蒂埃：那个偏执狂下手终究还是有分寸。
也许在心里，她其实从未真的傲慢地自诩为“正义的代言人”……

Poitier: Well, no use wondering about it. Years on this job'll quickly show you that the madness in arcanist blood always comes out in arcanist criminals.
波蒂埃：……算了，虽然我自己也是神秘学家，但做这行之后，你就会意识到那些血脉中的疯狂，往往会在神秘学家罪犯身上体现得淋漓尽致。

Poitier: Trying to understand them is a waste of time.
波蒂埃：试图理解他们从一开始就是无用功。

Liang Yue: That may be the case, but ...
梁月：也许吧，但……

Liang Yue: I think that if we look at each other as individuals, we can come to understand one another eventually.
梁月：我想人与人——或是个体与个体之间，只要愿意去尝试，我们仍然是可以无限趋近于相互理解的。

She takes out the brick-sized mobile phone she has carried with her since she was six years old.
她从口袋中掏出了那只从六岁起便随身携带、未曾离身的大哥大。

But now, its screen remains dark. No matter how much Liáng tries to summon the spirit residing within, there is no response.
但此时它的屏幕暗了下去，无论梁月再如何呼唤寄宿在其中的兽魂，都得不到半点回应。

Liang Yue: If we all try our best.
梁月：……只要愿意尝试。

Holding onto hope, Liáng tries a few different button combinations on the phone. Usually, the screen would light up, but this time, there is nothing.
怀抱着几分微薄的希望，梁月按下大哥大上的按键摆弄了一番。
它的屏幕会正常亮起，但按下拨号键时，听筒中只有死寂。

Poitier: Still nothing from Qiángliáng?
波蒂埃：……你的强梁，还是没有回应吗?

Liáng lowers her gaze and shakes her head.
梁月垂下眼眸，摇了摇头。

An-an Lee: Well, what did you expect? That huge spooky spookster was a nasty opponent on its own, not to mention all the ghosts that were attracted by that film reel.
泥鳋的士：这也难怪，那天的那个大家伙可不好对付。
那盘胶片本身虽然并不是什么特别有来头的东西，但无奈特性非同寻常。

An-an Lee: It was creepy lah. All those ghosts in one place. It was more crowded than the Dai Pai Dong, I mean, the Chinatown food stall on a Saturday night.
泥鳋的士：什么孤魂野鬼、魑魅魍魉……各路妖魔鬼怪，只要是能钻进那张胶片的都来了，人头比大排档都多!

An-an Lee: What's worse, those specters drained the Saam Wan Chat Paak of innocent people. If that hadn't happened, then Qiángliáng wouldn't have had to sac—
泥鳋的士：偏偏它们又裹挟了那些受害者们丢失了的“三魂七魄”，若是能够不管不顾地将其消灭，恐怕以险道兽强梁之能，还不至于搭上自己，但……

An-an cuts herself off. It would be too cruel to say these words in front of Liáng.
泥鳋的士没有将剩下的话说下去，那对于面前低落的见习执夜人来说，未免有些过于残忍了。

Liang Yue: Qiángliáng was lost because of my incompetence. I don't know how I'll be able to face my family now.
梁月：这下我真的将强梁给弄丢了，我都不知道该如何向家里人交代。

Liang Yue: And there's something else that's bothering me.
梁月：……但关于强梁最让我耿耿于怀的，是另外一件事。

Liang Yue: When Qiángliáng pulled in the evil spirits, I thought I was going to die with it, but it looked at me and pushed me aside. It bore everything, all alone.
梁月：那个时候，我还以为自己要死了。
但强梁它看了我一会儿，将我推开，独自去承担了一切。

Liang Yue: Why did it go to such lengths to help me? Because I'm its Zhènzǐ?
梁月：为什么它要帮我到这个地步？
仅仅因为我是它的侦子吗？

Liang Yue: The way it looked at me, I think it wanted to tell me something.
梁月：我不这么认为。
我总觉得那个时候，它有什么话想要对我说。

Liang Yue: But I didn't understand what.
梁月：……但我却读不懂，它想要和我说些什么。

Liang Yue: Qiángliáng had been by my side since I was six, but I always saw it as a heavy burden, or a double-edged sword.
梁月：从六岁起，它便理所当然般陪伴在我的左右，但我一直将它视作一种重负，一份责任，一件能够斩杀敌人、却也容易刺伤自己的利器……

Liang Yue: I never saw it as an independent individual or as a friend. I never tried to truly understand it.
梁月：却从来没有想过，强梁也会有它的想法。
我从来没有尝试去了解它。

Liang Yue: And now, I've probably lost the opportunity to ever understand it.
梁月：而现在也许一切都已经太迟了。

Liáng sighs and falls silent. The other two exchange a glance and simultaneously pat her on the shoulders.
梁月叹出一口气，不再言语。
一旁的二人见状对视一眼，不约而同地分别拍上梁月一侧的肩头。

An-an Lee: Come on, enough with the long face. Maybe Qiángliáng will respond to you one day lah. You never know! And I'm here if you ever need my professional ghostbusting service. Exclusive discount just for you ah.
泥鳐的士：别哭丧着个脸嘛，靓女！事情也许还有转机，我也会帮助你的。
我可是专业人士，如果是你的话，可以打折哦！

Poitier: Agreed. Isn't it a literal legendary beast that's existed for ages? No way it bit the dust just like that.
波蒂埃：要我说，你的那个强梁不是什么很厉害的古老神兽吗？
它肯定没有那么容易完蛋的。

Poitier: I bet it's recharging in its lair or something. Then it'll come back when it's full of juice again.
波蒂埃：也许只是耗尽了能量，回它的窝里充电去了。
过一段时间，你就能再见到它了。

Liang Yue: I hope so.
梁月：……希望吧。

She knows these are just comforting words, but their concern for her gives her the strength to move forward nonetheless.
她当然知道这些不过是毫无根据的安慰之辞，但二人的关切仍然带来了叫人重振精神的气力。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Oh, Poitier, there you are. And the ghostbusting girl and Liáng. Great!
神秘学警察 I： ——波蒂埃！还有梁，以及捉鬼人女孩，我可算找到你们了。

A familiar figure waves from the end of the hallway as she hurries over. Noticing Liáng's slightly surprised expression, she slows her steps.
熟悉的面孔向她们挥着手，从走廊尽头走来。
当她看到梁月略带吃惊的目光后，恍然慢下了脚步。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Oh, sorry, I mean Officer Liáng. But if you don't mind—
神秘学警察 I： 哦！我是说梁警官。
但如果你不介意的话……

Liang Yue: O-Of course, I don't. Just call me Liáng.
梁月： 当然不介意，您叫我梁就好。

Despite her swift response, Liáng still feels a little surprised when she sees the officer extend her hand toward her.
尽管立刻给出了肯定的答复，但在看到对方向自己伸出的右手时，梁月的心中仍然难免错愕。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Oh, where are my manners? Name's Jenny Carter. Just Jenny's fine. Unlike your instructor, I don't try to hide my appreciation of people.
神秘学警察 I： 自我介绍一下，珍妮·卡特，叫我珍妮就行。
我和你的这个大个子教官不同，对待欣赏的人可不会端着架子。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: I gotta say, you've done an awesome job. Folks at the department have all been talking about it. We're proud of you. Please tell me there's some way to postpone the end of your field training.
神秘学警察 I： 我们都知道了——你做得漂亮。很高兴能有你这样的人加入我们科，现在我们最不期望到来的就是你的实习截止日期了。

This is the second hand Liáng has shaken today.
这是今天梁月握住的第二只手了。

Liang Yue: Th-Thank you. That's very kind. Um. What brings you here?
梁月： ……谢谢，您过奖了。
您找我们是?

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Deputy Chief Elden, of course. Who else?
神秘学警察 I： 埃尔登警长让我来喊你们。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: Foundation staff have arrived. They're gonna take over Qí Xīng's interrogation and everything. They're gonna take the film reel back to their headquarters, too.
神秘学警察 I： 基金会的增援已经赶到，奇星小姐之后会交给他们那边负责协调审讯、定罪和量刑的事宜，那张让人头疼的胶片也会被带回基金会。

Arcane Affairs Officer I: But your request has been approved. We can watch Reunion of the Three Swallows before they take it away.
神秘学警察 I： ——但在那之前，你们的请求被同意了。
我们将会放映一次那盘胶片《三燕归巢》。

Division of Arcane Affairs, LA
洛杉矶·神秘学犯罪科

Deputy Chief Elden: For crying out loud, the DAA isn't a movie theater. Where'd all these people come from?
埃尔登警长：……该死，神秘学犯罪科的办公室可不是电影院，哪里来的这么多人？

Elden scans the group before him.
埃尔登的目光扫过面前的众人，不禁咒骂出声。

Noire: My apologies, sir. I invited them.
菲林士多：我很抱歉，警长先生，是我将各位喊来的。

Noire: This may be the only chance for Teresa's last work to be shown to the public. I want as many people to see it as possible.
菲林士多：泰瑞莎最后的作品在短时间内，恐怕只有这么一次展示在人前的机会了，作为她的好友，我希望能够有尽可能多的观众作为见证。

Noire: Every filmmaker wants their work to be shown to the world. I appreciate your understanding.
菲林士多：这是每个创作者的愿望，也是我的私心，还请您原谅。

Before Elden can respond, An-an cuts in.
埃尔登还想要说些什么，但被泥鳐的士抢了先。

An-an Lee: Come on, Ā sir, it's no big deal. Everyone here knows what really happened. We just want to know what the film's about.
泥鳐的士：有什么关系嘛，阿 sir！在这里的都是了解事件内情的人，我们也很想知道，那张胶片原本拍的东西到底是什么。

Private Investigator: Yeah, didn't you say something on TV about assistance and feedback? You'd be going back on your word if you ignored us now.
民间侦探：我可是在电视上看见了，“我代表神秘学犯罪科，期待着来自你们的意见与帮助”……难道说现在心怀正义与热情的市民，连点知情权都没有了？

Deputy Chief Elden: Hey, don't you go talking circles around me again.
埃尔登警长：周先生，你真是越来越巧舌如簧了啊，嗯？

Even in this harmonious scene, the two men can't help but bicker.
尽管不再像是过去那样充满了火药味，但二人间再次剑拔弩张了起来。

Poitier rolls her eyes. Luckily, the two are quickly interrupted by a woman in a Foundation uniform.
一旁的波蒂埃不禁翻了个白眼——但率先及时制止了这场争吵的，是一旁身着基金会制服的身影。

Foundation Staff: No need to worry, Deputy Chief Elden.
基金会职员：没关系的，埃尔登警长。

Foundation Staff: After thorough examination, we've determined that the film reel no longer possesses the ability to twist reality.
基金会职员：经过我们的检测，这张胶片《三燕归巢》在经由执夜人见习生梁小姐的术式处理后，如今已经不具备干扰现实的能力。

Foundation Staff: It was our negligence that allowed the film to be taken in the first place, so, as Mr. Zhōu said, the people deserve to know the truth.
基金会职员：这一次叨扰各位的事件与我们的工作失误逃不开干系，而正如周先生所说，各位当然拥有知晓事件真相的权力。

Foundation Staff: Besides, every viewer is required to sign this confidentiality agreement before entering the screening room. Alright, everyone, please hurry. The movie starts in fifteen minutes.
基金会职员：因此在签署保密协议后，诸位便可以先行进入房间。
放映将在十五分钟后开始。

An-an Lee: Oh, I'm pumped. No way I'm missing this. Gimme a pen.
泥鳋的士：——听着就像是“电影即将开场”一样，太棒了！
我可不会错过这个，算我一个。

An-an heads over to the desk, and the DAA officers and Chinatown private detectives follow suit.
在泥鳋的士第一个跳到办公桌前后，那些仍然在观望着的神秘学警察与来自唐人街的民间侦探们互相看了看，相继加入到了排在办公桌前的队伍之中。

Liáng and Noire, on the other hand, hang back. They already signed the confidentiality agreement. After all, they are the ones who drafted it.
但梁月与一旁的菲林士多并不着急，她们早就签署了保密协议——因为那份协议最初就是由她们草拟的。

Noire: You have my thanks, vigil.
菲林士多：谢谢你，执夜人小姐。

Noire: If it weren't for you, I doubt Ā Xīng and I would have had this chance to watch our good friend's swan song.
菲林士多：如果没有你帮助我一起争取，恐怕我和阿星并不一定能够获得这次观看泰瑞莎遗作的机会。

Noire: I also have to thank you for helping me stop Ā Xīng and for helping me keep my promise.
菲林士多：另外……我还必须感谢你帮助我阻止了阿星，帮助我守住了自己的誓言。

Liang Yue: Your promise?
梁月：誓言？

Noire pats her hands on her thighs.
菲林士多伸出手，抚摸自己的双腿。

Noire: Yes, I swore on these two legs.
菲林士多：是的，我曾经对着这双腿立下的誓言。

Noire: In the past, all I cared about was making the best film. I saw everyone, even my actors and writers, as tools to reach that goal. But I was wrong.
菲林士多：过去的我执着于追求“最好的电影”，将人放在其次……但那是错误的。

Noire: There's no such thing as a best film, only a better film. And to make a better film, I need a team around me.
菲林士多：这个世界上没有“最好的电影”，只有“更好的电影”。
而为了拍出“更好的电影”，我需要的是人。

Noire: What matters most is the people who make the film, not the film itself.
菲林士多：重要的不是“这一部”“那一部”的电影，而是拍电影的人。

She turns her head and looks toward the bolted door at the other end of the room.
她回头，向犯罪科深处的那扇房门望去。

Noire: But as long as we're living, there's still a future. Maybe I should hire a good lawyer for Ā Xīng. They can probably secure a shorter sentence.
菲林士多：只要还活着，就有未来。
也许我可以帮阿星请个律师，争取让她少判几年。

Noire: When she's free again, both physically and mentally, perhaps we can make a movie together, just like old times.
菲林士多：等到她出来……也许她会不愿意，但搞不好我们还可以合作。

Liáng is momentarily stunned.
梁月几乎是目瞪口呆。

Liang Yue: Are you sure? With all due respect, Ms. Noire, that will probably be a very long time from now.
梁月： 您的意思是还要找奇星小姐拍电影?
恕我直言，菲林士多女士，那恐怕会是很久很久以后了……

Noire: So? Even if we're old ladies by then, as long as we can still move, I'm certain we can make movies.
菲林士多： 谁说得准呢?
就算到时候我们都变成老奶奶了，只要能动弹，就能拍电影嘛。

Noire: Speaking of which, you'd make an excellent addition to my crew, Ms. Liáng. Don't hesitate to contact me if you reconsider your career choice.
菲林士多： 当然，我对梁小姐你也十分中意。
如果你今后有正式进军电影界的想法，请务必联系我。

Liang Yue: You're very generous, Ms. Noire. But I think I'll stick to being a fan for the time being.
梁月： 多谢您的赏识，菲林士多导演。但我想我还是停留在欣赏电影的层面就够了，短时间内我并没有转行的打算。

Liang Yue: I look forward to seeing what you do next.
梁月： 不过我倒是很期待您的下一部作品。

Noire: You won't be disappointed.
菲林士多： 它不会让你失望的。

Noire: By the way, have you seen Ms. Latham lately? I tried to invite her, but she didn't pick up the phone. She must've left it in her room again.
菲林士多： ……说起来，你见到莱瑟姆小姐了吗?
我邀请了她，但她并没有接电话，想来是又把手机忘在房间里了。

Liang Yue: Actually, I ran into her at the hospital earlier. Ms. Scott just regained consciousness. She wanted to visit her.
梁月： 我刚才在医院碰到了她。斯考特小姐恢复了意识，她急匆匆地前去探望了。

Noire's smile fades slightly, and a contemplative expression comes over her.
听到梁月的回答，菲林士多收起了笑容，露出了若有所思的表情。

Noire: Ms. Scott ... Something tells me that there's still an unsolved mystery there.
菲林士多： 那个女孩，斯考特……
我始终觉得，她的身上还有什么我们没能挖掘出来的秘密。

Liang Yue: You mean a truth hidden behind all these incidents?
梁月： ……您是指您之前提到过的，这一系列事件背后的隐情?

Noire: Yes. Like a chessboard, we are the pawns placed on the front line. Somehow, we've managed to fight our way out, escaping our planned doom.
菲林士多： 是啊。如果用象棋来比喻，我们就像是“兵”，巧攻渡河，因此逃离了原本被规划好的路线，得了一条生路。

Noire: But who is the player who placed us there? They're still a mystery, watching us from the shadows. I don't like this feeling.
菲林士多： ——但我们还是没能看到在这盘棋上对弈的执棋人。
我不喜欢这种感觉。

Liang Yue: I'll keep an eye on the matter.
梁月： ……我会持续关注这件事的。

Liang Yue: I already made a detailed report to my superiors. If there's anything else going on, I'm sure the Vigiles will put a stop to it.
梁月： 这起事件随后将会交给正式执夜人来负责，如果背后还有什么阴谋，想必他们也一定能够发现。

Noire: I suppose we'll have to wait and see.
菲林士多： 希望如此。

Noire's expression does not ease. It seems the title Vigiles Bureau doesn't bring her much confidence. Before Liáng can inquire further, Poitier calls her.
菲林士多的表情并未舒展，似乎“夜巡特遣管理局”的名号并没能带给她更多的信心。梁月心生疑惑，正欲追问，却听到波蒂埃的招呼声。

Poitier: Hey, you two, get your asses in the screening room. We're all waiting for you.
波蒂埃： 嘿，梁！还有菲林士多导演，大家都已经搞定了，就等你们就位后开场了。

Liang Yue: On our way.
梁月： 这就来！

Noire: Nothing's more important than a movie that's about to start. Let's go, vigil.
菲林士多： ……没有什么事情比一场即将开演的电影更紧要的了。
我们走吧，执夜人小姐。

They exchange a smile and enter the makeshift theater together.
她们相视一笑，走向那间临时的影院。

散场之后
After the Show 小径

This place was once known for its inexhaustible mines, the riches of its rainforests, and its brave and passionate people. But now, the first two are gone.
???: 这个美丽的地方曾经享有着号称永不枯竭的矿产、大地之肺的雨林与热情勇敢的人民，而现在他们只剩下了第三者。

Chaos and power struggles loom over the younger generation, while the rich and well-connected sit atop their piles of corpses and rubble and feast. Dining off golden plates with silver spoons, turning their noses up from the dogs at their feet.
???: 混乱和割据夺走了年轻人的美梦，而既得利益者总以为自己仍旧坐在巨大的金山上，殊不知那下面全是烂头骨、彩色瓦砾和携带病菌的老鼠。

But that gold has lost its shine and their silver spoons have tarnished, everyone can see them for what they really are. So, what now? Either the people save themselves or turn their fate over to the hands of the so-called "savior." What would you do, if it were you?
???: 镀金的遮羞布已然脱落，内里的草絮正朝所有人诉说着贫瘠与困窘，现在人们面前有两条路——自救，和加入所谓的“拯救”。我就此来咨询你的意见。

选项 / Choices

1. I'd save myself first.
1. 先自救，再救人

2. So, why can't this "savior" save me?
2. “拯救”不能救自己么?

分支 1 / Branch 1

That's a smart choice. Now that the carnival's over, people have to deal with more than just their hangovers—they must figure out how to save their own skins.
???: 保全自己，很明智。狂欢的宿醉后，异常虚软无力的身躯发出警告。每个人都不得不抬起被橡木塞堵满的浮肿头颅，拼了命地想一个自救的法子。

Most though will just run around like chickens with their heads cut off, begging for their pain to be taken away. But all they'll get is another morphine shot—nothing close to a real solution.
???: 于是人们开始盲目奔走。粗大的针管扎进了他们的心脏，他们以为那是一管强心剂，实际上是盐酸和吗啡。

Fear spreads like a disease. Until an entire generation is out on the streets, hoping to find anything that will lift them out of their misery.
???: 当某个倒霉蛋因生计而累垮时，名为迷茫与躁动的瘟疫开始传播。时至今日，流氓与赤贫者四处可见，结果没有人能救下这一带，以及这整一代人。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Who's asking the questions here, me or you? But fine, I'll clue you in a little about this "savior".
???: 请不要用问题回答问题，这不符合交流守则。但这次我会回答你。

I once met a kid from Buenos Aires who told me about the "hand of god" that gave them the World Cup. He saw it as proof there was a higher power, something men should follow and seek protection from.
???: 我曾听一个来自布宜诺斯艾利斯的孩子谈起“上帝之手”。他说那是光荣的行径，是伟力的显现，是对于外来者的惩罚。

Maybe he had a point, I don't know. Maybe there's truly something greater out there, or maybe it's just what we mortals need to believe.
???: ……好吧，见鬼。来吧，看看那帮以光荣与伟力自居的家伙都干了些什么好事儿。

These men from the Apostles Brotherhood used to be regular church-goers just like anybody else. But faced with an opportunity to rise above their own cruel realities, they all too readily turned away.
???: 他们曾是具象的虔诚，天国的投影。漫无目的地行走耗尽了他们的心智，一旦新的神迹显现，他们便如释重负地低下头，将灵魂交由了新的主。

They left their old altars and took communion with a new god. Will this new path save them? Is it worth all their efforts? I can't say.
???: 从雄壮的宗教支派沦为外来势力的附庸，这段短暂而可悲的历史为他们带来的唯一价值就是虚无的认同感，就像试图吞枪自尽的俘虏，发现敌人根本没给他留哪怕一小粒弹片。

But you wanted to know if this 'savior' can save its own. Well, I guess you've got your answer now.
???: 冠以“天使”之名的并非真正的天使，他们无法向世人许诺任何东西，愚蠢至极。

选项 / Choices

1. Are we going to be alright?
1. 现在能救我了么?

No need to start panicking just yet. Things are still under control. Your lady friend has stepped up to solve this mess, and the veteran knows what he's doing.
???: 不必担心，事态还在可控范围内，你并非无计可施。勇敢的绿裙小姑娘已经挺身而出，而半退休的老兵也有自己的谋划。

This city is unlike any you've seen before. You must learn its secrets to survive—remember which street kids are from which alley and what intel they can be relied on for, learn the dates when the dealers bring their "medicine" into port, and figure out which water tanks hide the key to the local gang's safehouse.
???: 这地方和你待过的任何一座城市都不一样。你得看清并抓住能利用的一切——比如可作为情报员的孩童喜欢聚在哪儿踢球，比如交易药物的邮船常在几月份靠岸，比如哪只蓝色的蓄水缸下面藏着帮派安全屋的钥匙。

Don't look at me for answers. It's none of my business.
???: 还有，提醒你一下，我不是你的助手，不会替你做这些事，你得自己去解决。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Excerpt from the New York Times
《纽约新闻报》节选

英文 / ENGLISH
Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson
中文 / CHINESE
前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。
于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。
火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

无署名访客
Anonymous Visitor SC-22

Hospital
医院

Loggerhead: Scott's ward, Scott's ward. Did I take a wrong turn?
空脑袋：斯考特……斯考特……奇怪，难道不是这个方向吗?

Loggerhead: Oh, excuse me, doctor. Could you tell me where Constance Scott's ward is? I'm kinda lost.
空脑袋：抱歉打扰一下，请问康斯坦丝·斯考特的病房是在哪里?
我有些迷路了……

Doctor: You're in the wrong area. You need to go straight forward this way, take a left at the corner, and a right at the next.
医生：哦，那间病房并不在这个区域。
您需要从这里向前走，在拐角处左拐，再在下一个拐角处向右。

Loggerhead: Forward, left, then right. Okay. I'll remember it now. Thanks for the help.
空脑袋：向前，向左，再向右……好的，我记住了。
谢谢您!

Doctor: Sure.
医生：不客气。

Loggerhead makes her way down the hallway, muttering the directions to herself as she goes.
身着亮黄色外套、顶着显眼机械脑袋的少女道过谢后，口中不断重复着方才得知的路线，迈步走开。

But then, she stops and turns back in confusion.
——但她走到一半，忽然停下了脚步，疑惑地回头看了一眼。

Loggerhead: Hm, that's odd. Why do I feel like I talked to that doctor a few days ago?
空脑袋：奇怪。
刚才的那名医生，我是不是曾经和她说过话?

Loggerhead: Must just be my bad memory. The lady last time was more friendly.
空脑袋：……不对，应该是我又记错了吧?
上次的那位女士应该更温柔一些。

She tilts her head before quickly, deciding to let it go.
绰号“空脑袋”的少女歪了歪头，很快决定将这个小小的疑问从大脑中清空出去。

Loggerhead: Wait, which way did she say again?
空脑袋：等等!
她刚才说怎么走来着?

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Sorry, doctor, it isn't time for the routine checkup yet.
神秘学警察 II：抱歉，医生。
但如果我没有记错，现在还不到要例行检查的时间?

Doctor: You're right, but yesterday's medical report showed some concerning fluctuations in the patient's data.
医生：是呀。昨天的体检报告出来了，数据上有一些波动。

Doctor: It's probably nothing serious, but we should conduct a clinical check on the patient just in case.
医生：虽然可能并无大碍，但我们还是需要确认一下病人的状态作确定。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Please wait a moment. Let me verify this with your superior.
神秘学警察 II： 请稍等，我向您的上级确认一下。

Doctor: Of course, officer. You can never be too cautious, especially when the patient's involved in a sensitive case.
医生： 我理解，警官。
没有什么比小心谨慎行事更重要的了，毕竟里面的可是重要的案件相关人员。

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Yeah. Thanks for your un ... der ...
神秘学警察 II： 是啊。
多谢您的理……解……

Arcane Affairs Officer II: Ugh ...?
神秘学警察 II： 唔……?

The patient inside the ward hears the conversation outside the door come to an abrupt halt.
隔着门板传来的对话声，中断在了一个并不自然的位置。

She sits with her hands cuffed to the railing, turning her head away from the window and toward the closed door before her.
病床上双手被铐在栏杆上的患者本百无聊赖地盯着窗外，但意识到这一点后，她不禁收回目光，望向紧闭的房门。

Scott: What's wrong?
斯考特： ……怎么了?

There is no response from the other side.
门外不再传来声音。

Several seconds later, the doorknob turns. Standing in the doorway is a doctor. She looks vaguely familiar.
数秒后，门把转动，她病房的房门被轻轻地打开。
站在门口的是一个她隐约有些印象的普通医生。

Doctor: Good afternoon, Ms. Scott. How are you feeling today?
医生： 您好，斯考特小姐。今天您感觉如何?

Arcane Affairs Officer II: ...
神秘学警察 II： ……

Before the door is closed again, Scott catches a glimpse of the Arcane Affairs Officer staring straight ahead. He doesn't so much as glance in her direction.
但在门被重新关上之前，斯考特瞥见站在门口的神秘学警察直视着前方，没有分给这个方向半点余光。

Something is wrong. Scott shoots up straight.
——有什么地方不对劲。斯考特立刻直起了身子。

Scott: Who are you?
斯考特： 你是谁?

Doctor: Someone brought you these flowers.
医生： 有人让我给您送来这束花。

Scott: Flowers?
斯考特： 花?

Only then does she notice that the doctor is holding a glass vase filled with pure white flowers, fresh and delicate.
她这才注意到女医生的手上捧着一只玻璃花瓶，插在里面的白色花束洁净无瑕，清新动人。

Scott: No. Something's not right.
斯考特：不对……这太奇怪了。

Scott: I heard what you said to the officer. How are you supposed to do a medical check with a flower ...
斯考特：我听到你和那个警员的对话了，刚才你还说你是来给我检查身体状况的，但拿着一只花瓶要怎么检——

Scott: ... vase ...
斯考特：……查……

Scott: ...
斯考特：……

Scott vaguely hears her own voice being swallowed, but somehow, she doesn't care. All her attention is locked on the vase.
斯考特隐约听到自己的声音也被吞没了，但她无暇顾及。
因为她的全部注意力，都伴随着她的视线钉在了那只花瓶的身上。

Not the flowers, but the vase itself. At first glance, it looked like any other glass item. But now that it's under the sunlight, it is shimmering like crystal, refracting dreamlike colors around the ward.
不是花，而是花瓶。明明看起来只是寻常的玻璃制品，在阳光的照射下，却如同水晶般美丽，折射出梦幻般的色彩。

Scott: Is this ... crystal?
斯考特：就像是……水晶……？

A barrier blocking off her memories suddenly bursts.
头脑中阻隔着一部分记忆的高墙，如同肥皂泡般“啵”的一声破碎、消失。

Scott: It's you, madame.
斯考特：……是您，女士。

Scott: You said you wouldn't contact me unless something bad happened. Is there something wrong with the object you bought?
斯考特：您说过除非出了什么意外，否则您不会再联系我了。
是出了什么事吗？是出售给您的那样东西有什么毛病吗？

???: No, it is perfect. You have been of superb help.
???：不，它很完美，你帮了我大忙。

Scott: It was my honor to serve you, madame. And I must say, you have incredible foresight.
斯考特：这是我的荣幸，女士。
另外我必须要感叹您的高瞻远瞩，您真是料事如神。

Scott: The Vigiles caught me, but they couldn't get any useful information, because I can't remember any.
斯考特：我失手了，被夜巡特遣的人抓住了……但他们并没有问出什么东西，因为我根本不记得。

???: But you still seem to be in a rather precarious situation.
???：但你看起来仍然身处麻烦之中。

Scott: Y-Yes, but you needn't worry. I can handle this myself.
斯考特：呃，是的……但您不用担心！
我会想办法解决的，这点小事，不用劳烦您。

???: That is good to hear.
???：那就再好不过了。

The other end of the communication incantation falls silent. If not for the light still refracting from the vase, she might have thought the other party already hung up.
传信术的对面不再传来声音了。若不是自花瓶中仍折射出令她隐隐头晕目眩的光，她也许会以为对方已经切断了这仅被允许单方面发起的通讯。

Scott: By the way, I met Matilda not long ago.
斯考特：对了！前些天，我还遇到了玛蒂尔达小姐。

Scott: She was worried about you. Have you not contacted her?
斯考特：她……很担心您。您并没有将您的近况告知她吗?

???: That is not necessary.
???：没有这个必要。

???: Were she more perceptive, she would have already discovered me herself. She will find me when she's ready.
???：如果她能更坚强和更敏锐一些，那么她便能够自己发现。

The voice on the other side shows little interest in the topic.
对方听上去并不如斯考特所想的那样，对这个话题感兴趣。

Scott smirks to herself but struggles to find another excuse to prolong the conversation.
这让斯考特在心中窃喜，却也不得不绞尽脑汁，寻找着下一个能够多少延长这场对话的借口。

But her moment has already passed.
——但实际上，已经没有这个必要了。

Scott: Hm?
斯考特：……嗯?

The colors twist, and her consciousness begins to spiral.
视野中的色彩扭曲了，意识开始旋转。

Scott: *sigh* What was I doing again?
斯考特：我要……做什么来着?

???: I am contacting you to express my gratitude.
???：我这次联系你，是为了向你表示感谢。

???: Thank you very much, Ms. Scott. And please believe me, you are far more gifted than you think.
???：谢谢你，斯考特小姐。
同时请相信我，你绝不像是你内心自认为的那样愚钝。

The woman's voice rings out from a particularly distorted and colorful spot in the room. It is elegant, dignified, and strangely familiar.
从房间中某处色彩与光线不自然地扭曲的位置上，传来一名女子的声音。
清雅，高贵，似曾相识。

Scott: Wh-Who are you?
斯考特：你是……?

The voice does not answer.
那个声音没有回答她。

???: However, those black dogs have a keener sense of smell than I thought. I'm afraid our relationship has come to an end.
???：但那些黑色猎犬的鼻子比我想象中的还要灵敏。
我想我们的关系就要到此为止了——因此这一次，我也是来道别的。

???: Goodbye, Ms. Scott.
???：再见了，斯考特小姐。

Scott: Huh? W-Wait!
斯考特：等等——

A bullet shatters the vase, shattering the dream and crashing her back to reality.
子弹将玻璃花瓶击成了碎片，梦与现实一同破碎，撒落一地。

At some point, the door was silently opened. A pair of black leather boots steps over the shards of the broken vase and comes to a stop at Scott's bedside.
病房的房门不知何时，已经悄无声息地打开了。一双黑色的皮靴踏着碎落满地的花瓶碎片，来到昏厥的斯考特病床前。

Black Ibis: Ha, they run fast, that's for sure. Looks like this fish is bigger than we thought.
黑鹮：跑得还挺快。
看来这条鱼比我们想象中的还要大。

Black Ibis: Have you figured out what happened to the two officers?
黑鹮：怎么样，他们两个情况如何?

The woman turns to her cadet.
身着漆黑制服的女子回过头，看向身后的副手。

A man, also dressed in the same black uniform, is dragging the unconscious body of the doctor who visited earlier beside that of the DAA officer who had been keeping guard outside.
同样身着漆黑制服的男子，正将方才造访这间病房的医生，与原本守在门外的神秘学警察扶到一旁。
他们同样已经陷入了昏睡。

Black Ibis's Cadet: They're under some kind of hypnosis. Caster's no amateur, either. Arcane fluctuations are impossible to trace.
副手：中了某种催眠术，施术者水平相当高，无法回溯，恐怕查不出来什么。

Black Ibis: Not bad. Not bad at all.
黑鹮：哦？不错……相当不错。

She crouches down to pick up a shard of glass. As she examines it, her mouth curls into a smile.
女子俯身捡起地上的一片玻璃碎片，勾起唇角连连点头。
这引发了一旁副手的不满。

Black Ibis's Cadet: Not bad? This is really bad. We already knew Scott was the culprit, but you just had to use her as bait to "reel in the fish hiding in the darkness."
副手：还不错呢？这一次费了这样大的周章，明明早知道斯考特就是犯人，还非要将计就计，用她引出什么“背后的人”……

Black Ibis's Cadet: Now all we have is Scott with no memories of what happened and a stone-cold trail. Truly genius!
副手：这下好了吧！
斯考特让那个罪魁祸首消除了记忆，这条线等于是断了。

Black Ibis's Cadet: And I still don't get why you're keeping all this from Liáng. She's your cadet and right here in the city. We should've had her join the investigation.
副手：而且我早就说过，没有必要特意瞒着梁。她也是你带的学徒，既然她刚巧在洛杉矶这边实习，让她协助我们显然是个更好的主意。

Black Ibis's Cadet: Ha, I can't wait to see her face when she finds out what's been going on. And I'm not defending you this time, either.
副手：哼，我到时要看看，等她知道这一切的来龙去脉后，你要怎么和她交代！
话说在前面，这次我可不会为你说好话了。

Faced with her cadet's accusations, the woman feigns innocence.
面对副手的指责，女子却一脸无辜。

Black Ibis: Defending me? There's nothing to defend.
黑鹮：什么怎么交代?
这些都是对她的考验呀。

Black Ibis: If we'd told her about our plan, she would've started acting differently and spooked our fish.
黑鹮：我们的计划原本就是“引蛇出洞”。若是告诉了梁，她的行动就必然会出现不自然的地方，搞不好就会打草惊蛇。

Black Ibis: Besides, the whole point of her field training program in the LAPD was to see if she could handle things on her own. And she's proven that she can.
黑鹮：再说本来这次的实习项目，考察的就是她是否能够在没有其他执夜人支援的情况下独当一面——而她也通过这次的事情证明了，她可以。

Black Ibis: The Division of Arcane Affairs seems to adore her, so I'm sure the Deputy Chief will give her an excellent write-up. Everything's turned out great, hasn't it?
黑鹮：我看那些神秘学犯罪科的家伙挺喜欢她的，那个警长嘴上不说，最后一定也会给她个不错的评价。这不是挺好吗?

Black Ibis: See how considerate I am? How I always do things in my cadets' best interests? How could you make me out to be such a heartless, irresponsible monster?
黑鹮：唉，作为她的导师，我可是用心良苦。
你不要把我说得像是什么不负责任的人一样呀。

She exaggerates a sorrowful expression, which only makes her cadet roll his eyes in exasperation.
女子装模做样地摆出了一副痛心的表情，这让她的副手没忍住翻了一个白眼。

Black Ibis: Oh, don't give me that look. Anyway, I think I've got an idea as to what's going on.
黑鹮：别这样嘛，这次的事件我已经有头绪了。

Black Ibis's Cadet: Really?
副手：……你的意思是?

The woman drops her act and smiles knowingly.
女子收起了方才胡闹的神色，扬起嘴角。

Black Ibis: Our big fish got away, yes, but just confirming that a fish this big exists has already made this worth our time.
黑鹮：这是一条大鱼，我们的线不够结实，让那家伙跑了——但光是确认了这塘池子里有这么一条庞然大物的存在，这次就已经收获颇丰了。

Black Ibis: Now, back to the stolen arcane items. There are five in total, including the cursed film reel and the wind-up toy that the Timekeeper shattered.
黑鹮：包括这次将唐人街弄得天翻地覆的那盘胶片，以及那个在圣保罗被司辰打了个稀巴烂的发条玩具，一共有五件神秘学管理品失窃。

Black Ibis: Tell me, Bob, does our fish need all five arcane items?
黑鹮：告诉我，鲍勃。
你觉得我们在追查的那名幕后黑手，是这五个东西都需要吗?

Black Ibis's Cadet: It's Alan, not Bob. How many times do I have to tell you?
副手：我叫阿兰，不叫鲍勃!
你到底什么时候能够记住?

Black Ibis's Cadet: And to answer your question, no, I don't think so. The wind-up toy's already been destroyed, and the film reel's been recovered by a fellow cadet.
副手：……我的答案是，不。那个发条玩具已经报废，这次的胶片也成功被我那名前途无量的小师妹回收。

Black Ibis's Cadet: These items did cause a few problems, but I don't see any common thread between the incidents they caused.
副手：它们的确惹出了不少麻烦，但我看不出它们引发的事件之间有什么共通之处。

Black Ibis: Correct, Brian. Those two items were probably just decoys to divert our attention.
黑鹮：你说得对，布莱恩。
它们明显是陪跑，是障眼法，是无关紧要的弃子。

Black Ibis's Cadet: Again, it's Alan.
副手：我叫阿兰。

Ignoring her cadet's correction, she goes on.
女子没有理会副手的纠正，继续侃侃而谈了下去。

Black Ibis: A clever fish knows how to muddy the waters to hide itself. Of the five objects, they probably only need one.
黑鹮：夫藏木于林，人皆视而不见……
我们的幕后黑手在那五件东西之中，真正想要的恐怕也只有一件。

Black Ibis: Take a guess, Buck. Which one do they need?
黑鹮：猜猜看，巴克。最有可能的是哪一个?

Black Ibis's Cadet: It's Alan! A-L-A-N! There isn't even a single B in it.
副手：我叫阿兰，不是 B，是 A……

The cadet sighs, half in reluctance, half in realization.
副手一边无奈地反驳，一边思索了起来。

Black Ibis's Cadet: Well, out of the three, which one is—Wait, could it be?!
副手：剩下的三件物品中最有可能的……等等，难道是?

Black Ibis: Bingo.
黑鹮：你猜对了。

From the way her cadet's face darkens, she can tell he has found the answer.
她从自己副手瞬间难看起来的脸色中，判断出对方找到了那个答案。

Black Ibis's Cadet: Does that mean the legend's real? It can really be used in "that" ritual?
副手：但那个传说是真的吗？它真的能够用在“那个”仪式中?

Black Ibis: It would seem so.
黑鹮：现在看来，恐怕是的。

Black Ibis's Cadet: So, it's Manus Vindictae again.
副手：……所以，是重塑之手。

He speaks the name, his expression grim.
他念出那个名字，表情凝重。

Black Ibis's Cadet: They must've planted a mole somewhere among the Foundation's elites, someone with clearance to the Arcanum Containment Department.
副手：至少是能够查阅到神秘学藏品管理部档案，甚至是能够拿到藏品管理部防护术式机密文件的基金会高层中——有重塑之手的人。

Black Ibis: Hm. It seems our fish doesn't wear the black robe.
黑鹮：这倒不一定。

The woman taps her chin. This response makes her cadet's eyes widen in disbelief.
女子摸了摸下巴，给出了一个令自己的副手再次大跌眼镜的答复。

Black Ibis's Cadet: Huh? So you're saying there's someone behind all this who wants to perform "that" ritual and somehow has the means to steal from the Foundation? There's just no way.
副手：什么？可……难道除了他们之外，还有其他势力有动机举行“那个仪式”，同时具有从基金会的眼皮底下盗走东西的能力？我实在不这么认为。

Black Ibis: The stolen items would probably go to the Manus eventually, but I have a hunch that our wily fish isn't totally on their side.
黑鹮：东西应当最终是要去向重塑之手没错，但我们的这只老鼠……我想他，或是她却不一定完全和重塑之手站在同一阵线。

Black Ibis: Manus Vindictae obviously considered the succubus a valuable asset before she got away, right?
黑鹮：重塑之手一度相当重用那个用发条玩具唤出的恶魔，明眼人都看得出她的价值。

Black Ibis: So if our fish was a die-hard loyalist, they would've delivered the wind-up toy to their master straightway, rather than letting it be passed around all over the place.
黑鹮：如果我们的嫌疑人完全效忠于重塑之手，那件封印物就不会辗转一番才来到启明会的人手中了。

Black Ibis: While our fish is in collusion with Manus Vindictae, they're swimming in murky waters. They may be pursuing their own agenda.
黑鹮：虽然与重塑之手有所勾结，但我们追踪的那位恐怕亦有着自己的目的。

She curls her lips into a smile and flicks the shard of glass from between her fingers.
女子扬起嘴角，将手中的那枚玻璃碎片弹飞。

Black Ibis: Things are starting to get interesting, aren't they?
黑鹮：事情开始有趣起来了，不是吗?

Black Ibis: Like I said earlier, not bad at all.
黑鹮：所以我才说——这相当不错。

With that, the two figures in black vanish out the door.
片刻后，两个黑衣人的身影从病房中消失了。